

Akelius Quiz Cards

World history

80 topics · 400 cards · English

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Text and pictures: Jonas von Essen

How to read this file

- Each page is one card. The left part is the front: clue text, picture, question and four answers. The right part is the back: the answer, word explanations and a second picture.
- The correct answer is marked with a tick. Words in bold in the clue text are explained on the back.
- Every topic has five cards: grade 6, grade 9, two cards for grade 12, and university. Each card stands alone.
- All text has passed an independent historian review and an editor review. Every card also exists in Swedish.
- The pictures are AI-generated and reviewed one by one. For 29 topics some or all pictures are still in production; those cards show a short picture brief instead.
- All text is also in the Excel file, one row per card, ready for layout and translation.

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* pictures in production

FRONT

Land X lies along one long river in Africa.
Almost no rain falls there.
But long ago, the river **flooded** every year.
The flood left black **soil** on the fields.
Farmers grew **wheat** in the black soil.
The river still gives life to the whole land.
The kings of Land X built huge stone **tombs**.
The most famous tombs have a square bottom.
The top is one point.
The biggest one is about 4,500 years old.
For thousands of years, it was the tallest building on Earth.



Huge stone tombs stand in the dry sand.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Mexico
- ☒ **Egypt**
- ☐ China
- ☐ India

Grade 6

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Egypt

flood: the river rises and water covers the land

soil: the earth where plants grow

tomb: a room or building for a dead person

wheat: a plant; people make bread from it



The river makes a green line of life in the dry land.

FRONT

Land X is a dry land by a long river.

The king wants a **pyramid** for his body after he dies.

There are no modern machines.

Thousands of workers pull heavy stones on wooden **sledges**.

They drag the stones up long **ramps** of earth and stone.

They cut the stone with tools of copper, a soft metal.

Today, **archaeologists** study the workers' village near the pyramids.

The workers are not slaves.

They get pay: bread, fish, and a place to sleep.

How do you feed thousands of workers, day after day?

Only a strong and well-planned land can do this.



Workers pull heavy stones on sledges up a ramp.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Peru
- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☒ **Egypt**
- ☐ Mexico

Grade 9

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Egypt

pyramid: a building with a square bottom and one point at the top

sledge: a flat wooden board for pulling heavy things

ramp: a road that goes up, little by little

archaeologist: a scientist who digs in the ground to learn about old times



The workers get bread and fish as pay.

FRONT

Why does a land build a mountain of stone?

Land X lies by a long river, at the edge of a great **desert**.

Its people believe their king is close to the gods.

While the king still lives, they build him a huge stone **tomb**.

It has a square bottom and one point at the top.

When the king dies, they make his body into a **mummy**.

They believe the body must last for the next life.

The tomb is a message in stone: our king lives on.

A building can show what people believe.

Think of the biggest buildings today: **temples**, banks, towers, stadiums.

What do they say about us?



The tomb is like a mountain of stone. It is a message in stone.

Which land is this?

- ☐ China
- ☐ Mexico
- ☒ **Egypt**
- ☐ Iraq

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Egypt

mummy: a dead body that is dried and wrapped so it lasts a very long time

tomb: a room or building for a dead person

temple: a building where people pray to a god

desert: very dry land with sand and almost no rain



The mummy lies inside this painted case. People believe the body must last for the next life.

FRONT

In Land X, a **scribe** sits by a field and counts sacks of wheat.

He writes signs on **papyrus**.

Picture-signs cover the temple walls.

The scribes collect **taxes** for the king.

Every year, the long river rises and covers the fields with water.

The water leaves rich black earth on the fields.

But the water also washes away the lines between the fields.

So every year, people must measure the land again.

All this measuring helps **geometry** grow.

A big kingdom needs writing and mathematics.

No scribes means no taxes, and no taxes means no pyramids.



A scribe counts the sacks of wheat and writes the numbers.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☐ China
- ☒ **Egypt**
- ☐ Greece

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Egypt

scribe: a person whose work is writing and counting

papyrus: a kind of paper; people make it from a river plant

tax: things people must give to the king or the state, like wheat or money

geometry: the mathematics of shapes and of measuring land



People make a kind of paper from this river plant.

FRONT

Land X is full of old picture-writing.

The signs cover temple walls and the huge stone **tombs** of kings.

For many hundreds of years, nobody can read them.

More than 200 years ago, soldiers find a special stone by the river.

On the stone, the same text is written three times, in three **scripts**.

One script is old Greek, and **scholars** can read Greek.

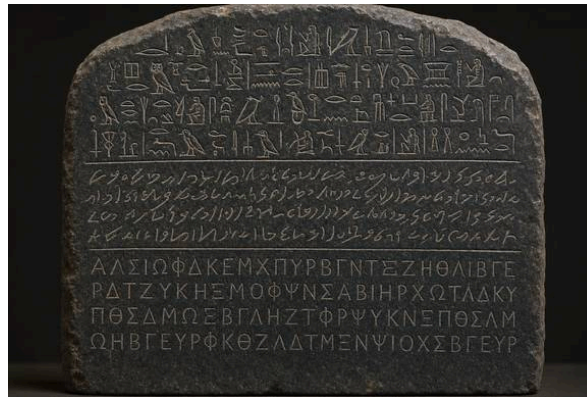
For many years, scholars compare the scripts, sign by sign.

At last, they can read the picture-signs again.

Now we can read the land's prayers, its laws, even its shopping lists.

When a script is lost, a land's memory goes silent.

Archaeology can give the voice back.



The same text is written three times on one stone.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Persia
- ☒ **Egypt**
- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☐ China

University

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Egypt

script: a set of signs for writing a language

scholar: a person who studies a subject very deeply

archaeology: the study of things people from long ago leave behind

tomb: a room or building for a dead person



Picture-signs cover the old walls. For a long time, nobody could read them.

FRONT

Land X lies between two big rivers, the Tigris and the Euphrates.

The sun is hot, and there is little rain.

So people dig **canals**.

The canals carry river water to the fields.

The fields give much **grain**, and the villages grow.

The villages become the first big cities on earth.

Over time, the cities get walls, markets, and tall **temple** towers.

People press small signs into wet **clay**.

It is the first writing that we know of.

The name of this land means 'between the rivers'.



A big city grows between two rivers.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Egypt
- ☒ **Mesopotamia**
- ☐ India
- ☐ China

Grade 6

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Mesopotamia

canal: a small river that people dig; it carries water to the fields

clay: soft, wet earth; it gets hard when it dries

temple: a house for a god

grain: the seeds of plants like wheat; people make bread from it



People press signs into wet clay.

FRONT

The temple storehouses in Land X are full: grain, wool, oil, and sheep.

The workers must count everything.

Who brings ten sheep?

Who gets three jars of oil?

Memory alone is not enough.

At first, people count with small clay **tokens**.

The two big rivers, the Euphrates and the Tigris, give endless mud, and mud gives clay.

Later, people press signs into wet clay with a cut **reed**.

Over time, the signs become little **wedges**.

The first writing that we know of is not a poem: it is **accounting**.

Much later, people write letters, laws, and stories.



A writer counts sheep and writes the numbers on clay.

Which land is this?

- ☐ China
- ☐ Egypt
- ☒ **Mesopotamia**
- ☐ Phoenicia

Grade 9

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Mesopotamia

token: a small clay piece that stands for one thing, like one sheep

reed: a tall grass that grows by the river

wedge: a small shape like the tip of a nail

accounting: counting goods and writing the numbers down



First, people count with clay tokens, and later they write with wedge signs.

FRONT

In Land X, between two big rivers, the fields need **canals**.

Families must share the river water fairly.

So they agree on shared rules and work together.

The watered fields give more food than the farmers can eat.

This extra food changes everything: some people can stop farming.

They become builders, potters, priests, and traders.

Each person learns one **craft** well.

This is **specialization**.

Soon thousands of **strangers** live together in one place: the first city.

Today this land is mostly in Iraq.

Maybe the city is the biggest invention that people ever make.



Canals bring water, and a city grows.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ the Indus Valley
- ☒ **Mesopotamia**
- ☐ China

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Mesopotamia

canal: a small river that people dig; it brings water to the fields

specialization: when each person learns one job very well

craft: a special skill or job; you learn it with long practice

stranger: a person you do not know



Each person learns one craft.

FRONT

The people of Land X write the oldest great story that we can still read.

They write it on **clay tablets**.

It tells about Gilgamesh, a king in the city of Uruk, between the rivers Euphrates and Tigris.

Gilgamesh loses his best friend, and now he is afraid of death.

He travels to the end of the world to find **eternal** life.

He fails.

A wise man tells him: no human lives forever.

So Gilgamesh goes home.

He learns to live well: build your city, love your people, enjoy your bread.

How do we live well, when life is short?

People ask this question 4,000 years ago, and we still ask it today.



A king travels far to find eternal life.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Greece
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ India
- ☒ **Mesopotamia**

Grade 12

civilizations

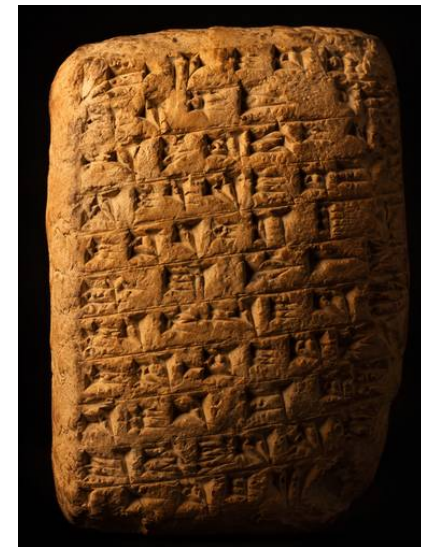
BACK

Answer: Mesopotamia

eternal: forever, without end

tablet: a flat piece of clay for writing

clay: soft, wet earth; it gets hard when it dries



People write the story on clay tablets.

FRONT

Paper burns, but clay dries hard and lasts almost forever.

Land X is a hot plain between two rivers, the Tigris and the Euphrates.

The plain has much river mud, but few trees and few stones.

So the people write on soft clay tablets, and they leave us hundreds of thousands of them.

There are laws and lists of kings, but also **receipts**, letters, and school exercises.

One angry customer even complains about bad copper.

For a long time, nobody can read the **wedge-shaped** signs.

On a high rock in Persia, there is a king's message in three languages.

Scholars compare the languages and learn to read the signs.

Suddenly, everyday voices speak to us from about 4,000 years ago.

Durable writing materials keep the small voices alive, not only the voices of kings.



We still have hundreds of thousands of clay tablets.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Greece
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ China
- ☒ **Mesopotamia**

University

civilizations

BACK

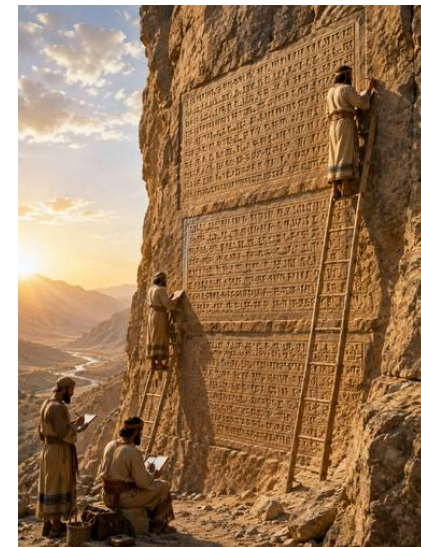
Answer: Mesopotamia

receipt: a note that shows what somebody buys or pays

scholar: a person who studies one subject very deeply

durable: strong; it lasts a very long time

wedge-shaped: looking like small triangles, wide at one end and sharp at the other



A king's message on a rock is in three languages.

FRONT

King X lives in the city of Babylon.
Babylon lies in a land between two big rivers.
Farmers use water from the rivers to grow food.
King X leads Babylon and many other cities.
He collects laws for the whole land.
A law is a rule that everyone must follow.
Workers **carve** the laws onto a tall black stone.
The stone is taller than a person.
It stands where all people can see it.
The king wants everyone to know the rules, not only **powerful** people.
This happens almost 4,000 years ago.



People look at the tall law stone in the city.

Who is King X?

- ☒ **Hammurabi**
- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☐ Confucius

Grade 6

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Hammurabi

carve: to cut letters or pictures into hard stone

powerful: able to tell many people what to do, like a king



A worker carves signs into the hard stone.

FRONT

King X is the king of Babylon, a rich city in **Mesopotamia**.

His land is big, and every town has its own old rules.

The rules are not the same everywhere.

King X wants one set of laws for the whole land.

Workers write his laws on a tall stone, for all to see.

Anyone can point at the stone.

- Look, this is the law.

A **judge** cannot change it as he likes.

The king says the laws protect the weak from the strong.

He says the law must also help **widows** and **orphans**.

When all people can know the law, life is more fair.



The laws are carved on this tall dark stone. Everyone can see them.

Who is King X?

- ☒ **Hammurabi**
- ☐ Cyrus the Great
- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☐ Alexander the Great

Grade 9

civilizations

BACK

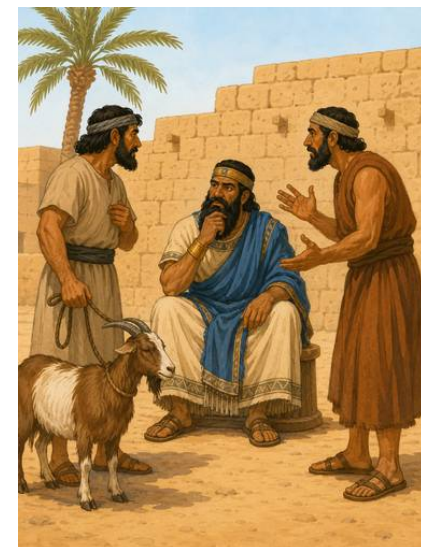
Answer: Hammurabi

Mesopotamia: an old land between two big rivers, in today's Iraq

judge: a person who decides who is right when people fight about rules

widow: a woman whose husband is dead

orphan: a child whose parents are dead



A judge listens to two farmers. Who is right?

FRONT

King X rules the city of Babylon about 3,800 years ago.

His workers cut nearly 300 laws into one tall stone. The laws talk about **wages** for workers and prices in the market.

They talk about doctors' **fees**, the **rent** for a boat, marriage, and **adoption**.

One law says: a builder builds a bad wall.

The wall falls.

Then the builder must pay.

Why is this stone so exciting for us today?

From one stone, we can see how people live in old Babylon.

Laws show the problems people really have: work, money, family, houses.

Old laws are a window into daily life.



People sail, buy, and build in old Babylon.

Who is King X?

- ☒ **Hammurabi**
- ☐ Augustus
- ☐ Ashoka
- ☐ Alexander the Great

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Hammurabi

wage: the money you get for your work

fee: the money you pay for a service, for example to a doctor

rent: the money you pay to use a thing, like a boat or a house

adoption: taking a child into your family as your own child



The signs are cut into hard dark stone. The laws look like this.

FRONT

King X of Babylon puts his laws on a tall stone.

His laws are some of the first written laws in the world.

One famous rule says: an eye for an eye.

But in Babylon, people are not **equal**.

Some people are free, and some people are **slaves**.

The **punishment** is not the same for every person.

If a man makes a free man blind, he can lose his own eye.

If he makes a slave blind, he only pays silver to the slave's owner.

Today, many lands want the same law for every person.

Ideas of **justice** have a history.

They can change, and they can get better.



He hurts a slave, and he only pays silver. Is that fair?

Who is King X?

☒ **Hammurabi**

☐ Moses

☐ Solon

☐ Julius Caesar

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Hammurabi

slave: a person who is not free and must work for an owner

punishment: something bad you must accept because you broke a rule

equal: the same for everyone

justice: when people are treated in a fair and right way



Her eyes are covered. Today the law must be the same for every person.

FRONT

King X is a king of Babylon, in the land between two big rivers.

His laws are carved on a tall black stone.

At the top of the stone, there is a picture.

In the picture, the sun god gives King X a **rod** and a ring.

The message is strong: this law comes with the power of a god.

Centuries later, an army from another land carries the heavy stone away.

For them, it is a **war prize**.

More than a hundred years ago, **archaeologists** dig the stone out of the earth.

Today the stone stands in a museum in Paris.

There are older laws, but no other old law stone is kept so well.

One stone shows how law, power, and things travel through time.



A god hands the king a rod and a ring.

Who is King X?

- ☒ **Hammurabi**
- ☐ Gilgamesh
- ☐ Cyrus the Great
- ☐ Alexander the Great

University

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Hammurabi

rod: a short straight stick

war prize: a special thing that the winners take home after a war

archaeologist: a scientist who digs in the earth to find things from the past



Archaeologists dig old things out of the earth.

FRONT

The X people live about 3,000 years ago.

Their home is on the east coast of the Mediterranean Sea.

Behind their cities, the mountains are full of tall **cedar** trees.

They build strong ships from the cedar wood.

They are great sailors and **traders**.

They sail from city to city with wood, oil, and cloth.

They also make a famous purple **dye** from sea snails.

Purple cloth is so **rare** that kings pay gold for it.

They sell the purple cloth to the Greeks and to the kings of Egypt.

Their trading cities send ships all over the sea.

Their land is small, but the open sea makes them rich.



A strong wooden ship carries things to sell across the sea.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Egyptians
- ☒ **The Phoenicians**
- ☐ The Greeks
- ☐ The Vikings

Grade 6

civilizations

BACK

Answer: The Phoenicians

trader: a person who buys and sells things

cedar: a tall tree with strong, good-smelling wood

dye: something that gives color to cloth

rare: very hard to find; there is only a little of it



Sea snails give a rare purple dye.

FRONT

The X people are traders on the Mediterranean Sea.

Egyptian and Sumerian writing systems have hundreds of **signs**.

Only a few **scribes** learn it, after years of school.

But traders need fast notes in every **port**.

They write prices, names, and lists of the things they sell.

So the X people use a new, simple writing with only 22 signs.

One sign means one sound.

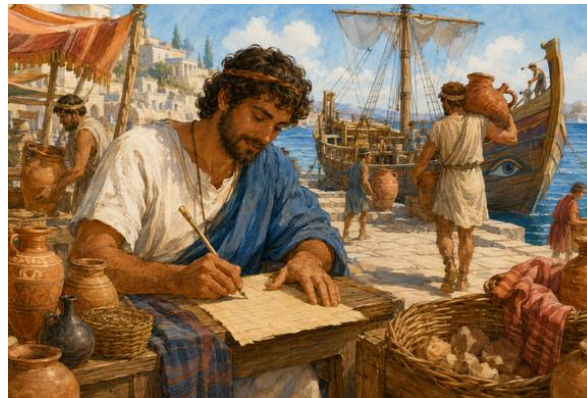
Now a child can learn to read in months, not years.

Their ships carry the signs to many lands.

Later, the Greeks learn the signs from the X people.

Most **alphabets** today come from those signs.

A simple tool can change the world.



A trader writes a fast note in the port.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Sumerians
- ☐ The Egyptians
- ☒ **The Phoenicians**
- ☐ The Greeks

Grade 9

civilizations

BACK

Answer: The Phoenicians

sign: a simple mark that you write, like a letter

scribe: a person whose job is writing

port: a town by the sea where ships stop

alphabet: a small set of letters that people use to write all words



The old writing has hundreds of signs. The new writing has only 22.

FRONT

The X people live in port cities on the east coast of the Mediterranean Sea.

Each city, like Tyre or Byblos, is a **city-state** with its own king.

The cities never join into one big **empire**.

Instead, the X people start small trading towns on many coasts, from Cyprus to Spain.

One of these towns is Carthage, in North Africa.

Carthage later grows into a great power of its own.

Their ships carry glass, purple cloth, and metals.

The ships also carry things you cannot put in a box.

They carry skills, ideas, and letters for writing.

Even the Greeks learn these letters from the X people.

Cities, towns, and sea roads form one big **network**.

Power can grow from trade, not from **conquest**.



Workers load ships with glass, cloth, and metal in a busy port.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Romans
- ☐ The Greeks
- ☒ **The Phoenicians**
- ☐ The Egyptians

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: The Phoenicians

city-state: a city that is its own small country

empire: one ruler over many lands and peoples

network: many points joined together, like a spider web

conquest: taking land by war



Sea roads join many towns into one big network.

FRONT

Look at the letter A on this card.

The X people are sea **traders** on the east coast of the Mediterranean Sea.

They write with only 22 simple **signs**.

Their first sign is called aleph.

Long before their time, aleph starts as a picture of an **ox** head.

Turn a big letter A upside down.

You can still see the two horns.

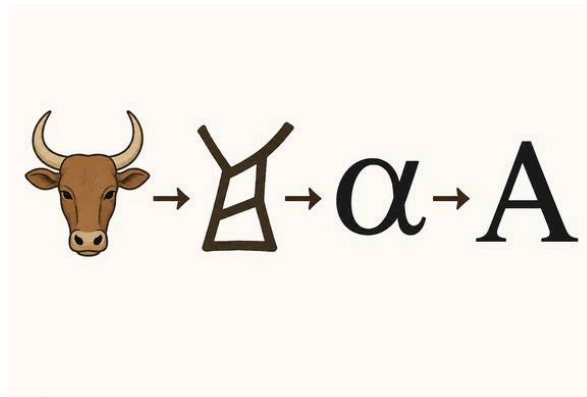
Greek sailors borrow the signs from the X traders.

The Greeks add **vowels**, like A, E, and O.

Later, in Italy, the Etruscans and then the Romans shape the letters again.

Hebrew and Arabic letters also come from those old signs.

A small idea can travel further than any ship.



An ox head slowly becomes the letter A.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Greeks
- ☐ The Romans
- ☐ The Hebrews
- ☒ **The Phoenicians**

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

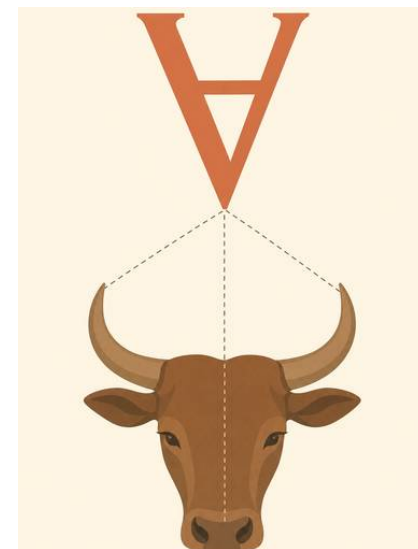
Answer: The Phoenicians

trader: a person who buys and sells things

vowel: a letter for an open sound, like A, E, O

ox: a strong farm animal, like a big cow

sign: a simple mark that you write, like a letter



Turn the A around. Can you see the horns?

FRONT

The X people spread simple letters all around the Mediterranean Sea.

Their home is the narrow coast where Lebanon is today.

But something strange happens to their story.

They write their notes and books on **papyrus**.

Papyrus **rots** fast in the wet air of the coast.

So almost all their own books are lost.

We know them mostly through their neighbors, like the Greeks and the Romans.

Those neighbors are often **rivals**, so their words are not always fair.

Even the name we use for the X people comes from a Greek word.

It is probably the Greek word for the purple color they make and sell.

Archaeologists read their story from broken pots, old ships, and short texts on stone.

When you read history, ask: who tells the story, and why?



Archaeologists read a story from broken pots.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Etruscans
- ☒ **The Phoenicians**
- ☐ The Egyptians
- ☐ The Persians

University

civilizations

BACK

Answer: The Phoenicians

papyrus: a kind of paper made from a river plant

rot: to slowly break down and fall apart, like old wet wood

rival: a person or group that fights or competes with you

archaeologist: a scientist who digs in the ground and studies old things



Papyrus rots fast in wet air. The old books are lost.

FRONT

Mr X lives long ago in Athens.

Athens is a famous city in **ancient** Greece.

He has a simple life.

He often walks **barefoot**.

All day he walks around the city.

He talks with everyone: young people, workers, rich people.

He teaches them, but he does not want money for it.

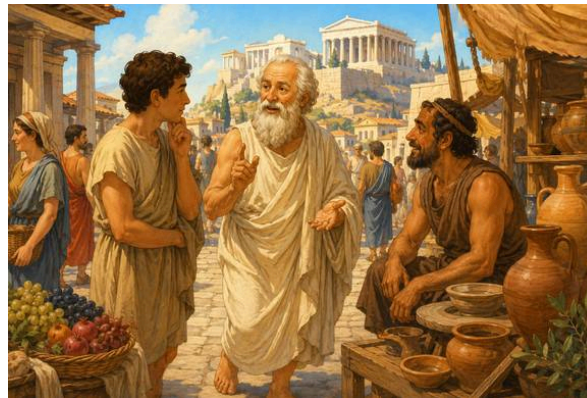
He never writes a book.

- I only talk with people, he says.

- That is how I teach.

His students write down the words of Mr X.

That is why we still know his ideas today.



Mr X walks in Athens and talks with everyone.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Socrates**

☐ Plato

☐ Aristotle

☐ Confucius

Grade 6

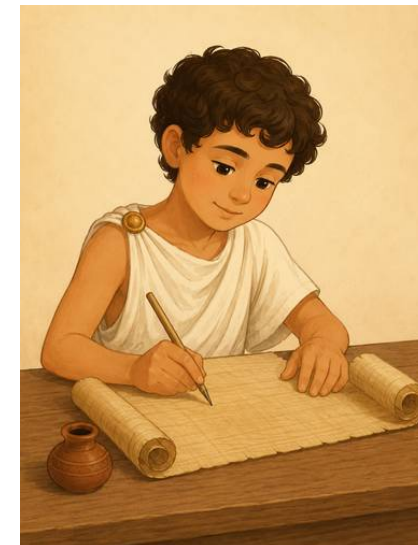
civilizations

BACK

Answer: Socrates

barefoot: with no shoes on your feet

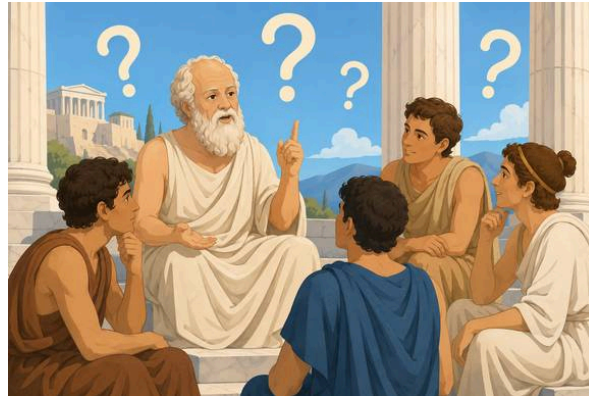
ancient: very old, from a time long ago



A student writes the words down.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Athens almost 2,500 years ago.
 When you ask him a question, he does not answer.
 He asks you a question back.
 - What is your **reason**?
 - Can you give an example?
 Step by step, he tests each idea with you.
 Weak ideas fall.
 Strong ideas stay.
 He is famous for one **saying**: I know that I know nothing.
 He means: never be too sure of an idea.
 Schools today still use his way of asking.
 It also helps you check news, **rumors**, and **advertising**.



Mr X answers a question with a question.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Socrates**

☐ Plato

☐ Buddha

☐ Aristotle

Grade 9

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Socrates

reason: why you think something is true

saying: a short sentence that many people know and repeat

rumor: a story people tell each other, but no one checks if it is true

advertising: words and pictures that try to make you buy something



Is this true? Check it first.

FRONT

Athens loses a long war.

The people are afraid and angry.

Mr X is an old man, famous for his hard questions.

Three men take him to court.

- He leads the young people the wrong way, they say.

- He does not respect the gods of our city.

A **jury** of about 500 normal people votes: **guilty**.

The court says: he must die.

His friends want to help him run away, but he says no.

He will not stop asking questions, and he will not run away.

He calmly drinks a cup of **poison** and dies.

His **trial** leaves us a big question: what may a country do to a thinker?



Mr X reaches for the cup of poison and still teaches his friends.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Socrates**
- ☐ Galileo Galilei
- ☐ Gandhi
- ☐ Nelson Mandela

Grade 12

civilizations

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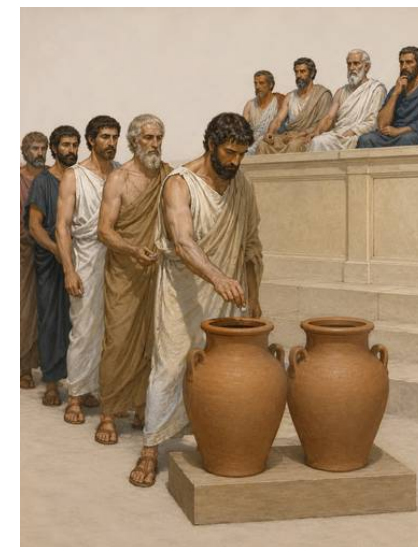
Answer: Socrates

trial: when a court (the place of judges) decides: did a person do a crime?

jury: a group of normal people who vote in court: did he do it or not?

guilty: the court says: yes, he did it

poison: a thing that kills you when you drink or eat it



The jury votes with small stones.

FRONT

Mr X walks through Athens.

He stops people and talks with them.

He stops the rich and important people too.

- You want money and **fame**, he says.

- But do you care for your **soul**?

He believes a good soul matters more than gold.

He says: when you do wrong, you hurt yourself most of all.

A man who **cheats** hurts his own soul.

He also says: the **unexamined** life is not worth living.

He means: stop and ask yourself, do I live in a good way?

His questions show that the powerful men often know little.

That is why many powerful men become his enemies.



Mr X asks a rich man about his soul.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Socrates**

☐ Aristotle

☐ Buddha

☐ Confucius

Grade 12

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Answer: Socrates

soul: the inner part of you: your thoughts, feelings, and character

fame: when many people know your name

unexamined: not checked, not looked at

cheat: to lie or trick people to win or get money



A good soul weighs more than gold.

FRONT

Mr X writes nothing.

But he changes thinking forever.

We know him only through the books of other people.

His student Plato writes many **dialogues** about him.

Another student, Xenophon, shows a simpler man of daily life.

A comedy writer in Athens laughs at him on stage.

The three pictures of him are not the same.

Experts still ask: who is the real man?

His method is **refutation**.

He questions each **claim** until it cannot stand.

This method starts ethics, the study of right and wrong.

Later, Aristotle turns this testing into logic, the study of good arguments.



Old books show three different pictures of Mr X.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Socrates**

☐ Plato

☐ Confucius

☐ Buddha

University

civilizations

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Answer: Socrates

dialogue: a written talk between two or more people

expert: a person who knows very much about one thing

refutation: showing, step by step, that an idea cannot stand

claim: something a person says is true



A dialogue is a written talk between people.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Athens, a city in Greece.

His teacher asks people questions at the big **square**.

His teacher does not write books.

One day, a big court in the city says his teacher must die.

Mr X is very sad and travels to other countries.

Later he comes back and opens a school in a quiet garden.

The school is called the **Academy**.

A young student named Aristotle studies at his school.

Mr X writes many books.

His books look like **conversations**.

In his books, his teacher asks questions, just like in real life.

Mr X writes, so his teacher's ideas never die.



Mr X teaches students in a garden in Athens.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Plato**
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Aristotle
- ☐ Confucius

Grade 6

civilizations

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Answer: Plato

Academy: the name of his school. Many schools use this name today.

conversation: two or more people talking together

square: an open place in the middle of a town

scroll: a long piece of paper that you roll up



He writes his books on a scroll.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Athens about 2,400 years ago.
His teacher is Socrates.
Mr X writes a famous story about a **cave**.
Prisoners sit in a dark cave.
They are **chained**, so they can only look at the wall.
A fire behind them makes **shadows** on the wall.
They think the shadows are the whole world.
One **prisoner** gets free and sees the sun.
He goes back to tell the others.
They do not believe him.
Mr X says: learning is like walking out of the cave.
Today, a phone screen can be like that wall.



The prisoners see only shadows on the wall.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Plato**
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Buddha
- ☐ Karl Marx

Grade 9

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Plato

cave: a big dark hole in a rock or under the ground

prisoner: a person who is not free and cannot go out

shadow: the dark shape a thing makes when it blocks light

chained: tied with metal rings, so you cannot move away



A hand makes a shadow on the wall.

FRONT

Mr X starts a famous school in Athens.

He is a student of Socrates.

Mr X is a **philosopher**, not a **mathematician**.

But his school loves **geometry**.

Try this: draw a circle.

Look closely: the line is always a little bit wrong.

No drawing is ever a perfect circle.

But the idea of a circle is perfect.

Mr X teaches that our eyes see only **imperfect** copies.

Only the mind can see the perfect ideas.

Geometry trains the mind to work with perfect ideas.

Ask yourself: do you trust your eyes, or your mind?



A student draws a circle in the sand.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Plato**
- ☐ Pythagoras
- ☐ Euclid
- ☐ Socrates

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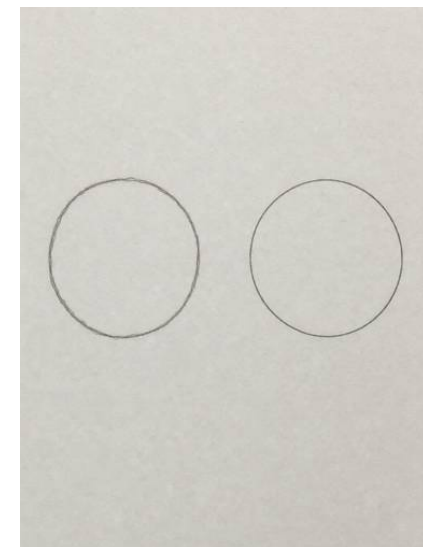
Answer: Plato

philosopher: a person who thinks hard about big questions

mathematician: a person who works with numbers and shapes

geometry: mathematics about shapes, like circles and triangles

imperfect: not perfect; with small mistakes



Every circle on paper is a little bit wrong.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Athens.

One day, a big **jury** judges his teacher, Socrates. Hundreds of people vote, and the teacher must die.

So Mr X does not trust every decision of the crowd. A clever talker can trick a crowd.

Later, Mr X writes a famous book called The Republic.

The book asks: what makes a **state** fair?

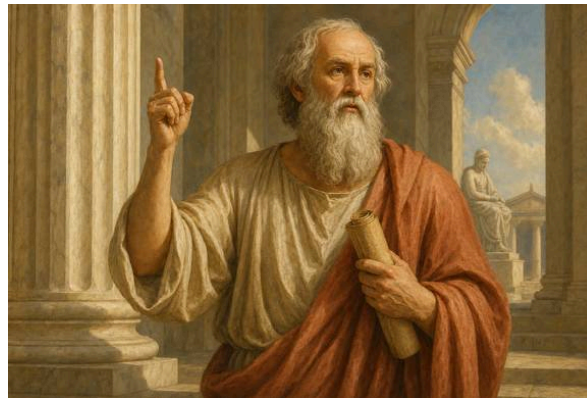
He says: **rulers** must be wise and love learning.

Not the richest people, not the loudest people.

A good ruler loves truth more than power.

Mr X teaches this to his student Aristotle.

His question is still alive today: how should we choose our leaders?



Mr X holds his book about a fair state.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Plato**
- ☐ Aristotle
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Karl Marx

Grade 12

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Answer: Plato

jury: a group of people who decide if someone did wrong

state: a country and the people who lead it

ruler: a person who leads a country



The people vote with raised hands.

FRONT

Mr X starts a school in Athens.

His teacher is Socrates.

The school stays open for about three hundred years.

Mr X asks a hard question: what is **knowledge**?

A lucky guess can be true, but it is not knowledge.

In one book he tests an answer.

You know something when your true **belief** has good reasons.

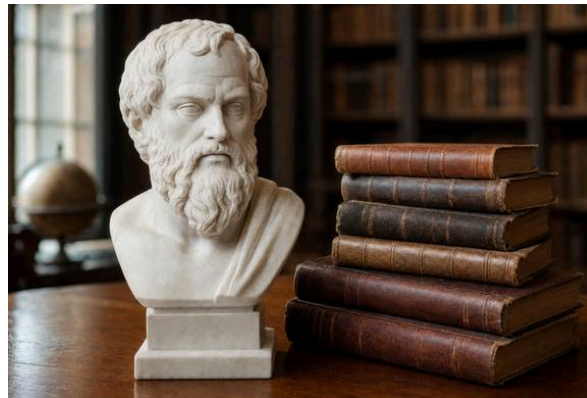
In another book, a boy with no schooling solves a problem about a square.

The boy only answers good questions, step by step.

Mr X says: questions wake up the mind, so learning is like remembering.

A famous modern thinker says: European **philosophy** is **footnotes** to Mr X's books.

So when you read the news, ask: do I know this, or do I only believe it?



Mr X asks: what is knowledge?

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Plato**
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Confucius
- ☐ Buddha

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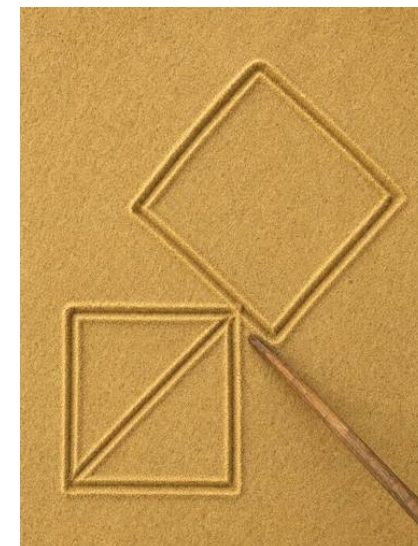
Answer: Plato

belief: something you think is true

knowledge: the things you really know, not only believe

philosophy: thinking hard about big questions

footnote: a small extra note at the bottom of a page



The boy solves the square problem by answering questions.

FRONT

Long ago, Mr X lives in Greece.

He wants to know about everything.

He studies animals, fish, birds, stars, and the weather.

He **collects** many things and **compares** them.

He has a school with a garden in Athens.

People tell a story: he walks when he teaches.

His students walk with him.

He also teaches a young **prince**.

This prince later becomes a very famous king:
Alexander the Great.

He teaches his students to look closely at the world.

When you look closely and compare, you learn new things.



A story says: he walks when he teaches, and his students walk with him.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Aristotle**

☐ Socrates

☐ Plato

☐ Darwin

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Answer: Aristotle

collect: to bring many things together in one place

compare: to look at two things and see what is the same and what is different

prince: the son of a king



He collects things and compares them.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Greece.
It is more than 2,300 years ago.
His teacher in Athens is the famous thinker Plato.
Plato trusts thinking more than looking.
But Mr X thinks you must also use your eyes!
He watches bees and **octopuses** for many hours.
He opens dead animals to see what is inside.
He describes hundreds of kinds of animals.
Many people call him the first **biologist**.
His big idea: do not only think, but also look and check.
This idea is a **root** of modern science.



He looks closely at small sea animals.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Aristotle**
- ☐ Darwin
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Hippocrates

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Answer: Aristotle

octopus: a sea animal with eight arms

biologist: a scientist who studies living things

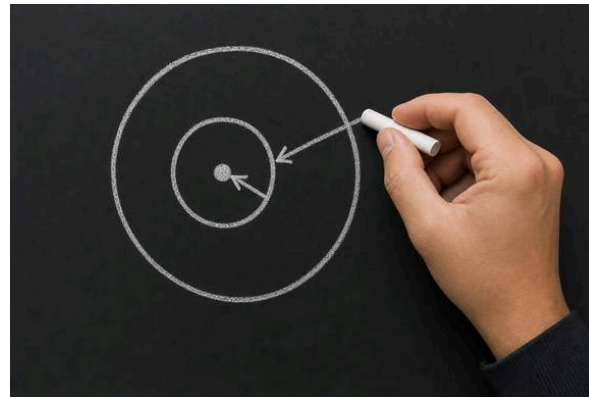
root: the place where something begins, like the root of a plant



An octopus is a sea animal with eight arms.

FRONT

Mr X is a student at Plato's school in Athens.
After many years, he opens his own school.
He asks: when is an **argument** good?
He writes clear rules for thinking.
Much later, teachers give a famous example of his rules:
All humans are **mortal**.
Socrates is a human.
So Socrates is mortal.
If the first two sentences are true, the third must be true.
People call this science **logic**.
Mathematics and computers still build on this science today.



If the first two sentences are true, the third must be true.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Aristotle**
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Pythagoras
- ☐ Euclid

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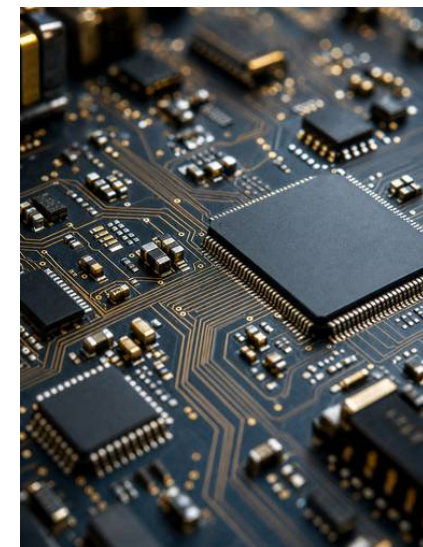
BACK

Answer: Aristotle

argument: reasons that you give to show that something is true

mortal: somebody who must die one day

logic: the rules for good, clear thinking



Computers work with rules of logic.

FRONT

Mr X is a Greek thinker.

He learns from Plato for many years.

Plato's own teacher is Socrates.

Later, Mr X opens his own school in Athens.

He asks: what is a good life?

His answer: look for the good middle.

Courage is in the middle, between being a **coward** and being **reckless**.

Generosity is between wasting money and giving nothing.

You become good by training good habits, like training a muscle.

Happiness is not one moment of fun, he says.

Happiness is a whole life, lived well.



The good way is often in the middle.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Aristotle**

☐ Plato

☐ Buddha

☐ Confucius

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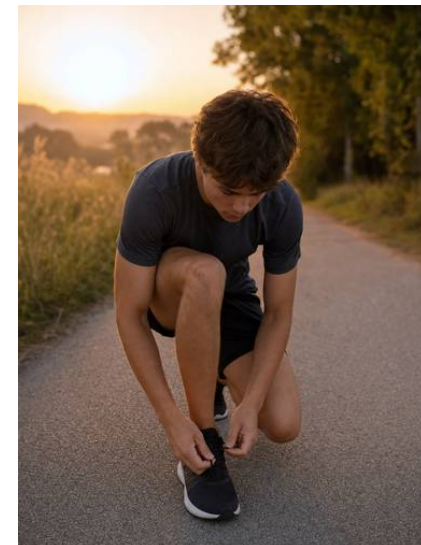
Answer: Aristotle

courage: being brave when something is hard

coward: a person who is too afraid to act

reckless: doing wild, dangerous things without thinking

generosity: giving gladly to other people



You train a habit like a muscle: again and again.

FRONT

Mr X is a Greek thinker.

He writes many books: about **logic**, nature, and the good life.

He loves his teacher Plato, but he loves truth more.

After his death, **scholars** in the Arabic world translate and study his books.

Later, the great scholar Ibn Rushd explains his ideas.

For many **centuries**, teachers say: if he writes it, it is true.

But he also writes: heavy things fall faster than light things.

Much later, scientists test this, and it is wrong.

Is this bad for him?

No, he himself teaches: when facts and ideas disagree, believe the facts.

Check every **authority**, even Mr X.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Atmospheric photo of an old library table in warm candlelight: a stack of closed leather-bound books from different times, one wrapped in plain cloth, one with a worn wooden cover, beside a rolled scroll tied with a cord. It shows how the books travel through many centuries.

His books travel through many languages and many centuries.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Aristotle**

☐ Plato

☐ Galileo Galilei

☐ Copernicus

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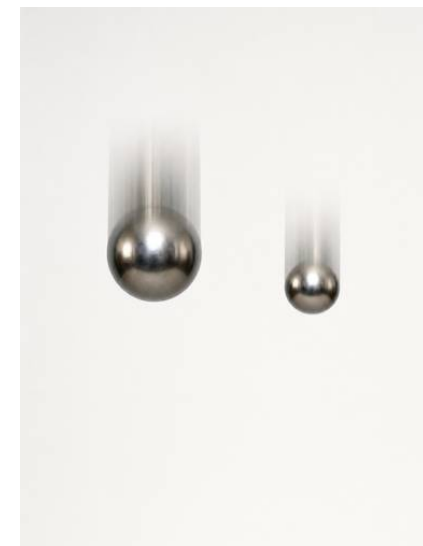
Answer: Aristotle

scholar: a person who studies books deeply

authority: a person or a book that many people trust and follow

century: one hundred years

logic: the rules for good, clear thinking



A test shows: the heavy ball and the light ball fall together.

FRONT

King X is a young king from Macedonia, near Greece.

A famous old story tells about him as a boy.

There is a horse that no one can ride.

Everyone is afraid of the horse, but the boy watches it carefully.

He sees that the horse is afraid of its own **shadow**.

He turns the horse toward the sun, and the horse becomes calm.

He wins the horse with **understanding**, not with **force**.

The boy's teacher is the famous thinker Aristotle.

Later, he leads his army east, all the way to India.

In Egypt, he builds a new city and gives it his own name.

The name of this city sounds like the name of King X.



The boy turns the horse toward the sun. The horse becomes calm.

Who is King X?

- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☒ **Alexander the Great**
- ☐ Augustus
- ☐ Hammurabi

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civilizations

BACK

Answer: Alexander the Great

shadow: the dark shape you make on the ground when you stand in the sun

force: strong power; when you push or fight to make something happen

understanding: when you watch and learn why something happens



The sun makes a shadow. The horse is afraid of its own shadow.

FRONT

King X is the king of Macedonia, a land next to Greece.

He and his soldiers speak Greek.

He leads a strong army east, through Egypt and Persia, to India.

The Greek language travels with the army.

Soon, many people from Egypt to Central Asia speak and write Greek.

New cities grow along the army roads.

They have theaters, sports fields, and **marketplaces**, like cities in Greece.

Greek, Egyptian, and Persian **customs** mix into something new.

King X dies young, and his **empire** quickly breaks apart.

An army can hold people together for a short time.

A language can hold them together for hundreds of years.



A Greek-style theater outside Greece. New cities look like Greek cities.

Who is King X?

- ☐ Cyrus the Great
- ☐ Genghis Khan
- ☒ **Alexander the Great**
- ☐ Julius Caesar

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civilizations

BACK

Answer: Alexander the Great

customs: the ways people usually do things, for example food, clothes, and holidays

empire: many lands and many people under one king

marketplace: an open place where people buy and sell things



The stone shows Greek letters. People in many lands share this language.

FRONT

King X, a king from the Greek world, takes lands from Greece to India.

In Egypt, he builds a new city by the sea and gives it his own name.

After his death, this city becomes the most important city for knowledge in the ancient world. Its famous library tries to collect every book in the world.

One story tells that the library takes the books from every ship in the **harbor**.

The ships get back only copies.

A giant **lighthouse** guides ships to the city.

People call it one of the **wonders** of the world.

Here a **scholar** measures the size of the whole Earth, with sticks, shadows, and mathematics.

When knowledge from many lands meets in one place, people can do new things.

The king's sword is gone, but his city of ideas still changes the world.



A giant lighthouse guides ships to the city of books.

Who is King X?

☒ **Alexander the Great**

☐ Cleopatra

☐ Julius Caesar

☐ Augustus

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civilizations

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Answer: Alexander the Great

lighthouse: a tall tower with a fire or light on top; it shows ships the way

scholar: a person whose work is to study and learn

harbor: a safe place by the sea where ships stop

wonder: an amazing building or thing; old lists name seven wonders of the world



A stick makes a shadow. With shadows, a scholar measures the Earth.

FRONT

People call King X "the Great".

He wants to be like Achilles, a hero from the old Greek poems.

His army wins many fights from Greece to India.

But look at the other side of the story.

His wars kill hundreds of thousands of people.

He burns Persepolis, the **palace** city of the Persian kings.

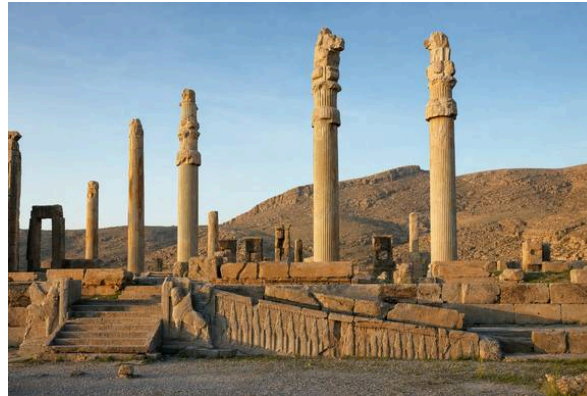
He fights the Persian kings, but he is not born one of them.

He dies young, and his **generals** break his **empire** into pieces.

So, is he great?

Great for which people: the winners, the dead, or the **conquered**?

The names we give people in history are a choice, not a fact.



This is Persepolis today. The beautiful palace city is only stones now.

Who is King X?

- ☐ Napoleon
- ☐ Genghis Khan
- ☒ **Alexander the Great**
- ☐ Julius Caesar

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civilizations

BACK

Answer: Alexander the Great

conquered: people whose land is taken by force

general: a leader in an army

palace: a very big and fine house of a king

empire: many lands under one king



After the king dies, his empire breaks like old stone.

FRONT

King X is a young king from the Greek world.
His armies go east, all the way to India.
He dies young, but people never stop telling his story.
For more than 2,000 years, his **legend** grows.
People from Ethiopia to Malaysia tell stories about him.
In some stories, he even looks for magic water that gives life forever.
Here is the problem for **historians**.
His friends and soldiers write books about him, but all those books are lost.
The oldest history books we still have are written centuries after his death.
So historians must ask which stories are facts and which are dreams.
The historian's hardest job is to find the real man behind the **myth**.



In many lands, storytellers make the king a legend.

Who is King X?

☒ **Alexander the Great**

- ☐ Genghis Khan
☐ Cyrus the Great
☐ Julius Caesar

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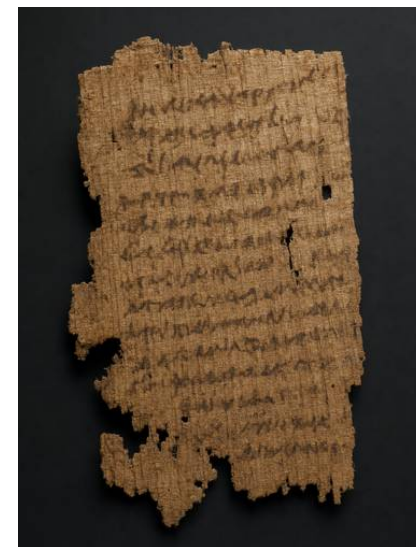
Answer: Alexander the Great

legend: an old famous story; it may be true or not true

myth: a story many people tell, but it is not a proven fact

source: an old text or thing that gives us information about the past

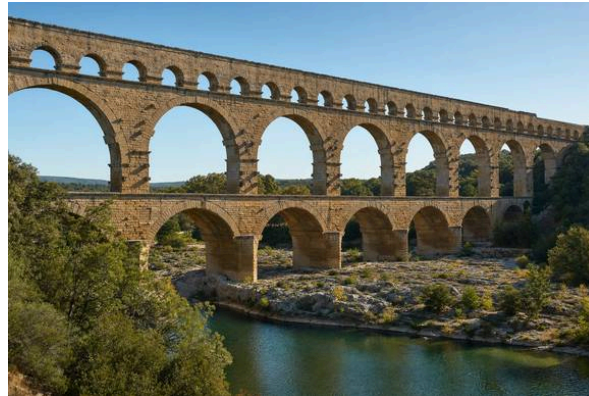
historian: a person who studies the past



Old books are lost. Historians read what is left.

FRONT

Empire X starts as a small town on a hill in Italy.
The town grows until it covers seven hills.
Slowly, it becomes a giant **empire**.
Its lands go all the way around the **Mediterranean Sea**.
Its people build long, straight roads of stone.
Stone **channels** carry fresh water into the cities.
People call these channels **aqueducts**.
People from many different lands live in this empire.
In most places, they use the same coins and the same laws.
So a trader can travel far and still feel at home.
You can still walk on some of the old roads today.
Today, that first town is the capital of Italy.



An aqueduct. It carries fresh water into a city.

Which empire is this?

- ☒ **Rome**
- ☐ Persia
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Carthage

Grade 6

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Rome

empire: many lands and people under one ruler

channel: a long open way made for water to run in

aqueduct: a stone channel that carries fresh water into a city, sometimes on tall arches

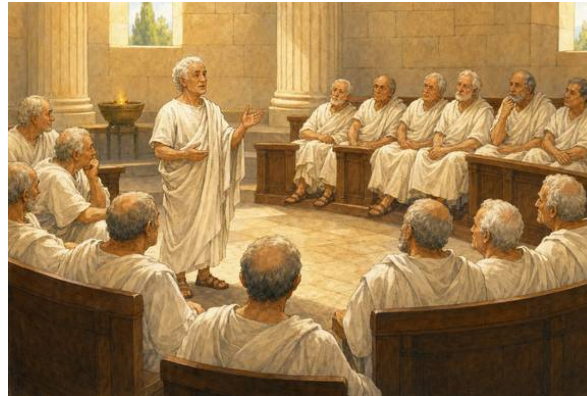
Mediterranean Sea: the big sea between Europe, Africa, and Asia



A very old stone road. People still walk on it today.

FRONT

The people of City X tell this old story:
About 2,500 years ago, they throw out their king.
They promise: we never want a king again.
Now, every year, they choose two new leaders,
called **consuls**.
One consul can always stop the other.
A **senate** of old, wise men gives advice.
Free men meet and **vote** on the laws.
Women cannot vote.
The people call their state *res publica*, 'the public thing'.
Our word '**republic**' comes from this.
The city lies in Italy.
But many countries far from Italy still use these ideas today.



The senate meets. The old, wise men give advice.

Which city is this?

- ☒ **Rome**
☐ Athens
☐ Sparta
☐ Carthage

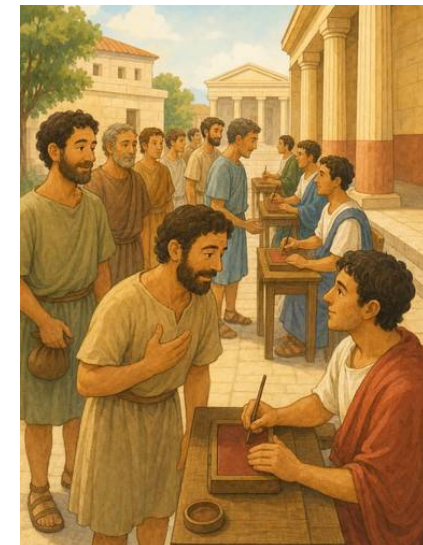
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Answer: Rome

consul: one of the two chosen leaders of the city
senate: a group of old, wise men who give advice
vote: to say your choice when a group decides something
republic: a country without a king; the people choose their leaders



The men vote. They choose their leaders.

FRONT

At first, kings rule City X.

Then the people send the kings away.

The city becomes a **republic**.

For hundreds of years, the people choose new leaders every year.

Then rich **generals** begin to give their soldiers money and land.

The soldiers now follow their general, not their city.

Generals fight generals: **civil war**.

People become tired and afraid, and they only want peace.

In the end, one man holds all the power in this city in Italy.

He keeps the old names, and he calls himself the 'first citizen'.

The republic is over.

Institutions last only when people protect them.



A general pays his soldiers. Now they follow him, not their city.

Which city is this?

- ☒ **Rome**
- ☐ Athens
- ☐ Carthage
- ☐ Babylon

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Rome

republic: a country without a king; the people choose their leaders

general: a leader of soldiers

civil war: a war between people of the same country

institution: a rule or group of a country that lasts a long time, for example a court



A laurel wreath. It is a sign for winners. Now one man alone has it.

FRONT

Empire X rules the lands around the Mediterranean Sea for centuries.

Then it ends, slowly, like all empires end.

But its language, Latin, does not die.

Latin grows into Italian, Spanish, Portuguese, French, and Romanian.

Its law shapes laws in many countries today.

One example: an **accusation** is not enough.

You must show that it is true.

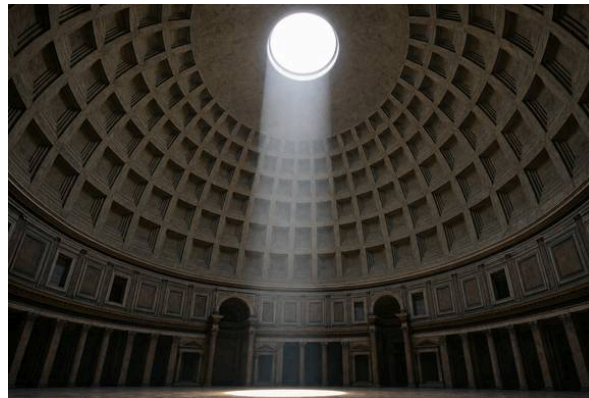
Its **concrete** buildings still stand, like the Pantheon with its great round roof.

And it has a powerful idea: a **conquered** person can become a **citizen**.

So belonging is not only about family and blood.

It can also come from law.

Empires end, but ideas and words remain.



A roof of concrete. It is very old, and it still stands.

Which empire is this?

- ☒ **Rome**
- ☐ Greece
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Persia

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civilizations

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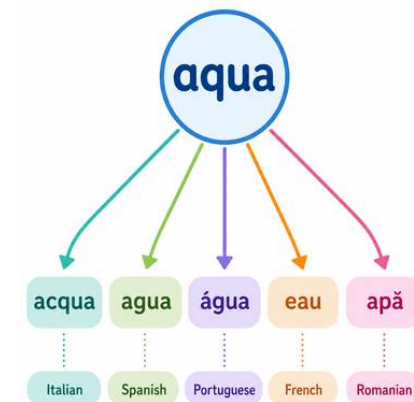
Answer: Rome

accusation: when someone says: this person did a bad thing

concrete: a building material, like liquid stone that becomes very hard

conquered: beaten in a war and taken over by the winners

citizen: a full member of a country, with rights and duties



One old word for water becomes five new words.

FRONT

Empire X rules all the lands around the Mediterranean Sea, from west to east.

Then hard times come to the west: wars at the **borders**, **plagues**, and money problems.

The western half breaks apart, piece by piece.

Many people say: the empire falls.

But wait.

The eastern half lives on for about a thousand years.

Its rulers sit in Constantinople.

Its people still call themselves by the old empire's name.

Some **historians** say 'fall'.

Other historians say '**transformation**'.

Each word teaches a different lesson.

You choose the lesson.



In the west, the old buildings become ruins.

Which empire is this?

- ☒ **Rome**
- ☐ The Ottoman Empire
- ☐ Persia
- ☐ Egypt

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civilizations

BACK

Answer: Rome

border: the line where one land ends and another land begins

plague: a sickness that spreads fast and kills many people

historian: a person who studies the past

transformation: a big, slow change from one form into another



In the east, the empire lives on for about a thousand years.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Rome, a little more than 2,000 years ago.

He is a famous Roman leader.

He leads soldiers in many lands.

He writes books about what he sees and does there.

His **adopted** son later becomes the first **emperor** of Rome.

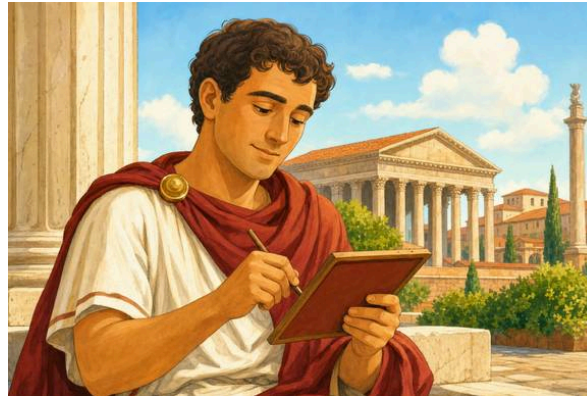
One month of the year gets his name: July.

His family name becomes the word for "emperor" in other languages.

Germans say "Kaiser".

Russians say "tsar".

People still use his name today, in everyday words.



A Roman leader writes about the lands he sees.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Julius Caesar**

☐ Augustus

☐ Alexander the Great

☐ Hammurabi

BACK

Answer: Julius Caesar

emperor: like a king, but over many lands

adopted: an adopted son is not born in the family; the family takes him in as their child, by law

Picture in production

Picture brief: A paper wall calendar hangs on a sunlit wall beside an open window with a green summer garden outside; its page shows a plain grid of empty day squares under a small painted summer sun.

The month of July has his name.

FRONT

Look at a calendar.
It comes from Mr X.
Mr X is the leader of Rome, long ago.
The old Roman calendar is a **mess**.
Some powerful men add an extra month when it helps their friends.
So the months no longer fit the seasons.
Mr X asks an **astronomer** from Egypt for help.
The new calendar gets 365 days, and a **leap day** every four years.
Now the year follows the sun, not powerful men.
People later call it the Julian calendar.
Today, after one small change, most of the world uses this calendar.



An astronomer studies the stars to fix the calendar.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Julius Caesar**
- ☐ Copernicus
- ☐ Augustus
- ☐ Leonardo da Vinci

Grade 9

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Julius Caesar

mess: things in bad order; nothing is in its right place

astronomer: a scientist who studies the sun, the moon, and the stars

leap day: one extra day, 29 February; it comes every four years



A leap day gives February one extra day.

FRONT

Rome is a **republic**, a state without a king.

One rule protects it.

A **general** may not bring his army into Italy without permission.

Mr X is a famous Roman general.

One winter day, he stands with his soldiers at a small border river.

The river's name is the Rubicon.

Old writers tell us that he says: "**The die is cast.**"
He crosses.

Civil war follows, and he becomes ruler for life.

Even today, people say "crossing the Rubicon" about a step with no way back.

When one man breaks the rule that protects the state, the state changes forever.



A general stands at a small river. One more step, and there is no way back.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Julius Caesar**

☐ Augustus

☐ Alexander the Great

☐ Hannibal

Grade 12

civilizations

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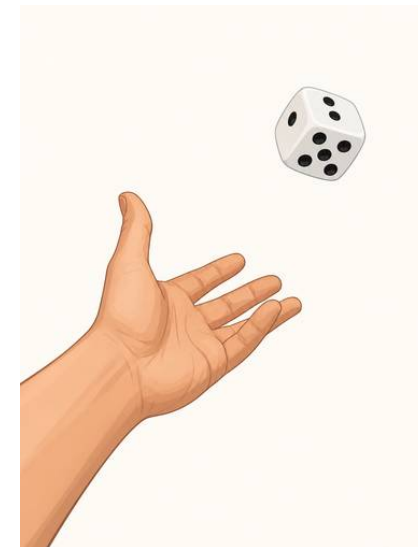
Answer: Julius Caesar

republic: a state without a king; the people choose their leaders

general: a leader of an army

civil war: a war between people of the same country

the die is cast: a die is a small cube for games; you throw it, and you cannot take the throw back



You throw a die. You cannot take the throw back.

FRONT

Mr X rules Rome alone.

Rome is a **republic**, and Romans do not want a king.

He wears no crown, but he rules like a king.

Many senators fear him, even his friend Brutus.

One day, at a meeting of the **senate**, they kill him with daggers.

One old story tells us that he asks: "You too, my child?"

The killers say that they want to save the republic. But the killing brings new wars, Roman against Roman.

In the end, the republic dies anyway.

His **heir**, Augustus, wins and becomes the first **emperor**.

Violence almost never builds the future that people plan.



Senators meet in a big stone hall in Rome.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Julius Caesar**
- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Gandhi

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civilizations

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Answer: Julius Caesar

senate: a group of powerful men who guide the Roman state; the men in this group are senators

republic: a state without a king; the people choose their leaders

heir: the person who gets your money and property after your death

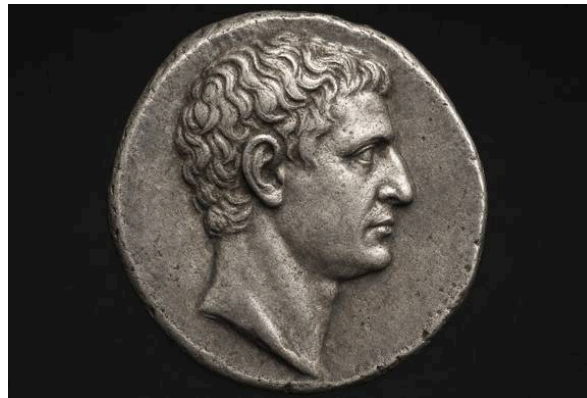
emperor: like a king, but over many lands



A dagger is a short knife.

FRONT

Mr X is a Roman general and politician.
He wins a long war in Gaul, in the north.
He writes the report of the war himself.
In the book, he writes his own name, not "I".
He sounds like a calm reporter: Mr X hurries, Mr X decides, Mr X wins.
His face appears on coins while he is still alive.
No living Roman does this before him.
He takes the job of **dictator**, an **emergency** job for six months.
He keeps the job until he dies.
We know about the war mostly from his own book.
Source criticism asks: who writes this, and why?



A living leader puts his own face on a coin.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Julius Caesar**
- ☐ Augustus
- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☐ Marx

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civilizations

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Answer: Julius Caesar

dictator: in Rome, a leader who gets all power alone, for a short time, in an emergency

emergency: a sudden time of danger

source: a text or an object that gives us information about the past

source criticism: asking who makes a source, and why, before you trust it



An old text is a source. Ask: who writes it, and why?

FRONT

Master X lives in China about 2,500 years ago.
He is a teacher.
He takes any student who really wants to learn.
Rich or poor, it does not matter.
A small gift of dried meat is enough, he says.
That is his **school fee**.
He teaches **kindness**, **honesty**, and **respect** for
parents and old people.
Why does he take poor students too?
Because everyone can learn to be good, he
believes.
People still learn from him today.



Master X teaches rich and poor students.

Who is Master X?

☒ **Confucius**

☐ Buddha

☐ Socrates

☐ Plato

Grade 6

religions

BACK

Answer: Confucius

school fee: money or a gift you give so you can
learn at a school

kindness: being good and friendly to other people

honesty: telling the truth

respect: you show that a person is important to
you



In old China, a gift of dried meat is a school fee.

FRONT

Master X is a teacher in China, long ago.

A student asks him a question.

- Is there one rule for the whole of life?

- Yes, Master X says.

- Do not do to other people what you do not want them to do to you.

Today, people call this the **golden rule**.

People in many **cultures** teach this same rule.

Master X starts with everyday life: how we **treat** each other.

Being good starts at home, with your family, he says.

Then it grows: to the village, the town, the world.



A student asks Master X about the right way to live.

Who is Master X?

- ☐ Buddha
- ☒ **Confucius**
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Aristotle

Grade 9

religions

BACK

Answer: Confucius

golden rule: a famous rule: treat other people as you want them to treat you; Master X says it with a 'do not'

culture: the way of life of a group of people

treat: how you act toward a person, good or bad



People in many cultures share the same rule: be good to others.

FRONT

Master X teaches in China, about 2,500 years ago.

Some rulers ask him for advice.

- Lead by good example, he says.
- Care for the people like a good parent.
- Do not rule through fear and hard **punishment**.
- If the ruler is **honest**, the people become honest.
- Choose **officials** who study and live honestly.
- Do not choose them because they are born into powerful families.

Few rulers listen to him.

But many centuries later, China chooses its officials with big **examinations**.

Can a test find a good heart too?



Master X says: lead by good example.

Who is Master X?

- ☐ Plato
- ☒ **Confucius**
- ☐ Buddha
- ☐ Marx

Grade 12

religions

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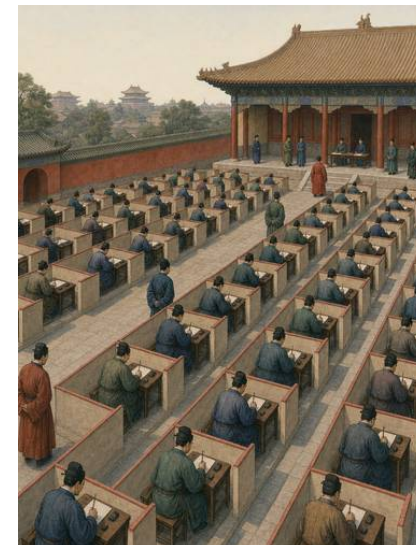
Answer: Confucius

official: a person who does work for the country and its ruler

punishment: trouble you get when you break a rule

examination: a big, important test

honest: you say what is true; you do not lie or cheat



In old China, people take a big exam to work for the country.

FRONT

Master X lives in China, long ago.

He teaches "**li**": the polite forms of daily life.

How to greet, how to eat together, how to speak with old people.

For him, these small forms are the **glue** of **society**.

They show respect, and respect holds people together.

He does not talk much about gods.

He talks about how people live together.

But some people ask questions.

- Does so much respect for old people stop new ideas?

- May a student question the teacher?

People can respect a **tradition** and still ask questions about it.



The family eats together and shows respect.

Who is Master X?

- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Buddha
- ☒ **Confucius**
- ☐ Gandhi

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Answer: Confucius

li: a Chinese word for polite ways to do things, like greeting or eating together

glue: a sticky material that holds things together; here: what holds people together

society: all the people who live together in a country or group

tradition: old ways that pass from parents to children



A young person gives tea to an old person with both hands.

FRONT

Master X is a teacher in China, long ago.

Like Socrates in Greece, he writes no book himself. Much later, his students and their students collect his **sayings**.

This little book of sayings carries his voice through time.

He teaches about family, respect, and good rulers.

Centuries after his death, China's rulers choose his teaching.

They follow it for about 2,000 years.

Then times change.

Modern **reformers** say his ideas are **old-fashioned**.

Today, people study him and show him respect again.

Ideas are like tools: each new time uses them for its own questions.



His sayings travel from bamboo strips to modern books.

Who is Master X?

- ☐ Plato
- ☐ Buddha
- ☐ Marx
- ☒ **Confucius**

University

religions

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Answer: Confucius

sayings: short wise sentences that a person says

century: a time of one hundred years

reformer: a person who wants to change the old ways

old-fashioned: from an old time; not fitting the new time



People show respect to the old teacher in a temple today.

FRONT

His followers tell this story about Prince X.

Long ago, a prince lives in a **palace** near the Himalaya mountains.

His father hides everything sad from him.

One day, the prince rides outside the palace walls.

He sees an old man, a sick man, and a dead man.

- Why do people **suffer**? he asks.

He also sees a calm holy man with no home.

He leaves the palace to understand suffering.

At last, he sits under a big **fig tree** and thinks deeply.

From that day, people call him "the **awakened** one".

His teaching, in simple words: do not hide from sad things.

Try to understand them.



Outside the walls, the prince sees an old man and a sick man for the first time.

Who is Prince X?

☒ **Siddhartha Gautama**

☐ Alexander the Great

☐ Confucius

☐ Gandhi

Grade 6

religions

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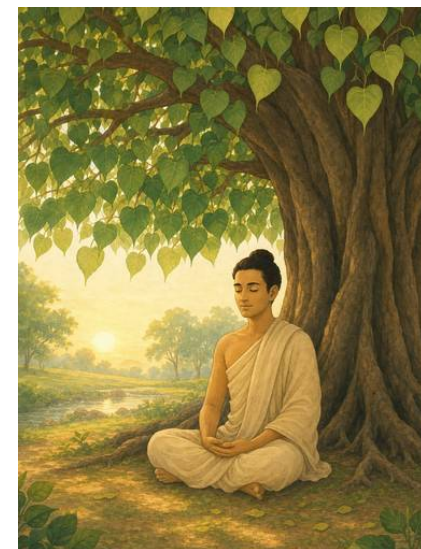
Answer: Siddhartha Gautama

palace: a very big and rich house for a king's family

suffer: to feel pain in the body or the heart

fig tree: a tree with fig fruits. The tree in this story has heart-shaped leaves.

awakened: awake, not asleep. Here it means: a person who sees life clearly.



He sits under a big fig tree and thinks deeply.

FRONT

Prince X lives long ago, in what is now Nepal and India.

The old stories tell us: as a young man he has every **luxury**.

Fine food, music, soft beds, but they do not make him happy.

The stories go on: he tries the **opposite** and eats almost nothing.

He almost dies, and he finds no answer.

So he chooses a middle way.

Live simply, hurt no one, train a calm and clear mind.

His teaching starts with an honest look at life.

Suffering is real, it has causes, and there is a way to end it.

One big cause, he says, is that we always want more.

Not too much, not too little: people still find this idea wise today.



Too much fails. Too little fails. He chooses the middle way.

Who is Prince X?

☒ **Siddhartha Gautama**

☐ Confucius

☐ Socrates

☐ Gandhi

Grade 9

religions

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Answer: Siddhartha Gautama

luxury: many fine and expensive things

opposite: the other side of something. Hot is the opposite of cold.

suffering: pain in the body or the heart



He trains a calm and clear mind.

FRONT

Prince X lives in India, about 2,500 years ago.

In his land, people are born into fixed groups.

These groups are called **castes**.

Priests say they are the highest group.

Prince X becomes a teacher.

He teaches the same way to everyone: farmers, barbers, kings.

- What you do matters more than the group you are born in, he says.

His followers say that a poor barber becomes one of his best students.

Women also join him and become **nuns**.

At this time, few teachers accept women as students.

It is a quiet **revolution**: change through ideas, not weapons.



Farmers, barbers, and kings all learn the same way.

Who is Prince X?

☒ **Siddhartha Gautama**

☐ Confucius

☐ Gandhi

☐ Mandela

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religions

BACK

Answer: Siddhartha Gautama

caste: a fixed group of people. You are born into it.

priest: a person who leads people in their religion

nun: a woman who lives a simple religious life

revolution: a big change in how people live or think



Women also join his group. They live simply and learn.

FRONT

Prince X lives in India, long ago.

Old stories say he leaves his palace to find answers.

Later, he becomes a teacher.

He teaches peace and a calm mind.

Long after his death, the **emperor** Ashoka rules India.

After a terrible war, Ashoka is full of **regret**.

He gives up new **conquests**.

He sends teachers to many lands.

Over hundreds of years, the teaching of Prince X travels the **trade roads**.

It reaches Sri Lanka, then China, Japan, and Southeast Asia.

In each land, it takes a new form: new art, new temples.

Ideas can travel farther than any sword.



The teaching travels the trade roads, land by land.

Who is Prince X?

☒ **Siddhartha Gautama**

☐ Alexander the Great

☐ Confucius

☐ Marx

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Answer: Siddhartha Gautama

emperor: a ruler of many lands and peoples

conquest: taking land from others by war

regret: a sad feeling about something you did

trade road: a road that people use to carry things to sell, from land to land



Each land gives the idea a new form.

FRONT

Prince X teaches in India long ago, but he writes nothing down.

For about four hundred years, **monks** learn his words by heart.

They **recite** the texts together, in groups.

If one monk makes a mistake, the others hear it and correct it.

They work like living books.

Then monks in Sri Lanka write the oldest full collection on palm leaves.

The leaves grow old, so monks copy them again and again.

Scholars today compare old copies to find his real words.

One part of his training of the mind is called **mindfulness**.

Hospitals around the world now use it to help people with stress and pain.

An old idea lives on: first in memory, then on leaves, now in hospitals.



The monks say the words together, from memory.

Who is Prince X?

☒ **Siddhartha Gautama**

☐ Socrates

☐ Confucius

☐ Aristotle

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religions

BACK

Answer: Siddhartha Gautama

monk: a man who lives a simple religious life in a group

recite: to say a text aloud from memory

scholar: a person who studies a subject very deeply

mindfulness: training to notice calmly what happens in your mind and body right now



Much later, the words are written on palm leaves.

FRONT

Land X lies in the south of Europe.

It has high mountains and hundreds of islands.

The warm blue sea is never far away.

The **soil** is thin, but olive trees and grapes grow well.

Many people become fishers, sailors, and traders.

Long ago, the land has no single king.

Instead, people live in many small **city-states**.

These cities are proud, and they often compete with each other.

In the middle of the city lies the **agora**, a busy market square.

People meet there, buy food, and talk about the news.

High on a rock over one famous city, a white **marble** temple still stands today.



Mountains, olive trees, islands, and the blue sea.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Egypt
- ☒ **Greece**
- ☐ Rome
- ☐ Phoenicia

Grade 6

civilizations

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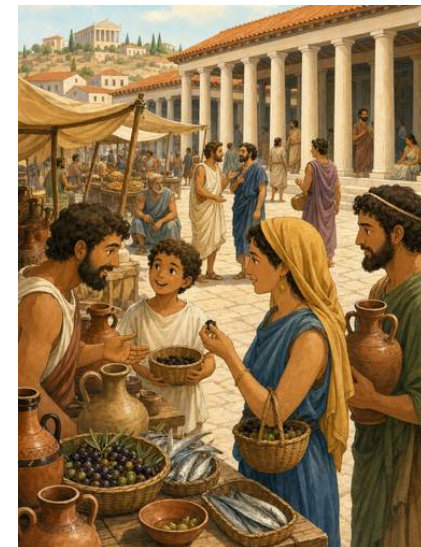
Answer: Greece

soil: the earth on the ground where plants grow

city-state: a city with its own laws and leaders, like a small country

agora: the open market square in the middle of the city

marble: a hard, shiny stone for fine buildings



The agora: people buy, sell, and talk about the news.

FRONT

About 2,500 years ago, one city-state in Land X tries a new idea.

The free men of the city meet on a hill.

They talk, and then they **vote** by raising their hands.

They decide about laws, money, war, and peace.

Many city jobs go **by lot**, like names from a hat.

The people call this *demokratia*, 'the people rule'.

Our word '**democracy**' comes from this.

But most people in the city cannot vote.

Women cannot vote, and neither can **slaves** or people from other cities.

So this democracy is a start, not the finish.

Today, many lands build on the idea, and more people can vote.



The free men meet on a hill. They vote with their hands.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Rome
- ☐ Egypt
- ☒ **Greece**
- ☐ Mesopotamia

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civilizations

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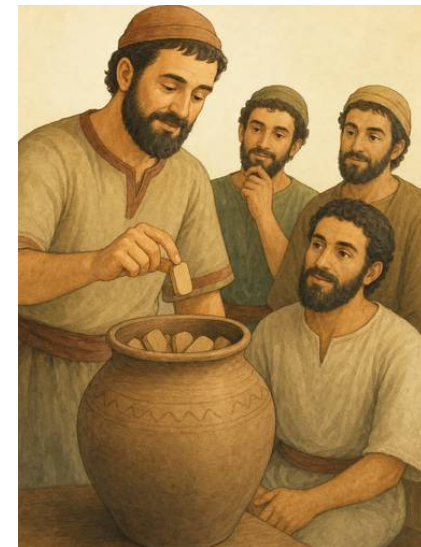
Answer: Greece

vote: to say your choice when a group decides something

by lot: chosen by chance, like pulling a name from a hat

slave: a person who is not free and is owned by another person

democracy: the people rule: the people of a land decide together



Many city jobs go by lot, like names from a hat.

FRONT

About 2,500 years ago, the people of Land X build the first great theaters.

First people sit on wooden benches.

Later they cut half-circles of stone seats into their hillsides.

Some theaters hold more than ten thousand people.

The **actors** wear **masks** with big, clear faces.

So people far up on the hill can still see who is sad or angry.

A sad play is a **tragedy**: it shows great people who fall through their own mistakes.

A funny play is a **comedy**: it laughs at the rich and powerful.

The plays ask big questions.

What is right, what is fair, and who decides?

Thousands of people watch together and feel together.

Our words 'theater', 'drama', 'tragedy', and 'comedy' come from the language of Land X.



Stone seats in a half-circle on a hillside. Thousands of people watch a play here.

Which land is this?

- ☒ **Greece**
- ☐ Rome
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Mesopotamia

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Answer: Greece

mask: a false face you wear over your own face

tragedy: a serious, sad play

comedy: a funny play

actor: a person who plays someone else in a play



One mask cries, one mask laughs.

FRONT

In old times, Land X is not one country.

It is hundreds of proud **city-states**, and they often **quarrel**.

Two of them are famous opposites.

One famous city loves ships, trade, and open talk.

Its rival loves order, simple food, and hard training.

Yet all these cities feel like one people.

They speak one language and **honor** the same gods.

They share the same stories about gods and heroes.

Many cities also send ships out and start **colonies**.

These new towns grow on coasts from Spain to the Black Sea.

A famous thinker from Land X writes: we live around the sea like frogs around a pond.



New towns grow along the coasts, like frogs around a pond.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Phoenicia
- ☐ Egypt
- ☒ **Greece**
- ☐ Rome

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Answer: Greece

city-state: a city with its own laws and leaders, like a small country

quarrel: to argue and fight with each other

honor: to show great respect for someone

colony: a new town that people from a city build in a faraway land



People from the old city build a new town by the sea.

FRONT

Historians ask: how do we know the story of Land X?

Its old books of plays, science, and **philosophy** survive only as copies of copies.

For centuries, **scribes** in Constantinople copy them, and scholars in Baghdad translate many science and philosophy books into Arabic.

Without this long work, most of the old books are gone today.

The white marble **ruins** tell only half the truth, too.

New research shows: long ago, the temples and statues shine with bright colors.

Later ages love the bare white stone and dream of a pure, perfect Land X.

But real life there includes slavery and long wars between the cities.

So historians see two lands: the real one, and the beautiful dream.

Both of them shape our world today.



This temple is white today. Long ago, parts of it have bright colors.

Which land is this?

- ☐ Rome
- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Mesopotamia
- ☒ **Greece**

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civilizations

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Answer: Greece

philosophy: the study of big questions about life and thinking

scribe: a person whose work is copying books by hand

ruin: a broken old building



The same statue: white today, colorful long ago.

FRONT

Games X take place in Greece, long ago.
They happen every four years, at one **holy** place.
People travel there from many Greek towns.
They watch runners, **wrestlers**, and jumpers.
The **stadium** has room for many thousands of people.
The winner gets no gold and no money.
He gets a **crown** of leaves from a holy olive tree.
At home, people greet the winner like a hero.
The games go on for more than a thousand years.
Today, the biggest games in the world carry the same name.



The runners race. Thousands of people watch.

Which games are these?

- ☐ The Roman gladiator games
- ☒ **The Olympic Games**
- ☐ The Pythian Games
- ☐ The Panathenaic Games

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Answer: The Olympic Games

holy: very special for a god or a religion

wrestler: a sports person who tries to bring another person to the ground, without hitting

stadium: a big place for sport, with room for many watchers

crown: a ring that you wear on your head



The prize: a crown of olive leaves.

FRONT

In Greece, long ago, the towns often fight each other.

But every four years, something special happens.

Messengers walk from town to town.

They call out: Games X start soon!

Games X are the oldest and greatest games in Greece.

They honor the king of the Greek gods.

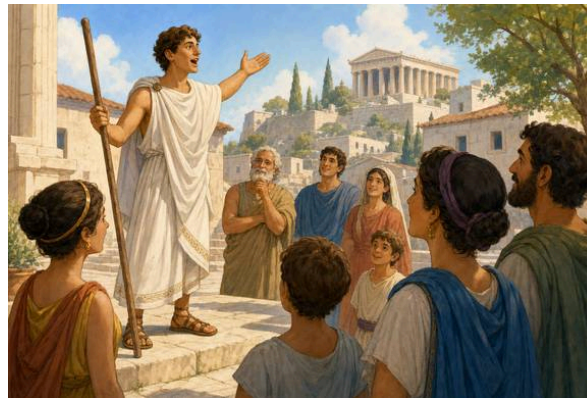
Now a **holy** peace begins.

Everyone who travels to the games must be safe.

Athletes and visitors walk through enemy land, and no one may harm them.

At the games, enemies **compete** in sport, not in war.

For a short time, sport brings the Greek world together.



A messenger calls out: the games start soon!

Which games are these?

- ☐ The Panathenaic Games
- ☐ The Pythian Games
- ☒ **The Olympic Games**
- ☐ The Isthmian Games

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civilizations

BACK

Answer: The Olympic Games

messenger: a person who carries news from place to place

holy: very special for a god or a religion

athlete: a person who does sport, for example a runner

compete: to try to win against others



The holy peace: everyone travels safely to the games.

FRONT

Games X take place at a holy place in Greece, every four years.

The oldest event is simple: a short, fast run across the stadium.

Later come wrestling, the long jump, and the **discus** throw.

Before the games, every athlete swears an **oath**: I follow the rules.

A **cheater** must pay money.

The money pays for statues on the way into the stadium.

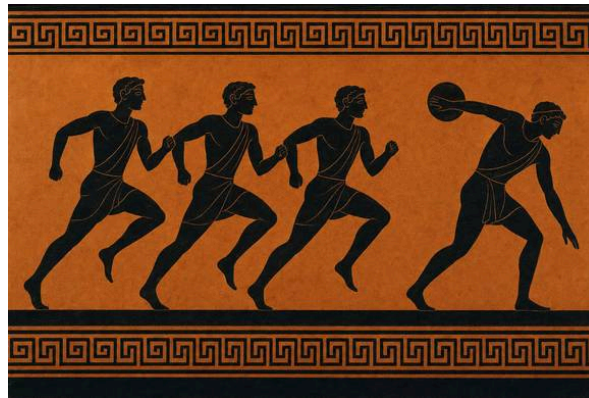
The statues warn every new athlete: win with **honor**.

The Greeks believe: a strong body and a sharp mind belong together.

But the games are not open to everyone.

Only free Greek men may compete.

Girls hold their own races for a goddess, at the same holy place.



Old Greek art shows the athletes.

Which games are these?

☒ **The Olympic Games**

☐ The Isthmian Games

☐ The Nemean Games

☐ The Pythian Games

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Answer: The Olympic Games

oath: a very serious promise

cheater: a person who breaks the rules to win

discus: a flat, round, heavy plate that athletes throw far

honor: when people see you as good and fair



A discus. Athletes throw this flat, round plate.

FRONT

Games X begin in Greece, almost 3,000 years ago.

Athletes meet there every four years, for more than a thousand years.

Then new rulers come, with a new **religion**.

They do not like **festivals** for the old gods. Slowly, the games stop.

For about 1,500 years, there are no games.

At the end of the 1800s, a man in France gets a big idea.

His big idea: let the young people of the world meet in sport, not in war.

So the games wake up again, now for the whole world.

A new city **hosts** them every four years.

Now women compete too.

Today, before the games begin, a **flame** travels from the old place in Greece to the new stadium.



The flame burns. The whole world watches the games.

Which games are these?

- ☐ The Panathenaic Games
- ☐ The Pythian Games
- ☒ **The Olympic Games**
- ☐ The Isthmian Games

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: The Olympic Games

religion: belief in a god or gods, with its own rules and feasts

festival: a big feast or celebration for many people

host: to hold the games in your own city

flame: the bright, burning part of a fire



A runner carries the flame to the stadium.

FRONT

How do we know about Games X in old Greece?

First: lists.

Greek writers keep long lists of the winners.

Later historians even count time with these games: four years, from games to games.

Second: a traveler.

About 1,800 years ago, a travel writer visits the holy place and describes its temples and statues.

Third: the ground.

Rivers and **earthquakes bury** the old place under sand and earth.

In the 1800s, **archaeologists** start to dig it out: the temples and stones with the winners' names. Later they also uncover the stadium.

One warning: many people say that all wars stop during the games.

The **sources** show less: a holy peace protects the travelers, but wars go on in other places.



The holy place today. Grass grows between the old stones.

Which games are these?

- ☐ The Pythian Games
- ☐ The Panathenaic Games
- ☐ The Nemean Games
- ☒ **The Olympic Games**

University

civilizations

BACK

Answer: The Olympic Games

source: an old text or thing that gives us knowledge about the past

earthquake: when the ground shakes strongly

bury: to cover something with earth or sand

archaeologist: a person who digs in the ground to find things from the past



Archaeologists dig out the old stones.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Rome, about 2,000 years ago.

He is only eighteen when his famous **great-uncle** dies.

The great-uncle is Rome's most famous leader.

In his **will**, the great-uncle **adopts** Mr X as his son.

Suddenly, the young man carries a very powerful name.

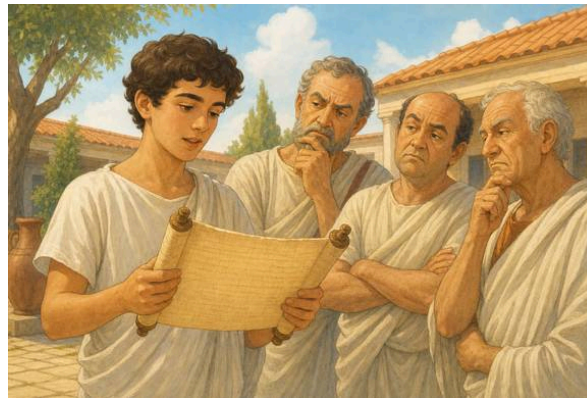
Many older men think: he is only a boy.

But Mr X is patient and careful.

After many hard years, he becomes the first **emperor** of Rome.

He rules for more than forty years, and Rome has peace.

One month of the year gets his name: August.



A young man reads an important paper.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☒ **Augustus**
- ☐ Nero
- ☐ Alexander the Great

Grade 6

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Augustus

great-uncle: the brother of your grandmother or grandfather

will: a paper that says who gets your money and things after your death

adopt: to take a child into your family as your own child, by law

emperor: like a king, but over many lands



A will says who gets your things after your death.

FRONT

For many years, Romans fight Romans in **civil wars**.

Then one man wins, and the fighting stops.

He becomes Emperor X, the first emperor of Rome.

A long time of peace begins.

People later call it Pax Romana, the Roman Peace.

Farmers can work, and **traders** can travel safely again.

The emperor repairs old temples and builds many new buildings.

An old writer tells us his words: "I find Rome a city of **brick**. I leave it a city of **marble**."

The peace lasts, with few breaks, for about two hundred years.

His long peace makes Rome richer than any war.



Workers build with white marble. The city changes.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☐ Constantine
- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☒ **Augustus**

Grade 9

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Augustus

civil war: a war between people of the same country

trader: a person who buys and sells things

brick: a small building block of baked clay

marble: a fine, shiny stone for beautiful buildings



Brick is baked clay. Marble is a fine, shiny stone.

FRONT

The people of Rome hate the word "king".
Long ago, they throw their kings out.
Mr X knows this well.
He rules Rome alone, but he never takes the **title** of king.
He wears no crown.
He calls himself "**princeps**", the first citizen.
Elections and the old jobs continue, like before.
But Mr X keeps control of the army and the money.
He says that he gives the **republic** back to the **senate** and the people.
He rules like this for more than forty years and dies as an old man.
Words can hide power as well as show it.



No crown, no throne. He sits like one citizen among many.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Augustus**
- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☐ Nero
- ☐ Constantine

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Augustus

title: an official name for a person's job or rank

princeps: a Latin word: the first citizen, the first man of the state

senate: a group of powerful men who guide the Roman state

republic: a state without a king; the people choose their leaders



He says no to a crown.

FRONT

Emperor X is the first emperor of Rome, and he rules for a long time.

Everywhere in the empire, people see his face.

In city after city, **statues** show him young, calm, and strong.

He grows old, but his statues never do.

Coins travel through the whole empire, and his face travels with them.

Great poets write that a new **golden age** begins with him.

One famous poem says that the gods choose Rome to rule the world.

The emperor and his rich friends support these poets.

Is this art, or is it **advertising** for one man?

Today we have a word for it: **propaganda**, pictures and words that build power.



A marble statue shows the emperor young and strong.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☒ **Augustus**
- ☐ Nero

Grade 12

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Augustus

statue: a figure of a person, made of stone or metal

golden age: a very good and happy time

advertising: pictures and words that try to sell something

propaganda: pictures, words, and art that try to control what people think



A small coin carries a face across the empire.

FRONT

Near the end of his long life, Emperor X writes a short report about himself.

The title means: "The things I did".

After his death, workers **carve** the text in stone in cities across the empire.

One big copy survives on a temple wall in today's Turkey.

In the text, the first emperor of Rome counts his buildings, his gifts, and his honors.

He writes that he saves the state and refuses to be a **dictator**.

He does not name his old enemies, and he does not mention his mistakes.

For **historians**, the text is a treasure: facts from the ruler himself.

But it is also a story with one storyteller: the main person himself.

So historians compare it with coins, ruins, and other writers.

Every **source** answers the question: who speaks, and who is silent?



The emperor writes his own story, and workers carve it in stone.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☐ Hammurabi
- ☐ Constantine
- ☒ **Augustus**

University

civilizations

BACK

Answer: Augustus

carve: to cut letters or pictures into stone or wood

dictator: in Rome, a leader who gets all power alone, for a short time, in an emergency

historian: a person who studies the past

source: a text or an object that gives us information about the past



A worker carves signs into hard stone. Stone words last very long.

FRONT

Mr X lives about 2,000 years ago.

He grows up in a small, quiet village.

His father is a **carpenter**, and Mr X learns to work with wood too.

As a grown man, he becomes a teacher.

He walks from village to village near a big lake.

Fishermen leave their boats to hear him.

He teaches with short stories from everyday life.

One story is about a **shepherd** who looks for one lost sheep.

The shepherd does not rest until he finds it.

Every person matters, the story says.

People all over the world still tell his stories today.



A teacher tells stories by a big lake.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Buddha
- ☒ **Jesus**
- ☐ Muhammad
- ☐ Moses

Grade 6

religions

BACK

Answer: Jesus

carpenter: a person who builds things from wood

fisherman: a person who catches fish

shepherd: a person who takes care of sheep



A shepherd finds his lost sheep and carries it home.

FRONT

Mr X is a teacher who lives about 2,000 years ago. Crowds follow him from village to village and up a green hillside.

- Love your **neighbor** as yourself, he teaches.

And he goes further: love your **enemies** too, he teaches.

He also teaches **forgiveness**: do not pay back a bad thing with a bad thing.

Forgive, not once, but again and again, he says.

And he gives one simple rule for daily life:

- Do to other people what you want them to do to you.

People later call this the **golden rule**.

Easy to say, hard to do, then and now.



A teacher speaks to a big crowd on a green hillside.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Moses
- ☐ Buddha
- ☒ **Jesus**
- ☐ Muhammad

Grade 9

religions

BACK

Answer: Jesus

neighbor: a person who lives near you; here it means every other person

enemy: a person who is against you

forgiveness: you stop being angry with a person who did a bad thing to you

golden rule: a famous rule: treat other people as you want them to treat you; Mr X says it with a 'do', not a 'do not'



Forgiveness: you stop being angry.

FRONT

Mr X is a famous teacher, about 2,000 years ago.
He answers big questions with small stories, called **parables**.

A man asks him: who is my neighbor?

Mr X answers with a parable.

A traveler is robbed and lies hurt by the road.

Two respected men see him, and they walk past.

Then a **foreigner** stops, a man from a group that many people **look down on**.

He cleans the traveler's **wounds**, puts him on his own donkey, and pays for his care.

- Who is the neighbor in the story? Mr X asks.

The listener must find the answer himself: the one who helps.

A rule is easy to forget, but a good story stays with you.



One man stops and helps the hurt traveler.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Jesus**
- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Buddha
- ☐ Muhammad

Grade 12

religions

BACK

Answer: Jesus

parable: a short story with a lesson inside

foreigner: a person from another land or group

wound: a hurt place on the body

look down on: to think that a person is less important



The lesson lives today: help, even a stranger.

FRONT

Mr X lives about 2,000 years ago, in a land ruled by Rome.

He is a teacher with a small group of **followers**.

The Roman rulers see him as a danger, and he is put to death.

But his followers do not give up.

His followers believe that he rises from death.

This **faith** makes them brave, and they carry his teaching from land to land.

Today, his followers form the largest religion in the world.

Our **calendar** counts the years from his birth.

But the **monk** who works out his birth year, many centuries later, makes a small mistake.

So Mr X is probably born a few years 'before' year one!



From one small land, the teaching travels around a great sea.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Muhammad
- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☒ **Jesus**
- ☐ Buddha

Grade 12

religions

BACK

Answer: Jesus

follower: a person who believes in a teacher and lives by his words

faith: a strong belief in a religion

calendar: the way we count and name days and years

monk: a man who lives a simple, religious life



A simple fish: an old sign of the first followers.

FRONT

Mr X is a teacher who lives about 2,000 years ago.

He writes no book himself.

So how do we know about him?

Decades after his death, his followers write four short books about his life.

The writers are **believers**, not **neutral** reporters.

Old Roman and Jewish **historians** also mention him, in a few short lines.

Because of this, almost all historians agree: the man is real.

He teaches, he gathers followers, and he is put to death by Roman power.

Believers say much more: for them, he is the Son of God.

History cannot prove such faith, and it cannot show it is wrong.

Historians and believers read the same old pages, with different questions.



Many years after his death, followers write his story down.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Muhammad
- ☐ Buddha
- ☒ **Jesus**

University

religions

BACK

Answer: Jesus

decade: a time of ten years

believer: a person who belongs to a religion

neutral: not taking any side

historian: a person who studies the past



A historian studies a very old page.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Arabia, about 1,400 years ago.

His town, Mecca, is a busy trading town in the desert.

Camel **caravans** stop there on long journeys.

Mr X works as a **trader**.

People trust him with their goods and money.

He often goes to a quiet **cave** in the mountains to think.

Muslims believe that an **angel** speaks to him there.

The angel brings him messages from God, Muslims believe.

Mr X starts to teach these messages to others.

Today, almost two billion people follow his message.

They are called Muslims.



A camel caravan travels through the desert to a trading town.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Jesus
- ☐ Buddha
- ☒ **Muhammad**
- ☐ Moses

Grade 6

religions

BACK

Answer: Muhammad

trader: a person who buys and sells things

caravan: a group of people and animals that travel together

cave: a big hole in a rock or mountain

angel: a messenger from God, in many religions



A quiet cave high up in the mountains.

FRONT

Mr X is a teacher in Arabia, about 1,400 years ago.

As an adult, he begins to teach.

His message is simple and strong.

- There is only one God, he teaches.
- Care for the poor and protect **orphans**.
- Be fair when you buy and sell.

Rich leaders in his hometown, Mecca, do not like this message.

They make life hard for him and his **followers**.

So he moves to another town, Medina.

There, his followers become a strong **community**: the **umma**.

This new start is so important that the Muslim calendar begins in that year.



In a town with palm trees, people share food and help each other.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Muhammad**

☐ Moses

☐ Jesus

☐ Buddha

Grade 9

religions

BACK

Answer: Muhammad

orphan: a child whose mother and father are dead

follower: a person who believes in a teacher and follows him

community: a group of people who live together and help each other

umma: an Arabic word for the community of all Muslims



A community: people help each other like one big family.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Arabia, about 1,400 years ago.

He brings his people a message in **Arabic**, in beautiful and powerful language.

Muslims believe that the words come from God.

Mr X speaks the words out loud to the people.

His followers learn them **by heart**.

They **recite** them: they say them from memory, again and again.

These words become the Quran, the **holy** book of Islam.

The name Quran means "the recitation".

After the death of Mr X, his followers collect all the words in one book.

Today, Muslims all over the world read it in Arabic.

Many learn the whole book by heart.



An old book on a wooden stand. Many people know every word by heart.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Martin Luther
- ☐ Jesus
- ☒ **Muhammad**
- ☐ Buddha

Grade 12

religions

BACK

Answer: Muhammad

recite: to say a text out loud from memory

by heart: from memory, without reading

holy: very special and important in a religion

Arabic: the language of Arabia, spoken in many countries today



The children say the words from memory. They recite.

FRONT

Mr X is a teacher in Arabia, about 1,400 years ago. His message unites many desert **tribes** into one community.

After his death, this message travels far and fast. Within one century, it reaches from Spain in the west to the river Indus in the east.

In this big new world, trade and learning grow.

Scholars translate old books from Greek, Persian, and Indian thinkers.

In the city of Baghdad, a famous library is called the House of Wisdom.

Scholars there work on **algebra**, **astronomy**, and medicine.

The word "algebra" comes from Arabic.

Even our numbers, 1, 2, 3, come to Europe through this world.

A message in the desert opens a new world of knowledge.



Scholars study the stars and write new books in a great library.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☒ **Muhammad**
- ☐ Genghis Khan
- ☐ Jesus

Grade 12

religions

BACK

Answer: Muhammad

tribe: a big group of families with one leader

scholar: a person who studies and knows very much

algebra: a part of mathematics; it uses letters for unknown numbers

astronomy: the study of stars and planets



An old tool for measuring the stars. The study of stars is astronomy.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Arabia, about 1,400 years ago.

How do historians know about his life?

The oldest **source** is the Quran, the holy book of Islam.

But it says little about the events of his life.

Stories about his words and actions are called **hadith**.

For **generations**, people pass these stories on, from teacher to student.

Only later do scholars write them down in big **collections**.

Muslim scholars check every story: who tells it, and who heard it from whom?

Modern historians ask the same kind of questions about all old sources.

Some pages of the Quran that still exist today are very, very old.



A researcher studies very old pages with great care.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Socrates
- ☐ Jesus
- ☐ Buddha
- ☒ **Muhammad**

University

religions

BACK

Answer: Muhammad

source: a text or thing from the past that gives us knowledge

hadith: a story about the words or actions of Mr X

generation: parents are one generation; their children are the next

collection: many things gathered together in one book or place



First people tell the story. Much later, someone writes it down.

FRONT

Empire X is a Christian empire with a **capital** city between two seas.

The city sits where Europe meets Asia.

Water protects it on two sides.

On the land side, the people build two strong walls, one behind the other.

For many centuries, no enemy army can break through these land walls.

Ships from many lands fill the city's great **harbor**.

Traders bring **silk** from the east and furs from the north.

Trade roads from Asia and Europe meet in this city.

Inside the walls, churches shine with pictures made of small golden stones.

People call these pictures **mosaics**.

Travelers say: no city on earth is richer.



Strong walls protect the city on the land side.

Which empire is this?

- ☐ Egypt
- ☐ Rome
- ☒ **The Byzantine Empire**
- ☐ The Ottoman Empire

Grade 6

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Byzantine Empire

capital: the main city of a land, where the ruler lives

harbor: a safe place by the water where ships can stop

silk: a fine, soft cloth that costs very much, first made in China

mosaic: a picture made of many small colored stones



Many small golden stones make one big picture. This is a mosaic.

FRONT

Empire X is a Christian empire in the east.

In its capital stands a very famous building.

The **emperor** wants a church greater than any other church.

Workers finish it in only five years, about 1,500 years ago.

Its giant **dome** seems to float in the air.

Light falls in through a ring of windows under the dome.

An old story says the emperor cries out: I have built something greater than the greatest temple!

For about 900 years, the building is a church.

Then new rulers take the city, and the church becomes a **mosque**.

Much later it becomes a **museum**, and today it is a mosque again.

One building tells the long story of its city.



This famous building is about 1,500 years old.

Which empire is this?

☒ **The Byzantine Empire**

☐ Greece

☐ The Ottoman Empire

☐ Egypt

Grade 9

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Byzantine Empire

dome: a round roof, like the top half of a ball

emperor: the ruler of an empire

mosque: a building where Muslims pray

museum: a building where people can look at old and important things



Light falls in under the great dome. The dome seems to float.

FRONT

About 1,500 years ago, an emperor rules Empire X from a rich city in the east.

His empire still uses the laws of old Rome.

But after a thousand years, the laws are a **mess**.

There are too many laws, and some laws say **opposite** things.

So the emperor calls a team of law **experts**.

Their job: read everything, and sort the good rules into clear books.

The team also writes a small first book for new law students.

Empires end, but these law books survive.

Many centuries later, law schools in Europe study them again.

Today, the laws of many countries still stand on this old **foundation**.

Good laws can live longer than the lands that write them.



The emperor's team sorts a thousand years of laws.

Which empire is this?

☐ Persia

☐ Rome

☐ Egypt

☒ **The Byzantine Empire**

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Byzantine Empire

mess: many things mixed up, without order

expert: a person who knows very much about one thing

opposite: totally different; the other way around

foundation: the strong part under a building;
here: the base that something stands on



Law books today stand on very old ground.

FRONT

The people of Empire X speak Greek, and they guard the old books of Greece.

For about a thousand years, **scribes** copy these books by hand, page by page.

Plays, poems, science, and **philosophy** survive this way.

The empire also argues about holy pictures.

For a time, the emperors even forbid them.

Later, the pictures come back.

About 600 years ago, an army from a new empire takes the capital.

Many **scholars** flee west, to Italy.

In their bags are old Greek books.

In Italy, people are hungry for old knowledge.

The old books feed this new age of art and learning: the **Renaissance**.



Scribes copy the old books by hand, page by page.

Which empire is this?

- ☐ Rome
- ☒ **The Byzantine Empire**
- ☐ The Ottoman Empire
- ☐ Persia

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Byzantine Empire

scribe: a person whose work is to copy books by hand

scholar: a person who studies and knows very much

philosophy: thinking hard about life, truth, and right and wrong

Renaissance: a time in Europe when art and learning grow fast; the word means 'rebirth'



The scholars sail west. The old books travel with them.

FRONT

Here is a strange fact: Empire X never hears its own modern name.

Its people call themselves Romans, in the Greek language.

Their neighbors in the west call them Greeks.

The empire lives long, but one day it falls.

About a hundred years later, a **scholar** in the west **prints** a book about its history.

He needs a name, so he uses the capital's very old Greek name.

His new name wins: today, history books all over the world use it.

Why not simply say Romans?

In the west, kings and popes keep that name for themselves.

Names in history are not **neutral**: someone chooses them, later, and for a reason.

So ask: who names the past?



Long after the empire ends, a scholar gives it a new name.

Which empire is this?

- ☐ The Ottoman Empire
- ☐ Persia
- ☐ Egypt
- ☒ **The Byzantine Empire**

University

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Byzantine Empire

scholar: a person who studies and knows very much

print: to make many copies of a book with a machine

neutral: not taking any side



The empire lies in the east, around one great city between two seas.

FRONT

The X people live in the cold north of Europe, about 1,000 years ago.

Most of them are farmers and fishers.

But they are also great **sailors**.

They build long, fast ships of wood.

The bottom of the ship is almost flat.

So the ship can cross the deep sea, and it can also sail up **shallow** rivers.

The sailors can even pull the ship up on a beach.

With these ships, the X people travel very far.

Some travel to **trade**, and some travel to **rob** other lands.

Today, you can see some of their real ships in museums.



A long, fast ship with one big sail.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Romans
- ☒ **The Vikings**
- ☐ The Phoenicians
- ☐ The Greeks

Grade 6

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Vikings

sailor: a person who travels and works on a ship

shallow: not deep

trade: to buy and sell things

rob: to take things from people with force



The water is shallow here. The ship can still go on.

FRONT

The X people live in the north of Europe, about 1,000 years ago.

Many of them are **traders**.

They sail east over the sea, and then they row up the big rivers.

Between two rivers, they sometimes carry their boats over land.

The rivers lead them south to Constantinople, a very rich city.

In their own language, they call it Miklagard, 'the big city'.

There they sell **furs** from their forests and **amber** from their sea.

They travel home with fine cloth and bright silver coins.

Archaeologists still find many old silver coins in the ground in the north.

Other traders from the same people sail west, to Ireland.

Their trade routes go from Ireland in the west to Constantinople in the east.



The traders travel on the big rivers with their goods.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Phoenicians
- ☐ The Greeks
- ☒ **The Vikings**
- ☐ The Romans

Grade 9

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Vikings

trader: a person who buys and sells things

fur: the warm, hairy skin of an animal

amber: a hard, gold-colored material from old tree sap; people make beads and jewelry from it

archaeologist: a person who digs in the ground to learn about the past



Amber from the northern sea. People love its warm gold color.

FRONT

The X people are sailors from the north of Europe.

They sail west over the open ocean in wooden ships.

They have no **compass** and no sea maps.

They read the sun, the stars, the birds, and the waves.

First, they **settle** on Iceland, an island with volcanoes and **hot springs**.

Later, some sail on to Greenland and build farms there.

Old stories tell of one more land in the west, with wild grapes.

The stories call it Vinland.

For a long time, people think Vinland is only a story.

Then archaeologists find **remains** of their houses in Canada.

People already live in this land, and the old stories tell of meetings with them.

So these sailors reach America about 500 years before Columbus.



No compass, no map: only the sun, the stars, and the birds.

Who are the X people?

☒ **The Vikings**

☐ The Phoenicians

☐ The Greeks

☐ The Romans

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Vikings

compass: a tool that always shows you which way is north

settle: to move to a new place and make your home there

hot spring: a place where hot water comes up out of the ground

remains: the parts of something old that are still there



Houses of earth and grass, in a new land far over the sea.

FRONT

The X people live on farms in the north of Europe, about 1,000 years ago.

They grow food, keep cows and sheep, fish, and make wool cloth.

They also have their own letters, called **runes**.

Runes have straight lines, so a knife can cut them into wood, bone, and stone.

When a loved person dies, the family can raise a big stone with runes on it.

The stone tells the person's name and good **deeds**.

Many of these memory stones still stand today.

A woman in this **society** can have real power: she can own a farm, and she can **inherit** land.

When the men sail away on long journeys, women often lead the farm at home.



A memory stone. The family raises it for a dead loved one.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Phoenicians
- ☐ The Egyptians
- ☐ The Maya
- ☒ **The Vikings**

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Vikings

runes: old letters made of straight lines

deed: a thing that a person does

society: all the people who live together in a country or group

inherit: to get land, money, or things from a family member who dies



She has the keys. She leads the farm when the men are away.

FRONT

About 1,000 years ago, ships from the north of Europe land in many countries.

Some of the X people on the ships rob churches and towns.

The **monks** in the churches can write, and they write about the attacks.

The X people themselves write only short texts.

Their own long stories are written down only hundreds of years later.

So most old books about them come from their **victims**.

Of course, these books show them as wild and **cruel**.

Much later, artists add new details to the picture.

About 150 years ago, a **costume designer** draws horned helmets for an opera.

Archaeologists never find one horned helmet from the real X people.

But films and cartoons still show the horned helmets today.

So when you read history, always ask: who writes this, and why?



A monk writes the story. But is his story the whole truth?

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Mongols
- ☐ The Romans
- ☒ **The Vikings**
- ☐ The Ottomans

University

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Vikings

monk: a religious man who lives simply and prays; many monks can write

victim: a person that something bad happens to

cruel: very unkind; a cruel person hurts others

costume designer: a person who makes the clothes for a play or a film



A real helmet from that time. It has no horns.

FRONT

The X wars begin about 900 years ago.

Knights, farmers, and **priests** in Europe pack their bags and start walking east.

Their goal is a city far away, in the lands at the east end of the Mediterranean Sea.

The city is **holy** for Jews, for Christians, and for Muslims.

The travelers **sew** a cross of cloth on their clothes.

The name of the X wars comes from this sign.

The journey takes months, over mountains and over the sea.

The way is long and dangerous, and many travelers die before they arrive.

The X wars come and go for about 200 years.

People of all three religions suffer in them.



The travelers walk east for many months.

Which wars are these?

- ☐ The Viking raids
- ☒ **The Crusades**
- ☐ The Punic Wars
- ☐ The Mongol conquests

Grade 6

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Crusades

knight: a soldier on a horse with metal clothes, long ago

holy: very special and important for a religion

priest: a man who leads prayers in a church

sew: to join cloth with a needle and thread



A knight. He rides a horse and wears metal clothes.

FRONT

The X wars begin about 900 years ago.

A powerful church leader in Europe gives a famous speech.

He asks people to march east and fight for a holy city, far away.

He promises: God **forgives** the **sins** of everyone who goes.

Why do so many people say yes?

Some truly believe, and want to pray in the holy city.

Some are poor, and hope for a better life.

Some knights dream of **honor** and adventure.

Some **merchants** hope for new trade.

In the east, the travelers see rich cities, bigger than any city at home.

But the people who live there see something else: strange armies at their gates.



A leader speaks. Many people decide to travel east.

Which wars are these?

- ☒ **The Crusades**
- ☐ The Persian Wars
- ☐ The Viking raids
- ☐ The Mongol conquests

Grade 9

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Crusades

sin: a bad act against the rules of a religion

forgive: to stop being angry about a bad act

honor: a good name; people think highly of you

merchant: a person who buys and sells things



A merchant sells cloth and spices.

FRONT

The X wars begin about 900 years ago.

Armies from Europe sail east, to the lands at the east end of the Mediterranean Sea.

The wars return again and again, for many years.

But soldiers are not the only travelers between the two **shores**.

Ships also carry **merchants**, **pilgrims**, and ideas. Europeans taste sugar and lemons, and they want more.

They buy paper, fine glass, and soft cotton cloth.

Arab doctors keep old Greek and Persian medicine alive in their books, and add new knowledge of their own.

Some of this knowledge slowly reaches Europe, through trade and through **translated** books.

Much also comes the peaceful way, through Spain and Sicily.

War closes doors; trade and books open them again.



Ships carry people and goods across the sea.

Which wars are these?

- ☐ The Persian Wars
- ☐ The Mongol conquests
- ☒ **The Crusades**
- ☐ The Viking raids

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Crusades

shore: the land at the edge of the sea

pilgrim: a person who travels far to visit a holy place

merchant: a person who buys and sells things

translate: to say or write something again in another language



A man writes an old book again in a new language.

FRONT

During the X wars, about 900 years ago, an army from Europe reaches the holy city at last.

The soldiers break through the walls, and many people in the city die: Muslims and Jews.

Writers from both sides describe terrible days.

Almost 100 years later, a famous Muslim leader takes the city back.

This time, many people can buy their freedom and leave alive.

The same wars, but not the same choices.

There are more dark **chapters**.

On the way east, some armies attack Jewish families in European towns.

And one army attacks **Constantinople**, a rich Christian city, and **robs** it: Christians against Christians.

Over 200 years, both sides show cruelty, and both sides show mercy.

So the X wars are not a simple story of good against evil.

In every war, **ordinary** people of every religion pay the highest price.



High walls around an old city. War is hardest for the people inside.

Which wars are these?

- ☒ **The Crusades**
- ☐ The Mongol conquests
- ☐ The Viking raids
- ☐ The Punic Wars

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Crusades

chapter: one part of a book; here: one part of a story

rob: to take things from people with force

Constantinople: a big old city by the sea; today it is Istanbul in Turkey

ordinary: normal, not special



Constantinople, a rich city by the sea.

FRONT

The X wars take place about 900 years ago, around a holy city at the east end of the Mediterranean Sea.

European writers of that time call the fighters from Europe holy pilgrims.

Arab writers of the same time call them simply "**the Franks**".

One Arab writer, Usama ibn Munqidh, meets Franks as enemies, and some as friends.

Another, Ibn al-Athir, later writes about the fall of the holy city with deep sadness.

European books tell the same days as a great victory.

Same city, same days: two very different stories.

Today, **politicians** sometimes use the name of these wars as a weapon in their speeches.

The old word still makes people angry or proud.

A **historian** reads both sides and checks every story against the **sources**.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Still life: two old closed books lie side by side on a dark wooden desk in the same warm light. One is bound in pale leather with brass corner fittings in a medieval European style, the other in dark red tooled leather with a flap cover in a medieval Middle Eastern style. Both books are the same size, so neither looks more important.

Two old books tell about the same wars.

Which wars are these?

- ☐ The Persian Wars
- ☐ The Punic Wars
- ☐ The Mongol conquests
- ☒ **The Crusades**

University

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Crusades

the Franks: an old Arabic name for people from western Europe

politician: a person who works with power and government in a country

source: an old text or thing that gives us knowledge about the past

historian: a person who studies the past



A historian studies old sources from both sides.

FRONT

Sickness X comes about 700 years ago.
It comes on ships from far away.
The ships sail across the sea to busy **ports**.
From the ports, it moves along the **trade roads**.
It travels from town to town.
It **spreads** very fast.
Very many people fall sick.
Sadly, many of them die.
In these years, people do not know what makes them sick.
They cannot see the real **cause**.
They are afraid, and they cannot stop it.



Ships come to a busy town by the sea.

Which sickness is this?

☒ **The Black Death**

☐ Smallpox

☐ Cholera

☐ Leprosy

Grade 6

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Black Death

port: a place by the sea where ships stop

trade road: a road where people carry things to buy and sell

spread: to go from one place or person to many

cause: the thing that makes something happen



Trade roads join far towns across land and sea.

FRONT

About 700 years ago, Sickness X spreads across many lands.

People want to know why.

Some say the air is bad and full of a bad smell.

Some say it is a **punishment**.

They try many strange **cures**, but the cures do not work.

They are only guessing.

Today, we know the real cause.

A tiny living thing, a **germ**, makes people sick.

This germ lives on small **fleas**.

The fleas ride on rats, and the rats travel with people and ships.

Guessing and knowing are not the same thing.



Rats travel with people, ships, and food.

Which sickness is this?

- ☐ Smallpox
- ☐ Malaria
- ☒ **The Black Death**
- ☐ Cholera

Grade 9

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Black Death

punishment: trouble you get when you do something wrong

cure: something that makes a sick person well again

germ: a tiny living thing, too small to see, that can make you sick

flea: a very small jumping insect that bites animals and people



A flea. This tiny insect jumps and bites.

FRONT

About 700 years ago, Sickness X spreads across many lands.

So many people die that some **villages** stand empty.

Before, there are many workers and little land.

Now there are few workers and much land.

But the **lords** still need people to work the fields.

So workers can ask for more **pay** and better food.

Some workers leave a hard lord and walk to a kinder one.

Before, many farmers are **bound** to one lord's land.

Now this old rule grows weak in many lands in western Europe.

A terrible sickness changes who holds the power.

When people are few, their work is worth more.



Few workers, and a lot of empty land.

Which sickness is this?

- ☐ Cholera
- ☐ Leprosy
- ☐ Smallpox
- ☒ **The Black Death**

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

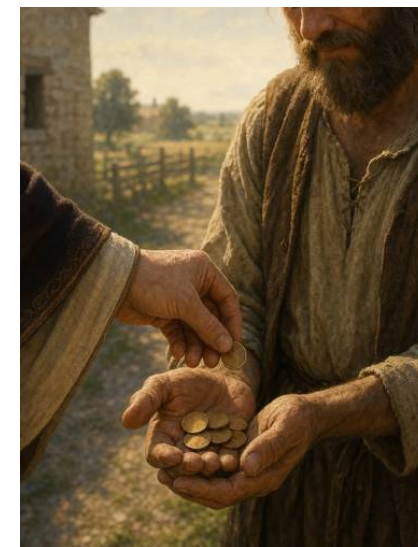
Answer: The Black Death

village: a very small town

lord: a rich man who owns land, and the people work for him

bound: tied to a place, and not free to leave

pay: the money you get for your work



Now workers can ask for more pay.

FRONT

About 700 years ago, Sickness X brings great fear. People are afraid, and they look for someone to **blame**.

In some towns, people wrongly blame their Jewish neighbors.

This is not true, and it is deeply unfair.

Sadly, many Jewish people are hurt and killed.

Fear can make people **cruel** to the **innocent**.

Other towns choose a wiser way.

In one city by the sea, ships must wait before they may land.

This wait lasts forty days.

From these "forty days" comes our word "**quarantine**".

In hard times, fear can lead to cruelty, or to wise care.



Ships must wait out on the water before they can land.

Which sickness is this?

- ☐ Leprosy
- ☒ **The Black Death**
- ☐ Smallpox
- ☐ Cholera

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Black Death

blame: to say that someone did a bad thing

innocent: a person who did nothing wrong

cruel: very unkind; wanting to hurt someone

quarantine: to keep people or ships apart for some days, so a sickness cannot spread



Sailors wait here many days before they may enter the city.

FRONT

About 700 years ago, Sickness X changes the world.

But how do we know about it today?

Writers of that time keep **chronicles**, and they tell of the sickness.

Yet fear and rumor can bend their words.

So historians also read old **tax lists** and church records that name the priests who died.

When many names drop from a list, it can mean many people are gone.

And now there is newer proof, from science.

Scientists study very old bones from graves.

In the teeth, they find the **DNA** of one tiny germ: *Yersinia pestis*.

So an old guess becomes a clear fact.

Many kinds of **sources**, put together, show us the truth.



Scientists study very old samples to learn the truth.

Which sickness is this?

- ☐ Smallpox
- ☐ Leprosy
- ☒ **The Black Death**
- ☐ Malaria

University

middle ages

BACK

Answer: The Black Death

chronicle: an old written record of things that happen, year by year

tax list: an old list of people who must pay money to the ruler

DNA: a tiny code inside living things that tells what they are

source: something from the past that tells us what happened, like a book or a bone



Long ago, writers wrote down what happened in books like this.

FRONT

Khan X lives about 800 years ago, on the wide **grasslands** of Asia.

His people live in round **felt** tents and move with their horses, sheep, and goats.

His father dies when he is a young boy.

His family becomes poor and often has too little food.

The boy learns to ride, to hunt, and to never give up.

The **clans** of the grasslands fight each other all the time.

When he grows up, he does something new.

He brings the fighting clans together into one people.

The clans give him a new name and **title**.

It may mean "strong ruler" or "ruler of all".



The people of the grasslands ride horses and live in round tents.

Who is Khan X?

- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☒ **Genghis Khan**
- ☐ Napoleon Bonaparte
- ☐ Kublai Khan

Grade 6

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Genghis Khan

grassland: big open land where grass grows

felt: thick cloth made of pressed wool

clan: a big group of families that belong together

title: a special name for a ruler or an important person



A round tent of thick felt is a warm home. The family can move it.

FRONT

Khan X grows up on the grasslands of Asia and unites the riding clans.

Then he and his riders build a huge **empire** on land.

His wars are terrible for the people he conquers.

After his death, his sons and grandsons make it even bigger.

It becomes the largest land empire in history.

It reaches from the sea in the east far into Europe.

How can one ruler control such a wide land?

Khan X and his family order horse **stations** along the big roads.

At each station, fresh horses wait.

A **messenger** rides fast, changes to a fresh horse, and rides on.

Messages travel day and night, faster than ever before.

This empire runs on grass, horses, and information.



A messenger rides fast. At the next station, a fresh horse waits.

Who is Khan X?

- ☐ Kublai Khan
- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☐ Julius Caesar
- ☒ **Genghis Khan**

Grade 9

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Genghis Khan

empire: many lands and many people under one ruler

station: a stop-place on a long road

messenger: a person who carries a message



This metal pass means: the ruler sends this rider. Give him a fresh horse.

FRONT

Khan X is a ruler from the grasslands of Asia.
As a boy, he has no school, and he probably never learns to read.
As a young man, he unites the fighting clans into one people.
He orders a writing system for his people's language.
He gives his empire **strict** laws.
He chooses his generals for their skill, not for their family name.
Even a poor **herder**'s son can become a top **commander**.
People of many religions live in his empire, and all can pray in their own way.
When his army takes a city, it spares the skilled **craft workers**.
But they must move far away and work for the empire.
Many of the other people in these cities are killed or lose their homes.
A ruler who cannot read builds a state that runs on writing, law, and skill.



People from many lands meet in peace in one empire.

Who is Khan X?

- ☒ **Genghis Khan**
- ☐ Hammurabi
- ☐ Napoleon Bonaparte
- ☐ Kublai Khan

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Genghis Khan

strict: very firm; the rules must be followed

herder: a person who keeps and moves animals, like sheep or horses

commander: a leader of soldiers

craft worker: a person who makes things with their hands, like pots, cloth, or tools



A craft worker makes fine things by hand. The empire wants this skill.

FRONT

Khan X, a rider who unites the clans of the grasslands, builds a giant empire across Asia.

Under him and his family, one power guards the long **trade** roads between east and west.

An old saying tells: a girl can carry a bag of gold across the empire, and no one robs her.

Silk, paper, and new ideas travel from land to land.

But the roads carry more than **goods**.

About a hundred years later, a **deadly** sickness follows them all the way to Europe.

And this peace has a terrible price.

The wars of Khan X kill millions of people.

Cities that do not give up are destroyed.

Traders remember the safe roads. The destroyed cities remember something else.

The empire opens roads for the world, and destroys millions of lives to build them.



Traders carry goods along the long, safe roads.

Who is Khan X?

- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☐ Napoleon Bonaparte
- ☒ **Genghis Khan**
- ☐ Kublai Khan

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Genghis Khan

trade: buying and selling things

goods: things people buy and sell

deadly: so dangerous that people die from it



Long roads join east and west. Goods and ideas travel on them.

FRONT

Khan X, a ruler from the grasslands of Asia, builds a huge empire about 800 years ago.

How can we know about him today?

Soon after his death, his own people write his story in their own language.

That book is even called "The Secret History."

It shows him from the inside: his poor childhood, his fears, and his mistakes.

The peoples he **conquers** write about him too, in Persian, Arabic, and Chinese.

They see their burned cities, and in their books he is often a monster.

Later, travelers from Europe visit the empire and send home **reports**.

Some report wild "**barbarians**"; others report law, order, and safe roads.

So who is he: a monster, or a builder of a state?

Every **source** stands somewhere; the historian's job is to see where.



Three old books tell about the same man. They do not tell the same story.

Who is Khan X?

- ☐ Alexander the Great
- ☐ Napoleon Bonaparte
- ☒ **Genghis Khan**
- ☐ Kublai Khan

University

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Genghis Khan

source: an old text or thing that gives us information about the past

conquer: to take a land by force

report: a text that tells what a person sees and learns

barbarian: an unfair old word for people that writers see as wild and simple



A traveler from far away writes a report about all he sees.

FRONT

Miss X lives in France about 600 years ago.
She is a farm girl in a small village.
She watches the animals and helps at home.
She cannot read or write.
Her land is at war with England, year after year.
One day she tells people a strange thing.
She says **holy** voices speak to her.
The voices tell her to save France, she says.
She is only about seventeen years old.
Yet she gets **armor**, a horse, and a place in the army.
Soon grown soldiers follow the farm girl into **battle**.



A farm girl watches the animals near her small village.

Who is Miss X?

- ☐ Mulan
- ☒ **Joan of Arc**
- ☐ Cleopatra
- ☐ Boudicca

Grade 6

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Joan of Arc

armor: hard metal clothes that keep a soldier safe

holy: of God, or close to God

battle: a fight between armies



Armor: hard metal clothes that keep a soldier safe.

FRONT

Miss X is a young woman in France, about 600 years ago.

France and England fight a war that lasts about a hundred years.

Now an English army surrounds Orléans, a key city on a river.

The **siege** lasts many months, and food runs low.

If this city falls, all France may fall.

Miss X says God sends her to save the city.

She rides in with fresh soldiers and food.

She carries a white **banner** into the fight.

She loves it more than her sword, she says.

The tired **defenders** find new hope and attack.

Within about a week, the English army leaves.

The long war slowly begins to turn.



An army camps around the city. No food comes in.

Who is Miss X?

- ☐ Boudicca
- ☐ Isabella I of Castile
- ☐ Elizabeth I
- ☒ **Joan of Arc**

Grade 9

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Joan of Arc

siege: an army waits around a city so no food or help can come in

banner: a flag on a pole that soldiers follow

defender: a person who fights to keep a place safe



Soldiers look for the banner of their leader in the field.

FRONT

Miss X is a young French woman, famous from a long war.

She is **captured** in battle and sold to the English side.

Simply killing a famous prisoner is not enough for them.

They set up a church court to judge her.

The judges ask about the voices she says she hears.

They hope to prove that her voices are not from God.

Scribes write down every question and every answer.

For weeks, they question her, day after day.

She cannot read, yet she answers with care.

One question is a trap: is she in God's **grace**?

- If I am not, may God put me there, she answers.

Still, the court finds her **guilty**, and she is put to death.



One young prisoner stands alone before many judges.

Who is Miss X?

- ☒ **Joan of Arc**
- ☐ Anne Boleyn
- ☐ Marie Antoinette
- ☐ Mary, Queen of Scots

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Joan of Arc

capture: to take a person prisoner

scribe: a person whose job is to write things down

grace: God's love and help, in Christian belief

guilty: the court says: this person did the bad thing



A scribe writes down every question and every answer.

FRONT

About 600 years ago, France is torn by war.
The king of England says the French **crown** is his.
Many French **lords** take the English side.
The young French prince is poor and full of **doubt**.
He is not even crowned in Reims, the city of kings.
Then Miss X, a village girl, comes to his court.
She says God sends her to make him true king.
In that age, a sign from God is strong politics.
The prince decides to try her help, and it works.
After a big victory, she leads him to Reims.
He is crowned there, and many doubters accept him.
When she is taken prisoner later, her king sends no help.



In the city of kings, a prince becomes a crowned king.

Who is Miss X?

- ☐ Eleanor of Aquitaine
- ☐ Margaret of Anjou
- ☒ **Joan of Arc**
- ☐ Isabella I of Castile

Grade 12

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Joan of Arc

crown: to make a person king or queen in a holy ceremony

lord: a rich and powerful man who rules land

doubt: a feeling that a thing may not be true or real



A crown is not just gold. It says: this rule is holy.

FRONT

Miss X is a French village girl from about 600 years ago.

Most village girls of her time leave no **trace**.

Yet historians know her better than most kings.

The reason: her famous trial is written down, word for word.

About twenty-five years later, a new court reopens her case.

It listens to her childhood friends and her old soldiers.

Their memories fill page after page.

The first court wants her guilty; the second wants her **innocent**.

So historians read both **records** with careful, cool eyes.

Almost five hundred years after her death, the Church names her a saint.

Today she is a national **symbol** of France.

Many political groups, left and right, use her as their sign.



The old trial records still exist. Historians read every page.

Who is Miss X?

- ☐ Bernadette of Lourdes
- ☒ **Joan of Arc**
- ☐ Catherine of Siena
- ☐ Hildegard of Bingen

University

middle ages

BACK

Answer: Joan of Arc

trace: a small sign that a person or thing was there

record: a written text that saves what people say and do

innocent: not guilty; the person did not do the bad thing

symbol: a person or thing that stands for a bigger idea



A statue can turn one person into a symbol for a whole land.

FRONT

Period X begins about 600 years ago, in the trading cities of Italy.

These cities grow rich from silk, **spices**, wool, and banks.

Ships and mule roads connect them with faraway lands.

The richest families want fine art in their homes and churches.

They pay artists to paint walls and build **domes**.

The artists learn from old Roman statues and buildings.

A young artist starts as a helper in a **master's workshop**.

He cleans brushes, mixes colors, and copies drawings.

After many years, he can become a master too.

Each city wants finer churches and statues than its neighbors.

So the cities compete with art, not only with ships and gold.



Ships bring silk and spices. The trading cities grow rich.

Which period is this?

- ☐ The Middle Ages
- ☒ **The Renaissance**
- ☐ The Industrial Revolution
- ☐ The Enlightenment

Grade 6

exploration

BACK

Answer: The Renaissance

spices: parts of plants that give food a strong taste

workshop: a room where a master and helpers make things

master: a fully trained artist or craftsman who teaches others

dome: a round roof, like half a ball



A dome, a round roof like half a ball, rises over the church.

FRONT

Period X starts in Italy about 600 years ago and spreads across Europe.

In this period, **scholars** hunt for old books.

They search in the dusty book rooms of **monasteries**.

There they find texts from ancient Rome, copied by **monks** long ago.

Some of these texts lie almost forgotten for a thousand years.

Scholars from the Greek east bring more old texts to Italy.

Now people can read famous Greek thinkers again.

The scholars compare the copies and fix mistakes in them.

Rich men pay for new libraries, open to readers.

The old texts are full of ideas about law, nature, and a good life.

Readers begin to ask new questions about their own time.



In a monastery, a scholar finds a text a thousand years old.

Which period is this?

- ☐ The Reformation
- ☐ The Middle Ages
- ☒ **The Renaissance**
- ☐ The Enlightenment

Grade 9

exploration

BACK

Answer: The Renaissance

scholar: a person whose work is studying and learning

monastery: a house where monks live, work, and pray

monk: a religious man who lives simply in a monastery



Monks keep the old texts safe, some even chained to the shelf.

FRONT

Period X brings new art to Italy about 600 years ago.

The painters of this time face an old problem.

A wall or a wood **panel** is flat.

How can a painting look deep, like a view through a window?

An **architect** in Florence finds exact rules for this. Far things must be painted smaller, by fixed rules. Lines that run away from the viewer must meet in one point.

Painters draw floors, streets, and halls with these rules.

Now the picture opens like a window in the wall.

Painters also study light, **shadow**, and the human body.

Rooms in their paintings look real enough to step into.



Far things look smaller. The lines that run into the depth meet in one point.

Which period is this?

☒ **The Renaissance**

☐ The Middle Ages

☐ The Enlightenment

☐ The Reformation

Grade 12

exploration

BACK

Answer: The Renaissance

panel: a flat piece of wood that artists paint on

architect: a person who plans and designs buildings

shadow: the dark place where light does not reach



The painter draws by rule. The flat panel starts to look deep.

FRONT

Period X spreads from Italy across Europe about 500 years ago.

In the middle of this period, a new machine appears in Europe.

In Germany, printers build **presses** with **movable** metal letters.

People in China and Korea print with movable letters much earlier.

In Europe this is new, and it changes how ideas travel.

A printed book costs much less than a hand-written copy.

A scholar in Italy writes about an old Roman text.

A few months later, students in Paris read the printed pages.

Scholars like him are called **humanists**.

They study language, history, poetry, and the good life.

Their rule is: go back to the **sources**, read the oldest texts yourself.



Printed books cost little. Ideas travel fast now.

Which period is this?

- ☐ The Reformation
- ☐ The Industrial Revolution
- ☐ The Enlightenment
- ☒ **The Renaissance**

Grade 12

exploration

BACK

Answer: The Renaissance

press: a machine that pushes ink onto paper

movable: easy to move and use again in a new place

humanist: a scholar who studies language, history, and poetry

source: the oldest text, where an idea first comes from



Far from Italy, a young scholar reads the printed pages.

FRONT

Historians give names to the periods of the past. But who chooses the names, and where do the lines go?

Period X shows how hard this is.

About 160 years ago, the Swiss **historian** Jacob Burckhardt writes a famous book about it.

He says: in Italy, six or seven hundred years ago, old art and learning are born again.

People there discover the world and themselves, he writes.

Later historians **doubt** this sharp, clean break.

Life for most farmers changes little in these years.

Scholars in the centuries before also read old Roman texts.

Some historians say: the sharp break is a story told long afterwards.

Today, many see both **continuity** and real new things in art and learning.



A sharp break, or a slow change? Historians do not agree.

Which period is this?

- ☐ The Middle Ages
- ☐ The Enlightenment
- ☒ **The Renaissance**
- ☐ The Reformation

University

exploration

BACK

Answer: The Renaissance

historian: a person who studies and writes about the past

doubt: to not feel sure that something is true

continuity: when life goes on without a sharp change



A historian writes about a period hundreds of years after it ends.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Italy more than five hundred years ago.

He is born in a small village among hills.

As a boy, he draws everything he sees.

His father takes him to the rich city of Florence.

There he becomes an **apprentice** in a famous **workshop**.

He learns to paint, to mix colors, and to shape metal.

But he asks questions about everything.

He asks why birds fly and how water moves.

A story tells: one day the student paints better than his master.

Later he paints a **portrait** of a woman with a quiet smile.

Today it may be the most famous painting in the world.



A young apprentice learns from a master in the workshop.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Michelangelo
- ☒ **Leonardo da Vinci**
- ☐ Raphael
- ☐ Galileo Galilei

Grade 6

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Leonardo da Vinci

apprentice: a young person who learns a job from a master

workshop: a room where people make things with their hands

portrait: a painting of a person



An apprentice grinds and mixes the colors for the paint.

FRONT

Mr X is an artist and thinker in Italy, about five hundred years ago.

He carries a small **notebook** on his belt.

He fills page after page with drawings and notes.

Machines, rivers, plants, faces: he draws everything.

In all, thousands of pages survive today.

But his writing runs from right to left.

Every letter is turned, as in a **mirror**.

To read it, you can hold the page to a mirror.

Maybe he hides his ideas from **curious** eyes.

Or maybe it is simply easier for his left hand.

Writing this way, the wet ink does not **smear**.

He plans big books, but he never finishes them.



He fills page after page with drawings and notes.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Johannes Gutenberg
- ☐ Galileo Galilei
- ☐ Isaac Newton
- ☒ **Leonardo da Vinci**

Grade 9

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Leonardo da Vinci

notebook: a small book with empty pages for writing and drawing

mirror: glass in which you can see yourself

curious: wanting very much to know things

smear: to make wet ink dirty by touching it



Hold the page to a mirror, and the writing turns the right way.

FRONT

Mr X, a painter in Italy, lives about five hundred years ago.

He wants to paint people as they really are.

So he asks: what is under the skin?

Doctors at a hospital let him study the dead.

He works at night, carefully, layer by layer.

He draws every **muscle**, every bone, every **vein**.

He draws the heart and its small doors.

He draws how a baby lies in the **womb**.

His **anatomy** drawings are centuries ahead of their time.

But he keeps them in his private papers.

Doctors learn nothing from them for hundreds of years.

The artist's eye sees what science has not yet seen.



At night he draws what is under the skin.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Leonardo da Vinci**

☐ Michelangelo

☐ Charles Darwin

☐ Isaac Newton

Grade 12

renaissance

BACK

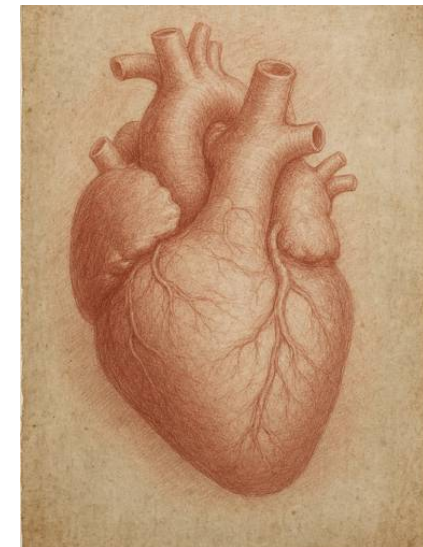
Answer: Leonardo da Vinci

muscle: a part of the body that moves your bones

vein: a thin tube that carries blood in the body

womb: the place inside a mother where a baby grows

anatomy: the science of how the body is built



He draws the heart and its small doors.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Italy about five hundred years ago.
Rich rulers pay him as their **engineer**.
For them he plans bridges, **canals**, and machines of war.
Yet he writes: war is a **beastly** madness.
But he has a dream of his own: humans should fly.
He watches birds and bats for hours.
He draws wings for a man to flap.
He draws a screw to climb the air.
He draws a cloth tent to fall slowly: a **parachute**.
Almost none of these machines are built in his lifetime.
Human muscles are too weak, and there is no motor.
Centuries later, people test some designs, and a few really work.



He draws wings, but human muscles are too weak.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Isaac Newton
- ☐ Johannes Gutenberg
- ☒ **Leonardo da Vinci**
- ☐ Galileo Galilei

Grade 12

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Leonardo da Vinci

engineer: a person who plans and builds machines, roads, or bridges

canal: a river dug by people, for boats or water

beastly: wild and cruel, like a dangerous animal

parachute: a big cloth that lets a person fall slowly and safely



A tent of cloth lets a person fall slowly.

FRONT

Mr X, an Italian artist and thinker, dies about five hundred years ago.

How can we know his ideas today?

He leaves thousands of notebook pages to a loyal student.

After that student's death, the pages begin to travel.

Collectors buy them, cut them, and mix their order.

Today the pages lie in libraries in several lands. Two lost notebooks appear again in Spain, only about sixty years ago.

Scholars think that perhaps half of all pages are gone.

Historians must date every page and rebuild the order.

People say he is good in almost every field.

But researchers still ask: lone **genius**, or man of a big workshop full of helpers?

Every claim about him rides on the **scattered** pages.



A scholar asks: where does this page belong?

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Michelangelo
- ☒ **Leonardo da Vinci**
- ☐ Nicolaus Copernicus
- ☐ Galileo Galilei

University

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Leonardo da Vinci

collector: a person who buys and keeps old or rare things

scholar: a person who studies books deeply

genius: a person with a very great mind

scattered: spread out to many different places



The pages travel to many lands, cut and sold.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Europe, about 600 years ago.
At this time, every book is written by hand.
A worker called a **scribe** copies every page.
One thick book can take years of work.
A book can cost as much as a farm.
Some libraries even **chain** their books to the shelf.
Most people never own a book.
Mr X is a metal worker with a new idea.
In his **workshop**, he builds a machine that makes book pages.
The machine makes hundreds of copies of a page in one day.
Slowly, books become cheap enough for more homes.



A scribe copies one page at a time. A whole book takes years.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Leonardo da Vinci
- ☒ **Johannes Gutenberg**
- ☐ Martin Luther
- ☐ Nicolaus Copernicus

Grade 6

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Johannes Gutenberg

scribe: a person whose job is writing

chain: to lock something to a place with metal rings

workshop: a room or building where people make things



A book is so costly that the library chains it to the shelf.

FRONT

Mr X is a **goldsmith** in the German city of Mainz. About 600 years ago, he builds a new way to make books.

He makes small metal blocks, one letter on each block.

With a hand **mold**, he pours thousands of equal blocks.

A worker sets the blocks in rows to build a page. The worker covers the blocks with thick, sticky **ink**.

A strong **press**, like a wine press, pushes paper onto the blocks.

One pull of the press prints a whole page.

The press makes copy after copy of the same page.

Then the workers take the rows apart.

The same blocks now build the next page.

A box of metal letters can print any book in his language.



A strong press pushes the paper onto the inked letter blocks.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Aldus Manutius
- ☐ Leonardo da Vinci
- ☐ Nicolaus Copernicus
- ☒ **Johannes Gutenberg**

Grade 9

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Johannes Gutenberg

goldsmith: a person who makes fine things from gold and other metals

mold: a hollow form; you pour something in, and it takes that shape

ink: the colored liquid used for writing and printing

press: a machine that pushes two things hard together



One small metal block for each letter. Rows of blocks build a page.

FRONT

In Mainz, Mr X builds his famous printing workshop, about 600 years ago.

But he is not the first to print with movable letters. In China, printers press whole book pages from **carved** wood blocks, centuries before him.

One Chinese printer even makes single letters of baked **clay**.

In Korea, printers **cast** letters of metal before Mr X is born.

One Korean book printed this way still exists today. So what does Mr X really add?

Chinese writing uses thousands of different signs. A European alphabet needs only about two dozen letters.

Mr X packs the whole craft into one cheap, fast system.

Any town with money can start its own workshop. Within fifty years, printing workshops open all across Europe.



In East Asia, printers make book pages centuries before Mr X.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Johannes Gutenberg**

☐ Aldus Manutius

☐ Leonardo da Vinci

☐ Galileo Galilei

Grade 12

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Johannes Gutenberg

carve: to cut a shape into wood or stone with a tool

clay: soft earth that becomes hard when you bake it

cast: to make a thing by pouring hot metal into a form



A printer in China makes single letters from clay, long before Mr X.

FRONT

Mr X of Mainz starts Europe's age of cheap printed books.

A printed book costs far less than a hand-written book.

Printers also sell small news booklets for little money.

A new idea can now cross a land in weeks.

About fifty years after Mr X dies, a German **monk** gets angry.

The church sells special papers, and buyers believe the papers bring God's **forgiveness**.

The monk writes sharp points against this sale.

Printers turn his **protest** into thousands of cheap copies.

The **quarrel** grows and splits the church in western Europe.

Kings and church leaders try to control the presses.

They learn that printed ideas are hard to stop.

Without the machine of Mr X, the protest may stay small.



Cheap printed sheets carry new ideas from town to town.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Martin Luther
- ☐ Aldus Manutius
- ☒ **Johannes Gutenberg**
- ☐ Nicolaus Copernicus

Grade 12

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Johannes Gutenberg

monk: a religious man who lives a simple life for his faith

forgiveness: when someone stops being angry about a wrong thing you did

protest: strong words or actions against something

quarrel: a long, angry fight with words



Thin printed papers pass from hand to hand in the market.

FRONT

Mr X of Mainz is called the father of European printing.

Yet historians know very little about the man.

No **document** records his birth, and no true **portrait** of him exists.

Even his famous printed Bible does not name its maker.

We know him mostly from money papers and **court** records.

He borrows a fortune from a business partner for his workshop.

Later, the partner takes him to court over the money.

Mr X loses the case.

Historians think the partner then takes over the Bible workshop.

Scholars also **debate** the word "revolution".

One famous study says print changes Europe fast and deeply.

Critics answer that people, not machines, make change, and slowly.



A historian studies old money papers and court records.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Laurens Janszoon Coster
- ☒ **Johannes Gutenberg**
- ☐ Aldus Manutius
- ☐ Leonardo da Vinci

University

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Johannes Gutenberg

document: an official paper with information

portrait: a picture of a person's face

court: the place where a judge decides who is right

debate: a public fight with arguments, not weapons



No true portrait of Mr X exists. The frame stays empty.

FRONT

Captain X lives about 500 years ago, in Europe.
The queen and king of Spain give him three small wooden ships.
He sails west, into the open ocean.
No map shows how far the water goes.
About ninety sailors are on board.
They eat hard bread, salted meat, and dried peas.
They drink water and wine from wooden **barrels**.
Most sailors sleep on the **deck**, under the stars.
After more than four weeks, the **crew** grows afraid.
Then, one night, a **lookout** sees land ahead.
The ships land on a green island in a warm sea.
People already live there, and they meet the sailors on the beach.



Three small ships sail west. No map shows the way.

Who is Captain X?

- ☐ Ferdinand Magellan
- ☐ Vasco da Gama
- ☒ **Christopher Columbus**
- ☐ Leif Eriksson

Grade 6

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Christopher Columbus

barrel: a big round wooden container for food or drink

deck: the open floor of a ship

crew: all the people who work on a ship

lookout: a sailor whose job is to watch for land or danger



Food and water for the long voyage travel in wooden barrels.

FRONT

Captain X is a sailor from a port city in Italy.

In his time, educated people know well that the earth is round.

The open question is how big the earth is.

Captain X reads old travel books and makes his own **calculation**.

His answer is far too small.

So he believes Asia lies only a few weeks west of Europe.

Experts in Portugal and in Spain check his numbers and say the ocean is far too wide.

The **experts** are right, but the rulers of Spain pay for his **voyage** anyway.

He sails west, and he does find islands.

He believes they lie near India, so he calls the people there Indians.

He makes four voyages, and he dies still sure that he has been to Asia.

He never learns that a **continent** unknown to Europe blocks his way.



How big is the earth? He trusts his own answer.

Who is Captain X?

☒ **Christopher Columbus**

☐ Marco Polo

☐ Vasco da Gama

☐ Amerigo Vespucci

Grade 9

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Christopher Columbus

calculation: finding an answer with numbers

expert: a person who knows one subject very well

voyage: a long journey by ship

continent: one of the biggest land areas of the earth, like Africa or Asia



He measures and counts. A small mistake grows very big.

FRONT

About 500 years ago, ships from Spain under Captain X reach islands in the Caribbean Sea.

The islands are not empty.

The Taíno people have lived there for more than a thousand years.

They farm **cassava** and maize, fish from canoes, and sleep in **hammocks**.

Words like hammock, canoe, and hurricane come from their language.

This meeting joins two halves of the world.

In the years that follow, ships carry maize, tomatoes, cacao, and potatoes east to Europe.

Other ships carry horses, cows, sugar cane, and wheat west.

But the ships also carry something invisible.

Smallpox and measles are new here, and the islanders' bodies have no **defense**.

Within about fifty years, most of the Taíno have died.

Sickness kills far more people than any weapon.



People farm, fish, and build their homes on these islands.

Who is Captain X?

- ☐ Ferdinand Magellan
- ☐ Leif Eriksson
- ☐ Amerigo Vespucci
- ☒ **Christopher Columbus**

Grade 12

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Christopher Columbus

cassava: a root plant; people make flour and bread from it

hammock: a hanging bed made of woven cloth or net

smallpox: a deadly sickness with high fever and sores on the skin

defense: protection against an attack or a sickness



A hammock, a hanging bed. The word comes from the Taíno language.

FRONT

On his second voyage west, Captain X returns to the Caribbean islands with seventeen ships.

More than a thousand men sail with him, and this time they come to stay.

Spain makes the islands a **colony**, and Captain X becomes its **governor**.

He orders the Taíno people to bring him gold.

Those who fail are **punished**, and families must wash river sand for gold, day after day.

Some Taíno leaders fight back, but bows cannot stop steel weapons and horses.

Years later, reports of harsh rule reach Spain.

A royal officer then sends Captain X home in chains.

How do we know all this?

A young colonist named Bartolomé de las Casas comes to the islands.

Later he becomes a priest and turns against the system.

He writes down the **cruelty** he sees, and through his books the Taíno story reaches us today.



A young colonist watches the forced work. Later he tells the world.

Who is Captain X?

- ☐ Vasco da Gama
- ☒ **Christopher Columbus**
- ☐ Hernán Cortés
- ☐ Ferdinand Magellan

Grade 12

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Christopher Columbus

colony: a land that people from another country take and rule

governor: the leader who rules a colony

punish: to make a person suffer for something

cruelty: very unkind acts that hurt people



Page after page, year after year. His books still speak.

FRONT

About 500 years ago, Captain X sails west from Spain and reaches lands unknown to Europe. For centuries, schoolbooks tell that he discovers a new world.

Historians now question every word in that sentence.

Can anyone discover a land where millions of people already live?

Sailors from the cold north reach the same lands about 500 years before him.

Archaeologists find the remains of their houses on the coast of Canada.

Even the captain's own **logbook** is a problem: the original is lost.

We read his words only in a later copy.

Another writer changes parts of the text.

Statues of him rise in cities on both sides of the ocean, and now some come down.

The lands themselves later get the name of a different sailor, not his.

In parts of the Americas, his old holiday now honors the **indigenous** peoples instead.



For a long time, statues tell only one side of the story.

Who is Captain X?

- ☐ Leif Eriksson
- ☐ Amerigo Vespucci
- ☒ **Christopher Columbus**
- ☐ Ferdinand Magellan

University

renaissance

BACK

Answer: Christopher Columbus

logbook: a book where a ship's captain writes what happens every day

archaeologist: a person who digs in the ground to study how people lived long ago

statue: a figure of a person, made of stone or metal

indigenous: belonging to the first peoples of a land



Grass-covered house remains in Canada. Archaeologists read the ground like a book.

FRONT

Captain X lives about 500 years ago.

He comes from Portugal, but he sails for the king of Spain.

The king gives him five wooden ships and about 270 men.

Captain X wants to sail west, all the way to the **Spice** Islands in Asia.

The ships cross the ocean and follow the coast of South America.

They sail south for many months, and the weather gets cold.

On the shore, the sailors see **penguins** and big sea lions.

Far in the south, they find a **strait**, a narrow water road through the land.

At night, they see fires on the shore, and later that land gets the name Land of Fire.

Only three ships come out of the strait. A huge new ocean opens in front of them.

The water is **calm**, so Captain X gives this ocean a name that means peaceful.

We still use that name today.



Ships in a narrow strait, far in the cold south.

Who is Captain X?

- ☐ Christopher Columbus
- ☐ Vasco da Gama
- ☒ **Ferdinand Magellan**
- ☐ Francis Drake

Grade 6

exploration

BACK

Answer: Ferdinand Magellan

strait: a narrow line of water between two pieces of land

spice: a dried plant part that gives food a strong taste, like pepper

calm: quiet and still, without wind or big waves

penguin: a black and white sea bird that swims but cannot fly



Penguins on the cold southern shore. The sailors have never seen such birds.

FRONT

About 500 years ago, Captain X sails for Spain around the south of the Americas into a new ocean.

He believes the islands of **cloves** and nutmeg lie only a few weeks further west.

Nobody in Europe knows how wide this ocean is. Captain X sails west for more than three months without any new food.

The ship's bread turns to powder full of worms.

The drinking water turns yellow and smells bad.

The men eat **leather** from the ship's ropes and yards and even hunt rats.

Then **scurvy** comes: **gums** swell and teeth fall out.

About twenty men die of it. Nobody yet knows that fresh fruit stops this sickness.

In all those weeks, the sailors see only two small empty islands.

They have crossed an ocean that covers about one third of the earth.



Week after week, only water. Nobody knows how far it is.

Who is Captain X?

- ☐ James Cook
- ☒ **Ferdinand Magellan**
- ☐ Christopher Columbus
- ☐ Francis Drake

Grade 9

exploration

BACK

Answer: Ferdinand Magellan

clove: a spice, the dried flower bud of a tree

leather: strong material made from the skin of an animal

scurvy: a sickness that comes from too little fresh food

gums: the soft pink flesh around the teeth



Seen from this side, the earth is almost all water.

FRONT

About 500 years ago, three ships from Spain reach the islands we now call the Philippines.

Their leader, Captain X, sails for the king of Spain.

People here have their own rulers and trade with China.

The ruler of Cebu welcomes the strangers and makes a friendship **pact** with Captain X.

He and hundreds of his people accept the sailors' religion.

Captain X now demands that the **chiefs** nearby obey Cebu and the king of Spain.

On the small island of Mactan, the chief Lapulapu refuses.

He is a rival of Cebu. He will not bow to a king across the sea.

At dawn, Captain X attacks Mactan with about sixty men in armor.

The water is **shallow**, so the boats and the ships' guns stay far from the beach.

Far more than sixty **warriors** meet the sailors in the water, and Captain X is killed.

The ships sail on without him. In the Philippines today, Lapulapu is a national hero.



The chief of the island will not bow. His warriors wait in the shallow water.

Who is Captain X?

- ☐ James Cook
- ☐ Christopher Columbus
- ☐ Vasco da Gama
- ☒ **Ferdinand Magellan**

Grade 12

exploration

BACK

Answer: Ferdinand Magellan

chief: the leader of a village or a people

pact: a promise between two sides to help each other

shallow: not deep

warrior: a person who fights for his people



A statue for the chief who defends his island. Today he is a national hero.

FRONT

Long before his famous voyage, Captain X is a soldier for Portugal in Asia.

In the port of Malacca, he takes a young man as a **slave** and calls him Enrique.

Enrique speaks Malay, the trade language of the seas of Southeast Asia.

Captain X takes him to Europe, and later west across two oceans as his **interpreter**.

After months at sea, the ships reach islands east of Malacca.

Enrique speaks to the islanders, and they understand him.

Then Captain X dies in a fight on one of the islands.

His **will** says Enrique is now free, but the new leaders refuse to let him go.

Soon the ruler of Cebu turns against the sailors. More than twenty of them are killed at a **feast**.

The sailors blame Enrique, but nobody knows the truth, and the sources never mention him again.

Some say Enrique is the first person to go around the world, back to his own language.

Others say: not quite, because he never reaches Malacca itself.



One man on the ship speaks the language of the islands.

Who is Captain X?

☒ **Ferdinand Magellan**

☐ Vasco da Gama

☐ Christopher Columbus

☐ Amerigo Vespucci

Grade 12

exploration

BACK

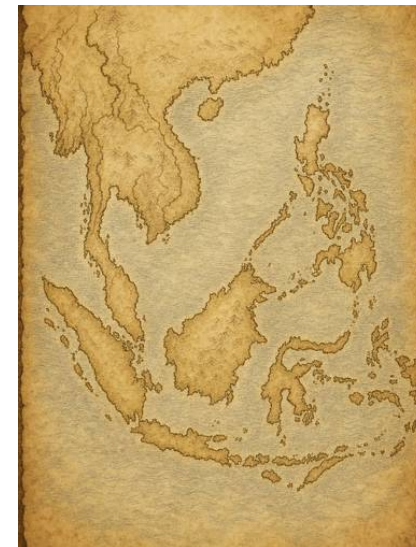
Answer: Ferdinand Magellan

slave: a person who is owned by another person and is not free

interpreter: a person who turns words from one language into another

will: a paper that says what happens to a person's things after death

feast: a big meal for many people



Many islands, many languages, and one trade language at sea.

FRONT

About 500 years ago, five ships leave Spain under Captain X to reach the Spice Islands from the west. Three years later, one ship comes back with eighteen men of about 270, and Captain X is not among them.

How do we know the story? A young Italian **gentleman**, Antonio Pigafetta, joins to see the world and keeps a **diary** through the whole voyage.

The original is lost; we read it in four later handwritten copies.

A **pilot**'s logbook and pay lists in the **archives** of Seville fill the gaps.

Pigafetta records a puzzle at the end: the sailors have lost a day.

They count every day with care, but at the first port on the way home the diary says Wednesday, and it is Thursday.

Sailing west with the sun, they have seen one sunrise fewer than people at home.

Today the date line in the middle of the ocean solves this puzzle.

So who first goes around the world? In one voyage, it is the last captain, Elcano, with seventeen men.

As a young soldier, Captain X reaches these seas by sailing east, to Malacca. As captain he reaches islands a little further east by sailing west.

Whether he ever sails that last stretch, no source tells us.



After three years, one ship comes home.

Who is Captain X?

- ☐ Francis Drake
- ☒ **Ferdinand Magellan**
- ☐ Christopher Columbus
- ☐ James Cook

University exploration

BACK

Answer: Ferdinand Magellan

gentleman: a man of good family who does not need to work with his hands

diary: a book where a person writes what happens every day

pilot: the sailor who guides the ship on its course

archive: a place where old papers are kept and protected



A page from a copy of the diary. The original is lost.

FRONT

Mr X lives about 500 years ago, in the north of Poland.

He works at a **cathedral** by the sea.

He is also a doctor and helps sick people.

He has a small tower in the wall around the cathedral.

At night, he climbs up and watches the sky.

He has no **telescope**, only his eyes and simple wooden tools.

In his time, people say: the earth stands still.

The sun, the moon, and the stars go around us.

Mr X thinks about this for many years.

Then he says something new: the sun stands in the middle.

The earth is a **planet**, and it goes around the sun.



At night, he climbs the tower and watches the sky.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Galileo Galilei
- ☒ **Nicolaus Copernicus**
- ☐ Isaac Newton
- ☐ Leonardo da Vinci

Grade 6

science

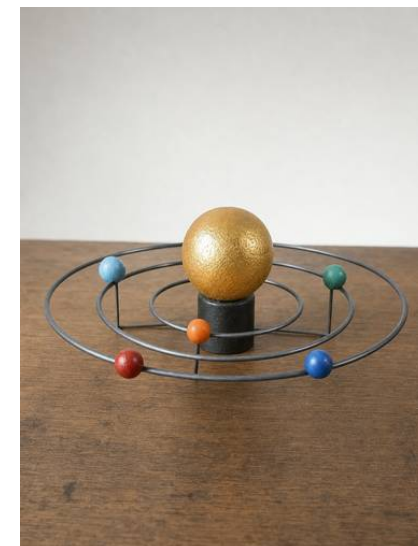
BACK

Answer: Nicolaus Copernicus

cathedral: a very big and important church

telescope: a tube with glass inside that makes far things look near

planet: a big round world that goes around the sun, like the earth



His new picture: the sun in the middle, the planets around it.

FRONT

In the sixteenth century, Mr X is a church **official** in Poland who studies the sky.

Everybody in his time is sure: the earth does not move.

We do not feel it move.

A stone falls straight down, and birds are not left behind.

Every night, the sky seems to turn around us.

But the planets make trouble.

A planet moves forward for months, then slides **backward**, then forward again.

The old books explain this with circles upon circles.

Mr X asks: what if the earth moves too?

Then the backward slide is easy to explain.

The earth **overtakes** a slower planet, like a fast runner passing a slow runner.

For a short time, the slow runner seems to go backward.



Every night, the sky seems to turn around us.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Ptolemy
- ☐ Tycho Brahe
- ☒ **Nicolaus Copernicus**
- ☐ Johannes Kepler

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Nicolaus Copernicus

official: a person with a job in the church or the government

overtake: to catch up with somebody and pass them

backward: in the direction behind you



The fast runner overtakes the slow one. For a moment, the slow one seems to go backward.

FRONT

Mr X, a church official in the north of Poland, writes a big book about the sky.

In it, the sun stands in the middle, and the earth moves.

He works on the book for about thirty years.

He is afraid that people will laugh, so he does not print it.

A **cardinal** in Rome writes and asks him to **publish**.

Then a young mathematician from Germany visits him and pushes him too.

At last, the book goes to a printer in Nuremberg.

A story tells: the printed book reaches Mr X on the day he dies.

The book has a strange **preface** without a name. It says: this is only a tool for **calculation**, not the truth.

Mr X never writes those words. A church scholar in the printing town adds them without permission.

For decades, readers think the words are his.



A story tells: the printed book reaches him on his last day.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Nicolaus Copernicus**

☐ Johannes Kepler

☐ Galileo Galilei

☐ Tycho Brahe

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Nicolaus Copernicus

cardinal: a very high leader in the Catholic church

publish: to print a text so that people can buy and read it

preface: the words at the start of a book, before the main text

calculation: working with numbers to find an answer



A preface: the words at the start of a book. Here, somebody else speaks.

FRONT

Mr X of Poland puts the sun in the middle of the world, in the sixteenth century.

The idea itself is old: about 1,800 years earlier, the Greek thinker Aristarchus says the same.

Almost nobody follows him.

Most **scholars** follow another Greek, Ptolemy, who keeps the earth in the middle.

Mr X finds the old idea in Greek and Roman books. In his handwritten pages, he names Aristarchus, then crosses the lines out.

He works for years to make the idea fit the numbers.

But his system is not simpler, and its **predictions** are not better.

Critics say: if the earth moves, the stars should seem to **shift**.

They do not shift. Mr X answers: the stars are very, very far away.

He proposes, and he calculates, but he cannot **prove**.

The tiny shift of the stars is measured only about three hundred years later.



Long before Mr X, a Greek thinker looks at the same stars.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Johannes Kepler
- ☐ Isaac Newton
- ☒ **Nicolaus Copernicus**
- ☐ Tycho Brahe

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Nicolaus Copernicus

scholar: a person who studies books deeply

prediction: a statement about what will happen

shift: to move a little to one side

prove: to show that something is surely true



Close one eye, then the other: the thumb seems to shift.

FRONT

Mr X, a church official in Poland, publishes his book about the moving earth in the sixteenth century.

Where does his knowledge come from?

He makes few **observations** of his own, and sea fog often hides the sky.

He builds on old star records from Greek and Arab astronomers.

Some of his mathematical tools match older tools from astronomers in Persia and Syria.

Nobody knows how those ideas reach him.

He **dedicates** the book to the Pope, and for decades the church takes no action.

Most astronomers use his tables but keep the earth in the middle.

Tycho Brahe offers a middle way: the planets circle the sun, and the sun circles the earth.

The church **forbids** the book more than seventy years after his death, and only "until corrected".

Much later, historians call his idea a **revolution**.

The word in his own book title means only this: a turning around.



For decades, scholars read the book but keep the earth in the middle.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Johannes Kepler
- ☐ Galileo Galilei
- ☐ Giordano Bruno
- ☒ **Nicolaus Copernicus**

University

science

BACK

Answer: Nicolaus Copernicus

observation: looking at something carefully and writing down what you see

dedicate: to write a book in honor of a person, and say so at the start

forbid: to say that something is not allowed

revolution: a big change in how people think or live; the word also means one full turn



One full turn of a wheel: that is all his title word means.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Italy about four hundred years ago. He teaches mathematics at a university. One day he hears about a new tool from the Netherlands. It is a tube with two glass **lenses**. Far things look close through it. Mr X does not **invent** it, but he builds a much better one. He shows it to the leaders of Venice from a high tower. They see ships far out at sea, long before other people. Then he points his tube at the night sky. Next to the **planet** Jupiter he sees four small lights. Night after night, the lights move around Jupiter. So not everything in the sky goes around the earth!



At night, Mr X points his tube at the sky.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Nicolaus Copernicus
- ☒ **Galileo Galilei**
- ☐ Isaac Newton
- ☐ Leonardo da Vinci

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Galileo Galilei

lens: a round piece of glass that makes things look bigger or closer

invent: to make a new thing that nobody has made before

planet: a big ball in space that goes around the sun, like the earth



Four small lights beside Jupiter. Night after night, they move.

FRONT

Mr X teaches mathematics in Italy, about four hundred years ago.

For almost two thousand years, teachers trust an old Greek book.

The book says: heavy things fall faster than light things.

Mr X says: do not only trust the book, look and **measure!**

A famous story tells: he drops two balls from a tall tower.

Historians are not sure the story is true.

But we know that he rolls balls down a long wooden **ramp**.

The ramp makes the fall slow, so he can measure the time.

He measures with water that drips into a cup.

He finds a rule: in double the time, the ball goes four times as far.

He also studies a hanging weight, a **pendulum**, and its swing.

Wide swing or small swing, each swing takes about the same time.



A ball rolls down the ramp. Dripping water measures the time.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Galileo Galilei**
- ☐ Aristotle
- ☐ Isaac Newton
- ☐ Leonardo da Vinci

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Galileo Galilei

measure: to find out how long, how heavy, or how fast something is

ramp: a flat board that goes up on one side, like a small hill

pendulum: a weight that hangs on a string and swings from side to side



A lamp on a long chain swings like a pendulum.

FRONT

Mr X is an Italian **astronomer** with a new, strong telescope.

Old books teach: everything in the sky is perfect and smooth.

Mr X looks at the moon and sees mountains and valleys.

From their shadows, he even measures how high they are.

He also sees dark spots on the sun, and they move across it.

Then, for months, he watches the planet Venus.

Venus shows **phases** like the moon, from thin **crescent** to almost full.

When Venus is full, it looks small and far away.

In the old picture of the sky, Venus can never look full.

So Venus must go around the sun, not around the earth.

This does not yet **prove** that the earth moves too.

But the perfect sky of the old books is gone.



The moon is not smooth. Its mountains throw long shadows.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Johannes Kepler
- ☐ Tycho Brahe
- ☐ Nicolaus Copernicus
- ☒ **Galileo Galilei**

Grade 12

science

BACK

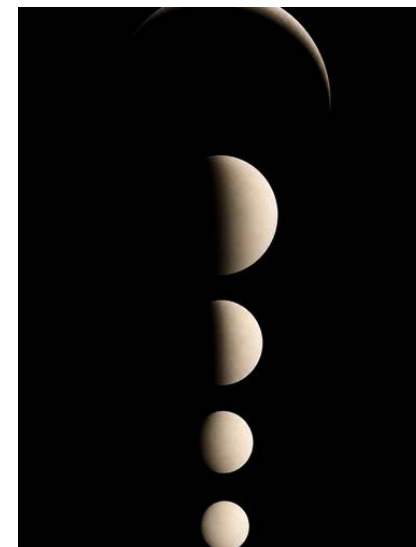
Answer: Galileo Galilei

astronomer: a scientist who studies the stars and the planets

phase: the shape of the lit part of the moon or a planet, as we see it

crescent: a thin curved shape, like the young moon

prove: to show with facts that something is true



Big thin crescent, small full disk: Venus goes around the sun.

FRONT

Mr X is a famous astronomer in Italy, almost seventy years old.

Ninety years before, an astronomer from the north writes: the earth goes around the sun.

The Church says: this is against the Bible, so Mr X must not defend it.

But now he writes a big book, and in it, the idea wins.

The Pope calls him to Rome, to a church **court**.

For weeks, the judges question him.

Another thinker is burned in Rome years before, for his ideas about God, but Mr X is not **tortured** or burned.

Still, he must **kneel** and say: I give up this idea.

A later story tells: he whispers, and yet it moves.

Historians find no proof for those words.

The court bans his book and puts him under **house arrest** for life.

There, going blind, he still writes a new book about how things move.



An old man kneels before the court and gives up his idea.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Giordano Bruno
- ☐ Nicolaus Copernicus
- ☒ **Galileo Galilei**
- ☐ Johannes Kepler

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Galileo Galilei

court: the place where judges decide if a person did something wrong

torture: to hurt a person on purpose to make them talk or obey

kneel: to go down on your knees

house arrest: a punishment: you must stay in your own home and may not leave



House arrest: he may not leave his villa near Florence.

FRONT

Mr X is an Italian astronomer from about four hundred years ago.

Later writers tell his story as a war: the Church against science.

Historians today say: look closer, it is not so simple.

His first **opponents** are university professors, not priests.

They defend the old Greek view, and some refuse even to look through his telescope.

Astronomers of the Church in Rome check his discoveries and confirm them.

The Pope himself admires him and allows his big book, a talk between three men.

The foolish one defends the old view, using the Pope's own favorite argument.

The Pope feels **mocked**, and the friendship ends in a trial.

Mr X is right about the planets, but his main proof, from the **tides**, is wrong.

More than 350 years after the trial, the Church says clearly: the judges of that time make mistakes.

Power can ban a book, but not the **evidence**.



Some professors refuse to even look through the tube.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Nicolaus Copernicus
- ☐ Charles Darwin
- ☒ **Galileo Galilei**
- ☐ Johannes Kepler

University

science

BACK

Answer: Galileo Galilei

opponent: a person who is against you in a fight or a debate

mock: to laugh at a person in an unkind way

tide: the sea rising and falling along the coast, twice a day

evidence: facts that show what is true



His book is a talk between three men. One of them looks foolish.

FRONT

Movement X begins in Europe about 500 years ago.

Almost everyone in western Europe belongs to one church then.

Its leader, the **pope**, lives in Rome.

He wants a huge new church there, and that costs a lot of money.

So church men travel from town to town and sell special papers.

The church teaches, and buyers believe: this paper makes God's **punishment** after death shorter.

A **monk** in Germany believes this is wrong.

Forgiveness is a gift from God, he believes, and no one can buy it.

He writes a list of points against the sale.

He sends the list to his bishop, and friends print it.

His words spread fast, and the pope says the monk is wrong.

But the quarrel grows, and the church in western Europe splits into several churches.



Money from far away pays for a huge new church in Rome.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Crusades
- ☒ **The Protestant Reformation**
- ☐ The Renaissance
- ☐ The Great Schism

Grade 6

religions

BACK

Answer: The Protestant Reformation

pope: the leader of the church in Rome

punishment: something bad that you must go through because you did wrong

monk: a religious man who lives a simple life and prays a lot

forgiveness: when God, or a person, stops being angry about a wrong thing you did



A monk lives a simple life of prayer and work.

FRONT

Movement X begins in Germany about 500 years ago.

A monk there starts a quarrel with the church.
His friends and his enemies all write about it.

Printers **translate** the texts into German and turn them into thin, cheap **booklets**.

In Europe, printing with movable metal letters is new, only about seventy years old.

One **press** can now make more than a thousand pages in a day.

Within a few months, the booklets reach towns all over Germany.

Some booklets have pictures, so people who cannot read can follow too.

Soon, translators put the Bible into German, English, and other everyday languages.

Now a farmer or a **weaver** can hear the holy book in his own words.

Leaders of the old church print answers too, but fewer, and later.

For the first time, a quarrel in the church is fought with thousands of cheap booklets.



Bundles of cheap booklets leave the town. Soon they are everywhere.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Renaissance
- ☐ The Enlightenment
- ☐ The Industrial Revolution
- ☒ **The Protestant Reformation**

Grade 9

religions

BACK

Answer: The Protestant Reformation

booklet: a small, thin book with only a few pages

press: a machine that pushes ink onto paper to make many copies

translate: to say or write something again in another language

weaver: a person who makes cloth from threads



A thin booklet of a few pages costs little.

FRONT

Movement X splits the church in western Europe about 500 years ago.

Some rulers join the new churches, and some stay with Rome.

Why do they choose as they do?

Some truly believe the new teaching, but power and money matter too.

A ruler who breaks with Rome can take the church's land, houses, and silver.

He can stop sending money to Rome, and he can choose the **bishops** himself.

In Sweden, the king takes church silver and land to pay his **debts**.

In England, the king wants to end his marriage, and the pope says no.

So the king makes himself head of the church in his land and closes the **monasteries**.

Rulers who stay with Rome have reasons too, and belief counts there as well.

The kings of France and Spain already choose their own bishops. They gain less from a break.

After years of quarrel and war in Germany, a **treaty** is signed. Each prince decides the faith of his land.



The king closes the monastery and takes its land. The walls stand empty.

Which movement is Movement X?

☒ **The Protestant Reformation**

☐ The Great Schism

☐ The Crusades

☐ The Enlightenment

Grade 12

religions

BACK

Answer: The Protestant Reformation

bishop: a high church leader who leads all the churches in one region

monastery: a house where monks live, work, and pray

debt: money that you owe and must pay back

treaty: a written agreement between rulers or lands



A bishop leads the church in one region. Who chooses him, the pope or the king?

FRONT

Movement X begins with a monk in Germany about 500 years ago. But it is not one man's work.

In Zürich, a priest named Zwingli preaches only what he finds in the Bible.

The **city council** agrees and removes the pictures and statues from its churches.

In Geneva, a Frenchman named Calvin builds a strict new church with tight rules for daily life.

His school trains **preachers**, who carry his teaching to France, the Netherlands, and Scotland.

The monk and Zwingli quarrel over the bread and wine in church. They never make peace.

Smaller groups **baptize** only grown people, and both big sides punish them hard.

The old church answers too, at a long meeting in the town of Trent.

There its leaders state their faith in clear words. They also end the sale of forgiveness papers for money.

Priests get better training. New **orders** of priests open schools as far away as India and Japan.

Each side believes it holds the true faith, and history cannot decide that question.



In cities by the lakes, other preachers build churches of their own.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Counter-Reformation
- ☐ The Renaissance
- ☒ **The Protestant Reformation**
- ☐ The Great Schism

Grade 12

religions

BACK

Answer: The Protestant Reformation

city council: the group of men who rule a city

preacher: a person who speaks about religion to a group of people

baptize: to pour water on a person, or dip the person in water, to make him or her a member of the church

order: here: a group of priests or monks who live by the same rules



A preacher explains the Bible in a plain church without pictures.

FRONT

Movement X splits the church in western Europe in the sixteenth century.

Historians agree on the events. But they argue about the **cause**: faith, power, or everyday life?

Older books tell the story of one brave monk in Germany and his **conscience**.

Later historians look at the princes and free cities that use the quarrel to win power.

Others look at the farmers and the poor of the towns.

Farmers in Germany soon read the new ideas as freedom from their **lords** too.

They rise up, and the princes crush them. Perhaps a hundred thousand die, and the monk takes the princes' side.

Wars over faith and power follow, in France, in the Netherlands, and across central Europe.

The biggest of them lasts thirty years.

Some **regions** lose a third of their people to fighting, hunger, and sickness.

One effect lasts: the new churches want every child to read the Bible, so village schools spread.

The old church answers with new schools of its own, and reading grows on both sides.



A village school. Children learn to read, so they can read the holy book themselves.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Renaissance
- ☐ The Enlightenment
- ☐ The Counter-Reformation
- ☒ **The Protestant Reformation**

University

religions

BACK

Answer: The Protestant Reformation

cause: the reason why something happens

conscience: the inner feeling that tells you what is right and wrong

lord: a powerful man who owns the land that farmers work on

region: a part of a land, bigger than a town



The farmer gives part of his harvest to the lord. Some hope the new ideas will end this.

FRONT

Brother X lives in Germany, about 500 years ago. As a young man, he studies to become a **lawyer**. One day, a thunderstorm catches him on an open road.

Lightning strikes close, and he is very afraid.

In his fear, he calls to a **saint**: help me, and I will become a monk.

He keeps his promise and enters a **monastery**.

There he prays, he works, and he **fasts**.

But he still feels afraid of God.

I can never be good enough, he thinks.

Then he reads an old letter in the Bible, again and again.

He finds a new idea there: God's forgiveness is a free gift, he believes.

No one can earn it, and no one can buy it. This idea will soon split the church in Europe.



A young monk prays alone. He is afraid he is not good enough.

Who is Brother X?

- ☐ Johannes Gutenberg
- ☒ **Martin Luther**
- ☐ John Calvin
- ☐ Ignatius of Loyola

Grade 6

religions

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther

lawyer: a person who knows the law and helps people in court

saint: a holy person; some Christians ask saints to help them

monastery: a house where monks live, pray, and work

fast: here: to eat no food for a time, for God



Lightning strikes close. In his fear, the young traveler makes a promise.

FRONT

Mr X is a monk and teacher in Wittenberg, Germany, about 500 years ago.

A preacher comes to the area and sells letters of **pardon** from the church.

The church calls these letters **indulgences**.

Buy a letter, the preacher says, and the punishment for your **sins** is gone.

Part of the money helps to build a great new church in Rome.

Mr X is angry: forgiveness is not for sale, he believes.

He writes ninety-five short points against the sale, in Latin, for a debate.

He sends them in a letter to the **archbishop**.

A story tells that he also nails them to the church door.

Historians are not sure the door story is true.

Printers copy the points, and friends translate them into German.

Within a few months, people read them all over Germany.



A story tells: a sheet of paper hangs on the church door, and people stop to look.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Jan Hus
- ☐ Erasmus
- ☒ **Martin Luther**
- ☐ John Calvin

Grade 9

religions

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther

pardon: forgiveness for a bad thing you did

indulgence: a church letter; the church teaches that it takes away punishment for sins

sin: a bad act against God's rules, in a religion

archbishop: a high leader of the church over a big area



A coin in the chest, a letter of pardon in the hand.

FRONT

Mr X is a monk from Wittenberg who writes against the sale of pardons.

His books spread fast, and the pope throws him out of the church.

About 500 years ago, the young **emperor** calls him to the city of Worms.

Princes, bishops, and the emperor wait for him in a great hall.

- Do you **take back** what you have written? they ask.

He asks for one day to think.

Next day he answers: no, unless the Bible or clear reason proves him wrong.

The first printed reports add a famous line: here I stand, I can do no other.

It is not in the official record, so historians doubt it.

On the road home, masked riders take him away.

A friendly **prince** hides him in a castle, with a new name and a beard.

Soon the emperor declares him an **outlaw**: anyone may now kill him without punishment.



One monk stands alone before the emperor and the princes.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Martin Luther**

☐ Jan Hus

☐ Thomas More

☐ John Calvin

Grade 12

religions

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther

emperor: a ruler over many lands and many princes

take back: to say that your own words were wrong

outlaw: a person outside the law; no one is punished for hurting him

prince: the ruler of one land inside the empire



An outlaw hides in a castle high above the forest.

FRONT

Mr X is a German monk and teacher, about 500 years ago.

In church, the Bible is read in **Latin**, a language few people know.

Hidden in a castle, Mr X begins to **translate**.

He works from the old Greek text, not from the church's Latin.

He wants words that a mother in the house and a child in the street can understand.

In about eleven weeks, the **New Testament** is ready in German.

Printers sell it in the thousands and print it again and again.

German has many **dialects**, and his book helps shape one written German.

He asks towns to open schools for girls and boys, so all can read it.

Church leaders in Rome say: the church must guide the reading.

Mr X says: every believer can read and judge for himself.

Each side believes it is right, and the question still divides churches today.



In a quiet castle room, one man puts an old book into everyday words.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Erasmus
- ☐ Johannes Gutenberg
- ☐ William Tyndale
- ☒ **Martin Luther**

Grade 12

religions

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther

Latin: the old language of Rome; the church uses it for centuries

translate: to put a text from one language into another

New Testament: the second part of the Christian Bible; it tells about Jesus and his followers

dialect: the way a language is spoken in one area



Now a mother can read the book at home, in her own language.

FRONT

Mr X is a German monk whose quarrel with Rome splits the western church, about 500 years ago.

Few people from his time leave so many **sources**.

His collected works fill more than one hundred thick **volumes**.

More than two thousand of his letters survive.

Students even write down his talk at the dinner table.

But they write in haste or from memory, and later editors change the words, so historians read them with care.

Even the famous story of the church door rests on two late reports, written decades after the event.

His **legacy** is divided too.

In his old age, he writes books full of hate against Jews.

Centuries later, others use these books for their own hate, and historians study how.

Churches that follow his teaching today **reject** these words.

In our own century, the pope prays with leaders of those churches, in Sweden.



One man's words fill a whole wall of books.

Who is Mr X?

☐ John Calvin

☐ Jan Hus

☐ Ulrich Zwingli

☒ **Martin Luther**

University

religions

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther

source: a text or thing from the past that gives us knowledge

volume: one book in a long row of books that belong together

legacy: what a person leaves behind for later times, good and bad

reject: to say clearly: this is wrong, we do not accept it



Five hundred years later, leaders of both churches walk in together.

FRONT

Revolution X begins in Britain about 250 years ago. At first, women **spin** cotton thread by hand at home. They turn a small wheel next to the fire. New machines can spin much more thread at once. Workers build a large **mill** beside a river. A big wheel in the river turns the machines inside. Later, a new **engine** burns coal for power instead. Now a mill does not need a river nearby. A town in the north of England grows very fast. Thousands of people move there to work in the mills. Tall **chimneys** rise over the town, and smoke fills the sky.



A new mill rises by the river. The wheel outside turns the machines inside.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Agricultural Revolution
- ☒ **The Industrial Revolution**
- ☐ The Scientific Revolution
- ☐ The French Revolution

Grade 6

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The Industrial Revolution

spin: to turn cotton or wool into long thread

mill: a large building full of machines that make cloth

engine: a machine that makes power from burning fuel

chimney: a tall pipe that carries smoke up into the sky



At home, a woman spins thread by hand, one wheel at a time.

FRONT

About 200 years ago, Revolution X changes life for working families.

Children as young as six work inside the mills.

A working day often lasts twelve to fourteen hours.

Small children crawl under moving machines to sweep up loose cotton.

Other children work far underground, pulling carts of coal in **mines**.

Families move from small villages into fast-growing cities.

Many of them live **crowded** together in one small room.

There is little clean water, and sickness spreads fast.

A disease called **cholera** kills tens of thousands in poor city streets.

Slowly, new laws limit how young a working child can be.

Workers also start to join together in groups called **unions**.

Together, they ask for shorter days and safer machines.



Inside the mill, even young children work long hours among the machines.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The French Revolution
- ☒ **The Industrial Revolution**
- ☐ The Agricultural Revolution
- ☐ The American Revolution

Grade 9

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The Industrial Revolution

mine: a deep hole or tunnel where workers dig out coal

cholera: a dangerous disease that spreads through dirty water

union: a group of workers who join together to ask for better and safer work

crowded: full of too many people in a small space



Other children work underground, in mines far from any mill.

FRONT

Revolution X depends on a new kind of engine. Earlier engines already pump water out of coal mines.

An **engineer** named Watt makes this kind of engine far better.

He receives a **patent** for his improved engine about 250 years ago.

Mines and ironworks use his engines from the 1770s.

From the 1780s, his engines also turn machines in mills.

Britain also mines huge amounts of coal and iron. Workers first move heavy goods along new **canals** by boat.

In 1830, the first **passenger** railway links two English cities.

A steam engine now pulls both passengers and goods.

Soon, steam also powers ships on wide rivers and across oceans.

Journeys that once took days can now take only hours.



A new engine pulls people and goods between two towns.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Scientific Revolution
- ☐ The Agricultural Revolution
- ☒ **The Industrial Revolution**
- ☐ The Digital Revolution

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The Industrial Revolution

engineer: a person who designs and builds machines or structures

patent: an official paper that gives one person the right to an invention

canal: a waterway that people dig for boats to travel on

passenger: a person who travels in a vehicle but does not drive it



An engineer studies the engine closely and makes it stronger and safer.

FRONT

Revolution X starts in Britain, but it soon changes the whole world.

British mills need huge amounts of raw cotton every year.

Enslaved workers in the southern United States pick most of it.

Farmers in India and Egypt also grow cotton for British mills.

For centuries, skilled **weavers** in India make fine cotton cloth by hand.

Now cheap cloth from British mills floods their local markets.

Many Indian weavers slowly lose their work and their **income**.

Other countries soon build mills and factories of their own.

Belgium and parts of Germany build mills within a few **decades**.

The United States and later Japan follow a similar path.

Everywhere, burning coal sends smoke and gas into the air.

Over two centuries, this gas slowly warms the whole planet.



Ships bring raw cotton from far away. British mills turn it into cloth.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Scientific Revolution
- ☐ The American Revolution
- ☒ **The Industrial Revolution**
- ☐ The Agricultural Revolution

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

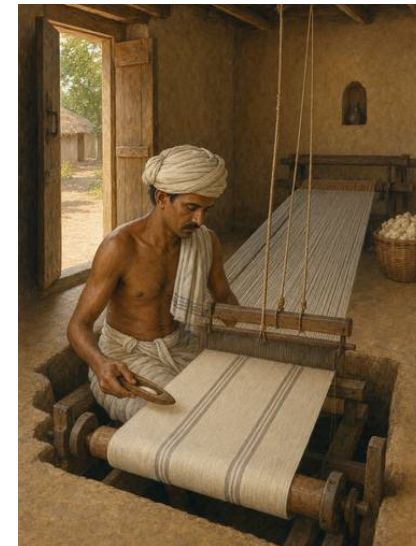
Answer: The Industrial Revolution

enslaved: forced to work without pay and owned by another person

weaver: a person who makes cloth from thread, often by hand

income: the money a person earns from work

decade: a period of ten years



A weaver in India makes fine cloth by hand. Cheap mill cloth now takes away his work.

FRONT

Historians even argue about the word revolution itself.

Some changes come fast, like the first steam railways.

But many other changes take a full century to spread.

So some **historians** prefer to speak of slow, steady change.

Others still call it a true revolution in how people live.

A second question asks why this begins in Britain first.

Britain has coal, money to invest, and **colonies** for raw goods.

It also has wide markets and, some say, well-paid workers.

Historians compare Britain with wealthy regions in China at the time.

Some historians say both regions look similarly advanced for a long time.

Then their paths separate, and historians call this the great **divergence**.

Historians read factory **inspectors'** reports, church records, and old wage lists.



Some say these two regions once look alike. Later, their paths separate.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

☒ The Industrial Revolution

- ☐ The Scientific Revolution
- ☐ The Agricultural Revolution
- ☐ The French Revolution

University

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The Industrial Revolution

historian: a person who studies and writes about the past

colony: a land ruled and used by another, more powerful country

divergence: the point where two similar things start to become very different

inspector: a person whose job is to check that rules are followed



An inspector visits a mill. Much later, his reports help historians.

FRONT

Mr X is a young man in Britain, almost 200 years ago.

He studies medicine in Edinburgh but hates it.

Blood and pain make him feel sick.

He collects rare **beetles** as a hobby.

His father wants him to work for the church instead.

Then a ship captain invites him to sail.

The small ship sails around the whole world.

The long **voyage** lasts almost five years.

Mr X feels **seasick** almost every day at sea.

On islands in the Pacific, he meets giant **tortoises**.

He also sees strange birds that live nowhere else.



For almost five years, Mr X sails on a small wooden ship.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Charles Darwin**
- ☐ Alfred Russel Wallace
- ☐ Louis Pasteur
- ☐ Carl Linnaeus

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Charles Darwin

beetle: a small insect with a hard shiny cover over its wings

voyage: a long journey by ship

seasick: feeling sick because a ship moves on the waves

tortoise: a slow animal with a hard shell that walks on land



On far islands, Mr X meets giant tortoises like this one.

FRONT

Mr X returns to England after five years at sea.

For years, he thinks about living things and change.

He notices something: animals fit their surroundings well.

Animals that fit well **survive** and have young.

Over a very long time, this slowly changes all living things.

Mr X calls this idea **natural selection**.

He fills notebook after notebook with his ideas.

Twenty years pass, and he tells almost nobody.

Then a letter arrives from a **naturalist** in Asia.

That man, Wallace, has the very same idea.

The next year, Mr X finally publishes his famous book.



For twenty years, Mr X walks, thinks, and fills his notebooks.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Charles Darwin**
- ☐ Alfred Russel Wallace
- ☐ Jean-Baptiste Lamarck
- ☐ Gregor Mendel

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Charles Darwin

survive: to stay alive

natural selection: nature lets the best-fitting animals and plants survive and have young

naturalist: a person who studies plants, animals, and nature



An animal that fits its surroundings is hard to see and hard to catch.

FRONT

More than 150 years ago, Mr X works quietly at home in England.

He **breeds** many different kinds of pigeons himself.

Breeders already change pigeons a lot by choosing parents.

Mr X wonders if nature chooses in the same way.

For eight long years, he studies tiny sea **barnacles**.

He carefully describes every known kind of barnacle.

In his garden, he studies unusual **orchid** flowers.

He watches how earthworms slowly move soil under grass.

He works alone and patiently tests idea after idea.

He writes many letters to farmers and gardeners.

Slowly, many small experiments at home support one big idea.



Mr X breeds many different kinds of pigeons at home.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Gregor Mendel
- ☒ **Charles Darwin**
- ☐ Carl Linnaeus
- ☐ Jean-Baptiste Lamarck

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Charles Darwin

breed: to keep animals or plants so they have young with chosen traits

barnacle: a small sea animal that sticks tightly to rocks or ships

orchid: a flower with an unusual shape, often grown for its beauty



Barnacles: small sea animals that cling tightly to rocks.

FRONT

In 1859, Mr X publishes a book that changes science.

It says that all living things slowly change over time.

Many people read it, and a big argument starts.

The next year, scholars **debate** the book in Oxford.

A **bishop** and a scientist argue in front of a crowd.

Later writers describe the debate in different ways.

Even people who are there remember the words differently.

Some religious leaders feel angry about the new idea.

Other believers see no conflict with their own **faith**.

Mr X himself stays quietly at home, often unwell.

He dies more than twenty years later, old and respected.

He is buried with honor in Westminster Abbey.



In Oxford, two men argue about Mr X's new book in front of a crowd.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Galileo Galilei
- ☐ Isaac Newton
- ☒ **Charles Darwin**
- ☐ Louis Pasteur

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Charles Darwin

bishop: a senior leader in the Christian church

debate: a formal argument between people with different views

faith: strong belief, often in God or a religion



Mr X is buried with honor inside a great old abbey.

FRONT

Mr X visits Pacific islands as a young man.

Later stories say finches teach him everything at once.

In fact, he hardly notes which island each finch comes from.

Mockingbirds interest him more at the time.

Later scientists and school books shape the famous finch story.

In the 1980s, a historian shows the story is a **legend**.

Some historians ask if Wallace, another **naturalist**, deserves more **credit**.

We know his ideas from notebooks and many letters.

One page from 1837 shows a small **sketch** of a tree.

Above the sketch, he writes two words: I think.

Other men later misuse his ideas to excuse racism.

He never calls for such policies himself.



Mr X draws life as a tree. One branch splits into many.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Alfred Russel Wallace
- ☒ **Charles Darwin**
- ☐ Carl Linnaeus
- ☐ Jean-Baptiste Lamarck

University

science

BACK

Answer: Charles Darwin

legend: a well-known story that is not fully true

naturalist: a person who studies plants, animals, and nature

sketch: a quick, simple drawing

credit: praise or recognition for doing something



Naturalists on different continents share their ideas by letter.

FRONT

Mr X lives in a small flat in London, about 175 years ago.

Before that, in Germany, the **government** closes his newspaper, so he leaves.

Every day, Mr X sits at a small table and writes. He writes about poor workers and rich factory owners.

The workers do the work, he says, but the owners get rich.

The family is very poor, and the flat is cold in winter.

Some of his children become sick and die.

His good friend Friedrich Engels lives in Manchester.

The Engels family owns part of a big **cotton mill**.

Friedrich sends money again and again, so the family can eat.

Mr X keeps writing, year after year.



A poor family lives in a small, cold flat. The father writes every day.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Friedrich Engels
- ☒ **Karl Marx**
- ☐ Charles Dickens
- ☐ Adam Smith

Grade 6

ideas

BACK

Answer: Karl Marx

government: the group of people who rule a country

cotton: a soft plant fibre used to make cloth

mill: a big factory, here one that spins cotton into thread



In Manchester, a friend's family owns part of a big cotton mill.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Brussels, in Belgium.

It is the year 1848.

With a friend who worked in Manchester, he writes a short book.

It is for a small group of workers.

The book says: history is a story of **struggle**.

In every age, some people own the tools and the land.

Other people work for them, for low pay.

The book calls this a struggle between **classes**.

It ends with a call: workers of all lands, **unite**!

The book is short, cheap, and easy to print.

At first, almost no one reads it.

Much later, it becomes one of the most printed books ever.



A cheap little book comes off the press, again and again.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Robert Owen
- ☐ Vladimir Lenin
- ☒ **Karl Marx**
- ☐ Georg Hegel

Grade 9

ideas

BACK

Answer: Karl Marx

struggle: a hard fight to get or keep something

class: a group of people with a similar place in society

unite: to join together as one group



The book ends with a call to workers: join together.

FRONT

Mr X studies in the reading room of a great London museum.

He reads there year after year to write a huge new book.

The book comes out about 160 years ago.

It asks a hard question: where does **profit** come from?

A worker makes goods worth more than his pay, the book says.

The owner of the factory keeps the extra **value**.

Mr X calls this extra value **surplus**.

For proof, he reads real government reports.

The reports describe men, women, and children at the machines.

Many work twelve hours a day or more.

The book is thick, and few people finish it while he is alive.



Every day, Mr X sits and reads in a great round library.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Karl Marx**
- ☐ Adam Smith
- ☐ John Stuart Mill
- ☐ Friedrich Engels

Grade 12

ideas

BACK

Answer: Karl Marx

profit: money a business earns above its costs

value: how much something is worth

surplus: an amount left over, more than what is needed



One pile of coins is just enough. The other pile has more.

FRONT

Mr X is born more than 200 years ago in Trier. Trier is a town in Prussia, a German state. His family has Jewish roots, and his father is a lawyer.

Mr X studies law and philosophy in Bonn and Berlin.

Then he becomes the **editor** of a newspaper. After a few months, the government closes the newspaper.

He leaves the country and lives most of his life in **exile**.

He lives first in Paris, then in Brussels, then in London.

His wife Jenny comes from a **noble** family in Germany.

Jenny copies his messy handwriting into clean pages for the printer.

He dies more than 140 years ago.

Only about eleven people come to his funeral.



Mr X must leave one city after another.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Georg Hegel
- ☐ Friedrich Engels
- ☐ Charles Dickens
- ☒ **Karl Marx**

Grade 12

ideas

BACK

Answer: Karl Marx

editor: a person who runs a newspaper and decides what it prints

exile: living away from your home country, often because you cannot go back

noble: belonging to a family of high rank



His wife copies his messy writing onto clean pages, every day.

FRONT

Mr X writes about history, work, and money, more than 150 years ago.

He dies more than 140 years ago.

Later, in the twentieth century, states in Russia and China take his name.

These states rule with violence and **famine** that Mr X never sees.

Historians ask a hard question: how much of this is his fault?

Many historians separate the thinker from the later **movements** named after him.

His old friend Friedrich Engels later reports one sentence.

Some followers in France use his name for their ideas.

Mr X says about them: I am not one of them.

No one else records this sentence, so historians treat it with care.

Today, some **economists** still study his idea of **crisis** in the market.

Many historians say the future does not turn out as he expects.



Today, historians and students still study Mr X and what came after him.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Vladimir Lenin
- ☒ **Karl Marx**
- ☐ Friedrich Engels
- ☐ Georg Hegel

University

ideas

BACK

Answer: Karl Marx

famine: a time when many people have little or no food

movement: a group of people who work together for one big idea

economist: a person who studies money, work, and trade

crisis: a very hard and dangerous time, often in money or the economy



In a quiet cemetery in London, the story of Mr X ends.

FRONT

Revolution X begins about 250 years ago.

Thirteen **colonies** sit on the east coast of North America.

Settlers there live under a king who rules from far away.

His country has just ended a long, costly war.

He needs money, so his **parliament** puts new **taxes** on the colonies.

The colonists have no voice in his faraway parliament.

No taxation without **representation**, they say.

One cold night, colonists board three ships in the harbor of Boston.

They break open chests of tea and dump it into the water.

The king's government answers with harsh new laws.

Anger now spreads fast across all thirteen colonies.



At night, colonists board the ships in the harbor.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Glorious Revolution
- ☒ **The American Revolution**
- ☐ The French Revolution
- ☐ The Industrial Revolution

Grade 6

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The American Revolution

colonies: lands ruled by another, faraway country

parliament: a group of people who make the laws of a country

taxes: money that people must pay to their government

representation: having someone who speaks and votes for you



Traders must pay the king a tax on goods such as tea, glass, and paper.

FRONT

Revolution X turns into full war about 250 years ago.

Colonists take up arms against the king's soldiers. A tall general from Virginia leads the colonial army.

Representatives from all thirteen colonies meet. In 1776, they **declare** independence from the king.

Their declaration states that all men are created equal.

Yet about one in five people in the colonies live **enslaved**.

The declaration does not free them.

Some colonists disagree with the revolt and stay **loyal** to the king.

The new nation must now win its independence in war.

The king's army is strong, and the war lasts for years.



Farmers and workers become soldiers almost overnight.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Russian Revolution
- ☐ The Haitian Revolution
- ☒ **The American Revolution**
- ☐ The Glorious Revolution

Grade 9

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The American Revolution

representatives: people chosen to speak and act for a group

declare: to say something clearly and officially

enslaved: forced to work for no pay and with no freedom

loyal: staying faithful and true to someone



A reader announces the new declaration to the town.

FRONT

Revolution X promises **liberty** to the colonies.

But that liberty is not equal for everyone.

Most enslaved people gain nothing from the new liberty.

Some northern states begin to end slavery slowly, but the south keeps it.

Free women support the cause with money, letters, and even secret spying.

Still, almost no woman gains the right to vote.

Loyalists, who wish to stay under the king, become outsiders overnight.

Tens of thousands leave for Canada or Britain, losing land and **property**.

Most Native nations along the **frontier** side with the king during the war.

They fear that independent settlers will take even more of their land.

After the war, that fear comes true again and again.

So the liberty of some becomes the loss of others.



Only some people may vote for the leaders of the new nation.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

☒ **The American Revolution**

☐ The Mexican Revolution

☐ The Industrial Revolution

☐ The Haitian Revolution

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The American Revolution

liberty: freedom to live and choose as you wish

loyalists: people who stay faithful to the old king

frontier: the edge of settled land, close to the wild land beyond

property: land or things that a person owns



A family that stays true to the king must now leave its home.

FRONT

After two years of war, Revolution X is going badly for the colonies.

The colonial army loses battle after battle.

It is often short of food, pay, and supplies.

Then the colonists win a big battle in the north.

Now France decides to help, partly to weaken its old **rival** across the sea.

The next year, French ships, soldiers, weapons, and money arrive.

Three years later, French warships trap the king's army near the coast.

Surrounded by land and sea, that army finally **surrenders**.

The colonies have now won their war.

But helping costs the French king enormous sums of money.

His **treasury** sinks even deeper into **debt**.

That royal debt soon helps cause serious trouble back home too.



Warships block the river. No one can escape by sea.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Mexican Revolution
- ☒ **The American Revolution**
- ☐ The Russian Revolution
- ☐ The Glorious Revolution

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The American Revolution

rival: a country or person competing against another

surrenders: stops fighting and admits defeat

treasury: the money and wealth that a government or king controls

debt: money that you owe and must pay back



Helping a war far away costs a fortune at home.

FRONT

Historians still debate the true impact of Revolution X.

Is it a true revolution, or only a change of rulers?

The new **republic** replaces a distant king with elected leaders.

Yet plantation slavery grows for decades after.

Freedom of religion and a free press become law, new ideas for the time.

A written constitution, **ratified** in the 1780s, still shapes government today.

Its early history relies on letters, diaries, and army records, many saved by chance.

Newspapers of the time already tell the story differently, depending on who prints them.

One generation later, the idea **inspires** new fighters far to the south.

In South America, a general named Simón Bolívar reads about the northern revolt.

He leads years of war so his own **homeland** can also become independent.

So one revolution's words echo across a continent, long after Revolution X itself ends.



Far to the south, decades later, new fighters cross the mountains for their own freedom.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The French Revolution
- ☐ The Industrial Revolution
- ☒ **The American Revolution**
- ☐ The Haitian Revolution

University

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The American Revolution

ratified: officially approved and accepted

republic: a country led by chosen leaders, not a king

inspires: gives someone else a new idea or wish to act

homeland: the country where a person is born and belongs



A new agreement becomes official once it is sealed.

FRONT

General X grows up on a farm in Virginia.

As a young man, he works as a **surveyor**.

He walks through forests and measures wild land as his job.

Years later, thirteen **colonies** in North America rise up against the British king.

Leaders choose General X to lead their new army.

His soldiers are mostly farmers, not trained soldiers.

In many early battles, his army must **retreat**.

On a freezing Christmas night, he crosses an icy river in the dark.

His tired men win a small battle early the next morning.

The next winter, his army camps in cold and mud with little food.

About two thousand of his soldiers die from sickness and cold that winter.

General X stays with his men, and the army holds together.



On a freezing night, General X and his men cross an icy river in secret.

Who is General X?

- ☐ Napoleon Bonaparte
- ☒ **George Washington**
- ☐ Simón Bolívar
- ☐ Alexander Hamilton

Grade 6

revolutions

BACK

Answer: George Washington

surveyor: a person whose job is to measure and map land

colonies: lands ruled by a country far away, across the sea

retreat: to move back and away from a battle, not forward



Before he leads an army, young General X works as a surveyor.

FRONT

Mr X leads thirteen colonies in a long war against their British king.

Near the end of the war, one of his officers writes him a letter.

The officer suggests that Mr X should become a king.

Mr X **refuses** at once, angry at the idea.

The colonies win the war, with important help from France.

Many expect Mr X to become the most powerful man in the land.

Instead, he goes in uniform to the new lawmakers and hands back his **commission**.

He gives up all his power and goes home to his farm.

Across Europe, people are amazed: a winning general who does not want to rule.

A few years later, leaders choose him as the country's first president.

After two **terms**, he steps down and goes home again.

Today, the **capital** of his country carries his name.



After the war is won, Mr X gives his command back to the lawmakers.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ John Adams
- ☐ Thomas Jefferson
- ☒ **George Washington**
- ☐ Benjamin Franklin

Grade 9

revolutions

BACK

Answer: George Washington

commission: the official paper that gives an officer his rank and command

term: a fixed period of years in a job like president

capital: the main city of a country, where its leaders work

refuse: to say no, and mean it



A brand new capital city slowly rises beside a wide river.

FRONT

Mr X owns a large farm called Mount Vernon, in Virginia.

Hundreds of **enslaved** people live and work there, forced and unpaid.

Mr X personally owns more than one hundred of these people.

One enslaved woman named Ona works as his wife's personal maid.

While Mr X serves as the country's first president, Ona plans her **escape**.

She flees north to a city and never goes back.

Mr X tries hard to find her and bring her back.

Ona is never caught.

She lives free in a northern town for the rest of her life.

In his **will**, Mr X gives an order: free the people I own.

But the will delays this until his wife also dies.

Historians see him as both a founder and an enslaver.



Hundreds of enslaved people work the fields of Mr X's large farm.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **George Washington**

☐ Thomas Jefferson

☐ Abraham Lincoln

☐ Benjamin Franklin

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: George Washington

enslaved: forced to work for no pay and with no freedom, as property

will: a paper that says what happens to a person's things after they die

escape: to get away and become free



Ona escapes by ship, and she never lets herself be brought back.

FRONT

As a young officer, Mr X serves the British in North America.

Britain and France both want the same forest land, further west.

Mr X and his Native allies lead a small group into the forest.

In a short, sudden fight, several French soldiers are killed.

Weeks later, young Mr X must **surrender** a small fort to French forces.

This small clash in the forest helps start a much bigger war.

Soon Britain and France fight each other on several continents.

Years later, the colonies rise up, and Mr X leads their new army.

Now France becomes his key **ally** against the British king.

Near a coastal town, Mr X and French troops trap a British army.

A French **fleet** blocks the sea, so no escape is possible by water.

The trapped army surrenders, and Britain soon starts to seek peace.



In a misty forest, a small fight begins a very big war.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Napoleon Bonaparte
- ☐ Alexander Hamilton
- ☐ John Adams
- ☒ **George Washington**

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: George Washington

ally: a country or group that fights on your side

surrender: to stop fighting and admit defeat

fleet: a large group of warships that sail together



In the rain, young Mr X must surrender a small wooden fort.

FRONT

Mr X dies at the end of the eighteenth century.

A few years later, a preacher and writer publishes a short book about him.

The book tells a sweet story: young Mr X damages a cherry tree.

When his father asks who did it, the boy says: I cannot tell a lie.

No letter, diary, or **witness** from Mr X's own lifetime mentions this story.

Historians agree: the writer most likely **invents** the whole scene.

Still, **generations** of children learn the story as if it is true.

The new nation wants a perfect founding hero, honest and brave.

Historians instead study his letters and account books.

These pages record daily details, from crops sold to money spent.

From small, dry facts, historians slowly rebuild a truer picture of his life.

This picture is less simple than the cherry tree story.



A writer invents a sweet story about a boy and a cherry tree.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Abraham Lincoln
- ☒ **George Washington**
- ☐ Thomas Jefferson
- ☐ John Adams

University

revolutions

BACK

Answer: George Washington

invent: to make up something that is not true or real

witness: a person who sees an event happen and can tell about it

generations: groups of people born and living around the same time



Historians rebuild the truer picture from old letters and account books.

FRONT

Revolution X begins in France in 1789, almost 240 years ago.

Bad harvests make bread very expensive.

Poor families cannot buy enough food.

Society here has three big groups, called **estates**.

The first estate is priests, and the second is **nobles**.

The third estate is everyone else, almost everybody.

The third estate pays nearly all the **taxes**.

Anger grows over hunger and unfair taxes.

In Paris, the capital city, a crowd gathers.

The crowd attacks an old **fortress** used as a prison.

Only seven prisoners are inside the huge building.

The crowd breaks in and takes the gunpowder stored there.



In the capital, a crowd attacks an old fortress used as a prison.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The American Revolution
- ☒ **The French Revolution**
- ☐ The Russian Revolution
- ☐ The Industrial Revolution

Grade 6

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The French Revolution

estate: one of the big social groups in an old kingdom

noble: a person born into a rich, powerful family

fortress: a strong building built to defend against attack

tax: money that people must pay to a government



Priests, nobles, and everyone else. Society here has three big groups.

FRONT

In France, Revolution X is only a few months old.

A new **parliament** takes power from the king.

Nobles must give up their old special rights.

The rich must now pay taxes too.

The parliament then writes a **declaration** of rights.

All men are born free and equal, it states.

Free speech and fair trials become new rights.

A few weeks later, bread is still hard to find in Paris.

Thousands of women march to the king's palace outside the city.

They demand bread, and they want the king to live in Paris.

He agrees, and the royal family moves to the city under **guard**.

Two years later, the king tries to **flee** in secret, but he is caught.



Thousands of women walk out of the city to demand bread.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Glorious Revolution
- ☐ The Mexican Revolution
- ☒ **The French Revolution**
- ☐ The Haitian Revolution

Grade 9

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The French Revolution

parliament: a group of people chosen to make laws for a country

declaration: an official written statement that says something clearly

guard: a soldier who protects a person or a place

flee: to run away from danger, often in secret



A carriage is stopped at night, far from Paris.

FRONT

In France, Revolution X removes the old king's power step by step.

After three years, its leaders end the **monarchy** and declare a **republic**.

The former king stands **trial** for crimes against the new nation.

Soon after, the new republic **executes** him.

Fear of enemies, at home and abroad, grows fast.

A period called the Terror begins.

Courts work quickly, and they sentence thousands of suspected enemies to death.

Official records count about seventeen thousand such deaths in one year.

Many more die in prisons or in fighting across the country.

One powerful leader, Robespierre, leads much of this.

The following year, his own allies turn against him, and he is executed too.



Hundreds of lawmakers sit as a court to judge a man once above the law.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

☒ **The French Revolution**

☐ The Russian Revolution

☐ The American Revolution

☐ The Haitian Revolution

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The French Revolution

monarchy: a country ruled by a king or queen

republic: a state without a king, led by chosen representatives

trial: a formal process in court that decides if someone is guilty

execute: to kill a person as a legal punishment



An empty throne. The old kingdom is gone.

FRONT

Revolution X promises **liberty**, equality, and brotherhood for all.

At first, though, only some men can vote.

A woman writer named Olympe de Gouges disagrees.

She writes her own declaration for the rights of woman.

She demands votes and equal rights for women too.

Later she attacks the new leaders in print.

They have her executed.

Far away, in the **colony** of Saint-Domingue, **enslaved** people rise up against their enslavers.

A few years later, the parliament in France **abolishes** slavery in its colonies.

It is one of the first such laws anywhere in the world.

The new government also creates a new system of measurement.

Meters and kilograms slowly replace hundreds of old local units.



On a distant island colony, enslaved people walk out to claim their freedom.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Haitian Revolution
- ☒ **The French Revolution**
- ☐ The Industrial Revolution
- ☐ The Glorious Revolution

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: The French Revolution

liberty: freedom; the right to live and choose without being controlled by others

colony: a land ruled and controlled by another, distant country

abolish: to end something completely, especially by law

enslaved: forced by others to work without freedom or pay



A woman writes her own declaration of rights.

FRONT

Historians still argue about the causes of Revolution X.

Older historians tell a story of class struggle.

In this story, a rising middle class overthrows a tired old **nobility**.

Later historians, called **revisionists**, question this simple picture.

They study **pamphlets**, letters, and police reports from Paris and the provinces.

These **sources** show many local causes, not just one big class conflict.

Politics, personal networks, and pure chance also matter.

Historians also compare Revolution X with the uprising in Saint-Domingue.

Enslaved people there use the same words about liberty and rights.

Yet their revolution follows its own separate path to freedom.

The comparison shows how one revolution's ideals can travel far.

Every generation of historians asks new questions of the same old sources.



Old papers in an archive. Historians read them again and again.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Russian Revolution
- ☐ The Mexican Revolution
- ☐ The Glorious Revolution
- ☒ **The French Revolution**

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revolutions

BACK

Answer: The French Revolution

pamphlet: a small, thin printed text that argues for an idea

revisionist: a historian who questions and rewrites an older, accepted story

nobility: the group of people born into powerful, high-ranking families

source: an old text or thing that gives us knowledge about the past



A historian compares two old stories side by side.

FRONT

Mr X is born on a small island.

The island is called Corsica, near Italy.

France takes the island the year before he is born.

All his life, he speaks French with an accent.

He leaves home young to go to a military school in France.

There he studies maps, math, and the science of **cannons**.

He becomes an **officer** who commands cannons.

At this time, the **revolution** in France changes everything.

Old rules about noble birth and **rank** start to break.

Now, a soldier can rise fast through skill alone.

Mr X rises very fast, and becomes a general at only twenty-four.



In a military school, one boy among many learns to be an officer.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Napoleon Bonaparte**

☐ Julius Caesar

☐ Charlemagne

☐ Otto von Bismarck

Grade 6

revolutions

BACK

Answer: Napoleon Bonaparte

officer: a leader in the army, with soldiers under his command

cannons: big heavy guns that shoot iron balls far away

revolution: a fast, big change in a country's rulers and rules

rank: your level or position in an army or a group



A cannon is a big heavy gun. Young officers learn to use it well.

FRONT

At first, Emperor X is only a young general.
After many victories for France, he takes power in a **coup**, with little fighting.
He sells Louisiana, a huge area in North America, to a young country.
A few years after the coup, he makes himself **emperor** in a great **ceremony**.
In a great church in Paris, the pope stands beside him.
But Emperor X takes the crown himself and places it on his own head.
Under him, law experts write a new book of laws for the country.
It gives all men the same rules, and clear rules for **property** and family.
Women get fewer rights than men.
Many countries still use ideas from this book today.
His armies fight many wars across Europe.
Soon he rules over much of the continent, directly or through his family.



In a great church, a ruler places a crown on his own head.

Who is Emperor X?

☒ **Napoleon Bonaparte**

- ☐ Louis XIV
☐ Charlemagne
☐ George Washington

Grade 9

revolutions

BACK

Answer: Napoleon Bonaparte

coup: a sudden takeover of power, often fast and by surprise

ceremony: a special formal event that marks an important moment

emperor: a ruler above kings, who rules a very large land or many lands

property: things or land that belong to a person by law



This book of laws still shapes laws in many countries today.

FRONT

In 1812, Emperor X marches into Russia with about six hundred thousand soldiers.

On the long march, sickness, hunger, and battle cost him most of his men.

When he reaches the great city, it is empty, and soon much of it burns.

Then winter comes, and the Russian army attacks his **retreat**.

Soldiers die by the thousands from cold, hunger, and fighting.

Most of his huge army never comes home.

Other countries then **unite** against him, and two years later he gives up his **throne**.

His enemies send him to a small island called Elba.

Within a year, he escapes, and rules again for a hundred days.

His last battle ends in **defeat** near a village called Waterloo.

This time, his enemies send him to a lonely island far out at sea.

He dies there about six years later.



The retreat from Russia. Sickness, hunger, cold, and enemy attacks destroy the army.

Who is Emperor X?

☒ **Napoleon Bonaparte**

☐ Julius Caesar

☐ Alexander the Great

☐ The Duke of Wellington

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: Napoleon Bonaparte

retreat: when an army stops fighting and moves back

throne: the special seat and power of a king or emperor

defeat: when you lose a battle or a fight

unite: to join together for one purpose



A lonely island far out in the ocean. Here the ruler spends his last years.

FRONT

Mr X leads a French army into Egypt, with scientists and artists too.

By the river Nile, his soldiers rebuild an old fort.

In one wall, they find a dark grey stone with three kinds of writing.

This stone later helps experts read ancient Egyptian writing.

Some years before this, France ends slavery in its **colonies**.

Mr X brings slavery back to the French colonies.

On one island, people freed from slavery fight to stay free.

They defeat his army there, and their colony becomes **independent**.

Many call it the first free nation of formerly **enslaved** people.

Old cartoons and enemy jokes show Mr X as a very short man.

Historians check the records: he is about one meter sixty-eight, a normal height for his time.

So the story of the short leader is a **myth**, not a fact.



In an old fort by the river, soldiers find a stone with three kinds of writing.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Napoleon Bonaparte**

☐ Simón Bolívar

☐ Louis XIV

☐ Charlemagne

Grade 12

revolutions

BACK

Answer: Napoleon Bonaparte

colonies: lands ruled and controlled by another, faraway country

enslaved: forced by others to work, with no freedom and no pay

independent: free to rule itself, not controlled by another country

myth: a story many people believe, but it is not true



A broken chain. On this island, formerly enslaved people fight and win their freedom.

FRONT

Historians still argue about Emperor X.

Some call him the **heir** of the revolution, who saves its best ideas.

Others call him its gravedigger, who buries freedom under his own crown.

As ruler, he controls most newspapers in the country.

He also pays painters to make heroic pictures of himself in battle.

These pictures shape how people see him for **generations**.

On his last island, he has many empty years.

He dictates his own life story to **loyal** followers there.

In his story, he is always wise, and his mistakes are small.

Historians read these **memoirs** with great care.

They compare his words with letters, orders, and reports from his own time.

The true picture of Emperor X lies somewhere between the myth and the man.



The ruler pays painters to show him as a hero in battle.

Who is Emperor X?

☒ **Napoleon Bonaparte**

☐ Otto von Bismarck

☐ Julius Caesar

☐ Simón Bolívar

University

revolutions

BACK

Answer: Napoleon Bonaparte

heir: a person who continues someone else's work or place

memoirs: a book where a person writes the story of their own life

loyal: always faithful and supportive, especially to a leader

generations: large groups of people born and living around the same time



Far from Europe, he tells his own story to loyal followers.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Germany, about ninety years ago.

His country holds free **elections** and has free newspapers.

Hard times come, and millions of people lose their jobs.

Mr X leads a party with an angry, simple promise.

He blames Jewish people and other groups for the hard times.

He promises to make the country strong and proud again.

In 1933, the old **president** names him head of government.

Within months, the government shuts down free newspapers.

It **bans** every other political party.

People go to prison simply for their **opinions**.

In school, children now learn to hate these groups.



A newspaper office stands closed. No one prints the free news anymore.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Joseph Stalin
- ☒ **Adolf Hitler**
- ☐ Benito Mussolini
- ☐ Francisco Franco

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Adolf Hitler

elections: when people vote to choose their leaders

president: the highest elected leader of a country

bans: makes something against the law

opinions: what a person thinks or believes



The school door has closed behind the children. Inside, they learn a new lesson.

FRONT

Mr X wants to become a painter as a young man.

He moves to Vienna and tries to enter the art **academy**.

The academy rejects him, not once but twice.

He lives alone in a cheap shelter for poor men.

When the great war of 1914 begins, he becomes a soldier.

He is wounded, and near the end of the war he is **gassed**.

After the war, he joins a small party blaming Jews and democracy for the defeat.

In Munich, he tries to **seize** power by force.

The attempt fails, and he goes to prison.

In prison, he writes a book full of hate.

In one election, his party wins fewer than three votes in every hundred.

After a great **economic crisis**, one voter in three chooses his party, never a majority.



A blank canvas waits in a shelter for poor men. The academy has said no, twice.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Kaiser Wilhelm II
- ☐ Paul von Hindenburg
- ☒ **Adolf Hitler**
- ☐ Benito Mussolini

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Adolf Hitler

academy: a school for special skills, like art or science

gassed: poisoned by a dangerous gas, used as a weapon in the war

seize: to take something suddenly and by force

economic crisis: a time when many businesses fail and people lose work and money



In a prison room, a prisoner writes a book full of hate.

FRONT

Mr X leads the government of Germany.

His government targets one group above all: Jewish **citizens**.

In his first year in power, his supporters block the doors of Jewish shops.

Two years later, new laws take away their rights as citizens.

The same laws forbid marriage between Jews and other Germans.

In November 1938, his party sends its men to attack Jewish homes, shops, and **synagogues**.

Crowds join in, and windows break across the country in one night.

About thirty thousand Jewish men are sent to **camps**.

Jewish families now try to leave the country.

Many countries let in only a few of them.

Then war comes, and the **persecution** turns into mass murder.

His state murders six million Jews, and also Roma people, disabled people, and others.



By morning, broken glass covers the pavement outside a Jewish family's shop.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Joseph Stalin
- ☐ Hideki Tojo
- ☒ **Adolf Hitler**
- ☐ Francisco Franco

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Adolf Hitler

citizens: people who legally belong to a country and share its rights

synagogues: buildings where Jewish people gather to pray

camps: here: guarded places where prisoners are kept against their will

persecution: cruel and unfair treatment of a group, again and again



A packed suitcase waits by the door. Many countries will not let the family in.

FRONT

Mr X's government in Germany controls what people hear and see.

A radio stands in most homes, and one voice fills it. Huge **rallies** gather crowds under bright lights and loud music.

One group of students burns books that the government calls dangerous.

Children must join **youth groups** run by the state. A **secret police** force listens for any word against the government.

Neighbors grow afraid to trust each other.

Most people simply join in, or quietly look away.

A different group of students resists: in Munich, they print **leaflets** against the government.

In February 1943, the government executes three of them for their leaflets.

Fear alone cannot explain it all: many ordinary people choose to believe.



In most homes, a radio brings one voice into the kitchen.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Benito Mussolini
- ☒ **Adolf Hitler**
- ☐ Joseph Stalin
- ☐ Hideki Tojo

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Adolf Hitler

rallies: big public meetings to cheer for a leader or a cause

youth groups: clubs where children and teenagers meet, often run by the state

secret police: police who spy on citizens in secret, not openly

leaflets: small printed sheets of paper with a message



A few students print words against the government. It costs them their lives.

FRONT

Historians no longer explain Mr X as one evil genius acting alone.

They ask a harder question: how does a whole society follow him?

One group of historians stresses his own choices and **intentions**.

Another group stresses the structures around him: rivals, chaos, and weak **institutions**.

A famous phrase describes officials who guess his wishes and act without orders.

One historian calls this: working towards the leader.

The sources include party files, private diaries, and letters home.

After the war, trials use these sources to judge the accused.

Some people later deny that the murder of six million Jews and others even happened.

Historians study this **denial** too, as a **phenomenon** in itself.

In 1945, with his war lost and Berlin surrounded, Mr X takes his own life.



After the war, courts in Nuremberg and elsewhere try to judge what happened.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Francisco Franco
- ☐ Hideki Tojo
- ☐ Joseph Stalin
- ☒ **Adolf Hitler**

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Adolf Hitler

intentions: the plans or purposes inside a person's mind

institutions: the organizations and systems that run a country

phenomenon: something that happens and that can be studied and explained

denial: refusing to accept that something true really happened



Private diaries and letters home help historians understand how it all happened.

FRONT

Mr X lives in India, where British rulers are in charge.

An old law says only the rulers may make and sell salt.

Salt comes free from the sea, but people must pay a **tax**.

Mr X says this law is not fair to poor people.

In 1930, he starts to walk from his home toward the **coast**.

Every day along the road, more people join him.

The walk takes about twenty-four days in all.

He and his **followers** walk nearly four hundred kilometers.

At the seashore, Mr X bends down to the water.

He picks up a small handful of natural salt.

With this quiet act, he breaks the tax law.

Police **arrest** tens of thousands of his followers, but they do not fight back.



Day by day, the crowd walking toward the sea grows longer.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Jawaharlal Nehru
- ☒ **Mahatma Gandhi**
- ☐ Muhammad Ali Jinnah
- ☐ Subhas Chandra Bose

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Mahatma Gandhi

tax: money that people must pay to the rulers

coast: the land next to the sea

followers: people who join and support a leader

arrest: when police take a person away and do not let them go free



A handful of salt from the sea, taken in front of everyone.

FRONT

Mr X leads a movement in India, about a hundred years ago.

He believes people can fight **injustice** without any weapons.

He calls this method **satyagraha**, or holding on to truth.

Instead of buying British cloth, he asks people to spin their own.

He often sits and spins cotton thread on a simple wooden wheel.

Homespun cloth becomes a quiet symbol of independence.

British rulers repeatedly send Mr X to prison for his protests.

In total, he spends about six years of his life in prison.

Sometimes he refuses all food as a form of protest.

He calls these fasts an appeal to people's **conscience**.

Slowly, a small movement grows into one that includes millions.



Spinning thread by hand becomes a quiet act of protest.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Rabindranath Tagore
- ☐ B. R. Ambedkar
- ☒ **Mahatma Gandhi**
- ☐ Muhammad Ali Jinnah

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Mahatma Gandhi

injustice: something that is not fair or right

satyagraha: a special word for fighting for what is right without violence

homespun: cloth spun and woven by hand at home, not made in a factory

conscience: the inner feeling that tells a person right from wrong



For his protests, he spends years locked behind walls like these.

FRONT

Mr X studies law in London, more than a hundred years ago.

After his studies, he takes work in South Africa.

There, laws treat people differently because of the color of their skin.

One night, he sits in a first-class train **carriage** with a valid ticket.

An **official** orders him off because of his skin color. He refuses to move, and guards throw him off the train.

Cold and angry on the empty platform, he decides to act.

Over the next twenty-one years, he builds a method of peaceful **resistance**.

He organizes Indians in South Africa to resist unfair laws without violence.

Historians note that his early writings there share the **prejudice** of his time against Africans.

Only later does his thinking grow to include all people.



Thrown off the train at night, he decides to act.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Jawaharlal Nehru
- ☐ Subhas Chandra Bose
- ☐ Rabindranath Tagore
- ☒ **Mahatma Gandhi**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

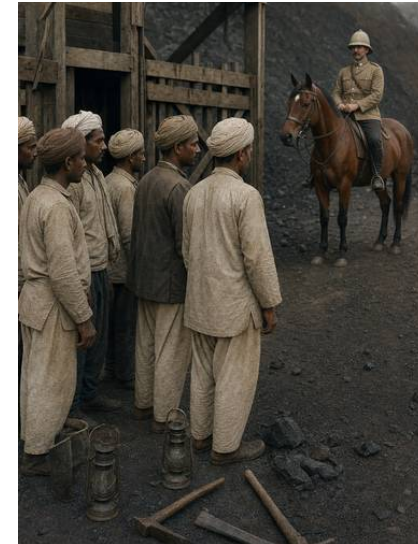
Answer: Mahatma Gandhi

carriage: a train car where passengers sit

official: a person who works for a government or a company and has some power

resistance: fighting against something, here without weapons

prejudice: an unfair opinion about people, often based on the group they belong to



He teaches a new idea: break unfair laws openly, and never fight back.

FRONT

In 1947, Mr X's homeland finally becomes **independent**.

British rulers and Indian leaders also divide the land into two new countries.

Millions of Hindus, Muslims, and Sikhs must suddenly move.

Violence breaks out between neighbors of different faiths.

Estimates say hundreds of thousands of people, maybe far more, are killed.

Mr X is heartbroken by **violence** he has tried to prevent.

In the capital, he refuses all food to make the killing stop.

His fast works: Hindu and Sikh leaders promise to protect their Muslim neighbors.

Not everyone welcomes his message of friendship between faiths.

Twelve days later, a Hindu **nationalist** shoots him dead.

The gunman believes Mr X is too friendly toward Muslims.

His death shocks the young nation.



In 1947, millions cross the new border between two countries.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ B. R. Ambedkar
- ☐ Muhammad Ali Jinnah
- ☐ Jawaharlal Nehru
- ☒ **Mahatma Gandhi**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Mahatma Gandhi

independent: free to rule itself, not controlled by another country

violence: actions that hurt or kill people

estimates: careful guesses based on the facts we have

nationalist: a person with very strong pride in one nation, sometimes against other groups



He refuses food and asks: please, let the killing stop.

FRONT

Mr X becomes one of the most studied leaders of the twentieth century.

Not everyone in India agrees with his methods or his ideas.

B. R. Ambedkar is a leader of the Dalits, the people the **caste** system places lowest.

He says Mr X defends the caste order and does too little against caste **discrimination**.

Ambedkar wants strong legal protection, not only a change of heart.

Other leaders find peaceful protest too slow and want an armed uprising instead.

Mr X insists that the method matters as much as the goal.

Decades later, movements on other continents study his method of nonviolent protest.

He writes a long **autobiography**, openly admitting many of his own mistakes.

His collected writings and letters fill about one hundred **volumes**.

Even British police files, kept to watch him, survive as evidence today.

Together, these sources let historians question the popular image of the man.



His own words fill about a hundred volumes, and police files add still more.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Jawaharlal Nehru
- ☒ **Mahatma Gandhi**
- ☐ Muhammad Ali Jinnah
- ☐ Subhas Chandra Bose

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Mahatma Gandhi

caste: a group a person is born into in India's old social order, ranked above or below other groups

discrimination: treating a group of people unfairly because of who they are

autobiography: a book a person writes about their own life

volume: one book in a long series of books that belong together



Some leaders want new laws, others want a very different kind of protest.

FRONT

The biggest war in history ends in 1945.
Many countries want **peace** to last this time.
Fifty countries meet in San Francisco, a city by the sea.
There they sign a long **agreement** together.
One more country signs it a little later.
Now Organization X starts with fifty-one countries.
Today, almost every country in the world belongs to it.
Every country sends people to one huge hall.
In that hall, each country gets exactly one vote.
Organization X also feeds hungry children and sends doctors.



Fifty countries sign a long agreement. More join later.

**Which organization is
Organization X?**

- ☐ The League of Nations
- ☒ **The United Nations**
- ☐ The Commonwealth
- ☐ NATO

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The United Nations

agreement: a promise that two or more people or countries make together

peace: a time with no war or fighting



An agreement is a promise that countries make to each other.

FRONT

Organization X works by clear, simple rules.

All member countries meet in one big **assembly**. There, the biggest and the smallest country have one vote each.

A smaller **council** also meets, with fewer countries.

Five countries always have a seat on that council.

The council can send soldiers to keep the peace.

The soldiers wear plain blue **helmets** for this work.

Each of the five can also say no to a plan.

This power to block a plan is called a **veto**.

One veto is enough to stop the whole council.

So the same five stay strong, but help can be blocked too.



Hands go up in the big hall: one vote for each country.

Which organization is Organization X?

- ☐ The World Bank
- ☐ The Arab League
- ☒ **The United Nations**
- ☐ The European Union

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The United Nations

assembly: a big meeting where every member has a seat

council: a smaller group that meets often and decides on quick action

veto: the power to say no and stop a plan, even if everyone else says yes

helmet: a hard hat that protects the head



Soldiers in plain blue helmets try to keep the peace.

FRONT

In 1948, Organization X writes a new kind of list. The list names rights that every human should have.

People from many cultures help write thirty short **articles**.

A woman leads the **committee** that writes the text.

A **philosopher** from China also shapes the final words.

Long debates happen about rights that fit every culture.

When the vote comes, no country votes against the list.

A few countries choose not to vote for or against.

Translators later put the text into hundreds of languages.

Still, the list is only words on paper.

The gap between the words and daily life stays wide.



A small committee writes a list of rights for every human.

Which organization is Organization X?

- ☐ The League of Nations
- ☐ The Red Cross
- ☐ The European Union
- ☒ **The United Nations**

Grade 12

twentieth century

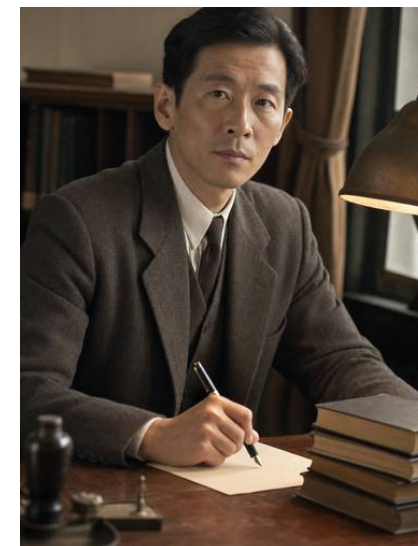
BACK

Answer: The United Nations

committee: a small group of people chosen to do one job

philosopher: a person who thinks deeply about big questions like right and wrong

articles: short, numbered parts of a longer written text



A philosopher helps choose the exact words for every right.

FRONT

About eighty years ago, **empires** still rule most of Africa and much of Asia.

Over the next decades, dozens of new countries join Organization X.

Each new member brings its own voice to the big assembly.

Organization X openly supports countries that want **independence**.

Later, it bans arms sales to the **apartheid** state in South Africa.

It also calls on countries to stop trading with that state.

But Organization X also fails badly at times.

In 1994, in Rwanda, its soldiers are ordered to stand back.

About eight hundred thousand people are killed there in only a few months.

The next year, in Srebrenica, its soldiers cannot protect a town that trusts them.

About eight thousand men and boys are killed after the town falls.

Both failures are studied closely so such harm does not happen again.



New countries send their first delegates to the big hall.

Which organization is Organization X?

- ☒ **The United Nations**
- ☐ The Organization of African Unity
- ☐ The Commonwealth
- ☐ The World Bank

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The United Nations

empires: large groups of lands and peoples ruled by one strong power

independence: being free to rule yourself, without another country in charge

apartheid: a system of laws in South Africa that kept people apart by skin color and gave white people the power



The guard post stands empty. Help does not come in time.

FRONT

Historians study Organization X like any other **institution**.

After an earlier great war, countries make a first attempt at world peace.

That first attempt is too weak, and it collapses within twenty years.

Its failure shapes the design of the second attempt in 1945.

Five countries keep a veto from the very first drafts.

For decades, **diplomats** argue about who deserves a permanent seat too.

Historians disagree about how to measure the organization's success.

Some count wars it stops, others count wars it fails to stop.

Old **archives** and internal memos help settle some of these arguments.

But the records cannot answer the hardest question of all.

Can states protect people from their own governments?

That question stays open.



Old records help historians study what the organization did and did not do.

Which organization is Organization X?

- ☐ The League of Nations
- ☐ NATO
- ☒ **The United Nations**
- ☐ The Red Cross

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The United Nations

institution: a large, lasting organization with clear rules

archives: old papers and records kept safe for later study

diplomats: people who represent their country and talk with other countries



One seat at the table can say no to everyone else.

FRONT

War X starts more than a hundred years ago, in Europe.

Many countries have signed **alliances** before the war starts.

These alliances work like two rows of **dominoes**. If one country falls into war, its allies often follow. In the summer of 1914, a prince is shot and killed. It happens in a city named Sarajevo, in the Balkans.

Historians call this shot the **spark**, not the cause. Alliances turn one shot into a war across a **continent**.

Many young men, not all, march off cheering.

Many believe they will be home again by Christmas.

Instead, War X lasts four long years.



Young men leave for the war. Many think they will be home again soon.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ The Balkan Wars
- ☒ **World War I**
- ☐ World War II
- ☐ The Russian Civil War

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War I

alliance: a promise between countries to help each other in war

spark: a small thing that starts something much bigger

continent: a very large area of land, like Europe or Africa

dominoes: small flat game pieces, when one falls, it knocks over the next



One country falls into war. Its allies follow, like dominoes.

FRONT

War X is fought mostly in the fields of Europe. Soldiers on each side dig long **trenches** in the earth.

These trenches stretch across the land for hundreds of kilometers.

Between the two lines lies open ground called **no man's land**.

Machine guns can fire hundreds of bullets every minute.

Both sides also use poison gases that burn the eyes and lungs.

For years, the front line barely moves at all.

Soldiers spend long weeks in mud, cold, and fear.

They write letters home to wives, mothers, and children.

Lice and rats share the trenches with the soldiers.

By the end, about ten million soldiers have died.



Soldiers spend long weeks in mud and cold, close to the enemy line.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ The Vietnam War
- ☐ The Korean War
- ☒ **World War I**
- ☐ The Spanish Civil War

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War I

trench: a long, deep ditch dug in the ground

no man's land: the open, dangerous ground between two enemy lines

lice: tiny bugs that live in hair or clothes and bite



Between the two trench lines lies empty, dangerous ground.

FRONT

War X is fought by soldiers from every continent. It begins in 1914 and lasts four years.

European countries call on soldiers from their **colonies** too.

Soldiers from India fight in the trenches of France and on other **fronts**.

Men from Senegal cross the sea to fight in France. Australians, Canadians, and soldiers from the Caribbean join as well.

The Ottoman Empire, ruling much of the Middle East, fights too.

It loses the war, and the **empire** falls apart.

New borders are then drawn across the Middle East.

Some of these borders still shape the region today.

At home, many men leave their jobs to fight.

Women take their place in factories that make weapons and tools.



Soldiers arrive from a colony far away to fight in Europe.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ World War II
- ☐ The Korean War
- ☐ The Balkan Wars
- ☒ **World War I**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War I

colonies: lands ruled by a country far away

empire: many lands and peoples ruled by one strong state

front: here: a line where two armies fight each other



At home, women take on new jobs in factories.

FRONT

In 1917, War X has already lasted for years.

The United States joins the war and sends soldiers across the ocean.

That same year, a **revolution** shakes the empire of Russia.

Its new leaders soon pull the country out of the war.

Fighting on the other fronts continues for one more year.

At last, an **armistice** stops the fighting.

It is eleven o'clock on the eleventh day of the eleventh month.

Crowds in many cities cheer, cry, and hug strangers.

The next year, leaders sign a peace **treaty** at the palace of Versailles.

It says one country caused the war and must pay for the damage.

Around the same time, a new sickness spreads across the world.

In two more years, it kills even more people than the war.



When the fighting finally stops, crowds fill the streets in joy and relief.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ The Russian Civil War
- ☒ **World War I**
- ☐ The Spanish Civil War
- ☐ World War II

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War I

armistice: an agreement between enemies to stop fighting

revolution: a sudden, big change in who rules a country

treaty: a written agreement between countries



A new sickness fills hospital wards, even after the fighting ends.

FRONT

Historians agree on the main events of War X.

It begins in Europe in 1914, more than a hundred years ago.

But historians still argue about its deeper cause.

One group of historians blames the **ambition** of one country in particular.

Another group says the leaders of Europe drift into war like sleepwalkers.

On this view, no leader wants the huge war that follows.

The sources from the time are hard to use.

Soldiers write letters home, but a **censor** removes some lines.

A **diary** gives private views, yet not many soldiers keep one.

After the war, each government writes its own official history.

Even the number of soldiers who die is still debated today.

Historians keep comparing new sources to test old answers.



A soldier's letter home. A censor has already removed some lines.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ The Balkan Wars
- ☐ The Vietnam War
- ☒ **World War I**
- ☐ The Korean War

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War I

censor: a person who reads letters and removes parts before they are sent

diary: a book where a person writes each day about life

ambition: a strong wish to gain power or success



A soldier writes in his diary. Historians read such private notes with care.

FRONT

War X begins in 1939.

It grows bigger than any war before it.

Armies fight on land, at sea, and in the air.

Soldiers fight on three continents and across the oceans.

In some countries, governments **evacuate** many children from the big cities.

Each child carries a small suitcase and a name tag.

Trains carry them to new families in the countryside.

Back home, food grows **scarce**, so families use **ration books**.

A ration book says how much sugar or meat you may buy.

Thick, dark curtains cover every window at night.

No light may show outside, or planes might see the town.

At school, children practice putting on **gas masks**.



Children travel by train to new homes in the countryside.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ The Korean War
- ☒ **World War II**
- ☐ The Chinese Civil War
- ☐ The Spanish Civil War

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War II

evacuate: to send people away from a dangerous place to somewhere safer

ration book: a small book that says how much food a family may buy

scarce: hard to find, because there is not much of it

gas mask: a mask that covers your face and helps you breathe clean air



A ration book. It says how much food a family may buy.

FRONT

War X does not begin only in Europe.

In Asia, Japan already fights a long war in China.

In Europe, a dictator's armies conquer most of the **continent** in two years.

Then his armies **invade** the Soviet Union, a huge country to the east.

Soon after, Japan attacks an American naval base in the Pacific.

The United States joins the war.

Now fighting truly covers most of the world.

Deep inside the Soviet Union, one long battle becomes a **turning point**.

In the Pacific, a great sea battle turns the **tide** too.

Soldiers from many countries land on the beaches of northern France.

Steadily, armies push the dictator's forces back toward Germany.

After almost six years of war, Germany surrenders in 1945.



Soldiers from several countries land on a beach in northern France.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ World War I
- ☐ The Vietnam War
- ☒ **World War II**
- ☐ The Gulf War

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War II

invade: to enter another country with an army in order to take control of it

continent: one of the world's very large areas of land, such as Europe or Asia

turning point: the moment when something starts to change in a big way

tide: here: the direction that a war is going, toward one side winning



After one long battle, the war slowly begins to change direction.

FRONT

In Germany, more than eighty years ago, a dictator takes power.

His government spreads hatred and blames Jewish people for the country's problems.

Step by step, new laws take away their rights and their safety.

During the war, the dictator's state turns this hatred into organized mass murder.

In occupied lands, it forces Jewish families into sealed districts called **ghettos**.

In the east, its police and special units shoot huge numbers of Jewish civilians.

The **regime** also builds camps whose only purpose is killing people.

Roma people are murdered there too, and so are other groups.

Disabled people are murdered in special killing centers in Germany.

In total, about six million Jewish people are murdered in this **genocide**.

Not everyone looks away. Some neighbors hide families at great risk.

After the war, **survivors** tell their stories, so today we know what happened.



Some neighbors hide families in secret rooms, at great risk.

Which war is War X?

- ☒ **World War II**
- ☐ The Chinese Civil War
- ☐ World War I
- ☐ The Gulf War

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War II

ghetto: a closed off part of a city where a group of people is forced to live

genocide: the planned murder of a whole group of people because of who they are

regime: a government, especially one with great and often harsh power

survivor: a person who lives through something very dangerous



A part of the city is closed off behind a wall. Families are forced to live inside.

FRONT

War X reaches almost every part of the world, not only Europe.

Millions of soldiers from Africa and India fight for the **empires** ruling them.

Soldiers and workers from the Caribbean and Latin America join too.

At home, women take new jobs building weapons and **bombers**.

Bombers attack cities on every side, and many **civilians** die.

In August 1945, two powerful new bombs destroy two cities in Japan.

By the end of that year, about two hundred thousand people are dead.

Days later, Japan **surrenders**, and the fighting finally stops everywhere.

In total, historians count more than sixty million dead.

Most of them are not soldiers, but ordinary civilians.



Soldiers from many parts of the world serve far from home.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ The Vietnam War
- ☐ The Korean War
- ☐ The Spanish Civil War
- ☒ **World War II**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War II

empire: a large group of countries or peoples ruled by one powerful country

surrender: to stop fighting and admit defeat

bomber: a plane built to carry and drop bombs

civilian: a person who is not a soldier



Women build large aircraft in factories while the men are away.

FRONT

Historians still argue about the exact number of dead in War X.

Estimates range from about fifty million to about eighty million people.

In some countries, records are incomplete, lost, or never kept.

After the war, courts in Nuremberg and Tokyo try the former leaders.

Judges from the winning countries hear evidence of war crimes and mass murder.

Historians also debate the two atomic bombs dropped on Japan.

Some argue the bombs saved lives by ending the war quickly.

Others argue that the war was already close to its end.

They add that the Soviet attack on Japan mattered too.

Museums, **memorials**, and survivor **testimony** keep the memory of the war alive.

A few people falsely **deny** the genocide of six million Jewish people.

Historians answer with documents, photographs, and the words of survivors.



Historians study old documents to understand what really happened.

Which war is War X?

- ☐ World War I
- ☒ **World War II**
- ☐ The Chinese Civil War
- ☐ The Vietnam War

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: World War II

estimate: a careful guess based on the information you have

testimony: what a witness says about what happened

deny: to say that something is not true, even when it is

memorial: a place built to help people remember something important



A quiet memorial helps people remember those who died.

FRONT

As a boy, Mr X does badly in Latin and mathematics.

He loves **toy soldiers** more than lessons.

More than a hundred years ago, he becomes a young army officer.

He fights for his country's army in Sudan and writes for newspapers.

Later, he travels with soldiers in South Africa, as a **reporter**.

Boer fighters capture him and lock him in a **prison camp**.

One night, Mr X climbs over the camp wall.

He hides among coal sacks on a goods train.

Then helpers hide him in a mine and on another train.

After a long, dangerous journey, he reaches safety.

Newspapers print his escape story, and he becomes famous.

Years later, he leads his country's government in the war against Germany's dictator.



In the dark, Mr X climbs onto a wagon of coal sacks and escapes.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ David Lloyd George
- ☒ **Winston Churchill**
- ☐ Neville Chamberlain
- ☐ Harold Macmillan

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Winston Churchill

reporter: a person whose job is to write news for a newspaper

prison camp: a guarded place where captured soldiers are kept

toy soldiers: small model soldiers that children play with

Boer: a farmer of Dutch family background in South Africa, more than a hundred years ago



As a boy, Mr X lines up his toy soldiers for hours.

FRONT

In 1940, Mr X becomes the leader of his country's government.

It stands almost alone in the war against the dictator in Germany.

In **parliament** he promises only blood, **toil**, tears, and sweat.

Newspapers print his words, and people repeat them.

His words are simple, and many people say they give them courage.

Soon, enemy planes bomb the capital city, night after night.

Families hide in **shelters** and underground stations.

Fires burn through whole streets by morning.

Mr X walks through the **ruins** the next day.

He talks with tired families among the broken houses.

His speeches from these months become famous around the world.



After the bombing, the street lies in ruins, and helpers search through the morning.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Neville Chamberlain
- ☐ Charles de Gaulle
- ☐ Clement Attlee
- ☒ **Winston Churchill**

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Winston Churchill

toil: hard, tiring work

parliament: the group of elected people who make a country's laws

shelter: a safe place that protects people from danger

ruins: what is left after buildings are destroyed



Every night, families walk down into a shelter, safe from the bombs above.

FRONT

In 1915, Mr X pushes hard for a bold naval attack.

The target is a narrow sea **strait**, far from the main front.

The plan fails badly.

More than one hundred thousand soldiers die on both sides.

Mr X takes much of the **blame**, and he loses his government job.

He returns within two years and holds high office in the 1920s.

Then come ten years without office, which biographers later call his **wilderness years**.

In these years, he warns that a dictator in Germany grows more dangerous.

Few politicians want to listen to his warnings.

Later, he leads his country through the war in Europe.

Weeks after victory, his country holds an election.

Voters choose another party, which promises new housing, health care, and jobs.



In 1915, ships and soldiers attack a narrow strait, and the bold plan fails.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Winston Churchill**

☐ David Lloyd George

☐ Neville Chamberlain

☐ Clement Attlee

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Winston Churchill

strait: a narrow strip of sea between two areas of land

wilderness years: a long period out of power and influence

blame: responsibility for something bad that happens



Weeks after victory, voters line up to choose their next leaders.

FRONT

Mr X leads his country's government in the war against Germany's dictator.

He believes strongly that his country's empire is a good thing.

He says harsh words about Indian people and their wish for independence.

In 1943, **famine** strikes the region of Bengal, in India.

A **cyclone** and floods ruin the rice **harvest**, and crop disease spreads.

The war cuts off rice from Burma, and ships carry weapons, not grain.

Officials in India beg his government for more help.

His government refuses to send enough food ships.

About three million people die from hunger and disease.

Historians still argue about how much blame belongs to Mr X.

Some point to wartime shipping **shortages** everywhere.

Others point to his own words and choices about India.



In 1943, hunger spreads through Bengal, and families wait for rice.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Clement Attlee
- ☐ Harold Macmillan
- ☒ **Winston Churchill**
- ☐ David Lloyd George

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Winston Churchill

famine: a time when many people cannot get enough food

cyclone: a huge storm with very strong winds that comes in from the sea

harvest: the crops gathered from fields at the end of the growing season

shortage: not having enough of something that is needed



A storm and floods ruin the harvest, and the fields give almost nothing to eat.

FRONT

After the war in Europe, Mr X writes his own history of it.

A team of helpers works with him.

His **account** fills six thick **volumes**.

The books shape how people remember the war for decades.

In 1953, he receives the Nobel Prize in Literature.

The prize honors his speeches and his historical writing, not his politics.

Away from politics, Mr X often paints quiet landscapes.

He calls painting his way to escape dark moods.

Historians later study his private papers, letters, and **cabinet** documents.

These sources sometimes support his own account, and sometimes contradict it.

Slowly, historians separate his own **myth** from the documented record.

His own story remains powerful, but it is now read with care.



Later in life, Mr X writes a long history of the war. It fills a row of thick volumes.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Charles de Gaulle
- ☒ **Winston Churchill**
- ☐ Joseph Stalin
- ☐ Franklin Roosevelt

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Winston Churchill

volume: one book in a set of books that belong together

account: here: a person's own telling of what happened

cabinet: the group of top ministers who advise a country's leader

myth: a popular story that is not fully true



When politics feels heavy, Mr X paints quiet garden scenes instead.

FRONT

A big city named Berlin stands cut in two by a wall. The wall stands there for twenty-eight years. Families on one side cannot visit the other side. Guards watch the wall every day and every night. Then, one evening in November 1989, everything suddenly changes. Guards at the **checkpoints** let people through the gates. Thousands of people walk across to the other side. **Strangers** on both sides hug each other and cry. Some climb up onto the wall itself that night. They swing hammers and **chip** small pieces off it. That November night is Event X.



One evening, the guards step aside and let the crowd walk through.

Which event is Event X?

- ☒ **The fall of the Berlin Wall**
- ☐ The Cuban Missile Crisis
- ☐ The Hungarian uprising of 1956
- ☐ The collapse of the Soviet Union

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The fall of the Berlin Wall

checkpoints: places where guards check who may pass

chip: to break a small piece off something hard

strangers: people you do not know



People chip small pieces off the wall with hammers.

FRONT

After the biggest war in history, a city lies in ruins. The winners of the war divide the city into four parts.

One part belongs to a state with closed **borders**. In that state, people cannot travel freely to other countries.

Every year, hundreds of thousands leave through the open city border.

So in August 1961, the state acts in one night.

Soldiers roll out barbed wire across the city.

In the days after, workers add a long **concrete** wall.

Soldiers with dogs and **searchlights** guard the new border.

At least one hundred and forty people die at the wall.

About a hundred of them die trying to cross it.

Event X comes many years later, the night the wall opens.



In one night, the border closes. Within days, a wall follows.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Prague Spring
- ☒ **The fall of the Berlin Wall**
- ☐ The Solidarity strikes in Poland
- ☐ The end of apartheid

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The fall of the Berlin Wall

concrete: a hard grey material made from sand, stone and cement

searchlights: strong lights used to light up a dark area

border: the line where one country or area ends and another begins



A searchlight sweeps over the empty ground along the border.

FRONT

By the autumn of 1989, the wall has stood for years.

The leader of the eastern giant now allows **reforms**.

That September, Hungary announces on television that its western border is open.

Tens of thousands from behind the wall escape through that gap.

Every Monday, crowds in Leipzig grow into hundreds of thousands.

They **chant** one simple phrase, "We are the people."

Under this pressure, the old leader of the state is pushed out.

One evening, a party **spokesman** holds a press conference on live television.

At the press table, he reads a new travel rule badly.

A reporter asks when it starts, and he answers, "immediately".

Crowds rush to the checkpoints that same night.

Confused guards finally lift the **barrier**, and Event X begins.



Every Monday evening, the crowds in one city grow larger and larger.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Hungarian uprising of 1956
- ☐ The collapse of the Soviet Union
- ☐ The Solidarity strikes in Poland
- ☒ **The fall of the Berlin Wall**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The fall of the Berlin Wall

reforms: changes made to improve how a country is run

chant: to say or shout the same words together, again and again

spokesman: a person who speaks to the public for a government or a group

barrier: something that blocks the way, like a gate or a fence



At the press table, a spokesman reads a new rule out loud, and reads it badly.

FRONT

Event X is the night when the wall opens.
After that night, huge changes follow very fast.
In the autumn of 1989, change sweeps across the whole region.

One by one, other closed states loosen their grip on power.

In most places, the change happens peacefully.
In Romania, though, the change turns **violent**.

Less than a year later, the divided country becomes one again.

Reunion brings joy, yet it also brings hard change in the east.

Many old factories close, and workers there suddenly lose their jobs.

For years, the **secret police** have watched millions of ordinary citizens.

Two years after Event X, people can read their own secret files.

Some are shocked to learn who reported on them, even neighbors.



After reunion, people can ask to read the files written about them.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Cuban Missile Crisis
- ☒ **The fall of the Berlin Wall**
- ☐ The Prague Spring
- ☐ The end of apartheid

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The fall of the Berlin Wall

secret police: police who work in secret to watch and control people

reunion: coming back together after being apart

violent: involving force that hurts people or damages things



In the east, reunion also means that some old factories close.

FRONT

Event X is the night the wall opens in 1989.
 Historians still **debate** why it happens.
 Some stress the **reformer** in the eastern giant who allows change.
 Others point to the huge crowds who force the pace of events.
 Others again stress the churches that shelter the first protest meetings.
 Still others point to one spokesman's mistake at the press conference.
 Some also point to western television, which reports the gates are open.
 No single cause fully explains what happens that night.
 To study it, historians use grainy television **footage** from the time.
 They also read files kept by the old secret police.
 Interviews with people who were there add memory to the record.
 Yet memory itself differs, and east and west recall that night differently.



Today, a line of stones in a park shows where the wall once stood.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Hungarian uprising of 1956
- ☐ The Cuban Missile Crisis
- ☒ **The fall of the Berlin Wall**
- ☐ The Solidarity strikes in Poland

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The fall of the Berlin Wall

debate: to discuss a question on which people disagree

reformer: a person who works to change and improve a system

footage: recorded pictures from a film or video camera



Later interviews add personal memory to what the old pictures show.

FRONT

Event X happens in July 1969, more than fifty years ago.

Three men sit inside a tiny **capsule**.

A giant **rocket** lifts the capsule into the sky.

The rocket stands taller than a building with thirty floors.

The three men travel through space for four days.

They aim for the Moon, high above the Earth.

Two men climb down a ladder onto grey dust.

The dust keeps their **footprints**, because there is no wind.

Back home, about 600 million people watch on television.

The two men gather grey stones and carry them home.



A rocket stands ready. It will carry three men far above the Earth.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The first flight across the Atlantic
- ☐ The first spacewalk
- ☒ **The first Moon landing**
- ☐ The first space station

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The first Moon landing

capsule: a small closed vehicle that carries people through space

rocket: a tall machine that burns fuel to fly into space

footprints: marks left in the ground by feet



Back home, millions of families watch the grey pictures on television.

FRONT

Two great powers compete for years.

One of them sends the first **satellite** into space.
That happens in 1957, and it shocks the other side.

Some years later, that power also sends the first human into space.

His name is Yuri Gagarin, and he circles the Earth once.

Soon after, a president speaks to his country's lawmakers.

He promises to reach the Moon before the **decade** ends.

About 400,000 people join the huge program that follows.

Many are **engineers**, and some are **mathematicians**.

One mathematician, Katherine Johnson, checks flight paths by hand.

During a test on the ground, a sudden fire kills three astronauts.

Even so, the program moves forward, and Event X still lies ahead.



Rows of workers watch small screens and paper as the flight moves forward.

Which event is Event X?

- ☒ **The first Moon landing**
- ☐ The first spacewalk
- ☐ The first woman in space
- ☐ The first flight across the Atlantic

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The first Moon landing

satellite: an object that circles a planet or a moon in space

engineers: people who design and build machines

mathematician: a person who works with numbers and shapes

decade: a period of ten years



Before computers do the work alone, a person checks the numbers by hand.

FRONT

Event X almost fails before it truly begins.

During the final approach, an onboard computer **overloads** with alarms.

The **commander** looks out and sees large rocks ahead.

He takes control and steers past the rocks by hand.

Only seconds of fuel remain when he sets the small craft down.

Hours later, he climbs down onto the dust.

He calls it "one small step for man, one giant leap for mankind."

A second man joins him for about two and a half hours.

A third man waits alone in the main ship, circling above.

Each time he passes behind the Moon, its body blocks **radio contact**.

Later, all three men fly home in the main ship.

It falls through hot flames and **splashes down** in the ocean.



Through the window, the commander sees rocks where the craft is heading.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The first spacewalk
- ☐ The first human in space
- ☒ **The first Moon landing**
- ☐ The first space station

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The first Moon landing

overloads: takes in more signals or work than it can handle

commander: the person in charge of a crew

radio contact: a spoken link between two places, sent through the air

splashes down: comes down and hits water at the end of a flight



Behind the Moon, no signal can reach the man who circles alone.

FRONT

Event X is the high point of a huge program.

The whole program costs about 25 billion dollars.

That is in the money of that time.

Critics say the money could instead fight **poverty** at home.

At the same time, the country fights a costly war in Asia.

One **poet** writes a bitter poem about the huge cost.

In it, a rat bites his sister while a man walks on the Moon.

Not everyone at home shares the pride many feel that summer.

Even so, five more crews step onto the surface after this one.

Three later crews even drive a small open car on the surface.

Then the program ends after only a few years.

No astronaut has walked on the Moon since 1972.



Some people ask if the money should instead help families at home.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The first satellite in orbit
- ☒ **The first Moon landing**
- ☐ The first expedition to the South Pole
- ☐ The first woman in space

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The first Moon landing

critics: people who say something is wrong or has faults

poverty: the state of being very poor

poet: a person who writes poems



A later crew drives this small car across the grey ground.

FRONT

Scientists still study Event X using hard evidence today.

Six crews together bring home 382 **kilograms** of grey rock.

Labs across the world study these stones for new clues.

Some equipment left on the surface still works after decades.

Small mirrors **reflect laser** light sent from telescopes on Earth.

These signals measure the exact distance between Earth and the Moon.

The **rival** great power also follows each flight closely.

Its scientists track the flights and never call them fake.

Even so, some people later claim the event never happens at all.

Historians study this false claim as a case of modern doubt.

Scholars still debate whether the program is mainly science, politics, or show.



Scientists in labs around the world still study these grey stones today.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The first expedition to the South Pole
- ☐ The first woman in space
- ☐ The first flight across the Atlantic
- ☒ **The first Moon landing**

University

twentieth century

BACK

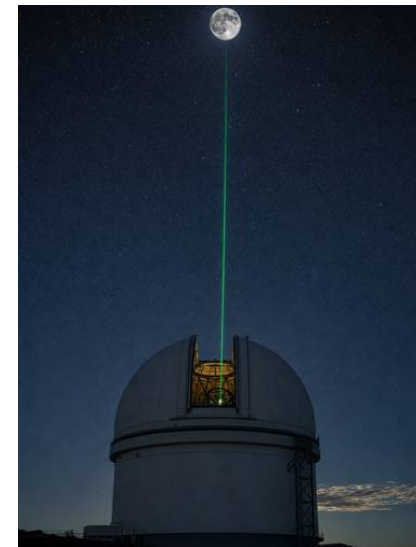
Answer: The first Moon landing

kilograms: a unit used to measure how heavy something is

laser: a strong, narrow beam of light

reflect: to bounce back, the way light bounces off a mirror

rival: a person or group competing against another



A laser beam climbs toward a small mirror left on the surface long ago.

FRONT

Conflict X starts after the biggest war in history ends in 1945.

Two very strong powers come out of that war.

One power stands in the west, one power stands in the east.

Each side builds bombs strong enough to destroy whole cities.

The two powers never openly fight each other.

Instead, each side fears the plans of the other.

A line of fences and **guards** cuts Europe in two.

People call this line an **iron curtain**.

In some schools, children practice a hiding **drill** under their desks.

They fear a bomb might fall from the sky.

This tense **rivalry** lasts for more than forty years.



Some children practice hiding under their desks, just in case.

Which conflict is Conflict X?

- ☐ World War II
- ☒ **The Cold War**
- ☐ The Korean War
- ☐ The Vietnam War

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The Cold War

iron curtain: a name for the guarded line that cuts Europe in two

guard: a person whose job is to stop people from crossing a border

drill: a practice exercise done again and again to prepare for danger

rivalry: a long contest between two sides that both want to be the strongest



A line of fences and towers cuts straight across the land.

FRONT

Conflict X is fought mostly through other countries and other people.

The two **rival** powers rarely send soldiers to fight each other.

In the early 1950s, the western power fights in Korea with its own army.

The eastern power secretly arms the other side.

Later, the western power sends its army into a long war in Vietnam.

The eastern power later sends soldiers into a war in Afghanistan.

Both powers send weapons and money into a **civil war** in Angola.

They also back rival sides in several wars across Central America.

The two powers also race each other into space.

A wall cuts one divided city in Europe in two.

Millions of soldiers and **civilians** die in these wars.



Soldiers and supplies arrive to help one side in another country's war.

Which conflict is Conflict X?

- ☐ The Gulf War
- ☐ The Yugoslav Wars
- ☒ **The Cold War**
- ☐ The Spanish Civil War

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The Cold War

rival: a country or person competing strongly against another

civil war: a war fought between groups inside one country

civilian: a person who is not a soldier



The two powers compete to be first to send rockets into space.

FRONT

In October 1962, Conflict X reaches its most dangerous moment.

Spy planes find **missiles** hidden on an island near the United States.

These missiles could reach many cities within minutes.

For thirteen tense days, the world fears a **nuclear** war.

The two leaders exchange secret letters late at night.

Military officers on both sides prepare for the worst.

At last, the two sides agree on a deal, part of it secret.

One side promises to remove its missiles from the island.

The other side promises not to invade the island.

It also secretly agrees to remove missiles near its rival.

After the crisis, the two leaders set up a direct line for urgent messages.

They hope fast contact can prevent such danger in the future.



Warships stop ships heading toward the island and check their cargo.

Which conflict is Conflict X?

- ☐ The Vietnam War
- ☐ The Yugoslav Wars
- ☐ The Korean War
- ☒ **The Cold War**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The Cold War

missile: a weapon that flies through the air to hit a target far away

nuclear: using the huge power inside atoms, strong enough to destroy whole cities

spy plane: an aircraft that flies high and takes secret photographs of another country



Late at night, the two leaders send each other careful, secret messages.

FRONT

Conflict X shapes lives in Asia, Africa and Latin America too.

Many countries in Asia and Africa become independent around this time.

In 1955, **representatives** from twenty-nine countries meet in a city named Bandung.

Many of them want to stay out of the rivalry between the two powers.

Still, the rivalry reaches into their countries in painful ways.

In Congo, outside powers help remove the country's first elected leader.

Years of crisis and civil conflict follow.

In Chile, a **coup** overthrows an elected leader.

One power helps prepare the coup and welcomes it.

In Indonesia, political violence kills several hundred thousand people.

Dictators in many poorer countries receive support from one side or the other.

Ordinary people bear the heaviest cost of this global rivalry.



Leaders of many new countries meet and look for their own path.

Which conflict is Conflict X?

- ☒ **The Cold War**
- ☐ The Yugoslav Wars
- ☐ The Gulf War
- ☐ The Korean War

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The Cold War

representative: a person sent to speak and act for a country or group

coup: a sudden illegal takeover of a government, often by the army

dictator: a ruler who holds total power and allows little freedom



One night, soldiers take control of a government building by force.

FRONT

Historians disagree about who is most to blame for Conflict X.

One early group of historians blames the eastern power's **ambitions**.

A later group of historians blames the western power's actions instead.

A third group argues that fear and misunderstanding drive both sides.

The rivalry ends gradually between the late 1980s and the early 1990s.

The eastern power lets its allies in Europe hold free elections.

Soon after, the eastern **superpower** breaks apart into fifteen separate countries.

After 1991, **archives** in the east open to researchers.

The new documents force historians to revise some earlier conclusions.

Historians still argue about which explanation fits the evidence best.

Each newly opened archive can quietly change the accepted story.



As the rivalry ends, a crane lifts an old statue off its base.

Which conflict is Conflict X?

- ☐ World War II
- ☐ The Vietnam War
- ☐ The Yugoslav Wars
- ☒ **The Cold War**

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: The Cold War

ambition: a strong wish to gain power, success, or influence

archive: a place where old documents and records are kept

superpower: an extremely powerful country with influence across the world



The two powers begin to take some of their missiles apart.

FRONT

Mr X lives in a city in the southern United States. In 1955, Black passengers must sit at the back of buses.

One day, a woman named Rosa Parks refuses to give up her seat.

Police **arrest** her, and Black leaders plan a **protest**.

They choose Mr X, a young **pastor** of twenty-six, to lead it.

For more than a year, Black **residents** refuse to ride the buses.

They walk long distances or share rides in cars instead.

The bus company loses money every single day.

At last, a court rules that the seating rule is against the law.



In 1955, where a passenger may sit depends on skin color.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Thurgood Marshall
- ☐ Jesse Jackson
- ☒ **Martin Luther King Jr.**
- ☐ John Lewis

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther King Jr.

pastor: a leader of a Christian church

protest: a public action that shows something is wrong

residents: people who live in a place

arrest: when police take a person away and do not let them go free



Many neighbors choose to walk rather than ride the bus.

FRONT

Mr X studies the ideas of a leader in India who fights without weapons.

He believes protest should never turn to violence, even when police attack.

In the southern United States, **activists** sit at **lunch counters** that refuse to serve them.

Police arrest Mr X again and again for these peaceful protests.

In 1963, police put him in **jail** in a city called Birmingham.

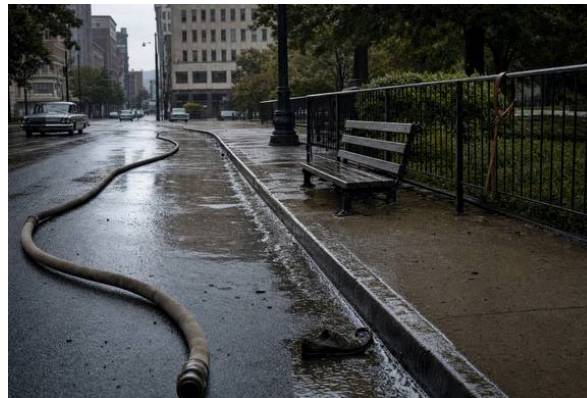
In jail, Mr X writes a long letter.

In it, he explains why people must not wait patiently for freedom.

A few weeks later, children join a big march in the same city.

Police turn dogs and powerful water hoses on the young **marchers**.

Cameras film the attack, and people around the world watch on television.



In 1963, the police use dogs and powerful water hoses against the marchers.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Thurgood Marshall
- ☒ **Martin Luther King Jr.**
- ☐ Medgar Evers
- ☐ Jesse Jackson

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther King Jr.

activists: people who work hard to bring about change

lunch counter: a long table in a shop where people sit to eat a quick meal

marchers: people who walk together to show what they believe

jail: a place where police keep people who are arrested



In a small jail cell, he writes his answer on scraps of paper.

FRONT

In 1963, Mr X helps lead a huge march in the United States.

About two hundred fifty thousand people gather in the **capital** to listen.

He gives a famous speech about his dream for the future.

He dreams that people will judge his children by their **character**, not their skin.

The speech becomes one of the most quoted in the country's history.

The next year, a new law bans **segregation** in public places across the country.

That same year, Mr X receives a great prize for peace.

At thirty-five, he is then the youngest person ever to win it.

The year after, another new law protects the right of Black **citizens** to vote.



In 1963, about a quarter of a million people gather to listen.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ John Lewis
- ☐ W. E. B. Du Bois
- ☐ Medgar Evers
- ☒ **Martin Luther King Jr.**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther King Jr.

capital: the main city of a country, where the government meets

segregation: the unfair separation of people because of skin color

citizens: people who legally belong to a country

character: a person's inner qualities, like honesty and kindness



That same year, a committee in Europe honors him with a great prize for peace.

FRONT

Mr X faces sharp **criticism** from other Black leaders.

A leader named Malcolm X calls his peaceful method too slow.

In his last years, many younger activists say the same.

They want faster change and are ready to use force if needed.

Mr X begins to speak out against the war in Vietnam.

The president and many old allies turn against him because of this stand.

He starts a new **campaign** against **poverty** for poor Americans of every color.

In 1968, he travels to Memphis to support **sanitation** workers who are on strike.

There, on a motel balcony, a gunman shoots him dead.

His death shocks the nation, and riots break out in many cities.



In 1968, sanitation workers in Memphis go on strike for fair pay.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Martin Luther King Jr.**

☐ John Lewis

☐ Thurgood Marshall

☐ Jesse Jackson

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther King Jr.

criticism: comments that say what is wrong with something

campaign: an organized effort to reach a goal

poverty: the state of being very poor

sanitation: the systems that keep a place clean, like trash collection



A few weeks later, in Memphis, his story comes to a sudden end.

FRONT

Historians still debate how much one leader can shape a mass movement.

Mr X leads a movement for equal rights in the United States after 1955.

Some argue thousands of local **organizers** do the daily, quiet work.

Women such as Ella Baker and Jo Ann Robinson plan and organize for years.

Yet public memory often remembers only a handful of famous names.

For years, government agents secretly watch Mr X.

They record his private conversations and try to damage his **reputation**.

Historians study his **sermons**, recordings, and court records to understand him.

Today, textbooks often remember a calm dreamer of peaceful change.

Fewer people remember his later, sharper criticism of poverty and war.

Historians argue that both pictures are true, and both are **incomplete**.



For years, government agents secretly record his private conversations.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Thurgood Marshall
- ☐ John Lewis
- ☒ **Martin Luther King Jr.**
- ☐ W. E. B. Du Bois

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Martin Luther King Jr.

organizers: people who plan and arrange the work of a group

reputation: what other people think and say about a person

sermons: religious speeches given in a church

incomplete: not whole, missing some parts



His sermons, spoken from a pulpit like this, become a key historical source.

FRONT

Mr X grows up in a small village in South Africa.

As a boy, he **herds cattle** on green hills.

On his first day of school, a teacher gives him a new name.

Later, his family **arranges a marriage** for him.

Mr X does not want this marriage, so he runs away.

He travels far to a big city and begins to study law.

New laws now say where people may sit, eat, and travel.

These laws depend only on the color of a person's skin.

Mr X decides that these laws are not fair.

Many years later, he becomes his country's first Black president.



In the hills of his home region, a boy learns to herd cattle.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Steve Biko
- ☒ **Nelson Mandela**
- ☐ Desmond Tutu
- ☐ Oliver Tambo

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Nelson Mandela

herd: to move a group of animals together

cattle: cows and bulls kept by farmers

arrange: to plan something before it happens

marriage: when two people become husband and wife



Even a park bench like this one is only for some people.

FRONT

Mr X works as a lawyer in Johannesburg.

In 1964, he stands **trial** for actions against an unfair government.

In court, he speaks of his **ideal** of a free society.

He says he is ready to die for this ideal.

The judge sends him to prison for the rest of his life.

Guards take him to an island near Cape Town for eighteen years.

For thirteen years, he breaks stone in a hot limestone **quarry**.

Dust and sunlight from the quarry harm his eyes.

He may write and receive only a few **censored** letters.

Later, guards let him grow a small garden in the yard.

In total, Mr X spends twenty-seven years behind bars.

Outside, more and more people around the world sing songs about him.



In a quiet courtroom, Mr X answers for the fight he has chosen.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Walter Sisulu
- ☐ Julius Nyerere
- ☒ **Nelson Mandela**
- ☐ F. W. de Klerk

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Nelson Mandela

trial: when a court decides if a person did something wrong

quarry: a place where workers cut or break stone from the ground

censored: checked and partly blocked by an authority before it is allowed

ideal: an idea of how something should be, at its best



Far from the courtroom, he spends years breaking stone in the sun.

FRONT

For years, Mr X and his movement in South Africa protest without weapons.

In 1960, police open fire on an **unarmed** crowd, killing sixty-nine people.

After this **massacre**, Mr X changes his mind about peaceful protest alone.

He believes peaceful methods now meet only violence in return.

With others, he starts a small armed group for **sabotage**.

Later, he explains that it attacks power lines and empty buildings, not people.

Police arrest him, and at his trial he defends this choice himself.

He calls it a hard decision, taken only when other paths close.

While he is in prison, his **colleague** Oliver Tambo leads the movement from abroad.

In the 1980s, parts of the movement also turn to violence against people.

In the end, Mr X chooses talks over more fighting.



A silent crowd gathers, and the mood turns tense and fearful.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Desmond Tutu
- ☐ Walter Sisulu
- ☐ Kwame Nkrumah
- ☒ **Nelson Mandela**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Nelson Mandela

massacre: the killing of many people who cannot fight back

unarmed: carrying no weapons

sabotage: damaging machines or buildings on purpose to stop an enemy

colleague: a person who works with you for the same cause



The new campaign aims at towers like this one, not at people, he says.

FRONT

In 1990, guards in South Africa finally open the prison gate for Mr X.

He walks out hand in hand with his wife.

Mr X then holds long talks with the white president, F. W. de Klerk.

During these years, political violence in the country kills thousands of people.

At last, all sides agree that every adult may now vote.

Four years after his release, people of every color vote in a first free election.

Many wait for hours in long, patient lines to vote.

At seventy-five years old, Mr X becomes the country's new president.

Later, a **commission** lets **victims** and those who hurt them both speak.

Desmond Tutu leads this Truth and **Reconciliation** Commission.

After only one **term** as president, Mr X steps down from power.



For the first time, people of every skin color may vote, and many wait for hours in line.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Nelson Mandela**

☐ Walter Sisulu

☐ Oliver Tambo

☐ Julius Nyerere

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Nelson Mandela

commission: a group of people given an official job to do

reconciliation: becoming friendly again after a conflict

victims: people who are hurt or harmed by others

term: a fixed length of time in an official job



A gate opens, and two figures walk out together into a waiting crowd.

FRONT

Historians still debate how to judge Mr X, a leader in South Africa.

Some call him a hero who ends a brutal system peacefully.

Others say he **compromises** too much, and **inequality** remains after 1994.

The gap between rich and poor in his country stays wide for decades.

Historians also ask how much credit belongs to one man alone.

A whole movement of thousands works and suffers for the same cause.

Mr X writes a long **autobiography** with help, a rich but personal source.

Historians note what the book leaves out, as well as what it tells.

Prison guards and officials also keep careful written records of his prison years.

These **archives** let researchers check and sometimes correct his own account.

His country once jails him as a terrorist.

Later, it calls him a father of the nation.



Historians can still visit the small cell where he spends many years.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Steve Biko
- ☒ **Nelson Mandela**
- ☐ Kwame Nkrumah
- ☐ Julius Nyerere

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: Nelson Mandela

compromise: giving up part of what you want, to reach agreement

inequality: when wealth or chances are not shared fairly

autobiography: a book a person writes about their own life

archives: collections of old documents kept for the future



An empty chair of power waits for a man once called a terrorist.

FRONT

Mr X is a scientist who lives in France, about 150 years ago.

He studies tiny living things that people cannot see.

These tiny living things can make milk and wine turn **sour**.

They can also make cuts and **wounds** turn bad.

Mr X finds a way to heat wine and beer very gently.

The gentle heat kills the tiny living things inside.

After that, the wine and beer stay good for much longer.

Later, other people use his idea for milk.

In 1885, a dog with **rabies** bites a boy named Joseph Meister.

Two doctors say the boy will die without help.

Mr X makes a new treatment in his **laboratory**.

A doctor gives the boy the treatment while Mr X watches, and the boy lives.



Mr X shows that gentle heat kills the tiny living things in wine.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Edward Jenner
- ☒ **Louis Pasteur**
- ☐ Alexander Fleming
- ☐ Ignaz Semmelweis

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Louis Pasteur

sour: tasting sharp and bad, like old milk

wound: a cut or hurt place on the body

rabies: a dangerous disease that a sick animal can give with a bite

laboratory: a room where a scientist does tests and experiments



In 1885, Mr X helps a boy who is bitten by a dog like this one.

FRONT

Mr X works in a laboratory in France, about 160 years ago.

Many people believe that life can appear from nothing inside old soup.

Mr X boils **broth** inside a glass flask with a long, bent neck.

Air can enter the flask, but dust and germs cannot pass the bend.

The broth stays clear for months, so life does not appear by itself.

This experiment shows that germs always come from other germs.

Later, Mr X helps save the French silk industry from a **silkworm** disease.

He shows which tiny living things make the silkworms sick.

Farmers learn to keep only healthy silkworm eggs.

He then makes a **vaccine** from **weakened** germs.

In 1881, he tests it on sheep in front of a large crowd.

The treated sheep stay healthy, and the idea spreads across the world.



Inside this bent glass neck, Mr X proves where tiny living things really come from.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Robert Koch
- ☐ Joseph Lister
- ☒ **Louis Pasteur**
- ☐ Charles Darwin

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Louis Pasteur

broth: a thin, watery liquid made by boiling something, like a simple soup

silkworm: a small caterpillar that makes silk thread

vaccine: a weak form of a germ given to protect the body against the strong form

weakened: made less strong than before



In 1881, Mr X tests his vaccine on sheep like these, in front of a watching crowd.

FRONT

In France, about 150 years ago, many doctors do not believe that germs cause disease.

Some doctors still think that bad smells and bad air alone make people sick.

Mr X strongly disagrees, and he calls this old idea wrong and dangerous.

He argues that germs too small to see cause **infection** in wounds and blood.

Many respected doctors mock this idea, and Mr X faces years of **criticism**.

A famous story says that in 1879 an assistant leaves the laboratory to go on holiday.

He forgets to inject hens with a fresh **culture** of chicken cholera germs.

When he returns, he uses the old, weak sample instead.

The hens get slightly sick but **recover**, and they survive a later infection too.

Mr X understands that a weakened germ can train the body to fight disease.

This discovery slowly changes how doctors around the world think about illness.



Mr X looks for tiny living things that many doctors do not believe in.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Joseph Lister
- ☐ Robert Koch
- ☐ Ignaz Semmelweis
- ☒ **Louis Pasteur**

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Louis Pasteur

infection: illness caused by germs getting into the body

criticism: when people say something is wrong or bad

culture: a group of tiny living things grown together in a laboratory

recover: to get well again after being sick



A story says a forgotten sample of hen disease germs leads Mr X to a new idea.

FRONT

Mr X is a French chemist, not a **licensed** doctor. He studies the tiny living things that cause disease. In 1885, his treatment saves a boy bitten by a dog with rabies.

Newspapers around the world report the **extraordinary** news.

People from many countries send money to thank him.

With this money, a new research center opens in Paris in 1888.

Scientists there study disease and treat rabies patients who travel from far away.

Mr X already knows deep personal loss.

Three of his daughters die as children, two of them of **typhoid**.

Years earlier, a **stroke** leaves one side of his body weak.

Even so, he keeps directing his research with the help of loyal assistants.

After his death, these assistants carry on his work at the center.



After a stroke, Mr X still directs his loyal assistants at the bench.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Edward Jenner
- ☐ Robert Koch
- ☒ **Louis Pasteur**
- ☐ Alexander Fleming

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Louis Pasteur

licensed: officially allowed to do a job, like being a doctor

extraordinary: very unusual or amazing

typhoid: a serious disease spread by dirty water and food

stroke: a sudden illness in the brain that can leave part of the body weak



Patients travel from far away to the new research center in Paris.

FRONT

Mr X keeps detailed laboratory notebooks throughout his working life.

He tells his family that nobody may ever read them.

Decades later, in the 1970s, a historian finally studies these private notebooks.

The notebooks reveal that his public reports sometimes hide the messy, real story.

In one famous case, his published method differs from what he actually used.

Historians still debate how much this changes his **reputation** as a careful scientist.

They also ask if it was **ethical** to treat a boy for rabies in 1885 before the animal tests were finished.

In the 1880s, a **rival** scientist in Berlin, Robert Koch, studies the germs behind **tuberculosis**.

Robert Koch and Mr X compete fiercely, partly because their countries are rivals too.

This competition between French and German science pushes both men to work faster.

As germ theory becomes accepted, more hospitals begin washing hands and cleaning instruments carefully.

Death rates from infection in hospitals and disease in growing cities begin to fall.



Decades after his death, a historian finally opens Mr X's private notebooks.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Edward Jenner
- ☒ **Louis Pasteur**
- ☐ Alexander Fleming
- ☐ Charles Darwin

University

science

BACK

Answer: Louis Pasteur

reputation: what other people think and say about someone

ethical: right and fair according to moral rules

rival: someone who competes strongly against another person

tuberculosis: a serious lung disease caused by germs



As germ theory wins, hospitals begin to clean their instruments with care.

FRONT

Mr X is a boy in England, about a hundred years ago.

He loves numbers and hard **puzzles**.

He also loves running very long distances alone.

He is not the best student in other subjects.

Later, he studies at a famous old university in England.

As a young man, he dreams of a machine that follows a list of steps.

Such a machine could solve almost any puzzle.

Then a great war starts in Europe.

Mr X moves to a secret place with wooden **huts**.

Many clever men and women work there in secret.

They try to break a very hard **enemy code**.

Mr X and his friends find a way to read the enemy's secret messages.



Mr X often runs long distances alone, even in cold weather.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Charles Babbage
- ☒ **Alan Turing**
- ☐ Ada Lovelace
- ☐ Konrad Zuse

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Alan Turing

hut: a small simple building, often made of wood

code: a secret way of writing so only some people can read it

puzzle: a problem that is fun and hard to solve

enemy: a country or person you are fighting against in a war



Later, Mr X works in simple wooden huts like these, in secret.

FRONT

Mr X studies **mathematics** at Cambridge, in England.

In 1939, a great war begins in Europe.

Mr X moves to Bletchley Park, a secret country **estate**.

There, teams try to break Enigma, a German machine that makes secret codes.

Polish mathematicians break the machine's secrets first, before the war.

Building on their work, Mr X helps design a large machine called the bombe.

Every day, it tests thousands of possible code **settings**.

Reading the German messages helps **convoys** of ships cross the Atlantic safely.

Thousands of people work at Bletchley Park, and most of them are women.

They must never tell anyone what they do there.

The secret is kept for about thirty years after the war.



A new machine searches through thousands of possible code settings.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Alan Turing**

☐ John von Neumann

☐ Claude Shannon

☐ Grace Hopper

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Alan Turing

mathematics: the study of numbers, shapes and patterns

estate: a large piece of land with a big house on it

setting: one specific way that a machine's parts are arranged

convoy: a group of ships that travel together for safety



Convoys of ships cross the ocean together, for safety.

FRONT

In 1936, a young Cambridge mathematician named Mr X publishes an unusual paper.

He imagines a simple machine that reads and writes **symbols** on a paper **tape**.

One such machine, built the right way, can copy the work of any other.

Soon after, he spends two years studying in Princeton, in the United States.

In 1948, he moves to Manchester and writes **programs** for one of the first real computers.

In 1950, he publishes a paper asking a simple question: can machines think?

He describes a game: a **judge** asks written questions to two hidden players.

One player is a person, the other is a computer program.

If the judge often cannot tell which is which, he says, the machine has passed the test.

In 1952, a law of that time punishes him for loving another man.

The government says sorry in 2009, and he is pardoned in 2013.



On paper, Mr X imagines a simple machine that could compute anything.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Charles Babbage
- ☐ Konrad Zuse
- ☒ **Alan Turing**
- ☐ John von Neumann

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Alan Turing

symbol: a written mark that stands for a letter, a number or a sound

tape: a long thin strip, here used to store information

judge: a person who decides who is right, or who wins a game

program: a list of steps that tells a computer what to do



A judge asks questions and tries to guess who answers, person or machine.

FRONT

Mr X is a British mathematician who does secret work during a world war.

When the war ends in 1945, he still cannot tell anyone what he has done.

He joins a national **laboratory** near London and **designs** a computer of his own.

The machine is built later, smaller than he planned, and a company sells copies of it.

He also writes one of the first **chess** programs, by hand on paper.

No computer of the time can run it, so he plays the moves himself.

Outside work, he runs **marathons** and is among the fastest marathon runners in Britain.

In 1952, a law of that time punishes him for loving another man.

He dies in 1954.

The government says sorry in 2009, and he is pardoned in 2013.



Mr X writes a chess program on paper and plays its moves by hand.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Claude Shannon
- ☐ Konrad Zuse
- ☐ Grace Hopper
- ☒ **Alan Turing**

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Alan Turing

laboratory: a place where scientists do tests and build new things

designs: makes a plan for how to build something

chess: a board game for two players with kings, queens and knights

marathon: a running race of about forty-two kilometers



Glowing glass valves like these do the counting inside the first computers.

FRONT

Historians today call Mr X one of the **founders** of computer science.

In 1936, he proves that some problems can never be solved by any machine.

Real computers, built about ten years later, follow the basic idea of his paper.

His **codebreaking** role in a world war is barely known until the 1970s.

Only then can historians begin to judge his part in that war.

The question and the game he describes in 1950 still shape how we test machines today.

Late in life, he studies why spots and stripes form on animal skin.

In 1952, a law of that time punishes him for loving another man.

He dies in 1954, and the **inquest** calls it suicide.

The government says sorry in 2009, and he is pardoned in 2013.

Today, the highest prize in computer science carries his name.



Late in life, Mr X studies why patterns like this form in nature.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ John von Neumann
- ☒ **Alan Turing**
- ☐ Claude Shannon
- ☐ Charles Babbage

University

science

BACK

Answer: Alan Turing

founder: a person who starts something important, like a new field of study

codebreaking: finding out how to read secret messages

inquest: an official inquiry to find out how a person died



His war work stays locked away until the 1970s.

FRONT

Miss X grows up in a rich family in England, about 200 years ago.

She has a big house, **servants**, and a comfortable life.

Most rich girls of her time do not choose a job at all.

One day, she says she hears a **call** from God.

She believes God wants her to help sick and hurt people.

Her family is not happy about her plan.

They want her to marry and stay quietly at home instead.

She **trains** as a nurse anyway, far from home.

Later, her country goes to war in a land far away.

She travels there with a small team of nurses.

At night, she walks through the hospital with a small **lamp**.



A rich family's daughter dreams of a very different life.

Who is Miss X?

- ☐ Mary Seacole
- ☒ **Florence Nightingale**
- ☐ Elizabeth Blackwell
- ☐ Clara Barton

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Florence Nightingale

servants: people who are paid to work and help in a rich home

call: here, a strong feeling that God wants you to do something

train: to learn the skills you need for a job

lamp: a small light that burns oil or holds a candle



A small lamp lights the dark for those who work at night.

FRONT

Miss X is a nurse in England in 1854.

Her country fights a war far away, called the Crimean War.

Newspapers report that **wounded** soldiers get very poor care.

Miss X leads a team of thirty-eight nurses to help.

They travel to a huge army hospital at Scutari, near Constantinople.

The building is dirty, cold, and full of rats.

Clean water and clean **bandages** are hard to find.

More soldiers die from **disease** than from their wounds.

Miss X works hard to make the **wards** cleaner and calmer.

She buys food and clean shirts for the soldiers with money from newspaper readers at home.

The next year, a special team cleans the hospital's **sewers**, and far fewer soldiers die.

When she goes home, the whole country calls her a hero.



A huge hospital far from home fills with sick and wounded soldiers.

Who is Miss X?

- ☐ Clara Barton
- ☐ Mary Seacole
- ☒ **Florence Nightingale**
- ☐ Dorothea Dix

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Florence Nightingale

wounded: hurt badly in a fight or accident

bandages: strips of cloth used to cover a wound

disease: an illness, often caused by germs, not an injury

ward: a large room in a hospital with many beds

sewer: an underground pipe that carries away dirty water and waste



A ward is a large room in a hospital with many beds.

FRONT

Miss X is a nurse who comes home from a war far away.

After the war, she studies numbers, not battles.

She collects careful facts about every soldier who dies in hospital.

Most deaths come from disease, not from enemy weapons.

She draws colorful **diagrams** to show this clearly. Army **officials** and politicians find the diagrams easy to read.

The diagrams help push for cleaner hospitals and cleaner army camps.

In 1858, a scientific society **elects** her as its first woman member.

That society studies numbers and facts about people and countries, called **statistics**.

Miss X argues that careful facts, not luck, save lives.

Her careful work slowly changes how governments plan health care.



Careful facts convince officials to change how hospitals are run.

Who is Miss X?

- ☐ Ada Lovelace
- ☒ **Florence Nightingale**
- ☐ Elizabeth Blackwell
- ☐ Marie Curie

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Florence Nightingale

diagrams: pictures that use shapes or lines to show facts clearly

officials: people who have an important job in the army or government

elects: chooses someone for a role by voting

statistics: the study of facts and numbers about many people or things



Diagrams use shapes and lines, not battles, to make a point.

FRONT

Miss X is born in an Italian city, and her family names her after it.

She grows up rich in England but later becomes sick from her time at war.

For the rest of her life, weak health often keeps her in bed.

Yet she keeps working hard from her bedroom for many years.

She writes a famous book about good nursing care.

Soon after, she opens a school for nurses in London.

The school trains women to nurse with clean, careful **methods**.

Officials in India ask for her **advice** about clean water and clean camps.

She never travels to India herself, but she studies its **reports** closely.

In 1907, a king gives her a high **honor**, the first time for a woman.



Even from her bed, Miss X keeps working for many years.

Who is Miss X?

- ☐ Marie Curie
- ☐ Edith Cavell
- ☐ Elizabeth Garrett Anderson
- ☒ **Florence Nightingale**

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Florence Nightingale

advice: ideas about what someone should do

honor: a special way of showing great respect

method: a careful, planned way of doing something

reports: written accounts that describe facts or events



Clean water and clean hands are part of the careful methods her school teaches.

FRONT

Miss X believes dirty air, not tiny living **germs**, causes most disease.

Later scientists show that germs are the true cause of **infection**.

Still, her hunt for clean air pushes hospitals to become cleaner anyway.

In 1855, during the Crimean War, deaths at her army hospital fall sharply after a team cleans its sewers.

Years later, Miss X studies this result closely and draws a clear lesson from it.

Popular stories later remember her mostly for her kindness at night.

Historians remind us she is also a tough, careful **statistician**.

Mary Seacole, a nurse from Jamaica, also wants to help in that war.

She asks to join the nurses sent out, but the officials say no.

So Mary Seacole cares for soldiers her own way instead.

Today, both women are honored as **pioneers** of modern nursing.



A team fixes the broken sewers, and the death rate falls sharply.

Who is Miss X?

☒ **Florence Nightingale**

☐ Elizabeth Blackwell

☐ Clara Barton

☐ Marie Curie

University

science

BACK

Answer: Florence Nightingale

germs: tiny living things, too small to see, that can cause disease

infection: illness caused by germs getting into the body

statistician: a person who studies facts and numbers carefully

pioneers: people who are among the first to try or achieve something new



Two nurses, two kits, two ways of caring for soldiers in the same war.

FRONT

Mr X is born in a small **village** in England.
His father dies just before he is born.
He grows up on the family farm.
Later, he studies at a **university**.
A serious **sickness** closes the university for a time.
Mr X goes home to the farm.
He stays there for more than a year.
He thinks and thinks about the world around him.
Later in life, he tells a story about an apple.
He says he watches an apple fall from a tree.
He asks himself what **pulls** the apple down to the ground.
He wonders if the same pull holds the moon in the sky.



A quiet afternoon in an orchard, long ago in England.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Isaac Newton**

☐ Galileo Galilei

☐ Charles Darwin

☐ Robert Hooke

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Isaac Newton

village: a small place where people live, smaller than a town

university: a school where adults study after ordinary school

sickness: an illness, a disease

pull: a force that draws something toward it



The sickness closes shops and empties the streets.

FRONT

Mr X studies at a university in England.

A deadly **plague** closes it for a time, and he goes home.

He lets sunlight pass through a glass **prism**.

White light spreads into all the colors of a rainbow.

So white light is a mix of all colors, he says.

A glass **lens** splits light in the same way, so old telescopes blur the picture.

In 1668, he builds a telescope with a curved **mirror** instead.

The picture is sharper, and the tube is much shorter.

He becomes a professor at only 26.

Scholars in London are amazed by his small telescope.

He also writes down three simple laws about how things move.

One law says a moving thing keeps moving unless something stops it.



With his own hands, Mr X builds a new kind of telescope.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Isaac Newton**

☐ Galileo Galilei

☐ Robert Hooke

☐ Edmond Halley

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Isaac Newton

plague: a dangerous disease that spreads quickly and kills many people

prism: a piece of glass with flat sides that splits light into colors

lens: a curved piece of glass that bends light

mirror: a smooth surface that reflects light and shows a picture



Sunlight through a prism becomes a small rainbow of colors.

FRONT

Mr X becomes a famous **scholar** in England.

In a letter to a **rival**, he writes a line that sounds humble.

He says he sees far only by standing on the shoulders of giants.

In 1687, he publishes his greatest book.

The book gives exact laws for how forces move all things.

It also describes one single force called **gravitation**.

Every object pulls every other object, he says, and heavy objects pull hardest.

The force that makes a stone fall also holds the moon in its path.

The moon's pull lifts the seas and makes the **tides**.

The same force keeps every planet moving around the sun.

Before this book, earth and sky seem to follow different rules.

After it, one set of laws explains both.



One force holds the moon in the sky and pulls every stone to the ground.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Galileo Galilei
- ☒ **Isaac Newton**
- ☐ Johannes Kepler
- ☐ Gottfried Leibniz

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Isaac Newton

scholar: a person who studies and knows a lot about a subject

rival: a person who competes against you or disagrees with you

gravitation: the pulling force between the earth, the moon, and all other things

tide: the rise and fall of the sea, twice each day



The moon's pull lifts the seas and makes the tides.

FRONT

Mr X invents a powerful new kind of mathematics.

Some years later, a **mathematician** in Paris invents very similar ideas.

His name is Gottfried Leibniz, and he works alone too.

For years, the two men argue about who was first.

Followers on both sides write angry letters.

The bitter argument lasts until both men are dead.

Later in life, Mr X takes a high post at the royal money house.

There, he hunts down men who make **fake** coins.

He studies court records and questions **witnesses** himself.

Few people know that he also spends years on secret experiments.

In a hot **furnace**, he tries to turn cheap metals into gold.

He also fills many private pages with his own ideas about the Bible.



Later in life, Mr X hunts down men who make fake coins.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Johannes Kepler
- ☒ **Isaac Newton**
- ☐ Robert Hooke
- ☐ Edmond Halley

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Isaac Newton

mathematician: a person who is an expert in numbers and mathematics

witness: a person who sees something happen and can tell others about it

fake: not real, made to look like something it is not

furnace: a closed fire built to make things very hot



In secret, he heats metals in a furnace and hopes to make gold.

FRONT

Mr X becomes one of the most famous scientists in history.

But **historians** remind us he does not work alone in an empty room.

Earlier thinkers already study falling objects and moving planets.

A rival scientist already guesses that a pulling force weakens with **distance**.

Mr X takes such scattered clues and proves them with exact mathematics.

He writes far more pages about old chemistry and about the Bible than about motion.

Colleagues describe him as brilliant but also difficult and **secretive**.

He rarely admits his own mistakes, and he almost never forgives a rival.

More than two hundred years later, new science changes some of his rules.

Even so, his basic laws still guide bridges, rockets, and machines today.



Mr X sees further only because others study the sky before him.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Robert Hooke
- ☒ **Isaac Newton**
- ☐ Christiaan Huygens
- ☐ Gottfried Leibniz

University

science

BACK

Answer: Isaac Newton

historian: a person who studies and writes about the past

distance: how far away one thing is from another

colleague: a person you work with

secretive: keeping many things hidden or private



His laws still guide the builders of bridges and machines today.

FRONT

Mr X is a small boy in Germany, more than 140 years ago.

His family says he is slow to start talking.

One day his father shows him a small **compass**.

The needle always points the same way, and this **amazes** him.

He wants to know why, and he never stops asking why.

He also loves to play the **violin**.

As a young man, he cannot find a steady job as a teacher.

He takes a job in an office in Switzerland instead.

His job is to check other people's new **inventions**.

In his free time, he thinks about light and time.

Years later, his strange ideas are tested, and he becomes famous all over the world.



Mr X checks other people's new inventions all day long.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Albert Einstein**

☐ Isaac Newton

☐ Michael Faraday

☐ Niels Bohr

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Albert Einstein

compass: a small tool with a needle that always points north

violin: a small wooden music instrument with strings, played with a bow

invention: a new thing that a person makes for the first time

amaze: to surprise someone very much



A small compass like this one fills Mr X with wonder.

FRONT

Mr X works in a quiet office, more than 100 years ago.

In one single year, he writes four amazing papers. One paper says light can act like tiny **particles**, not only waves.

Another paper explains why tiny bits of **matter** dance in water under a **microscope**.

A third paper gives strange new rules for space and time.

A fourth paper says mass and huge energy are really the same thing.

Only a few scientists notice these papers at first.

Many years later, he wins a great science prize.

The prize is for the paper about light as particles.

It is not for his idea called relativity, which is even more famous.

In 1933, a new **dictator** takes power in his home country.

Mr X leaves for good and sails to safety in the United States.



In 1933, Mr X leaves his home country and never returns.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Max Planck
- ☒ **Albert Einstein**
- ☐ Ernest Rutherford
- ☐ Lise Meitner

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Albert Einstein

particle: a very, very small piece of something

matter: anything that takes up space, like water, wood, or air

microscope: a tool with lenses that makes very small things look big

dictator: a ruler who has all the power and lets nobody disagree



Only under a microscope can you see tiny bits of matter dance in water.

FRONT

Mr X works out a strange new idea about space and time.

Others soon call the idea **relativity**.

Nothing can travel faster than the speed of light, he says.

Time itself can run slower or faster, depending on speed.

Ten years later, he finishes an even bigger version of the idea.

This time, it is about **gravity**.

Gravity is not a pull, he says, but a **bending** of space itself.

Heavy stars and planets bend the space and time around them.

If he is right, starlight should bend when it passes close to the sun.

In 1919, a total **eclipse** hides the sun's light for a few minutes.

Scientists photograph stars near the darkened sun and measure the bending.

The result supports his idea, and he becomes famous all over the world.

Picture in production

Picture brief: On a tropical hillside in 1919, a small team of European scientists in white linen tropical suits and pith helmets of that era set up a large brass telescope and a wooden photographic camera on wooden tripods, pointed at the sky, while two local assistants with brown skin in light cotton working clothes and straw hats help carry wooden crates at the same distance, palm trees around them, bright daylight, all seen ...

In 1919, scientists travel far to test his strange new idea.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Arthur Eddington
- ☐ Max Planck
- ☒ **Albert Einstein**
- ☐ James Clerk Maxwell

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Albert Einstein

gravity: the force that pulls things toward each other, like the earth pulling you down

relativity: a scientific idea that connects space, time, and motion

eclipse: when the moon covers the sun and the sky goes dark for a while

bend: to curve, so something is no longer straight

Picture in production

Picture brief: A total solar eclipse as seen on an old photographic plate: a round black disk with a large streaky glowing white corona around its edge, and a few tiny white points of starlight scattered around it against the black sky. The picture shows what the expedition photographs during the eclipse.

During the eclipse, the hidden sun lets scientists see stars nearby.

FRONT

In 1933, a dictator takes power in Germany.

Mr X leaves, and by the late 1930s he lives safely in the United States.

He hears that scientists in Europe can now split the tiny core of an **atom**.

Splitting this core can release a huge burst of energy.

Other scientists worry that the dictator's country could build a powerful **weapon**.

Just before a great war begins in Europe, Mr X signs a letter to the American president.

The letter warns that such a weapon is now possible.

He never works on the weapon project himself.

Years later, the weapon is used, and he feels deep **regret**.

For the rest of his life, he speaks and writes for peace between nations.

Late in his life, Israel offers him its highest office.

He kindly **refuses**, saying he understands ideas better than people.

Picture in production

Picture brief: On a plain wooden desk in a 1930s American university office, a sealed cream envelope lies face down beside a black fountain pen and a closed brown leather folder, a green-shaded desk lamp giving warm light, tall wooden bookshelves softly blurred in the background. No visible address or writing on the envelope, no people.

In 1939, Mr X signs a serious warning to the president.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Leo Szilard
- ☐ Otto Hahn
- ☒ **Albert Einstein**
- ☐ Max Planck

Grade 12 science

BACK

Answer: Albert Einstein

atom: one of the very small pieces that everything is made of

weapon: a tool made to hurt or destroy

regret: a sad feeling about something you wish had not happened

refuse: to say no to an offer

Picture in production

Picture brief: A single leafy olive branch rests on a worn stone windowsill, an old ivy-covered 1930s university building softly blurred beyond the window glass, gentle afternoon light. The picture shows his later work for peace.

For the rest of his life, he works and speaks for peace.

FRONT

By the 1920s, Mr X has changed how scientists think about space, time, and gravity.

His ideas go beyond the laws of motion that rule science for two hundred years.

In the same decade, a new and stranger science takes full shape: **quantum theory**.

This theory says that, deep down, nature may only offer chances, never **certainty**.

Mr X helps start this new science, but he never accepts its full picture.

He famously argues that nature cannot simply leave things to pure chance.

Most physicists disagree with him, and quantum theory keeps succeeding.

In 1939, worried colleagues persuade him to sign a **fateful** letter.

Historians still debate how much responsibility one signature really carries.

His face becomes one of the most printed and copied images in history.

Yet the real man is often anxious, uncertain, and privately self-critical.

The famous **icon** and the real man are not quite the same person.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A crowd of 1920s press photographers in dark wool coats and felt hats, seen entirely from behind, hold up boxy wooden and metal press cameras and flash lamps toward the closed tall doors of a grand stone building, grey daylight. No faces visible. The picture suggests how the cameras follow him everywhere without showing any actual face.

Wherever he goes, the cameras wait for him.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Niels Bohr
- ☐ Isaac Newton
- ☒ **Albert Einstein**
- ☐ Ernest Rutherford

University

science

BACK

Answer: Albert Einstein

quantum theory: a science of very small things, like atoms, that often works by chance

certainty: being completely sure that something is true

fateful: having very important and serious results later

icon: a person or image that stands for something famous and important

Picture in production

Picture brief: A lone elderly man in a loose 1950s wool cardigan and soft grey trousers, wearing a plain dark wool hat that hides his hair, walks slowly away along a quiet snowy path on an American university campus, seen from a distance and from behind, bare trees on both sides, old brick and stone buildings softly blurred beyond, his face never visible. The picture shows the quiet private man behind the famous image.

Behind the famous image is a quiet, private man.

FRONT

Mrs X is a girl in Warsaw, more than 150 years ago.
A foreign **empire** rules her country at this time.
Girls cannot study at the university there.
So young women study in secret, in a different room each time.
For about five years, Mrs X works as a **governess**.
She saves money to help her sister study first.
At last, she travels to Paris herself.
She studies late into the night, often hungry and cold.
Later, she works in a cold wooden shed.
Inside, a strange new **substance glows** softly in the dark.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A small dark wooden shed at night in 1890s Paris, plain glass jars, flasks and beakers on a rough wooden table inside, one jar giving off a faint bluish green glow in the dark, seen through a half-open door from outside. No people visible.

In a cold wooden shed, something strange begins to glow.

Who is Mrs X?

- ☒ **Marie Curie**
- ☐ Rosalind Franklin
- ☐ Emmy Noether
- ☐ Ada Lovelace

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Marie Curie

empire: a large group of countries or lands ruled by one power

governess: a woman paid to teach children at home

substance: a material, the stuff that a thing is made of

glow: to give off a soft, gentle light

Picture in production

Picture brief: A young woman in a modest dark 1880s dress sits with two small children at a table in a plain sitting room, a closed book and a wooden bead abacus between them, soft daylight from a window, seen from the side at a small distance.

For about five years, Mrs X earns money teaching other people's children.

FRONT

Mrs X now works as a scientist in Paris.

She studies strange rays coming from a heavy dark **ore**.

With her husband, she searches for their true source.

Within one year, they find two new **elements**.

They name one polonium, after her home country, and one radium.

It then takes years of hard work to make a tiny amount of pure radium.

In 1903, Mrs X wins the Nobel Prize.

She is the first woman ever to win it.

Three years later, her husband dies in a street accident.

She keeps working alone, deep in **grief**.

The Sorbonne then gives her his old **post**.

She becomes its very first woman professor.

Picture in production

Picture brief: The wide stone steps and inner courtyard of a large university in Paris in the early 1900s, male students in dark coats and hats and a few women in long skirts on the steps, one woman in a plain dark dress and hat seen from behind walking up the steps alone, overcast sky.

The university in Paris gives Mrs X a great honor.

Who is Mrs X?

- ☐ Lise Meitner
- ☒ **Marie Curie**
- ☐ Chien-Shiung Wu
- ☐ Elizabeth Blackwell

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Marie Curie

ore: rock that contains a useful metal or material

element: one of the basic simple substances that make up everything

grief: the deep sad feeling after someone dies

post: a job or official position

Picture in production

Picture brief: A rough chunk of dark, almost black mineral ore rests on an old wooden laboratory table, faint mineral dust around it, a simple brass balance scale nearby, dim natural light from a window.

Inside this heavy dark rock hide two elements nobody has named yet.

FRONT

Mrs X already holds the Nobel Prize from years earlier.

Her husband has died, but she keeps working alone.

In 1911, she wins the Nobel Prize a second time, for her own **research**.

She becomes the first person in history to win two.

By now, she works daily with strong glowing **substances**.

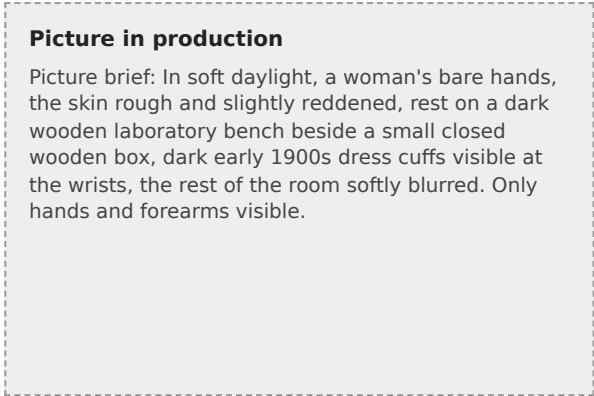
People say she carries small glowing tubes around in her pocket.

She loves the soft light they give at night.

Few yet understand how much the **invisible** rays can hurt the body over many years.

Slowly, her hands grow rough, and her eyes grow weak.

Years of **exposure** quietly damage her health.



Years near the strange rays slowly hurt her hands.

Who is Mrs X?

- ☐ Elizabeth Blackwell
- ☐ Grace Hopper
- ☒ Marie Curie
- ☐ Mary Seacole

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Marie Curie

research: careful study to find out new things

substance: a material, the stuff that a thing is made of

invisible: impossible to see

exposure: being close to something, again and again, over time



A second great prize makes her the first person ever to win two.

FRONT

The great war of 1914 begins in Europe.

Wounded soldiers arrive at hospitals every single day.

Mrs X has an idea to help doctors see broken bones fast.

She puts simple X-ray machines inside ordinary cars.

She trains young women to drive and use the machines near the **front**.

Her own teenage daughter works beside her as a helper.

The X-ray service they build examines more than a million **wounded** men.

After the war, Mrs X returns to her quiet laboratory.

She dies in 1934, worn out after decades near strong radiation.

Even today, her old notebooks are too **radioactive** to touch safely.

Picture in production

Picture brief: An early 1900s automobile of 1914 to 1918 design converted into a simple mobile medical vehicle with a boxy rear compartment, parked on a muddy rural road near plain canvas army tents, overcast grey sky, seen from a distance, no people in clear focus nearby.

Mrs X sends simple X-ray cars close to the wounded soldiers.

Who is Mrs X?

- ☐ Lise Meitner
- ☒ **Marie Curie**
- ☐ Mary Seacole
- ☐ Rosalind Franklin

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Marie Curie

wounded: hurt or injured, often in a war

front: the place where two armies fight closest to each other

radioactive: giving off strong invisible rays that can harm the body

Picture in production

Picture brief: A thick lead-lined grey metal box stands open on a quiet archive shelf, revealing a single worn old notebook inside, a present-day archivist's hand in a thin grey protective glove reaching toward it but not yet touching, soft archive lighting.

Her old notebooks are still kept locked away today, too dangerous to touch freely.

FRONT

In 1903, a Nobel Prize **committee** first plans to honor only two men.

One of the men, her husband, insists that her name be added too.

So her name is added, and she shares the prize. Eight years later, a second prize follows, for her own work alone.

That same year, a **hostile** press attacks her private life instead of her science.

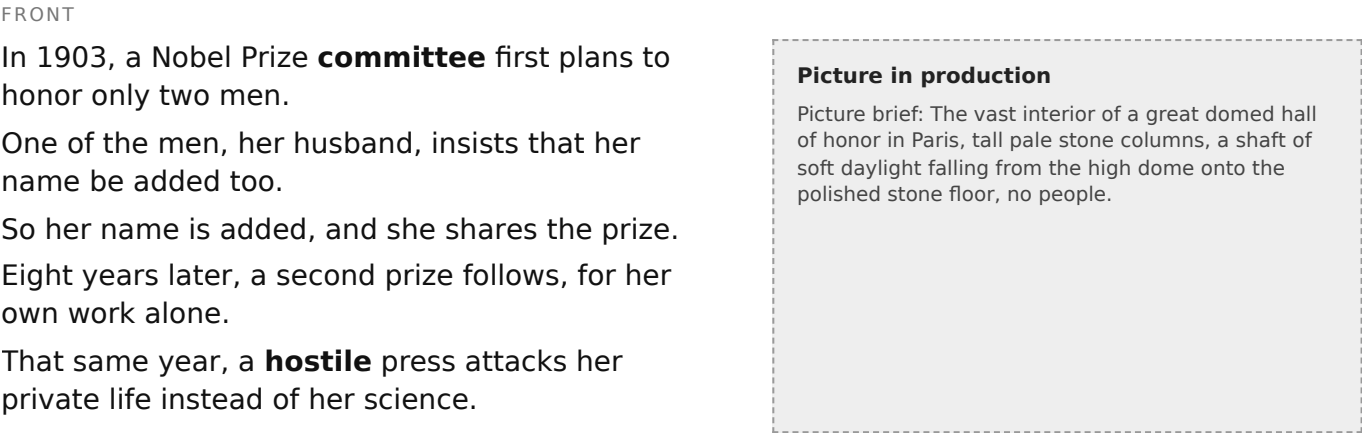
Some newspapers even question whether a foreign-born woman deserves such honors.

Historians later study these attacks as a case of gender and **prejudice**.

Her life also raises a hard question about the price of new knowledge.

More than sixty years after her death, France moves her **remains** to its great hall of honored citizens.

She becomes the first woman honored there for her own achievements.



Picture in production

Picture brief: The vast interior of a great domed hall of honor in Paris, tall pale stone columns, a shaft of soft daylight falling from the high dome onto the polished stone floor, no people.

Long after her death, France gives her a place among its most honored citizens.

Who is Mrs X?

- ☐ Emmy Noether
- ☒ **Marie Curie**
- ☐ Chien-Shiung Wu
- ☐ Lise Meitner

University

science

BACK

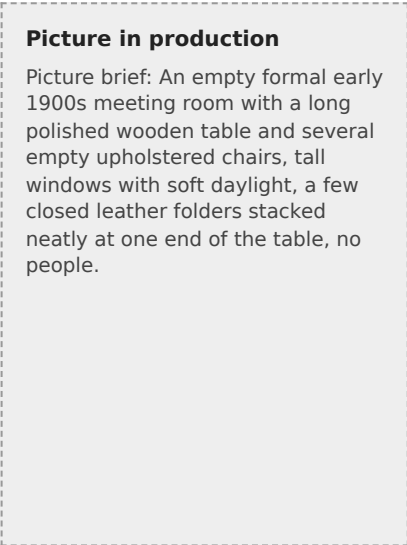
Answer: Marie Curie

committee: a small group of people chosen to decide something

hostile: unfriendly and full of anger

prejudice: an unfair opinion about someone formed before knowing them

remains: here: the body of a person who has died



Picture in production

Picture brief: An empty formal early 1900s meeting room with a long polished wooden table and several empty upholstered chairs, tall windows with soft daylight, a few closed leather folders stacked neatly at one end of the table, no people.

A small committee first decides who deserves the great prize.

FRONT

Mr X lives in a Greek city by the sea.

The city is called Syracuse, on the island of Sicily. He loves shapes and numbers more than almost anything.

He draws circles and triangles in the sand.

Farmers need to lift water up to their dry fields.

Mr X builds a clever machine: a long **screw** inside a **tube**.

When you turn the screw, water climbs up and up.

A famous story says he moves a **huge** ship almost alone.

He pulls it with ropes and many turning wheels.

He also explains the **lever**, a long stick with a support under it.

A story says he makes a bold claim about it.

With a long enough lever and a place to stand, he could move the whole Earth.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A wooden water screw stands at an angle from a wide, calm river into a dry irrigation channel on the banks of the Nile in Egypt, with date palms and reed beds behind. Only sandaled feet treading on the outer wooden casing of the screw, and a pair of hands resting on a wooden frame, are visible; the person's face and body are out of frame.

A screw inside a tube lifts water up from the river.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Pythagoras
- ☒ **Archimedes**
- ☐ Euclid
- ☐ Hero of Alexandria

Grade 6

mathematics

BACK

Answer: Archimedes

screw: a piece of metal or wood that turns round and round and moves things as it turns

tube: a long, hollow, round object, like a pipe

lever: a bar or stick that helps you lift or move heavy things

huge: very, very big

Picture in production

Picture brief: A close view of two hands gripping a long wooden pole that is wedged under a large stone boulder, with a small rock placed under the pole as a support point. Sandaled feet stand braced on dry ground. The picture shows how a lever lifts a heavy stone.

A long pole and one small stone can lift a heavy rock.

FRONT

Mr X lives in the Greek city of Syracuse, on Sicily.

A king asks him to check if a new **crown** is **pure** gold.

A famous story says he finds the answer in his bath.

He watches the water rise as he steps into the tub.

Gold is very heavy for its size, so pure gold takes up little room.

A crown of pure gold pushes out less water than a mixed crown of the same weight.

His ideas about water also explain why some things float and others sink.

Years later, ships from Rome attack his home city.

Mr X builds huge machines to help **defend** the walls.

Long wooden arms swing out and drop stones on the ships.

In 212 BC, Roman soldiers finally break into the city.

A soldier kills Mr X, even though the **general** wants him alive.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A huge wooden arm on a stone city wall by the sea swings out on a rope and chain, ready to drop a heavy stone toward Roman war ships below. The scene is seen from behind the wall, at a distance, with no faces visible. Old Greek stone towers stand along the coast; the ships are oared wooden warships with plain square sails and no marks.

Huge machines on the walls drop stones on the ships below.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Archimedes**

☐ Thales

☐ Eratosthenes

☐ Ptolemy

Grade 9

mathematics

BACK

Answer: Archimedes

crown: a gold ring worn on the head by a king or a queen

pure: not mixed with anything else

defend: to fight to protect a place from attack

general: the leader of an army

Picture in production

Picture brief: An empty terracotta bathtub in a plain ancient Greek bathhouse, water still rippling and a little spilled onto the stone floor around it. Soft daylight falls through a small high window. No person is in the tub.

Water rises and spills when something goes into the tub.

FRONT

Mr X lives in the Greek city of Syracuse in the 200s BC.

He wants to know the value of a special number: **pi**.

Pi tells you how far around a circle is, compared to its width.

He draws many-sided shapes just inside and just outside a circle.

More sides make each shape closer to a true, round circle.

With this method, he traps pi between two very close fractions.

He also studies a ball fitting tightly inside a tube-shaped block.

The block is exactly as tall as it is wide.

He proves the ball's **volume** is two thirds of the block's volume.

He is so proud of this **proof** that he wants it on his **tomb**.

Long after his death, a Roman writer named Cicero finds the tomb.

The lost grave is exactly as Mr X wished, with the shapes carved on it.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A close view of geometric shapes drawn with a stick in smooth sand: a circle with a many-sided shape drawn tightly inside it and another many-sided shape drawn just outside it. Only a hand and a wooden stick are visible, no face. Warm Mediterranean coastal light.

A circle sits tightly between two many-sided shapes.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Euclid
- ☐ Hipparchus
- ☒ **Archimedes**
- ☐ Apollonius

Grade 12

mathematics

BACK

Answer: Archimedes

pi: a special number used to measure circles

volume: how much space is inside a shape

proof: facts and steps that show an idea must be true

tomb: a place where a dead person is buried

Picture in production

Picture brief: A pale marble sphere rests exactly inside a marble cylinder that is exactly as tall as it is wide, touching the top, bottom, and curved side of the block. Soft studio-like daylight, plain stone surface below. No person in the image.

A ball fits tightly inside a tube-shaped block of stone.

FRONT

Mr X lives in Syracuse, a Greek city on Sicily, in the 200s BC.

Some people say nobody can count all the **grains** of sand in the world.

Mr X disagrees and invents a new way to write huge numbers.

With his method, he counts grains of sand that could fill the whole **universe**.

He writes this idea down in a book for the king's son.

He also sends letters with new mathematical ideas to **scholars** in Alexandria.

In one letter, he asks the scholars to prove his **claims** for themselves.

Many of these letters and books survive, copied again and again over time.

Later writers add dramatic stories about him.

One story says he burns enemy ships with mirrors during a war.

It is a late story that many historians doubt.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A man in a simple ancient Greek chiton stands on a cliff at night, seen from behind, looking up at a sky thick with stars. In one hand he holds a small bundle of closed papyrus rolls, seen from a distance with no visible marks.

He writes down his boldest ideas about huge numbers and the stars.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Eratosthenes
- ☐ Ptolemy
- ☐ Hypatia
- ☒ **Archimedes**

Grade 12

mathematics

BACK

Answer: Archimedes

grain: one tiny piece, like one small piece of sand

universe: all of space, with every star and every world

scholar: a person who studies and learns deeply

claim: something a person says is true

Picture in production

Picture brief: An extreme close-up of pale sand grains on a beach, with a gentle wave just reaching them, countless tiny grains visible in sharp detail. No hands, no objects, no marks.

Countless tiny grains of sand, more than anyone can count by hand.

FRONT

Mr X is a Greek mathematician from Syracuse, in the 200s BC.

More than a thousand years after his death, a **scribe** copies his books by hand.

In the 13th century, monks need **parchment** and **scrape** this copy clean.

They write a prayer book over the **faint**, old mathematical text.

For centuries, nobody knows his lost book still hides underneath.

In 1906, a scholar finds the hidden book and reads part of it.

About a hundred years later, scientists use modern light and imaging tools.

They read pages far too faint for the human eye to see.

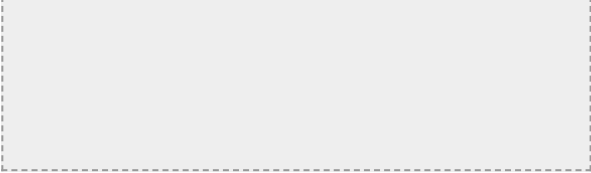
One hidden text explains a method: cutting shapes into countless thin slices.

This method comes very close to a big mathematical idea developed much later.

Historians must now separate his real, documented work from later, dramatic legends.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Inside a dim medieval monastery room, a monk's hands in a plain wool habit scrape old ink from a parchment page with a small blade, by the light of one candle. Faint, ghostly circles and straight lines from an older drawing are just visible beneath the scraping. The monk's face is not shown.



A monk scrapes an old page clean to write a new prayer book.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Apollonius
☐ Hero of Alexandria
☐ Hipparchus
☒ **Archimedes**

University
 mathematics

BACK

Answer: Archimedes

scribe: a person whose job is to copy text by hand

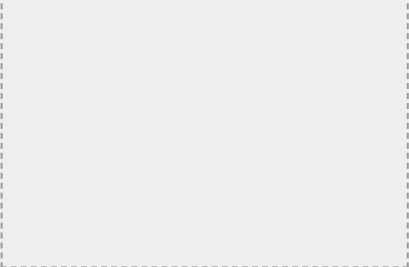
scrape: to rub something hard to remove its top layer

parchment: a material made from animal skin, used like paper for writing

faint: very weak and hard to see

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a modern research lab, a gloved hand holds a special light over an old, worn parchment page lying flat under a small imaging device, revealing faint pale patterns invisible to the naked eye. The scientist's face is out of frame.



Modern light reveals writing that was hidden for centuries.

FRONT

Mr X lives about twelve hundred years ago.

His home is Baghdad, a great new city built by a **caliph**.

Traders, poets, and **scholars** fill the streets inside its round walls.

Mr X works with numbers every single day.

When a father dies, families often **argue** about the land and the gold.

Mr X writes a book that helps them share it fairly.

He also learns about new number signs that come from India.

One strange little sign stands for nothing at all.

Today we call it zero.

With these new numbers, hard counting becomes much easier for everyone.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Busy daytime riverbank market outside the walls of a great ninth-century city: wooden boats with plain sails moored along the wide river, traders in long robes and turbans unloading sacks and closed clay jars, high round mud-brick city walls and domes rising behind, palm trees along the bank.

A great new city by a great river, full of traders and boats.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Brahmagupta
- ☒ **al-Khwarizmi**
- ☐ Fibonacci
- ☐ Omar Khayyam

Grade 6

mathematics

BACK

Answer: al-Khwarizmi

caliph: a Muslim ruler who leads a large early empire

scholars: people who study and learn very much

argue: to talk in an angry way because people do not agree

Picture in production

Picture brief: A simple wooden counting board lies on a table, divided into several shallow rows, each holding neat lines of smooth round pebbles, except for one row, which is completely empty. It shows the new idea of a sign for nothing at all.

One row on the board is empty. A whole new number: nothing at all.

FRONT

Mr X works in Baghdad in the ninth century.

He writes a math book with a strange long title.

The title talks about restoring numbers and balancing them, like a **scale**.

In the book, he solves hard number **puzzles**.

He never uses plus signs, minus signs, or letters for unknown numbers.

Instead, he explains every step in plain words and simple pictures.

He writes it for merchants, judges, and builders who need it in their daily work.

Centuries later, European scholars **translate** his book into Latin.

From its title, they take a brand new word for this kind of mathematics.

Today, students all over the world still use that word: **algebra**.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Close view from behind of a robed scholar's shoulder and hand, wearing a turban, drawing with a thin wooden stylus in a shallow tray of fine sand on a low table in a sunlit courtyard: a large square with a narrow rectangle attached to two of its sides, plain geometric lines only. Closed paper books lie nearby.

He explains every step with plain words and simple pictures.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Thabit ibn Qurra
- ☐ Fibonacci
- ☒ **al-Khwarizmi**
- ☐ al-Kindi

Grade 9

mathematics

BACK

Answer: al-Khwarizmi

puzzles: problems that need careful thinking to solve

translate: to change words from one language into another

scale: a tool that shows if two things weigh the same

algebra: a kind of mathematics that uses letters or words for unknown numbers

Picture in production

Picture brief: A man in a ninth-century long robe and turban, seen from behind, carries a wooden shoulder pole with one plain clay water jar hanging level at each end, walking down a narrow mud-brick lane with a dome beyond. It explains the idea of balancing: the same weight on both sides.

Balancing: the same weight on both sides, so nothing tips over.

FRONT

Mr X writes two important books in Baghdad in the ninth century.

One book is about restoring and balancing numbers.

The other book explains the new number signs from India, including zero.

In the twelfth century, a scholar in Europe translates this second book.

He turns the Arabic words into **Latin**.

Nobody knows exactly who this **translator** is.

Later, every Arabic copy of the book is lost.

Only the Latin text **survives**.

The Latin text begins with his name, written in a Latin way.

Slowly, scholars use that Latin form of his name for something new.

It becomes a word for any clear set of **steps** that always gives the same answer.

That word is still used today, in every school and every computer.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A dim scriptorium in twelfth-century Toledo: a translator in a long medieval robe sits at a slanted wooden desk with two closed leather-bound books before him, one with a geometric-stamped cover, a quill and an ink pot resting beside them, warm candlelight, shelves of closed books behind.

A translator turns the book's Arabic words into Latin.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Nasir al-Din al-Tusi
- ☒ **al-Khwarizmi**
- ☐ Fibonacci
- ☐ al-Biruni

Grade 12

mathematics

BACK

Answer: al-Khwarizmi

translator: a person who changes words from one language into another

survive: to still exist after a long time or a big danger

Latin: the language of ancient Rome, used by scholars for many centuries

steps: the small parts of a job, done one after another

Picture in production

Picture brief: A worn stone staircase with a few wide steps climbs one level in a sunlit ninth-century courtyard between two plain plastered walls, moss softening the stone edges.

Steps: one clear stage, then the next, always leading the same way.

FRONT

Mr X works as an **astronomer** and **geographer** in Baghdad.

He makes detailed tables that track the sun, the moon, and the planets.

Other scholars use these tables to make calendars, find prayer times, and read the stars.

Mr X also studies the geography books of Greek scholars of old.

An earlier Greek scholar drew a famous map of the known world.

That old map has many mistakes about coasts, rivers, and distances.

With other scholars, Mr X checks and corrects more than two thousand place locations.

Together, they draw a new and more **accurate** map of the world.

His own name may point to a **region** east of the Caspian Sea.

Historians are not sure if he himself is born there.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A flat rooftop in ninth-century Baghdad at midday: two scholars in long robes and turbans measure the short shadow of a tall plain wooden pole with a knotted cord, while a third sits nearby with a stack of closed record books, brick domes and the wide river beyond under a bright sky.

By day, scholars measure the sun's shadow and write down what they find.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ al-Battani
- ☒ **al-Khwarizmi**
- ☐ al-Biruni
- ☐ Nasir al-Din al-Tusi

Grade 12

mathematics

BACK

Answer: al-Khwarizmi

astronomer: a scientist who studies the stars, the sun, and the planets

geographer: a person who studies and maps the earth, its lands and seas

accurate: correct, with no or very few mistakes

region: a big area of land, bigger than one town or city

Picture in production

Picture brief: A large aged paper world map lies unrolled at a sharp angle on a wooden table, showing only coastlines, rivers, and mountain symbols in faded ink, with no place names or writing anywhere, weighted flat by smooth stones at the corners.

A new map of the world, drawn to correct old mistakes.

FRONT

Mr X works as a mathematician and scholar in Baghdad in the ninth century.

Historians know his life mainly from a handful of short, later **biographical** notes.

No personal letters from him survive.

His famous book on restoring and balancing numbers draws on older **traditions**.

Some of its methods likely come from earlier Babylonian, Indian, and Greek mathematics.

Yet Mr X **organizes** these methods into clear, general rules for the first time.

Later scholars in the Middle East and Europe build on his rules for centuries.

Some historians call him the father of this kind of mathematics.

Others say his great gift is to collect and organize what others know.

Historians still debate how much is truly his own **invention**.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A quiet library shelf holds three different kinds of closed old books side by side: a rolled papyrus scroll tied with cord, a stack of dried palm-leaf pages bound with string, and a leather-bound codex with a plain geometric-stamped cover, lit by a single shaft of window light.

Old knowledge from many lands sits side by side on his shelf.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Thabit ibn Qurra
- ☐ Archimedes
- ☒ **al-Khwarizmi**
- ☐ Brahmagupta

University

mathematics

BACK

Answer: al-Khwarizmi

biographical: about a person's life story

traditions: old ways of doing or knowing things, passed down over time

organize: to put things in a clear order

invention: something new, made for the first time

Picture in production

Picture brief: Close-up of a generic hand arranging smooth pebbles into a neat triangular pattern on fine sand at the edge of a wide, calm river, each row one pebble longer than the last, reed beds and a moored wooden boat blurred in the background, morning light casting soft shadows. It shows the idea of taking scattered pieces and arranging them into one clear, ordered pattern.

Scattered ideas, arranged into one clear and ordered pattern.

FRONT

Mr X is a boy who lives near Bukhara.

That is more than a thousand years ago.

Bukhara is a city in Central Asia.

Mr X learns to read very early.

Later he writes his own life story.

In it, he says he knows the holy book of Islam by heart at ten.

Soon he knows more than his own teachers, he says.

He studies medicine and starts to **treat** sick people.

His life story says he already works as a doctor at sixteen.

One day, the **ruler** of his city becomes very ill.

Mr X treats him, and the ruler gets well again.

As a **reward**, the ruler lets him read every book in his **private** library.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A young physician in late tenth century Central Asian dress, seen from behind or at a distance so his face is not clearly visible, kneels beside an older ruler who rests on cushions in a modest brick palace room, checking his wrist pulse. Brass bowls and closed unlabeled clay jars sit on a low wooden table nearby, and a brick archway with a domed window is visible behind them.

A young healer examines the ruler who has fallen ill.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Ibn Sina**
- ☐ Hippocrates
- ☐ Galen
- ☐ al-Razi

Grade 6

ideas

BACK

Answer: Ibn Sina

ruler: a person who governs a country or a city

treat: to help a sick person get well

reward: something good that you get for doing something helpful

private: only for one person, not for everyone

Picture in production

Picture brief: A quiet alcove in a mudbrick palace library, rows of closed plain leather-bound books stacked on carved wooden shelves, warm light falling through a small window with a geometric lattice pattern, brick dome visible above, no people present.

The grateful ruler opens his private library to the young healer.

FRONT

Mr X is born near Bukhara, more than a thousand years ago.

He grows up to become a doctor and a thinker.

He writes a huge book about medicine.

The book has five long parts.

It describes diseases, medicines, and how to care for the body.

Doctors across the Muslim world use the book for **centuries**.

Later, it reaches **universities** in Europe too.

There, doctors still read it hundreds of years after his death.

Mr X is also very careful about testing medicines.

He says a new medicine must first be tried on real **patients**.

It must also work again and again before doctors can trust it.

His rules for testing a medicine still sound **modern** today.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Hands only, or a figure seen from behind, in eleventh century Persian dress grinding herbs with a stone mortar and pestle at a low wooden table in a simple clinic room. Brass bowls, closed unlabeled clay jars, and a small hanging balance scale sit nearby, soft daylight through a lattice window.

He tests and prepares each medicine with great care.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ al-Zahrawi
- ☒ **Ibn Sina**
- ☐ Ibn Rushd
- ☐ al-Razi

Grade 9

ideas

BACK

Answer: Ibn Sina

centuries: periods of one hundred years each

universities: places where people study at the highest level after school

patients: people who are ill and need a doctor's help

modern: of our own time, not of old times

Picture in production

Picture brief: A medieval European university lecture hall about six hundred years ago, seen from the back of the room: students in long dark gowns and hoods sit on plain wooden benches, a lecturer stands at a raised wooden desk with one thick closed leather-bound book, a tall arched stone window behind him. All faces turned away or generic, no readable pages, no modern clothes. It shows how his book is studied far away in Europe.

Far away in Europe, doctors study his book for hundreds of years.

FRONT

Mr X is a doctor in Persia around the year 1000.

He is also a **philosopher**.

He writes a huge book called the Book of Healing.

It is about ideas, not about medicine.

It talks about **logic**, nature, and the **soul**.

He builds on an ancient Greek philosopher, without copying him.

He also adds many new ideas of his own.

One idea is a strange thought experiment.

Imagine a man floating alone in empty air.

He cannot see, hear, or touch anything around him.

Yet the man still knows that he exists, Mr X **argues**.

This shows, he says, that the mind can know itself directly.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A scholar in eleventh century Persian dress, seen from behind, sits on cushions in a quiet brick room by day. A closed plain leather-bound book rests on a low wooden bookstand before him, an unlit oil lamp stands beside it, soft light falls through a lattice window, a brick dome above.

In a quiet room, he thinks and writes about difficult new ideas.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ al-Farabi
- ☐ Ibn Rushd
- ☒ **Ibn Sina**
- ☐ Maimonides

Grade 12

ideas

BACK

Answer: Ibn Sina

philosopher: a person who thinks deeply about big questions

logic: careful and clear thinking, step by step

soul: the inner part of a person that thinks and feels

argue: to give reasons for what you think is true

Picture in production

Picture brief: An abstract, dreamlike image of a human figure in plain simple clothes, seen from behind with only the back of the head and shoulders visible, floating gently in a dark, empty void, limbs loose and relaxed, softly lit from an unseen source, nothing else visible around the figure.

Imagine a man floating alone, feeling nothing at all around him.

FRONT

Mr X does not stay in one place for long.

He moves between rulers' courts in Persia and Central Asia.

For a while, he works as a **vizier**, a top adviser.

Later, an angry ruler locks him away for months.

After his **escape**, he keeps writing and moves on again.

He often works all day and writes deep into the night.

In his medical writings, he **suggests** an unusual idea.

Maybe illness spreads through something **unseen** in water.

Maybe it spreads through something unseen in the air too, he says.

Mr X dies in the city of Hamadan in 1037.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A lone rider in eleventh century dress, a long robe and simple turban, travels a rocky mountain road, seen from behind or at a great distance so his face is unclear. Two walled towns with brick domes are visible far apart in the valley below, warm dusk light.

He moves from one ruler's court to another.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ al-Biruni
- ☐ Galen
- ☐ Ibn Rushd
- ☒ **Ibn Sina**

Grade 12

ideas

BACK

Answer: Ibn Sina

vizier: a top helper and adviser to a ruler

escape: to get free from a place where you are locked in

suggest: to say that something might be true, as an idea

unseen: something that cannot be seen with the eyes

Picture in production

Picture brief: A plain unlabeled clay water jar sits on a stone courtyard ledge in the cool early morning, faint mist rising gently above the water's surface, soft diffuse light, no people.

Maybe illness hides, unseen, in water and air.

FRONT

Mr X is a doctor and thinker in Persia, about a thousand years ago.

He writes about **metaphysics**, the study of what truly exists.

Later scholars translate his work into Latin.

For centuries, his ideas shape teaching at distant universities.

Some later **theologians** disagree strongly with parts of his philosophy.

They argue that his ideas do not fit their religious beliefs.

A famous **legend** says Mr X remembers every book he ever reads.

His own life story presents him as a **genius** with an amazing memory.

He says he reads one hard Greek book forty times and still does not understand it.

Then a small, cheap book by another scholar explains it to him at once, he says.

Historians point out that he tells his life story to show how special he is.

They compare the old sources carefully before they trust such stories.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Two scholars in eleventh or twelfth century long robes and turbans stand in intense discussion under a brick courtyard arch, one gesturing with an open hand while the other frowns and shakes his head, faces generic and seen at a moderate distance. Closed plain leather-bound books are stacked on a nearby stone ledge.

Later thinkers argue fiercely about his difficult ideas.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ al-Biruni
- ☒ **Ibn Sina**
- ☐ Maimonides
- ☐ al-Farabi

University

ideas

BACK

Answer: Ibn Sina

metaphysics: the study of what things truly are

theologian: a person who studies religious belief deeply

legend: an old, popular story that may not be fully true

genius: a person with a very great mind

Picture in production

Picture brief: Looking straight up through a round opening in a brick courtyard dome at a deep night sky full of stars, the dome's edge softly lit from below by warm lamplight, no people.

Metaphysics asks what truly exists, from a single brick to the stars.

FRONT

Place X is a home for books.

It stands in Baghdad, a round city on a great river, in a hot **desert** land.

A **ruler** builds the city about 1,300 years ago.

He wants a perfect city, so he makes it in a circle, with high walls.

Soon the city grows into the biggest city in the world.

A later ruler pays smart people to **translate** old books from far away lands.

At this time, people also learn a new way to make paper, a way that first comes from China.

Before, people write on animal **skin**, and skin costs a lot.

Paper is cheap, so now many more people can own a book.

Place X becomes the home of these new books and ideas.



A ruler builds this city as a perfect circle, next to a great river.

Which place is Place X?

- ☐ The Library of Alexandria
- ☐ Al-Azhar in Cairo
- ☒ **The House of Wisdom**
- ☐ Nalanda

Grade 6 ideas

BACK

Answer: The House of Wisdom

ruler: a person who leads and controls a country

desert: a big dry land with sand and very little water

translate: to say or write a text again in another language

skin: the outer covering of an animal's body; here, a material used for writing before paper



Before paper, people write on stretched animal skin like this.

FRONT

In the early 800s, Place X stands in Baghdad.

A ruler named al-Ma'mun loves knowledge more than gold or **gems**.

He pays a large team of **scholars** to hunt for old books in Greek, Persian, and Indian languages.

Christians, Muslims, and others work side by side on the team.

The team turns hundreds of old books into Arabic.

The most famous **translator**, Hunayn ibn Ishaq, works a little later.

He knows several languages perfectly.

He checks every translation with great care before it leaves his hands.

A story says the ruler pays him the weight of each finished book in gold.

No one can confirm that story, but everyone agrees he works fast and well.

Doctors, star watchers, and thinkers can now read ideas from three **continents**.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Busy river harbor scene on the Tigris in ninth-century Baghdad: wooden boats loaded with sacks and bound crates line the riverbank, porters in long robes and turbans carry stacks of closed, unlabeled books toward a large courtyard building with brick arches, palm trees along the bank, warm afternoon light.

Books from far away arrive by river. Scholars will turn them into a new language.

Which place is Place X?☒ **The House of Wisdom**

☐ The Library of Cordoba

☐ The Academy in Athens

☐ Sankore in Timbuktu

Grade 9

ideas

BACK

Answer: The House of Wisdom

scholar: a person who studies and knows very much

translator: a person whose job is to put a text into another language

continent: one of the Earth's very large land areas, such as Europe or Asia

gem: a rare and beautiful stone that costs a lot of money

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a scholar in a turban and long plain robe seen from behind at a low wooden desk in a ninth-century Baghdad room: a closed codex with a plain wooden cover lies on his left, a closed leather book with a geometric pattern on its cover lies on his right, a reed pen and a small ink pot between them, soft light from a high window.

A translator turns a book from one language into another.

FRONT

About 1,200 years ago, Place X in Baghdad becomes a center for careful measurement.

A ruler sends teams of **astronomers** into the flat desert north of the city.

They walk and measure until the North Star stands one **degree** higher in the sky.

From this careful walk, they work out the size of the whole Earth.

Their answer comes close to the true number, long before anyone sails around the planet.

In the same city, three brothers design clever machines.

Their machines pour drinks by hidden tricks, and one even plays music on its own.

A **mathematician** from a land far to the east also works here.

He writes a famous book that later gives Europe a whole branch of mathematics.

He also explains an Indian way to write numbers, using a **symbol** for zero.

Place X gathers thinkers from many lands and many fields of study.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide view of a small team of ninth-century astronomers sent out from Baghdad, in long robes and turbans, standing in a flat open desert at dawn, one holds a plain brass sighting instrument up toward the sky, another walks ahead marking distance with a long measuring cord, camels wait nearby with equipment.

Careful walking and careful watching of the sky can measure something as big as the Earth.

Which place is Place X?

- ☐ The University of Bologna
- ☐ Al-Qarawiyyin in Fez
- ☐ The Library of Alexandria
- ☒ **The House of Wisdom**

Grade 12

ideas

BACK

Answer: The House of Wisdom

astronomer: a person who studies stars, planets, and the sky

degree: a small unit for measuring an angle, like a slice of a circle

mathematician: a person who studies numbers, shapes, and patterns

symbol: a mark or sign that stands for something else

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a scholar in simple ninth-century Baghdad robes bending over a low table, drawing careful circles and triangles on a sand tray with a wooden stick, a compass and a straightedge beside him, warm daylight from a window.

A mathematician works out new rules using careful drawings, not guesses.

FRONT

For centuries, Place X in Baghdad brings together knowledge from Greek, Persian, and Indian **sources**.

Scholars there write new works in medicine, astronomy, and mathematics.

Slowly, this knowledge moves west along trade roads and through Muslim Spain.

By the 1100s, teams in the Spanish city of Toledo translate Arabic books into Latin.

On the island of Sicily, other translators do the same important work.

Through these Latin copies, European universities finally read ideas kept and improved far to the east.

But Place X does not last forever.

In 1258, an army from the steppes reaches the city and destroys much of it.

A story says the river beside the city runs black with ink from countless ruined books.

Historians cannot **confirm** this exact detail, but they agree the **destruction** itself is real and huge.

The city **recovers** over time, but its great age of learning never fully returns.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A mule train with wooden chests strapped to the animals climbs a dry hill road in twelfth-century Spain toward a walled hill town with a tall cathedral tower, the drivers in plain medieval tunics and hoods walk beside the mules, olive trees on the slopes, warm evening light.

Books travel west to a Spanish city, where they are put into Latin.

Which place is Place X?

- ☐ The Academy in Athens
- ☒ **The House of Wisdom**
- ☐ The Library of Cordoba
- ☐ Al-Azhar in Cairo

Grade 12

ideas

BACK

Answer: The House of Wisdom

source: a text or place that gives information or knowledge

destruction: the act of destroying something completely

recover: to become well or normal again after a hard time

confirm: to show or state that something is definitely true

Picture in production

Picture brief: At dusk, the calm water of the Tigris in Baghdad carries a few loose, dark stained paper scraps past empty wooden boats tied at a quiet riverbank, the silhouette of brick courtyard buildings in the old Baghdad style behind, faint smoke on the far horizon.

A story says the river runs dark with ink from ruined books.

FRONT

Many popular books describe Place X as a grand **academy** full of famous scholars.

How much of that picture truly comes from the old historical sources?

The oldest sources mention little more than a caliph's library, with a few translators and copyists at work there.

They say almost nothing about lectures, classrooms, or enrolled students.

Some modern historians think Place X is mainly a royal library, not a school.

Other historians argue that the surviving sources are simply incomplete, and the place worked much like a true academy.

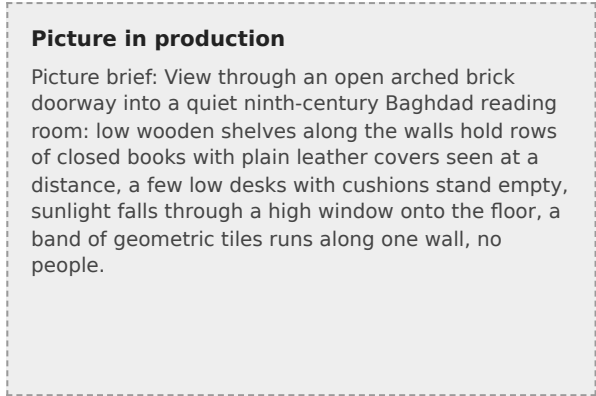
Many vivid details in popular retellings first appear centuries after the events they describe.

The gold payment for translations and the ink-darkened river are later stories, not **eyewitness** reports.

Even so, the record shows something remarkable.

Rulers pay for a long effort to gather and translate knowledge across languages.

Historians must separate this solid **evidence** from the romantic **legend** built up around it over time.



A quiet library, or a busy school? The oldest sources say very little.

Which place is Place X?

- ☐ Nalanda
- ☐ The University of Bologna
- ☒ **The House of Wisdom**
- ☐ Al-Qarawiyyin in Fez

University ideas

BACK

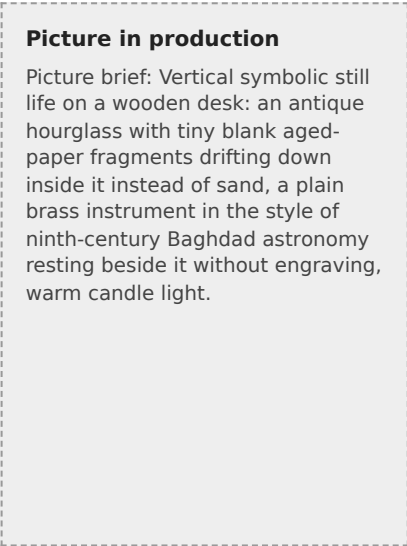
Answer: The House of Wisdom

academy: a school or place for higher study and teaching

evidence: facts or objects that show something is true

eyewitness: a person who saw an event happen with their own eyes

legend: an old story that many people believe, even though parts of it may not be true



Over time, a few plain facts can grow into a much bigger story.

FRONT

Mr X lives about seven hundred years ago.
He is born in Tangier, a **port** town in Morocco.
His family are religious **scholars** and **judges**.
At twenty-one years old, he leaves home alone.
He travels east on the road to Mecca, on a holy **pilgrimage**.
He rides camels across hot deserts and sails on wooden ships.
A journey like this usually takes more than a year.
But he loves the road, and he never really stops.
For almost thirty years, he moves from town to town.
He meets kings, judges, and holy men on the way.
His family waits at home, and for years they hear nothing.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A camel caravan sets out from a Moroccan port town at dawn, seen from behind: a young man in fourteenth-century North African dress, a long wool robe and a wrapped turban, walks beside a loaded camel with a plain rope harness, his back to the camera; behind him, flat-roofed whitewashed stone and earth buildings and the sea catch the first light.

A young man leaves his home town before sunrise.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Marco Polo
- ☐ Christopher Columbus
- ☒ **Ibn Battuta**
- ☐ Vasco da Gama

Grade 6

exploration

BACK

Answer: Ibn Battuta

port: a town by the sea where ships stop

scholar: a person who studies and knows very much

judge: a person who decides if someone has done wrong

pilgrimage: a journey to a holy place

Picture in production

Picture brief: A row of wooden sailing ships with triangular lateen sails rests at anchor in a busy North African port town, flat-roofed whitewashed stone and earth buildings along the shore, small fishing boats pulled up on the sand.

Ships wait in the harbor of a busy trading town.

FRONT

Mr X sails down the coast of East Africa, about seven hundred years ago.

He visits rich trading towns built from **coral** stone, like Kilwa and Mogadishu.

Gold and **ivory** pass through their busy markets.

Later, a strong seasonal wind carries his ship back north to Arabia.

Sailors call this wind the **monsoon**, and it blows one way in summer and the other way in winter.

Years later, after a long journey over land through many lands, he reaches India in 1333.

Mr X comes to Delhi, a great city ruled by a powerful **sultan**.

The sultan likes educated visitors and makes Mr X a judge.

He judges cases there for several years, far from his home in the west.

Later he sails on to the Maldives, a chain of small islands in the ocean.

The queen's court there also makes him a judge, this time among palm trees and white beaches.

He judges by the laws of his faith, even on this small island kingdom.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A grand fortified palace of grey stone and white plaster with sloping walls and round towers, fourteenth-century Delhi, rises in the distance under a heavy monsoon sky; in the foreground a robed judge in fourteenth-century South Asian Muslim dress, a long robe and a wrapped turban, seen only from behind, walks toward the palace with a camel and two servants nearby.

A judge from far away walks toward a great palace.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Zheng He
- ☒ **Ibn Battuta**
- ☐ Vasco da Gama
- ☐ Ferdinand Magellan

Grade 9

exploration

BACK

Answer: Ibn Battuta

coral: a hard stone-like material made by tiny sea animals

ivory: the hard white material from an elephant's tusk

monsoon: a strong wind that blows one way for months, then the other way

sultan: a Muslim ruler of a country or city

Picture in production

Picture brief: Palm trees bend in a strong wind on a tropical shore under heavy grey monsoon clouds, rain falling over the sea in the distance, spray blowing off the waves, no ships, no people.

A strong wind bends the palms. The same wind blows the other way every year.

FRONT

Mr X keeps traveling east, far past India, about seven hundred years ago.

He crosses the sea to Sri Lanka and then to Sumatra, an island covered in thick forest.

From there, ships carry him even further, all the way to China.

He describes huge cities, fine silk, and paper money that nobody in Morocco, his homeland, has ever seen.

Later historians read his **account** with care, and some parts trouble them.

His China **chapters** are shorter and less exact than the rest of his story.

Did he really see everything he describes, or did he also copy from other travelers' tales?

Historians still argue about how much of the China journey is truly his own.

After a few more years on the road, Mr X finally turns west, toward home.

When he reaches Morocco again, a great **plague** is killing people across three **continents**.

He has been away for so long that both of his parents have already died.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A vast harbor in a great port town of fourteenth-century China: dozens of tall wooden junks with battened sails crowd the water, Chinese dockworkers and merchants in long fourteenth-century robes carry bolts of silk and baskets of goods along a busy wharf, seen from a distance.

A great harbor far to the east, full of ships nobody at home has ever seen.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Marco Polo
- ☐ Zheng He
- ☐ Xuanzang
- ☒ **Ibn Battuta**

Grade 12

exploration

BACK

Answer: Ibn Battuta

account: a spoken or written report of what happened

chapter: one part of a book

plague: a disease that spreads fast and kills many people

continent: one of the biggest land areas of the earth

Picture in production

Picture brief: An empty stone-paved street in a North African town at dusk, shop doors closed and shuttered, no people anywhere, a single abandoned handcart to one side.

A quiet, empty street. Sickness has emptied the town.

FRONT

Years after coming home, Mr X sets out on one more great journey.

This time he crosses the Sahara, the largest hot desert on earth.

He joins a trading **caravan** of camels loaded with **slabs** of salt.

Workers far out in the desert cut this salt straight out of the ground.

Traders carry the slabs south into the kingdom of Mali and trade them for gold.

After many weeks, Mr X reaches the court of the king of Mali.

The salt, the gold, and the strict **customs** of the court all surprise him.

He says later that the people of Mali love justice and that travelers are safe there.

After this last journey, Mr X finally **settles** down and stops traveling.

A ruler in Morocco then asks him to tell his whole life story.

In 1355, in the town of Fez, Mr X tells his story aloud.

A trained writer sets it on paper.

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a spacious royal courtyard in a fourteenth-century West African kingdom, courtiers in fine woven robes and gold jewelry stand in respectful rows before a distant raised platform, gold dust and nuggets displayed in shallow bowls in the foreground, a robed foreign visitor in North African dress stands to the side, seen only from behind.

Strict customs at a royal court south of the great desert surprise a foreign visitor.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Leo Africanus
- ☒ **Ibn Battuta**
- ☐ Christopher Columbus
- ☐ Benjamin of Tudela

Grade 12

exploration

BACK

Answer: Ibn Battuta

slab: a thick flat piece of something hard

caravan: a group of people and animals that travel together

custom: a way of doing things that a group of people always follows

settle: to stop moving around and stay in one place

Picture in production

Picture brief: Close-up of large pale flat slabs of rock salt stacked and tied on a kneeling camel's back, a plain rope harness visible, dry cracked desert ground beneath.

Slabs of salt travel south to be traded for gold.

FRONT

About seven hundred years ago, Mr X ends his travels.

Historians **estimate** his journeys cover several times the distance of the most famous traveler from Venice.

Within two years of coming home, Mr X dictates his book, and it is finished in 1355.

He speaks mostly from memory, and his earliest journeys lie thirty years in the past.

Because of this, historians compare his book carefully against older travel books.

Some passages match an older pilgrim's travel book by Ibn Jubayr almost word for word.

Other passages carry small details that only an **eyewitness** could know.

So scholars ask, for each part, is this what he saw or what he read?

His book also describes, as he saw it, women's lives and the practice of slavery in the lands he visits.

Modern historians read these passages as **evidence** of the customs of that century, not as an **endorsement** of them.

For centuries, few people outside his own region read his book at all.

European scholars only translate and study it widely in the eighteen hundreds.

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a quiet nineteenth-century European university library, a scholar in formal nineteenth-century dress, seen from behind, lifts a closed leather-bound manuscript out of an open wooden crate; four more closed volumes with different plain bindings wait on the table beside it, soft daylight from a tall window, no lamp.

Centuries later, a scholar in Europe compares old copies of the same story.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Ibn Battuta**

☐ Zheng He

☐ Rabban Bar Sauma

☐ Evliya Celebi

University

exploration

BACK

Answer: Ibn Battuta

estimate: to guess a number using known facts

eyewitness: a person who sees something happen with their own eyes

evidence: facts that help to prove something is true

endorsement: a statement that says you approve of something

Picture in production

Picture brief: Close-up of an antique brass pair of dividers resting on an aged, blank globe of the earth, soft daylight.

How far did he really travel? Historians measure and estimate.

FRONT

Movement X spreads across Europe in the seventeen hundreds.

Before this time, most people simply **obey** the king, the lords, and the church.

Now some thinkers say something new.

Every person can use his or her own mind, they say.

Ask questions, they say, and do not just believe old rules.

In one country, writers plan a giant book that tries to explain everything in the world.

In busy **coffee houses**, men sit for hours and **argue** about these new ideas.

In fine rooms in Paris, women **host** talks where thinkers meet and speak freely.

Slowly, more and more people start to think this way.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A crowded coffee house in a European city in the seventeen hundreds: men in waistcoats and long coats sit at wooden tables, drinking from small coffee cups, candles burn between them, one man reads a paper aloud while others lean in to listen.

Men gather in coffee houses and talk for hours about bold new ideas.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Renaissance
- ☐ The Scientific Revolution
- ☒ **The Enlightenment**
- ☐ Romanticism

Grade 6

ideas

BACK

Answer: The Enlightenment

obey: to do what someone in charge tells you to do

coffee house: a place where people sit, drink coffee, and talk

host: to invite people and welcome them at an event

argue: to talk about a subject when people do not agree

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical illustration of a village road in the seventeen hundreds: villagers in simple eighteenth-century clothes, plain shirts, caps, and long skirts, bow their heads as a lord in a fine coat and tricorn hat rides past on horseback, a church tower behind, soft daylight.

Before, most people simply obey the king, the lords, and the church.

FRONT

Movement X grows fast in the seventeen hundreds. Two writers, Diderot and d'Alembert, lead the work on one huge **encyclopedia** to explain all human knowledge.

It will have thousands of long articles, from farming tools to the stars.

Soon, church and state leaders **ban** the encyclopedia because they fear its dangerous ideas.

Diderot does not stop, and he keeps working half in secret.

Slowly, the encyclopedia grows into many thick books.

One famous writer of the movement, Voltaire, becomes known for a different fight.

In 1762, judges in France wrongly **execute** a father who belongs to a small religious group.

Voltaire writes and argues for years until the man's name is finally cleared.

He says that people of every faith deserve fair treatment under the law.

This idea, called **tolerance**, becomes central to the movement.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A dim printing workshop at night in the seventeen hundreds: several workers in aprons and waistcoats quietly operate a wooden printing press by candlelight, tall stacks of large bound volumes with blank spines line the walls, one worker peers through a shuttered window as if keeping watch.

Workers keep printing the encyclopedia, even though it is banned.

Which movement is Movement X?☒ **The Enlightenment**

☐ The Reformation

☐ Humanism

☐ The Industrial Revolution

Grade 9

ideas

BACK

Answer: The Enlightenment

encyclopedia: a huge book, or set of books, that explains many different subjects

ban: to say officially that something is not allowed

execute: to kill a person as a legal punishment

tolerance: accepting that other people may believe or live differently

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a market square in a European town in the seventeen hundreds: a priest in a black cassock, a pastor in a plain dark coat and white collar, and a bearded man in a broad-brimmed hat and long coat stand together talking in a friendly group, townspeople in eighteenth-century dress pass by with baskets, a church tower and shop fronts without signs behind, soft daylight.

People of different faiths share one town in peace. That is what tolerance means.

FRONT

Movement X shapes new ideas about government in the seventeen hundreds.

One thinker, Montesquieu, says power should never sit in one place alone.

Lawmaking, ruling, and judging, he argues, should be three separate powers.

Each power should watch and limit the other two, he says.

Another thinker, Rousseau, asks a different question: why should anyone obey a ruler at all?

He answers that fair government rests on a **social contract**, an agreement among free people.

Long before this, an English thinker named Locke argues that rulers need the people's **consent**.

Much of this talk happens in **salons**, regular gatherings held in private homes.

In Paris, a woman named Madame Geoffrin hosts one of the most famous salons of the age.

There, thinkers meet, argue, and share new writing long before it is printed.

Decades later, these ideas about power and consent feed the revolutions in North America and France.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A grand candlelit drawing room in Paris in the seventeen hundreds: a well-dressed woman stands near a marble fireplace, gesturing as she speaks to a small seated group of men and women in silk gowns, waistcoats, and powdered wigs, a harpsichord stands in one corner, gilded mirrors on the walls.

In rooms like this, thinkers share bold new ideas about power and government.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Counter-Reformation
- ☐ The Scientific Revolution
- ☐ Positivism
- ☒ **The Enlightenment**

Grade 12

ideas

BACK

Answer: The Enlightenment

social contract: an agreement among people about how they will be ruled

consent: saying yes and agreeing to something

salon: a regular private gathering where people talk about ideas

lawmaking: the work of writing the laws that a country follows

Picture in production

Picture brief: Close vertical view of two men in eighteenth-century coats shaking hands in a village square, a small group of townspeople in period dress looking on, a modest church tower in the distance, daylight.

A fair ruler needs the people's agreement, some thinkers now say.

FRONT

A Berlin magazine prints a question: what is Movement X?

In 1784, a philosopher named Kant answers with a whole essay.

One line in it becomes famous: have the courage to use your own understanding.

Do not simply trust old **authority**, he says, and think for yourself, carefully and bravely.

Twenty years earlier, an Italian thinker named Beccaria attacks two common practices of the courts.

Torture used to force **confessions** is cruel and unreliable, he argues.

The death penalty does not even stop crime, he adds, and courts should use fairer methods instead.

In 1792, a British writer named Wollstonecraft asks a bold question: why not educate women as carefully as men?

Women seem weaker only because they receive a worse education, she argues.

Across the movement, thinkers admire one shining example: an English scientist's laws of motion, published a century earlier.

If careful **reasoning** can explain how the planets move, they ask, why not use it on laws and government?

Picture in production

Picture brief: An eighteenth-century courtroom: a judge in a long robe and full powdered wig sits behind a high wooden bench, a pair of brass scales stands on a side table, clerks with quill pens sit below writing, soft daylight through tall windows.

A courtroom of the seventeen hundreds. Some thinkers now question its harshest methods.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ Romanticism
- ☒ **The Enlightenment**
- ☐ The Renaissance
- ☐ The Industrial Revolution

Grade 12

ideas

BACK

Answer: The Enlightenment

authority: a person or group with the power to tell others what to do

torture: causing someone great pain on purpose; here, to force a person to confess

confession: when a person admits, often under pressure, that they did something

reasoning: careful thinking used to reach an answer

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a heavy iron-bound wooden door with a large old lock in a stone corridor of the seventeen hundreds, a ring of iron keys hanging on a hook beside it, a single candle burning in a wall holder, no people.

Locked doors and old rules. Now some thinkers ask if the rules are fair.

FRONT

Historians still argue about the legacy of Movement X, a movement of philosophers in the seventeenth hundreds.

Its thinkers praise reason, freedom, and equal rights for every person.

Yet some writers of the time use the new science to rank peoples, calling whole nations naturally **inferior**.

Meanwhile, European **empires** grow, and the trade in enslaved people from Africa to the Americas goes on.

Thinkers of the movement such as Condorcet and Raynal attack slavery and colonial cruelty in their own writings.

Later historians also ask whose reason the movement really centers on: mostly European men of a certain class.

Women host the salons but rarely get to publish.

Colonized peoples and the poor never sit at the salon table.

In the twentieth century, philosophers ask a darker question: can cold **calculation** itself lead to terrible violence?

Still, schools on every continent today teach its central idea: question authority, and think for yourself with evidence.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A grand eighteenth-century library reading room: tall shelves of leather-bound books with blank spines line the walls, a large globe stands on a wooden stand in the center, a small ship model rests on a side table, sunlight falls through tall windows, no people in the room.

Its books praise reason and freedom. Historians still argue about what that meant for everyone else.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ Humanism
- ☐ The Counter-Reformation
- ☒ **The Enlightenment**
- ☐ Positivism

University

ideas

BACK

Answer: The Enlightenment

inferior: lower in worth or ability than others; here, what some writers wrongly claimed about whole peoples

empire: many lands and peoples ruled by one distant power

colonized: living under the control of a distant ruling power

calculation: careful counting or reasoning used to solve a problem

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a busy harbor at a distance in the seventeenth hundreds: wooden sailing ships with tall masts and square sails at anchor, small distant figures loading crates and barrels onto horse carts along a stone quay, warehouses behind, hazy morning light.

Empires grow rich on goods from far away. The philosophers' praise of freedom does not reach everyone.

FRONT

Mr X grows up on a small farm in Iowa, in the United States.

As a boy, he works outdoors on the farm every day.

He studies forests at university, then chooses a new path.

He starts to study sick farm plants instead.

Mr X becomes a scientist who works with wheat.

Some wheat plants grow tall and weak, and fall over in the wind.

Some wheat plants catch a **disease** and turn brown and die.

Mr X **breeds** new wheat with short, **stiff** stems that do not fall over.

His new wheat also fights off the plant disease.

In many countries, **harvests** fail and people go hungry.

Ships carry his special seeds to these countries, and harvests grow bigger.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A young white farm boy in 1920s work clothes, denim overalls and a straw hat, walks alone through a golden Iowa wheat field at dusk, seen from behind at a distance, a weathered wooden farmhouse and windmill silhouetted on the horizon.

As a boy, Mr X works every day on his family's small farm.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ M. S. Swaminathan
- ☒ **Norman Borlaug**
- ☐ George Washington Carver
- ☐ Luther Burbank

Grade 6

science

BACK

Answer: Norman Borlaug

breeds: chooses plants or animals so their young have wanted traits

disease: a sickness that can hurt or kill living things

stiff: hard to bend

harvests: the crops that farmers gather from their fields

Picture in production

Picture brief: A close-up of a single sickly wheat plant with brown, wilted leaves and a bent stem, standing among tall healthy green wheat, morning dew on the leaves.

A plant disease can turn healthy wheat brown and make it fall.

FRONT

In the 1940s, the Rockefeller **Foundation** sends Mr X to Mexico.

Mexican wheat farmers lose whole fields to a plant disease called **rust**.

Rust turns wheat stems and leaves a rusty orange color.

Mr X moves seeds between two farms in different parts of Mexico.

One farm lies high in the mountains, the other low near the coast.

The two places have different seasons, so he gets two harvests every year.

Normal plant breeding needs one slow **generation** each year.

Mr X doubles his speed and tests new wheat twice as fast.

He breeds wheat that can fight off the rust disease.

Farmers plant his new wheat across the country.

By 1956, Mexico grows enough wheat to feed itself.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide view of experimental wheat test plots on a highland farm in Mexico in the 1940s, narrow dirt paths dividing small rectangular plots of wheat of different heights and colors, distant mountains under a bright sky, a man in plain 1940s clothing seen from behind far in the distance, bending among the plants.

In Mexico, Mr X tests many kinds of wheat side by side.

Who is Mr X?

☒ **Norman Borlaug**

☐ Yuan Longping

☐ Justus von Liebig

☐ Fritz Haber

Grade 9

science

BACK

Answer: Norman Borlaug

rust: a plant disease that makes stems and leaves turn orange-brown

foundation: a group that gives money to help important work

generation: one round of plants or animals having young

Picture in production

Picture brief: A close-up of green wheat stems and leaves covered with small rusty orange-brown patches, a few healthy green leaves beside them, soft natural light.

This orange-brown disease on wheat is called rust.

FRONT

In the middle of the 1960s, India and Pakistan face a terrible **famine** threat.

The rains fail, and harvests are small.

The old wheat **varieties** grow tall and fall over in wind and rain.

Officials ask Mr X to bring his new wheat from Mexico.

Ships carry thousands of tons of his seed across the ocean.

Trucks and trains rush the **sacks** of seed to farms before planting season ends.

Farmers plant the short, strong wheat on millions of small fields.

They add more water and more plant food to help it grow.

Within a few years, wheat harvests in both countries almost double.

Fewer people die from hunger than experts once feared.

In 1968, an American official names this whole change the green revolution.

In 1970, Mr X receives the Nobel Peace Prize for his work.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A wide golden wheat field in Punjab in the 1960s during harvest, South Asian farmers in simple cotton kurtas, dhotis, and turbans cutting wheat by hand with sickles, a wooden bullock cart piled high with plain wheat sheaves in the foreground, calm oxen standing nearby, dust drifting in warm afternoon light.

In the 1960s, farmers in South Asia harvest much bigger crops of wheat.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ M. S. Swaminathan
- ☐ Fritz Haber
- ☒ **Norman Borlaug**
- ☐ Louis Pasteur

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Norman Borlaug

famine: a time when there is not enough food for many people

officials: people who work for the government

varieties: particular types of a plant, different from other types

sacks: big strong bags, often used for grain or seed

Picture in production

Picture brief: A large cargo ship docked at a busy port in the 1960s, a tall dock crane lifting a cargo net full of plain burlap sacks into the ship's open hold, more sacks stacked on wooden pallets on the quay, dockworkers in plain 1960s work clothes and cloth caps guiding the loads, seen from a respectful distance.

Ships carry tons of new seed across the ocean to farmers who need it.

FRONT

Mr X breeds his short, strong wheat in Mexico.

By the 1970s, farmers plant it across large parts of Asia.

The new wheat needs much more chemical **fertilizer** than old wheat did.

It also needs steady water, so farmers dig hundreds of thousands of new **wells**.

Pump after pump lifts water from underground, and in some places the water level slowly falls.

Farmers spray **pesticides** to protect the valuable young plants from insects.

Fields that once grew many old wheat varieties now grow only a few new ones.

Losing so many varieties worries scientists who study plants.

Small farmers borrow money for seed, fertilizer, and water pumps.

A bad harvest can leave a small farming family deep in **debt**.

Mr X himself says the new wheat only gives the world more time.

His work in Africa from 1986 reaches only a few countries.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A 1970s South Asian wheat field split between lush green irrigated crop on one side and dry cracked bare earth on the other, a simple diesel water pump with a rubber hose at the edge of the field, a South Asian farmer in plain cotton clothing seen from behind adjusting the pump.

New wheat needs much more water and fertilizer than the old kind did.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ M. S. Swaminathan
- ☐ Yuan Longping
- ☐ Fritz Haber
- ☒ **Norman Borlaug**

Grade 12

science

BACK

Answer: Norman Borlaug

fertilizer: plant food added to soil to help crops grow

pesticides: chemicals used to kill insects that harm crops

debt: money that a person owes and must pay back

wells: deep holes dug to reach water under the ground

Picture in production

Picture brief: A deep, hand-dug stone well seen from above looking down into darkness, a rope and a plain wooden bucket hanging just above the visible water line far below, dry cracked earth around the rim.

In some places, the water deep underground slowly drops.

FRONT

Historians still debate the true **legacy** of Mr X's short, strong wheat.

Supporters say his wheat saves hundreds of millions of people from famine.

Critics such as Vandana Shiva say the new farming harms small farmers and the environment.

She says hunger comes from unfair sharing of food, not from too little grain.

Another **scholar** notes that big landowners often gain more than small farmers do.

Some historians ask if the feared famine would really have come without his wheat.

Harvest records and government **statistics** show that the **yield** rose sharply.

Interviews with farmers reveal costs that official numbers do not always show.

In Africa today, many small farmers still use little fertilizer and their own saved seed.

Researchers still argue about the right path for farming in Africa.

Some want new seeds and fertilizer, others want many crops and local knowledge.

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a Punjab village in the 1980s, a researcher in plain modern cotton clothing, seen from behind, sits under a large shade tree and listens to a group of South Asian farmers in plain cotton kurtas and turbans, closed notebooks resting on the ground, mud-brick houses and a wheat field behind, warm afternoon light.

Researchers listen to farmers to learn what the numbers do not show.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Wangari Maathai
- ☒ **Norman Borlaug**
- ☐ Yuan Longping
- ☐ George Washington Carver

University

science

BACK

Answer: Norman Borlaug

legacy: the lasting effect of a person's work after they are gone

statistics: numbers collected to study facts, like harvests or people

yield: the amount of crop a field produces

scholar: a person who studies a subject deeply, often at a university

Picture in production

Picture brief: A modest crop research plot on a small farm in a dry East African landscape today, low rows of young maize and bean plants growing in reddish soil, a Black African farmer in plain cotton work clothes seen from behind kneeling to examine a row of plants, distant hills under a wide open sky.

In Africa, farmers and researchers still test what works best on small farms.

FRONT

Trade X lasts for hundreds of years, from the 1500s to the 1800s.

Ships sail from Europe to Africa, then across the ocean.

They carry people away from their homes in Africa.

Nobody asks these people if they want to go.

The long journey across the ocean takes many hard weeks.

On the other side, new **owners** force people to work.

These **enslaved** workers **labor** on farms far away, without any pay.

Owners often **separate** husbands, wives, and children.

Many families never see each other again.

Some of the enslaved people fight back, run away, or buy their freedom.

Slowly, more and more people say that this is wrong.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A tall grey stone fort stands on a rocky point of the West African coast in the late 1700s, its cannons facing the sea. Several three-masted sailing ships are anchored in the calm bay beyond, seen from a distance, with small rowing boats moving between the ships and the shore.

A stone fort guards the coast where ships wait at anchor.

Which trade is Trade X?

- ☐ The Silk Road trade
- ☒ **The transatlantic slave trade**
- ☐ The spice trade
- ☐ The fur trade

Grade 6

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The transatlantic slave trade

enslaved: forced to work without any pay, and owned by another person

owners: people who have control over another person or thing

separate: to keep people or things apart from each other

labor: to do hard, tiring physical work

Picture in production

Picture brief: A wide stone doorway is set into a thick fortress wall, framing an empty view of the open sea beyond. The stone floor and walls are bare and weathered, and nobody stands in the doorway.

An empty stone doorway once opened onto ships waiting on the sea.

FRONT

The usual picture of Trade X shows three steps across the ocean.

First, ships carry goods from Europe to the coast of Africa.

There, **merchants** exchange these goods for **captives**.

Second, ships carry these captives across the ocean to the Americas.

Third, ships carry sugar, tobacco, and cotton back to Europe.

Portugal starts this trade before any other European country.

Brazil later receives more people than any other place.

Sugar islands in the Caribbean receive the next largest number.

Only a small **share** of people go to the future United States.

Some African kings and merchants sell captives for goods and guns.

In 1526, King Afonso of Kongo writes to the king of Portugal.

His letters **protest** that traders carry away his own people.

Picture in production

Picture brief: At a wooden river landing in West Africa in the 1600s, Black West African merchants in patterned woven cloth and white European traders in plain coats and hats stand near stacked bundles of cloth, bars of metal, and strings of beads, a wide brown river and dense forest behind them.

Traders meet at a river landing and exchange goods brought from far away.

Which trade is Trade X?

- ☐ The trans-Saharan trade
- ☐ The Indian Ocean trade
- ☒ **The transatlantic slave trade**
- ☐ The opium trade

Grade 9

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The transatlantic slave trade

merchants: people who buy and sell goods, often over long distances

captives: people who are caught and held by force

protest: to say strongly that something is wrong

share: a part of a total amount

Picture in production

Picture brief: Rows of tall green sugar cane stretch across a Caribbean plantation field under a bright sky, seen from a respectful distance, with a few Black workers in plain period clothing moving between the rows far in the background. Supports the idea of the goods ships carry back to Europe.

Sugar cane fields like these send their harvest across the ocean to Europe.

FRONT

Trade X faces resistance at almost every stage.

Historians count **revolts** on about one voyage in ten.

Captives on board sometimes fight the crew, or refuse food.

On land, some enslaved people manage to **escape** into forests or mountains.

These escaped people build their own free **communities**, far from any plantation.

In 1789, a formerly enslaved man named Olaudah Equiano **publishes** his own life story.

His book describes the voyage and moves many readers in Britain.

It becomes an important tool in the growing fight to end Trade X.

In 1791, a successful revolt begins on a Caribbean island.

Within years, the people there win their freedom by force.

Their new state is the first in the Americas founded by formerly enslaved people.

Picture in production

Picture brief: High in green forested mountains, a small cluster of simple huts stands hidden among the trees, built by a community of escaped people. A few Black residents in plain worn 1700s clothing tend a small garden plot and stand watch at the tree line, seen from a respectful distance.

High in the mountains, escaped people build a free community of their own.

Which trade is Trade X?

☒ **The transatlantic slave trade**

☐ The sugar trade

☐ The Hanseatic trade

☐ The spice trade

Grade 12

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The transatlantic slave trade

revolts: times when people rise up together and fight against those in power

escape: to get away from a place where a person is held or forced to stay

communities: groups of people who live together and support each other

publishes: prepares and puts out a book for people to read

Picture in production

Picture brief: On a small wooden writing desk lit by a single candle, a closed plain leather-bound book rests beside an inkwell and a quill pen, its cover unmarked.

A closed book like this one carries a life story across the ocean to new readers.

FRONT

Trade X ends slowly, country by country, over many **decades**.

In 1781, the crew of a ship named the Zong forces more than a hundred sick captives into the sea.

The owners then ask for **insurance** money for the people the crew killed.

News of the case shocks many people in Britain.

In 1807, Britain bans its ships from carrying captives across the ocean.

The United States bans new captives from entering the country the next year.

Yet slavery itself continues in many places for decades more.

In 1833, Britain passes a law to end slavery in its colonies.

Slavery there ends in 1834, but freed people must work for their old owners for four more years.

In 1865, the United States ends slavery after a long **civil war**.

Brazil is the last country in the Americas to end slavery, in 1888.

Each new law leaves behind new **struggles** for equal rights.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A dark-hulled sailing ship with a pale band along its gunports, a wooden naval vessel of the early 1800s, patrols close to a tropical coastline, its sails full in a strong wind, sailors in period uniforms, some of them Black African, visible on deck at a distance.

Naval ships begin to patrol the coast, stopping ships that still carry captives.

Which trade is Trade X?

- ☐ The trans-Saharan trade
- ☐ The fur trade
- ☐ The Indian Ocean trade
- ☒ **The transatlantic slave trade**

Grade 12

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The transatlantic slave trade

insurance: money paid to cover the loss of something, like a ship or its cargo

decades: periods of ten years

civil war: a war fought between groups within one country

struggles: hard and long efforts to achieve something difficult

Picture in production

Picture brief: Seen from the back of the room, rows of empty wooden benches face a raised judge's bench and an empty witness stand inside a plain 1780s London courtroom, tall windows letting in grey daylight, a stack of closed papers resting on a table.

A court in London later hears the shocking case of a ship named the Zong.

FRONT

Historians now study Trade X using a huge digital **database**.

It combines records from thousands of individual voyages across centuries.

Historians count about twelve and a half million people taken aboard, and about ten and a half million who reached land.

The records show that ships from Portugal and Brazil carry the most people, and over the longest time.

Many of these ships sail straight between Brazil and Angola and back, not in three steps.

The trade also leaves a lasting legacy across the modern world.

Millions of **descendants** of transported Africans now live across the Americas.

Together, they form what people often call the African **diaspora**.

Historians also trace some modern racist ideas back to old writings that once excused Trade X.

Today, memorial sites and museums mark old ports and departure points.

Some people now call for **repair**, meaning action or payment for the past harm.

Historians and governments still disagree about whether, and how, to do this.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Inside a quiet research archive, tall wooden shelves hold rows of closed ships' logbooks with plain blank spines, while a historian in modern clothing, seen from behind, walks down the aisle carrying one closed logbook toward a bare reading table with a lamp.

Historians now study thousands of old voyages, kept together in one great archive.

Which trade is Trade X?

- ☐ The Silk Road trade
- ☒ **The transatlantic slave trade**
- ☐ The opium trade
- ☐ The Hanseatic trade

University

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The transatlantic slave trade

database: a large, organized collection of information stored for research

descendants: people related to people who lived long before them

diaspora: a large group of people who now live spread far from their original homeland

repair: here, an action or payment meant to make up for a past wrong

Picture in production

Picture brief: On a quiet stretch of coastline, a plain smooth stone monument stands facing the sea, its surface bare of any inscription, with a small mixed group of Black and white visitors in modern clothing standing respectfully at a distance.

Today, quiet memorials like this one stand at old ports around the ocean.

FRONT

King X lives in West Africa, about seven hundred years ago.

His land lies next to a great river.

In the south, people wash gold dust out of river sand.

In the north, workers cut blocks of salt out of the **desert** ground.

Traders carry salt south and gold north on **camels**.

King X takes a **share** of all this trade.

This makes him very rich.

He rules many towns along the river.

People call his kingdom Mali.

Later, he makes a famous journey to a **holy** city far away.

Picture in production

Picture brief: At the edge of a wide brown river in fourteenth-century West Africa, Black West African men and women in plain 1300s cotton wraps wash gold dust from river gravel in shallow wooden bowls, seen from behind and at a distance so no faces are visible; a mud-brick town with a wooden-beamed wall stands far in the background under golden light.

By a great river, people wash gold out of the sand.

Who is King X?

☒ **Mansa Musa**

☐ Sundiata Keita

☐ Shaka Zulu

☐ Osei Tutu

Grade 6

Africa

BACK

Answer: Mansa Musa

desert: a very hot, dry land with much sand and little water

camels: big desert animals that can carry heavy loads for many days

share: a part of a total amount

holy: very special and important in a religion

Picture in production

Picture brief: A market in a mud-brick town by the river in the 1300s: Black West African traders in plain cotton robes and indigo-blue wraps, seen from behind, sit beside piles of folded white and indigo cotton cloth, baskets of grain, and a few pale blocks of salt laid on woven mats.

Traders sell salt, cloth, and grain in a town by the river.

FRONT

King X rules an **empire** in West Africa that grows rich from gold and salt.

King X is a Muslim.

Muslims believe every follower who is able should visit the holy city of Mecca once in life.

In the year 1324, he leaves his empire for this great journey.

Stories say his **caravan** has many thousands of people.

Stories say it carries **tons** of gold.

Stories say he gives gold to poor people along the road.

On the way, he stops in the city of Cairo.

About ten years later, a **scholar** in Cairo writes about the visit.

He says King X gave away so much gold that its price fell for years.

The whole journey takes more than a year.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A vast desert caravan in the fourteenth century seen from a high dune at dawn: dozens of camels with simple rope harnesses in a long single file cross golden sand toward the horizon, tiny figures of Black West African and North African travelers in cotton robes and turbans walking beside them, far too small and distant for any face to be seen.

A huge caravan crosses the desert on a long journey.

Who is King X?

- ☒ **Mansa Musa**
- ☐ Sonni Ali
- ☐ Ezana of Aksum
- ☐ Idris Alooma

Grade 9

Africa

BACK

Answer: Mansa Musa

empire: a large group of lands and peoples ruled by one king or queen

caravan: a group of people and animals that travel together

tons: a huge amount of weight, many hundreds of kilograms

scholar: a person who studies and knows very much

Picture in production

Picture brief: A brown-skinned Egyptian scholar in a plain 1300s turban and robe sits cross-legged on a low bench in a shaded courtyard in old Cairo, listening to two men of Cairo in plain 1300s Egyptian robes and turbans, a closed book and a reed pen resting on the low desk beside him, all faces turned away or in shadow, sandstone walls and an arched doorway behind.

A scholar in Cairo asks people what they saw, then writes it down.

FRONT

King X returns home from his great journey in the year 1325.

He does not come home with only gold.

He brings home **scholars** and judges.

He also brings a builder from Granada in Spain, whom he meets on the journey.

Stories say this builder plans a new **mosque** of mud and wood for him.

Workers finish the mosque in the city of Timbuktu in 1327.

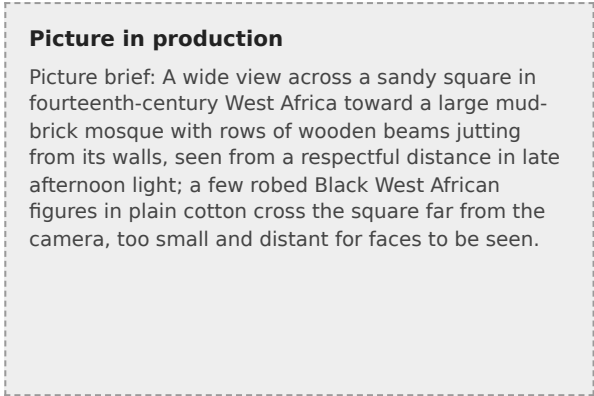
In the 1300s, Timbuktu begins to grow into a center of study and books.

Students travel there from far away to learn law and science.

Scribes copy **manuscripts** by hand, page after page.

Many of these old manuscripts still exist today.

Families in Timbuktu still keep some of them safe in their homes.



A great mud mosque rises in a city known for learning.

Who is King X?

- ☒ **Mansa Musa**
- ☐ Askia Muhammad
- ☐ Mutota
- ☐ Sundiata Keita

BACK

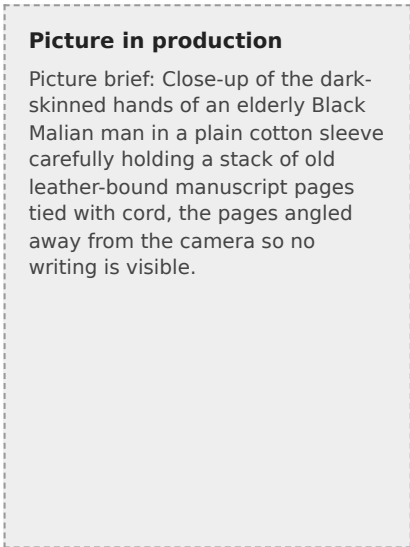
Answer: Mansa Musa

scholars: people who study and know very much

mosque: a building where Muslims pray

scribes: people whose job is to copy books and letters by hand

manuscripts: old books or papers written by hand



Old handwritten pages are still kept safe today.

FRONT

Two **generations** before King X, a ruler founds a new empire in West Africa.

That empire grows strong from trade in gold and salt.

King X becomes its ruler around the year 1312.

Under him, the empire reaches its greatest size and **wealth**.

After his death, the empire stays strong for one more generation.

Then later rulers cannot keep it together.

In the 1400s, wars and weak leaders make the empire smaller.

Trade **routes** slowly move to other roads and other rulers.

A new empire named Songhai rises to the east.

Songhai even takes the city of learning that King X once made part of his empire.

Historians study old cities and old writings to understand this long story.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A wide dusk view of a great river in fourteenth- to fifteenth-century West Africa with a few plain wooden dugout canoes without motors or paint on the water and a stretch of quiet, weathered mud-brick walls along the bank, tall grass growing through old paving stones, no people in the foreground.

Empires rise by the great river, and empires fall.

Who is King X?

☒ **Mansa Musa**

☐ Idris Aloomaa

☐ Osei Tutu

☐ Sonni Ali

Grade 12

Africa

BACK

Answer: Mansa Musa

generations: groups of people born around the same time, one after another

wealth: having a lot of money or valuable things

routes: roads or paths that people travel again and again

historians: people who study the past to understand what happened

Picture in production

Picture brief: A single old caravan trail crossing cracked, dry earth into the far distance, with faint old camel footprints and no travelers anywhere on it, as it might have looked in the 1400s.

An old trade route lies quiet and empty.

FRONT

King X dies in the 1330s.

No writing from his own kingdom in his own time survives today.

Historians must rely mostly on later writers to learn about him.

A **scholar** in Cairo writes about King X's visit about ten years after it happens.

That scholar never meets King X, so he asks people in Cairo who did.

Later writers in North Africa gather more stories about King X from many **sources**.

Scholars in Timbuktu write **chronicles** about him in the 1600s, three hundred years after his death.

In 1375, **mapmakers** in Europe draw King X on a famous map of the world.

Some people say King X is the richest man in history, but nobody can really know this.

There are no full written **records** of exactly how much gold he had.

Gold from his empire slowly travels north and becomes coins in Europe.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A still life on an old wooden writing desk in fourteenth-century Cairo: a stack of closed, worn manuscript pages, a reed pen resting beside a shallow dish of fine gold dust, and a small pile of plain unmarked gold nuggets, with a soft blurred view of distant Cairo rooftops through a narrow window behind.

Old writings and a little gold are nearly all that remain.

Who is King X?

- ☒ **Mansa Musa**
- ☐ Ezana of Aksum
- ☐ Askia Muhammad
- ☐ Mutota

University

Africa

BACK

Answer: Mansa Musa

scholar: a person who studies and knows very much

sources: old texts or things that give us information about the past

chronicles: books that tell the events of the past year by year

mapmakers: people whose job is to draw maps

records: written information that is kept and can be checked later

Picture in production

Picture brief: Close-up of a blank aged parchment sheet on a wooden drafting table of the 1370s beside a brass pair of dividers and a quill pen, the parchment left plain and textureless so no coastlines, figures, or labels can be seen.

Mapmakers far away hear of his gold and draw him on their maps.

FRONT

Place X is a string of stone towns by the sea.

The towns stand on the east coast of Africa.

Some of these towns are more than a thousand years old.

Each year, a steady wind brings ships from Arabia and India.

In Place X, **traders** sell **goods** like gold and **ivory** from the land behind them.

In return, they buy cloth, glass beads, and painted bowls.

The people of Place X speak an African language.

Over time, this language takes in many words from Arabia.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide dawn view of a stone coastal town on the East African coast around the year 1300: whitewashed coral-stone houses with flat roofs and plain wooden doors line a curving bay, three dhows with triangular lateen sails anchored in the harbor, palm trees along the shore, a few distant Black East African townspeople in plain cotton robes and head cloths walk near the water.

Ships arrive with the wind, and stone towns by the sea grow rich on trade.

Which place is Place X?

- ☐ The Gold Coast
- ☒ **The Swahili coast**
- ☐ The Horn of Africa
- ☐ The Barbary Coast

Grade 6

Africa

BACK

Answer: The Swahili coast

ivory: the hard white material from an elephant's tusk

traders: people whose job is buying and selling goods

goods: things that people buy and sell

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical scene in a market street of a stone town on the East African coast around the year 1300: a Black East African trader in a plain cotton robe and head cloth sits behind a low stall with two large elephant tusks, folded bolts of plain cloth, strings of glass beads, and a few painted clay bowls, whitewashed coral-stone walls behind, warm daylight.

A trader sells long white tusks and buys cloth and beads from across the sea.

FRONT

Place X is not one land but a row of separate towns.

They stand on the east coast of Africa.

Kilwa, Mombasa, Malindi, and the island of Zanzibar are some of these places.

Each town has its own ruler and makes its own choices.

A wind called the **monsoon** rules the sea along the whole coast.

For half the year, it blows ships in from Arabia, Persia, and India.

For the other half, the same wind blows the ships back home.

Kilwa grows rich on gold from a high **plateau** far to the south.

That gold comes north by sea from the port of Sofala.

Kilwa **strikes** its own copper coins.

Workers build a great mosque there from **coral** stone.

In the 1410s, a huge fleet from China visits this coast.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Exterior view of a large coral-stone mosque on the East African coast in the 1300s: rounded archways, a row of small domes and barrel vaults on the flat roof, thick whitewashed coral-stone walls with plain geometric carving only, no minaret, a few Black East African townspeople in plain white cotton robes and small caps walk past, palm trees and a glimpse of the sea beyond, warm daylight.

A great mosque built from coral stone rises above a rich trading town.

Which place is Place X?

- ☐ The Malabar Coast
- ☐ The Cape of Good Hope
- ☒ **The Swahili coast**
- ☐ The Red Sea coast

Grade 9

Africa

BACK

Answer: The Swahili coast

monsoon: a wind that blows one way for part of the year, then the other way

plateau: a large area of high, flat land

strikes: makes coins by stamping a design into metal

coral: a hard, stony material built by tiny sea animals, used here to build houses

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical close-up of an open Black East African hand holding a few small, thin, worn copper coins with smooth blank surfaces, a plain cotton sleeve at the wrist, a whitewashed coral-stone wall softly blurred behind, East African coast in the 1300s, soft daylight.

Small copper coins like these are made in the town itself.

FRONT

Place X is a coast in East Africa with many old stone towns.

From the 700s, the faith of Islam spreads along this coast.

Traders from Arabia and Persia settle in the towns.

Over many **generations**, local families marry these newcomers.

The people keep their own language, an African language of the coast.

Its **grammar** and everyday words come from an African language family.

Thousands of extra words come from Arabic, the language of prayer and learning.

Rich families build stone houses with heavy carved wooden doors.

Later, **poets** on the coast write long poems in this language.

Ships also carry **mangrove** poles from the creeks to build houses in Arabia.

Faith, trade, and marriage tie the towns to lands across the sea.

Yet the towns stay African in their people and their speech.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide view of a narrow street in a stone town on the East African coast around the year 1500: whitewashed coral-stone houses with flat roofs, one large heavy wooden door with simple carved geometric borders and no letters, Black East African townspeople in white cotton robes and small caps, women in plain cotton wraps and head cloths, a cat on a step, soft afternoon light.

Behind heavy carved doors, families of the coast live, pray, and trade.

Which place is Place X?

☒ The Swahili coast

☐ The Coromandel Coast

☐ The Slave Coast

☐ The Gold Coast

Grade 12

Africa

BACK

Answer: The Swahili coast

generations: all the people born and living at about the same time, one after another

grammar: the rules that show how words fit together in a language

poets: people who write poems

mangrove: a tree that grows with its roots in salty water along the shore

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a mangrove creek near a stone town on the East African coast around the year 1500: mangrove trees with arching roots stand in shallow water, a stack of straight mangrove poles lies cut and tied on the muddy bank, a small dugout canoe rests nearby, two Black East African men in plain cotton wraps load poles, morning light.

Straight poles from creeks like this are shipped across the sea to build houses.

FRONT

Place X is a coast of trading towns in East Africa.

In 1498, Portuguese ships sail along this coast for the first time.

Their captain looks for a sea **route** straight to India.

The Portuguese soon want to control the region's trade.

In 1505, Portuguese forces attack and badly damage the town of Kilwa.

For about two hundred years, Portugal holds parts of this coast by force.

In 1698, rulers from Oman drive the Portuguese out of the north.

Under Omani rule, the island of Zanzibar grows rich on a new **crop**.

Workers there grow cloves, a **spice** sold all over the world.

Most of these workers are **enslaved** people.

In the 1800s, Zanzibar also becomes a center of trade in enslaved people.

Later that century, outside **pressure** forces this trade to slowly end.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide view from the sea at dawn in the early 1500s: several late-1400s Portuguese carrack ships with tall masts and square sails approach a whitewashed coral-stone coastal town in the distance, thin smoke rises faintly above the rooftops, the water is calm, gulls fly overhead.

New ships from across the sea change the coast forever.

Which place is Place X?

- ☐ The Horn of Africa
- ☐ The Barbary Coast
- ☐ The Malabar Coast
- ☒ **The Swahili coast**

Grade 12

Africa

BACK

Answer: The Swahili coast

route: the way or path used to travel from one place to another

crop: a plant grown in large amounts for food or to sell

spice: a plant part used to give food a strong taste or smell

enslaved: forced to work and live as the property of another person

pressure: strong influence used to make someone act or change

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical scene on a clove plantation on the island of Zanzibar in the 1800s: two Black East African workers in simple cotton wraps and head cloths pick small pink clove buds from dark green clove trees into woven baskets, woven mats of buds drying in the sun nearby, warm tropical daylight.

Fresh clove buds are picked by hand and then dried in the sun before they are sold.

FRONT

Place X is a chain of old stone towns on the east coast of Africa.

For much of the twentieth century, many books called these towns "Arab colonies."

From the 1950s, **archaeologists** dig at several coastal ruins.

These first **excavators** also believe in Arab or Persian founders.

From the 1980s, new digs and new language studies change the picture.

Layer after layer, the finds show local pottery, local house plans, and local burial customs.

Pieces of Chinese **porcelain** in each layer help to date the towns.

Written **sources** are thin, and many come from outsiders passing through.

A traveler from Morocco visits Kilwa in 1331 and praises its fine buildings.

Most researchers today see African societies that welcome trade and slowly **absorb** new neighbors.

The African language of this coast, shaped by this long meeting, still lives on today.

It is the national language of Tanzania, and more than a hundred million people speak it.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide daylight scene of a present-day archaeological excavation at the weathered coral-stone ruins of an old town on the East African coast: two archaeologists, one Black East African and one white, in plain neutral work clothes and sun hats kneel and brush soil from layered pottery shards and old wall foundations, string lines mark small survey squares, crumbling coral-stone archways and low walls stand behind among ...

Archaeologists dig through old layers to test who really built these towns.

Which place is Place X?

- ☐ The Red Sea coast
- ☒ **The Swahili coast**
- ☐ The Cape of Good Hope
- ☐ The Slave Coast

University

Africa

BACK

Answer: The Swahili coast

archaeologists: scientists who study old objects and old buildings

excavators: people who dig carefully to find old things in the ground

porcelain: a fine, hard, white kind of pottery

absorb: to take something in and make it part of a bigger whole

sources: texts or objects that give historians information about the past

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a long table in a quiet present-day museum store room: a row of small earthenware pottery pieces and blue and white porcelain shards with plain leaf patterns laid out on a plain white cloth, a pair of white cotton gloves beside them, soft daylight from a window.

Pieces of pottery and porcelain from each layer help date the towns.

FRONT

Event X begins about 150 years ago.

At that time, only a few European countries hold land in Africa.

Then, within a few short **decades**, that changes fast.

Many European countries suddenly want land there too.

Leaders far away in Europe draw new lines across a huge map.

These leaders have never walked on the land they **divide**.

One single line can cut straight through one people's home.

By 1914, Europeans rule nearly the whole **continent**.

Only two countries in Africa manage to stay free.

Many of those far away lines still mark **borders** today.

Picture in production

Picture brief: On a wooden pier on an African coast in the 1880s, seen from the pier looking inland: European merchants and officials in frock coats and pith helmets talk with Black African traders and porters who carry crates and trunks, one small steam launch tied at the jetty, palm trees and low hills beyond, calm documentary mood.

Newcomers from Europe step ashore, and soon many countries want land here.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Age of Exploration
- ☒ **The Scramble for Africa**
- ☐ The Crusades
- ☐ The Opium Wars

Grade 6

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The Scramble for Africa

continent: a very large area of land, much bigger than any single country

divide: to split something into separate parts

decades: periods of ten years each

borders: the lines where one country or area ends and another begins

Picture in production

Picture brief: Close vertical view of a hand in a formal 1880s sleeve holding a wooden ruler and a dip pen, drawing a single straight ink line across a large blank sheet of paper on a dark wooden desk, an inkwell and a pair of brass dividers beside it, warm lamp light.

Far away, a hand draws a straight new line with a ruler and pen.

FRONT

Event X speeds up at a conference in Berlin in 1884.

Officials sent by many European governments sit around one long table.

No African leader sits at that table.

The officials agree on rules for **claiming** land across the continent.

A country must really control a piece of land before it can claim it.

New medicine against malaria lets outsiders survive far **inland** for the first time.

Steamboats carry soldiers and goods up rivers that used to stop them.

A new fast gun gives small forces a deadly **advantage** over larger ones.

Together, these new tools make fast **conquest** possible across the continent.

Picture in production

Picture brief: 1880s European delegates in dark frock coats and starched collars sit around a long polished conference table in a grand European hall, seen from behind so faces are not shown, papers and inkwells on the table, tall curtained windows admitting soft daylight, formal solemn mood, no African delegate present.

Officials from Europe agree on rules for taking land, without a single African at the table.

Which event is Event X?☒ **The Scramble for Africa**

☐ The Great Game

☐ The Congress of Vienna

☐ The Boer War

Grade 9

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The Scramble for Africa

conquest: taking control of a place by force

inland: away from the coast, deep inside a country

advantage: something that helps you do better than others

claim: to say that something belongs to you

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a small wooden river steamboat with a tall smoking funnel moving up a wide African river, dense green forest rising on both banks, the boat's wake rippling behind it, warm hazy daylight.

A steamboat pushes far up a river that once stopped outsiders.

FRONT

Event X is the European rush for land in Africa in the late 1800s.

It does not succeed everywhere without **resistance**.

In the mountains of the northeast, Ethiopia stays independent the whole time.

Its ruler, Menelik II, spends years buying modern rifles to prepare.

In 1896, at Adwa, his army defeats an **invading** Italian force completely.

In West Africa, a leader named Samori Touré builds his own army.

He resists the French for more than ten years.

In German East Africa, today Tanzania, people rise up together in 1905.

Colonial forces crush the **uprising**.

Historians count between seventy-five thousand and three hundred thousand dead, most of them from hunger.

In the southwest, colonial forces also wage a harsh campaign against the Herero and Nama peoples.

In 2021, Germany calls that campaign a **genocide**.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Ethiopian highland landscape at dawn, terraced hills and distant flat-topped mountains under soft golden light, a long line of Black Ethiopian soldiers in white shamma cloth and dark cloaks marches along a ridge path, seen from a distance, calm determined mood.

Ethiopian soldiers march through their mountains, ready to defend their land.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Great Game
- ☐ The Opium Wars
- ☒ **The Scramble for Africa**
- ☐ The Boer War

Grade 12

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The Scramble for Africa

resistance: fighting back against control by an outside power

invading: entering a country by force to take control of it

uprising: when many people rise up together against those in power

genocide: a planned effort to destroy a whole people

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a wide East African savanna at dusk in the 1900s, a cooking fire and a single homestead far in the distance, a Black East African woman carrying a water jar on a path in the foreground seen from behind, acacia trees and tall grass, calm everyday mood.

Evening falls over the land that today is called Tanzania.

FRONT

Event X is the European race for land in Africa in the late 1800s.

One European king gains the vast Congo in central Africa as his own private **property**.

Rubber grows there on wild vines that climb the forest trees.

The king's **agents** force local people to collect this rubber.

The people cut the vines with knives and catch the white **sap** in pots and **gourds**.

Each village must bring a set amount, or agents take **hostages** and punish the village.

Missionaries, a shipping clerk, and local witnesses gather reports and photographs.

Their reports shock people in Europe, and a campaign against the king begins.

In 1908, the king has to hand the land over to his country's government.

Many people die in those years, from violence, hunger, and disease.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A quiet clearing in dense equatorial rainforest in the Congo in the 1890s, thick wild rubber vines climbing the trunks of tall forest trees, a few vines with fresh cuts dripping white sap into a plain clay pot and a gourd at their base, a woven basket on the forest floor, a narrow dirt path leading into the deep green forest, soft hazy morning light, no people in the frame.

Deep in the rainforest, wild rubber vines are cut for their sap to feed a growing demand in Europe.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Partition of India
- ☒ **The Scramble for Africa**
- ☐ The Congress of Vienna
- ☐ The Suez Crisis

Grade 12

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The Scramble for Africa

property: something that belongs to a person

agents: people sent to act or work on behalf of someone else

sap: the liquid inside a plant

gourds: the hard, dried shells of a fruit, used as bowls or bottles

hostages: people held prisoner so that others will do what they are told

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view at the edge of a forest clearing in the Congo in the 1890s: a woven basket filled with dark lumps of raw wild rubber, two gourds and a plain clay pot beside it, a Black Congolese porter in a plain cotton wrap seen from behind walking away down a forest path with a similar basket on his shoulder, hazy green light.

Sap from the vines dries into dark lumps of rubber, carried out of the forest in baskets.

FRONT

Event X is the sudden European takeover of most of Africa in the late 1800s.

Historians still debate exactly why it happens when it does.

Some point to industrial economies in Europe hungry for raw materials and new markets.

Others stress rivalry between European powers competing for **prestige** and strategic position.

Still others point to new technology, which suddenly makes control of the interior possible.

No single explanation fully satisfies every historian.

To study it, historians read government **archives**, letters, and company account books.

They also read protest reports, missionary accounts, and oral histories preserved by **descendants**.

Sources from colonizers and from colonized peoples often tell very different stories.

Historians also debate the legacy of the drawn borders for the states that exist today.

Some scholars see mainly enduring conflict, while others stress African societies' own **resilience** and adaptation.

Picture in production

Picture brief: An empty grand conference room in a European palace of the 1880s, seen from the back of the room: a long bare polished table, heavy wooden chairs pushed back and left empty, tall curtained windows admitting pale morning light, a chandelier unlit, no people present, quiet reflective mood.

Historians ask why it all happened, and whose voices were missing from the room.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Suez Crisis
- ☐ The Partition of India
- ☒ **The Scramble for Africa**
- ☐ The Boer War

University

colonialism

BACK

Answer: The Scramble for Africa

archives: collections of old documents kept for later study

prestige: respect and importance in the eyes of others

resilience: the ability to recover and keep going after hard events

descendants: people who come after someone in later generations, such as children and grandchildren

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a single weathered iron boundary post standing in tall dry savanna grass, a faint straight line of small stones running from it toward the horizon, acacia trees scattered in the distance, warm late afternoon light.

A single iron post can mark a straight line that still divides the land today.

FRONT

Movement X grows strong in Africa after the war that ends in 1945.

Before this movement, most of Africa is ruled by **governments** in Europe.

Slowly, one country after another starts to choose its own leaders.

Each new country also chooses its own new flag.

In one single year, seventeen countries in Africa become free **states**.

People plan **parades**, and children learn new songs for their country.

Schools change too, with new maps and new words to learn.

The movement does not end there, and it takes many more years.

By the end of the **century**, almost every country in Africa rules itself.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A large crowd of Black West African men, women, and children gathers on an open field at dawn in a West African town in the late 1950s, seen from behind so no single face is shown, standing together facing a tall bare flagpole with no flag yet raised. The men wear plain shirts and trousers, the women wear long cotton dresses of the era without any pattern that could look like writing.

A crowd gathers at dawn to wait for a new flag to rise.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Indian independence movement
- ☐ The civil rights movement
- ☒ **African independence**
- ☐ The anti-apartheid movement

Grade 6

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: African independence

governments: the groups of people who rule a country or a region

parades: happy marches by many people, often with music

century: a period of one hundred years

states: countries, each with its own government

Picture in production

Picture brief: Inside a simple wooden classroom in an African town in the late 1950s, rows of plain wooden desks, Black African schoolchildren in plain cotton clothing of the era seated and seen from behind, a teacher's plain wooden desk at the front, sunlight through open wooden shutters, no board and no wall charts visible.

In school, children learn new maps and new songs for their country.

FRONT

Movement X turns **colonies** in Africa into free countries.

It gathers speed across Africa in the late 1950s.

In 1957, Ghana becomes **independent** under its new leader, Kwame Nkrumah.

It is one of the first countries in Africa to do this after the war.

A year later, Guinea says no to a new plan from its French rulers.

Guinea becomes independent alone, and French **support** stops at once.

Soon many more countries follow, in the north, west, east, and center of Africa.

In 1961, Tanganyika on the east coast becomes independent too.

Three years later, Tanganyika and the islands of Zanzibar join to form Tanzania.

In 1963, leaders from many African states meet in Addis Ababa.

There, the new free states start an **organization** to work together.

Picture in production

Picture brief: The wide stone steps of a newly built parliament house in a West African capital in 1957, a group of Black West African civil servants and new ministers in plain 1950s suits and a few in woven cotton cloth walk up the steps, all seen from behind, a few onlookers in 1950s dress at the foot of the steps, bright afternoon light.

In 1957, a new government walks up the steps to begin its work.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The labor movement
- ☒ **African independence**
- ☐ The Non-Aligned Movement
- ☐ The Arab nationalist movement

Grade 9

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: African independence

organization: a group of people or countries that work together toward a goal

support: help given to a person, a group, or a country

independent: governing itself, not ruled by another country

colonies: lands ruled and controlled by a country far away

Picture in production

Picture brief: A long meeting hall in Addis Ababa in 1963, rows of Black African delegates in the era's dark suits and a few in flowing robes seated at simple wooden desks, seen from behind and at a distance, a plain podium at the front with nothing on it, ceiling fans turning, soft daylight through tall windows.

Leaders meet in a hall to start a new organization together.

FRONT

Movement X frees the countries of Africa from European rule after 1945.

In some countries, it does not win without a fight.

In Kenya, farmers and workers who lose their best land start an **uprising** in the 1950s.

British rulers fight the uprising hard and open large camps for **suspects**.

Kenya becomes independent in 1963, after years of hard **struggle**.

In Algeria, a bitter war against French rule lasts almost eight years.

Hundreds of thousands of people die before Algeria becomes independent in 1962.

Portugal fights long wars in several of its colonies and holds on until 1974.

Then Portugal's own government changes, and it lets the colonies go in 1974 and 1975.

In the far south, most of the region is free by the 1960s and 1970s.

But one country there does not reach **majority** rule until 1994.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A misty highland landscape in Kenya at dawn in the 1950s. Rolling farmland and forest surround a distant fenced camp with simple watchtowers, seen from far away with no people visible anywhere and no fence detail visible at this distance.

During the war for land and freedom, the British hold thousands of people in camps like this.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Négritude movement
- ☐ The labor movement
- ☐ The civil rights movement
- ☒ **African independence**

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: African independence

uprising: a sudden fight by many people against their rulers

struggle: a long, hard effort against difficulty or an enemy

suspects: people who the rulers think may have done something against them

majority: more than half of a group

Picture in production

Picture brief: A stone well in a hillside village in the Algerian countryside in 1962, two North African women in plain long cotton dresses and head scarves draw water with a bucket, seen from behind, flat-roofed white houses and olive trees behind them, morning light.

After almost eight years of war, daily life in Algeria begins again.

FRONT

Movement X ends European rule over one African country after another.

This freedom brings new problems as well as new hope.

New countries inherit **borders** drawn by outsiders, which often split families and old kingdoms.

In several new countries, one political party ends up ruling alone.

In some places, army officers seize power in sudden **coups** instead.

In Congo, independence in 1960 quickly turns into a deep **crisis**.

Its first prime minister, Patrice Lumumba, is removed from power and killed within a year.

The two great powers of this time often support different sides in African conflicts.

In Tanzania, the government moves many farming families into new planned villages called **ujamaa** villages.

Its aim is to share land, schools, and health care more fairly among everyone.

In practice, some villages gain new schools and clinics, but many farmers lose **income** and choice.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A small village clinic in Tanzania in the 1970s: a Black Tanzanian nurse in a plain white cotton dress weighs a baby on a hanging scale while mothers in plain kanga cloth without any pattern that reads as text wait on a wooden bench, all seen from behind or from the side, a simple whitewashed room with an open door to bright daylight.

New clinics reach villages that never had one, but not every promise is kept.

Which movement is Movement X?☒ **African independence**

- ☐ The Arab nationalist movement
- ☐ The Non-Aligned Movement
- ☐ The Négritude movement

Grade 12

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: African independence

borders: lines that divide one country from another

coups: sudden takeovers of a government, usually by soldiers

crisis: a time of great danger or difficulty

income: the money a person or a family earns

ujamaa: a word in the language of Tanzania for living and working together as one family

Picture in production

Picture brief: A planned Tanzanian village from the 1970s, rows of simple rectangular and round mud-and-thatch houses laid out neatly along a dirt street, with one long low building serving as a school at the end of the row, seen from a distance in soft afternoon light, a few distant Black Tanzanian figures working in nearby fields with no faces visible.

Ujamaa villages aim to bring schools and clinics closer to everyone.

FRONT

Movement X turns the colonies of Africa into independent states in the decades after 1945.

Historians still debate how complete this freedom really is.

Many new states inherit an **economy** built to export **raw materials** to old rulers.

Factories, ports, and railways still mostly serve markets outside Africa.

Some historians call this pattern flag independence: new symbols, old economic ties.

Even before most countries become free, leaders from Africa and Asia meet in Bandung in 1955.

There, they agree to stand together against colonial rule.

In 1961, many of them meet again in Belgrade and agree to stay **non-aligned**.

In Tanzania, leaders choose a path that mixes **self-reliance** with foreign aid.

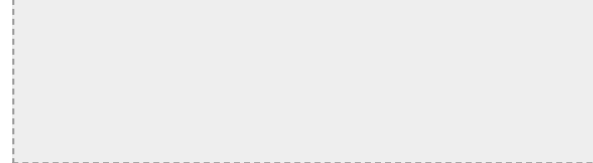
Written speeches, plans, and later interviews record why these choices are made.

Historians compare these sources with harvest records and household **survey** data from the same years.

The evidence often supports mixed conclusions, not simple praise or simple blame.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A busy African port in the 1960s, Black African dockworkers in plain shirts and shorts of the era guide a tall quay crane as it lifts a net full of wooden crates onto a large cargo ship at the quay, warehouses and a harbor town in the background, seen from a slight distance.



Ships still carry raw materials away, long after new flags are raised.

Which movement is Movement X?

- ☐ The Négritude movement
- ☐ The Pan-African movement
- ☒ **African independence**
- ☐ The anti-apartheid movement

University

twentieth century

BACK

Answer: African independence

economy: how a country makes, uses, and trades goods and money

raw materials: natural things like metals, oil, or crops before they are made into products

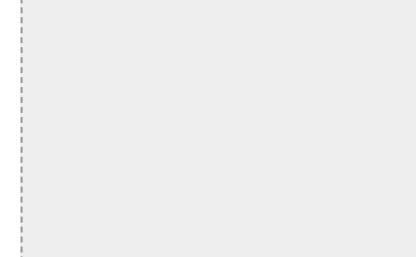
non-aligned: not joining or siding with either of two powerful groups

self-reliance: depending mainly on your own work and resources

survey: a careful study that collects information by asking or measuring

Picture in production

Picture brief: Inside a 1960s warehouse near an African port, stacked plain burlap sacks of coffee beans and bales of raw cotton without any labels, a Black African dockworker in a plain 1960s shirt and shorts seen from behind, soft daylight through a high doorway.



Coffee and cotton leave as raw goods and come back as costly products.

FRONT

Road X is not one single road.

It is many roads that connect together, like a long chain.

The roads start in a great city in China and run west.

Camels carry soft shiny cloth called **silk** from China.

The cloth comes from tiny worms that eat leaves and **spin** thread.

For a long time, only China knows this secret.

Traders bring horses, glass, and other goods back the other way.

Small towns along the roads grow rich at the desert's edge.

These **oasis** towns give travelers water, food, and a place to rest.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A long line of Bactrian camels, each with two humps, crosses a wide stony desert plain, with snow-capped mountains far in the background under a wide clear sky. Every camel carries wrapped bundles of soft cloth tied with plain rope. The camel drivers wear the felt hats and long padded coats typical of Central Asia around the Han era, walking beside their animals in warm late afternoon light.

A long line of camels carries soft cloth toward the west.

Which road is Road X?

- ☐ The Amber Road
- ☒ **The Silk Road**
- ☐ The Incense Route
- ☐ The Grand Trunk Road

Grade 6

Asia

BACK

Answer: The Silk Road

silk: a soft, shiny cloth made from very fine thread

oasis: a green, wet place with water in the middle of a dry desert

traders: people whose job is to buy and sell goods

spin: to turn something round and round to make a long thread

Picture in production

Picture brief: Inside a simple wooden tray, several pale silkworms feed on fresh green mulberry leaves, with one or two white cocoons resting beside them. Warm indoor daylight falls across the tray from one side.

Tiny worms like these eat leaves, then spin fine white thread around themselves.

FRONT

Road X grows into an important **network** around two thousand years ago.

A Chinese **envoy** named Zhang Qian travels west around 138 BC.

His long journey helps open a safer path between east and west.

Traders start their journeys in great cities like Chang'an in China.

Silk cloth passes from trader to trader, thousands of kilometers toward the west.

Along the way, traders also carry iron tools and polished bronze mirrors.

Going east, other traders bring horses, glass, wool, and gold.

Rich cities like Samarkand and Bukhara grow along the middle of the roads.

Wealthy people far away in Rome pay high prices for silk cloth.

Some Roman writers even complain that silk costs the **empire** too much gold.

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a busy oasis market city, Central Asian merchants in long coats and felt hats and Han-era Chinese traders in silk robes stand near stacked bales of cloth, small clay jars, and coils of rope, with resting Bactrian camels nearby and low mud-brick buildings behind them under a bright midday sun.

Merchants from east and west meet in a busy market town along the way.

Which road is Road X?

- ☒ **The Silk Road**
- ☐ The Tea Horse Road
- ☐ The Royal Road
- ☐ The trans-Saharan trade route

Grade 9

Asia

BACK

Answer: The Silk Road

envoy: a person sent by a ruler to speak or travel on official business

network: a set of roads or paths that connect and cross each other

empire: many lands and peoples ruled by one government

wealthy: having a lot of money or valuable things

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a shaded Roman market stall, a wealthy Roman woman in a fine draped gown examines a length of smooth, shimmering cloth held up by a merchant, other folded cloth resting on a wooden table beside them.

Far away in Rome, wealthy buyers pay a high price for this fine cloth.

FRONT

Silk and other goods travel along Road X, but ideas travel too.

Buddhism spreads from India into China along these very roads.

Monks carry **sacred** texts and teachings together with merchant caravans.

Going the other way, the skill of making paper slowly travels west.

A story says Chinese paper makers are captured after a battle far west of China.

Through Samarkand, the new skill of papermaking finally reaches the wider world.

Deep in the desert near Dunhuang, monks **carve** hundreds of caves into a cliff.

Inside, painters cover the walls with colorful scenes for many centuries.

One sealed cave, full of old **manuscripts**, stays hidden and forgotten for about nine hundred years.

A caretaker and his workers open this hidden cave again in the year 1900.

From 1907, **scholars** from Europe buy thousands of the manuscripts and take them away, and the rest go to Beijing in 1910.



Monks walk toward caves carved into a distant desert cliff.

Which road is Road X?

- ☐
The Spice Route
- ☐
The King's Highway
- ☐
The Amber Road
- ☒
The Silk Road

BACK

Answer: The Silk Road

sacred: seen as holy and treated with great respect

manuscripts: old books or texts written by hand

scholars: people who study and learn a subject very deeply

carve: to cut shapes into stone, wood, or rock



Old rolled manuscripts like these stay hidden in a sealed cave for centuries.

FRONT

In the 1200s, Mongol rulers take control of huge stretches of Road X.

For about a hundred years in the 1200s and 1300s, one family of rulers keeps the whole road safe.

Under their strong rule, **merchants** carry silk, paper, and painted pottery more safely than before.

A merchant named Marco Polo travels these roads all the way to China.

Later, he tells stories about the wonders he saw on his journey.

Many readers in Europe find his stories hard to believe.

In the 1300s, a great **plague** also travels west along these roads.

In the same years, around 1347, it spreads from Asia into the Middle East and into Europe.

The plague kills a huge share of the people it reaches.

Around the year 1500, sailors find new sea **routes** between east and west.

Slowly, ships carry more **cargo** than the old roads on land.



Under a long peace, travelers from many peoples rest safely together.

Which road is Road X?

- ☐
 The Incense Route
- ☐
 The Grand Trunk Road
- ☒
 The Silk Road
- ☐
 The Tea Horse Road

BACK

Answer: The Silk Road

merchants: people who buy and sell goods, often over long distances

cargo: goods carried by a ship, truck, or other vehicle

plague: a very serious disease that spreads fast and kills many people

routes: ways or paths that lead from one place to another



Later, ships like this one carry cargo across the sea instead of the old roads.

FRONT

Historians do not always use one single name for Road X.

For centuries, travelers and merchants speak only of separate roads and trading posts.

In 1877, a German **scholar** named Ferdinand von Richthofen **invents** a new name for the whole network.

He names the network after the most famous good carried along it, silk.

His new word links many different roads together under one single idea.

Some historians now argue that Road X was never really one road at all.

They prefer to say roads, in the **plural**, stretching across many centuries and cultures.

Others still find the single, simple name useful for teaching and writing.

Goods, ideas, diseases, and people all moved along these roads for a very long time.

Today, the same old name also has a busy political life in modern trade and **diplomacy**.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A large German university lecture hall of the 1870s seen from the back rows: students in dark frock coats and high collars sit with their backs to the camera, a lecturer in a dark coat stands far at the front behind a plain wooden lectern, tall windows and gas lamps light the room, the wall behind him bare plaster with no board or map.

In a lecture hall in Europe, a scholar gives the old roads one new name.

Which road is Road X?

- ☒ **The Silk Road**
- ☐ The Royal Road
- ☐ The Spice Route
- ☐ The King's Highway

University

Asia

BACK

Answer: The Silk Road

invents: makes up or creates something new

plural: a word form that shows there is more than one

diplomacy: careful talks between countries to solve problems peacefully

scholar: a person who studies a subject very deeply

Picture in production

Picture brief: A wooden shelf of closed leather-bound books from the 1800s, some standing with plain unlettered spines and some lying flat with their pages facing out, seen at a slight angle in warm lamp light.

Scholars write many books, and one simple name spreads through them all.

FRONT

Emperor X rules a great **empire** in India.
He lives more than two thousand years ago.
His family built this empire two generations before him.
Emperor X wants to make his empire even bigger.
He sends his army to attack a free land nearby.
The war is terrible, and many people die.
Afterward, Emperor X feels a deep, heavy **sorrow**.
He decides never to fight a war like this again.
He chooses a new way to rule.
He orders **wells** dug along the roads, for clean water.
He orders shade trees planted for tired **travelers**.
He orders care for the sick, for people and for animals too.

Picture in production

Picture brief: An empty battlefield in ancient India at dusk, broken wooden carts and scattered spears lying still on open ground, no bodies, no soldiers, seen from a distance under a heavy sky.

After a terrible war, the battlefield lies silent and empty.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Chandragupta Maurya
- ☒ **Ashoka**
- ☐ Harsha
- ☐ Kanishka

Grade 6

Asia

BACK

Answer: Ashoka

empire: a large group of lands and peoples ruled by one ruler

sorrow: a strong feeling of sadness

wells: deep holes dug into the ground to reach water

travelers: people who are on a journey, going from place to place

Picture in production

Picture brief: A stone well beneath a large banyan tree beside a dusty road in ancient India, a leather bucket resting on the well's rim, its rope still swinging; a wooden bullock cart and tiny distant travelers stand far in the background.

A stone well and a shady tree welcome tired travelers.

FRONT

Emperor X rules a great empire in India, more than two thousand years ago.

Around 261 BC, his army wins a terrible war in the land of Kalinga.

His own words, **carved** on a rock, say that a hundred thousand people die.

After this war, he turns more and more to the teaching of the Buddha.

He chooses a new way to rule, and he calls it **dhamma**, right living.

He orders his messages carved into rocks and tall stone **pillars**.

Workers place these messages across the whole empire, often beside busy roads.

The messages tell people to respect their parents, their teachers, and their servants.

Special officers of dhamma travel out to explain the messages.

In many **regions**, people hear his words read aloud in their own language.

In the far northwest, some messages are even carved in Greek.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A large flat-faced grey boulder beside an ancient dirt road in India, its surface showing fresh, shallow carved marks seen at a steep angle in low raking light so that nothing can be read; a brown-skinned South Asian worker kneels close to the stone, only his hands and a small iron chisel visible, his face out of frame.

A worker cuts the emperor's new words into solid rock.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Samudragupta
- ☐ Chandragupta II
- ☒ **Ashoka**
- ☐ Rajaraja Chola

Grade 9

Asia

BACK

Answer: Ashoka

dhamma: the emperor's own word for right living and good behavior

carved: cut deep marks into something hard, like stone

pillars: tall, strong stone posts that stand alone

regions: parts of a country or a large area of land

Picture in production

Picture brief: Brown-skinned South Asian workers in plain cotton dhotis raise a tall polished sandstone pillar with thick ropes, a wooden scaffold and two oxen beside a dusty road in third-century BC India, seen from a distance, faces turned away, the pillar's top plain and rounded.

Workers raise a tall stone pillar beside the road.

FRONT

More than two thousand years ago, Emperor X rules a great empire in India.

His new ideas are carved on rocks and pillars for all to read.

One message says: respect people of every **faith**, not only your own.

Another message **protects** animals: many kinds of animals may not be killed.

He says his own kitchen once killed many animals every day, and now only two peacocks and one deer.

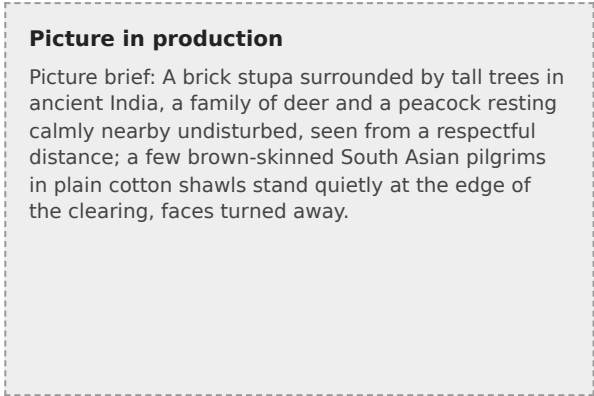
Emperor X also sends **messengers** to rulers in distant lands, far beyond his own empire.

They carry his ideas about kindness and right living.

Tradition says that his own son and daughter carry the Buddha's teaching to Sri Lanka.

There, **tradition** says, people welcome the new teaching warmly.

Through messages and messengers, one ruler's change of heart reaches far beyond his own land.



Near a quiet holy place, animals rest undisturbed and people gather in peace.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Krishnadevaraya
- ☐ Akbar
- ☒ **Ashoka**
- ☐ Harsha

Grade 12

Asia

BACK

Answer: Ashoka

faith: a religion, or a strong belief in something

messengers: people sent to carry news or messages to others

tradition: an old story or custom, passed on for a long time

protects: keeps something safe from harm



A messenger carries the emperor's words to a faraway ruler.

FRONT

Emperor X's own words are carved in stone across a great empire in India.

For more than two thousand years, people forget who wrote them.

Over the **centuries**, even the old **script** itself is forgotten, and nobody can read it.

The rocks and pillars stand quiet, their meaning unknown.

In 1837, a British **official** in India reads the script again.

His name is James Prinsep, and he works it out slowly, letter by letter.

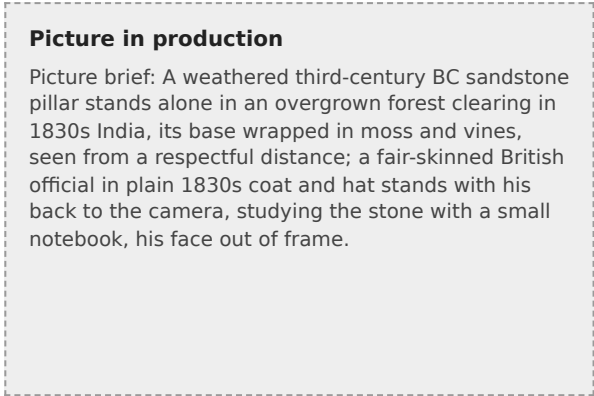
Suddenly, the emperor's own words speak again, after so long.

Soon, with help from old **chronicles** of Sri Lanka, historians can put a name to the ruler behind the **inscriptions**.

Today, a wheel from one of his stone pillars sits on India's flag.

Grade 12

Asia



Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Chandragupta Maurya
- ☐ Kanishka
- ☐ Samudragupta
- ☒ Ashoka

BACK

Answer: Ashoka

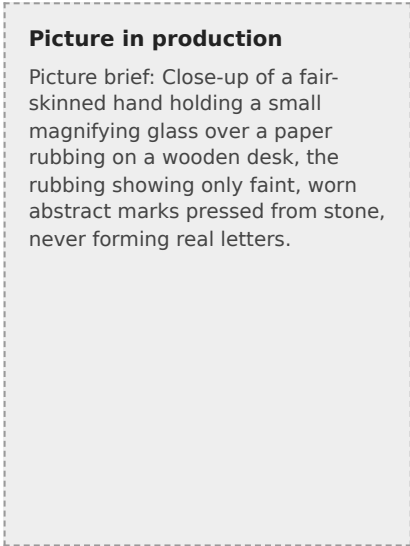
official: a person who does an important job for a government

script: a system of signs or letters used for writing

inscriptions: words cut into stone or metal

chronicles: old books that record events year by year

centuries: periods of one hundred years each



A magnifying glass helps a visitor study old, worn marks from stone.

FRONT

Emperor X rules a great empire in India from his capital, Pataliputra.

He leaves us two very different kinds of sources.

First, his own **edicts**, carved in his own lifetime on rocks and pillars.

These edicts tell us what he wants his people to believe about him.

Second, later Buddhist writers tell stories about him, centuries after his death.

These stories often praise him and make him sound like a perfect ruler.

Historians ask a hard question: is this history, or is it **propaganda**?

Perhaps the truth lies somewhere between real **conviction** and clever image-making.

Either way, his edicts are among the oldest **deciphered** writing from India.

In modern India, some movements use his image of non-violence as a model.

Every old source hides a second question: who wrote this, and what did he want?

Picture in production

Picture brief: On an old wooden library table, a fragment of grey sandstone with faint, unreadable third-century BC carved lines lies beside a bound palm-leaf manuscript tied with string, clearly much newer than the stone; a brown-skinned South Asian scholar's hand rests between the two objects, pointing from one to the other, face out of frame.

An old stone and a newer manuscript tell two different kinds of stories.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Rajaraja Chola
- ☒ **Ashoka**
- ☐ Krishnadevaraya
- ☐ Chandragupta II

University

Asia

BACK

Answer: Ashoka

edicts: official orders or rules announced by a ruler

propaganda: pictures, words, and art that try to control what people think

conviction: a strong, honest belief

deciphered: worked out the meaning of a difficult or secret writing system

Picture in production

Picture brief: Extreme close-up of a plain ancient silver coin with only small punched symbols such as a sun, hills and simple shapes, and no script, resting on a dark cloth beside a small magnifying glass.

A plain old coin is also a kind of source from the past.

FRONT

Admiral X is born about six hundred years ago in southwest China.

His home is in the mountains, in a region called Yunnan.

Soldiers take him away when he is a boy.

He is sent to serve at a prince's court.

He grows up clever and tall, and the prince trusts him.

Later, this prince becomes **emperor** and gives him a huge job.

Admiral X commands a **fleet** of huge wooden ships.

They are among the biggest ever built, records say.

The fleet sails to India, Arabia, and the coast of East Africa.

It gives away silk and **porcelain** from China.

It brings home spices, jewels, **incense**, **ivory**, and rare animals.

One gift amazes everyone: a tall animal with a very long neck.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A vast fleet of towering early fifteenth-century Chinese treasure ships, wooden junks with tall masts and battened sails, rides at anchor in a calm harbor bay at dawn, seen from a distant hillside, with dozens of small fishing boats scattered near the shore for scale.

Giant ships wait in a quiet bay at dawn, ready to sail far away.

Who is Admiral X?

- ☐
 Marco Polo
- ☐
 Christopher Columbus
- ☒
 Zheng He
- ☐
 Ferdinand Magellan

Grade 6

Asia

BACK

Answer: Zheng He

fleet: a large group of ships that travel together

emperor: a powerful ruler of a whole country, like ancient China

porcelain: a hard, thin, white type of pottery

incense: a material that gives a sweet smell when it is burned

ivory: the hard white material from an elephant's tusk

Picture in production

Picture brief: A tall, long-necked spotted animal stands calmly in a spacious stone palace courtyard, watched from a respectful distance by a small group of Ming court officials in fine silk robes and tall black hats.

A wonderful animal reaches the palace, and everyone wonders what it is.

FRONT

Admiral X leads seven great sea journeys between 1405 and 1433.

Each time, he sails from China with a huge fleet of wooden ships.

Records of the time say the biggest fleets have more than sixty large ships.

They carry about twenty-seven thousand men.

The ships carry soldiers, sailors, doctors, **translators**, and even **astrologers**.

The fleet sails south through the seas of Southeast Asia, then west across the Indian Ocean.

It reaches busy ports in India, where merchants trade pepper and cotton cloth.

From there, some ships sail on to Arabia and the Persian Gulf.

Other ships follow the coast of East Africa, stopping at towns that trade in gold and **ivory**.

At every port, Admiral X offers gifts of silk and **porcelain** in the emperor's name.

In return, local rulers send gifts back to China, including precious stones and rare woods.

The emperor wants respect and trade, not new land to rule.

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a bustling harbor market on the coast of southern India, South Indian merchants in period dress trade baskets of pepper and bolts of cotton cloth at open stalls, while in the background, far off the shore, a row of tall Chinese treasure ships rides at anchor. A robed Chinese official is seen only from behind in the foreground, overseeing the exchange of gifts.

Merchants trade in a busy port, while tall ships from far away wait offshore.

Who is Admiral X?

- ☐ Vasco da Gama
- ☒ **Zheng He**
- ☐ Xu Fu
- ☐ Ibn Battuta

BACK

Answer: Zheng He

translators: people whose job is to turn words from one language into another

astrologers: people who study the stars and believe they can predict the future

ivory: the hard white material from an elephant's tusk

porcelain: a hard, thin, white type of pottery

Picture in production

Picture brief: On the broad wooden deck of a large early fifteenth-century Chinese ship anchored off the coast of East Africa, a Chinese sailor in a plain cotton robe and a Black East African trader in a period cloth wrap weigh two elephant tusks on a plain wooden balance scale, both seen from behind, the coral-stone town small on the shore beyond.

Ivory from the coast of East Africa is weighed before it sails to China.

FRONT

Admiral X serves a new emperor who takes the **throne** in China in 1402, after years of civil war. The emperor wants the world to know China's power and wealth.

A later history says he also wants ships watching the seas, in case a **rival** is hiding abroad.

This rival is the emperor's own nephew, whom he had pushed from the throne.

He chooses Admiral X to lead great fleets across the seas to the west.

Most ports welcome the fleet with gifts and open markets.

On the way home from the first journey, in 1407, the fleet defeats a large **pirate** fleet near Sumatra. Traders in those seas can now sail more safely.

But in 1411, on the island of Sri Lanka, a local ruler turns against the sailors.

Admiral X and his soldiers fight and **capture** him, then send him to the emperor's court.

A few years later, on the island of Sumatra, another local ruler attacks the fleet.

Again, Admiral X and his men fight back and defeat him.



A new emperor gives one trusted man a very large task.

Who is Admiral X?

- ☐ Faxian
- ☐ Zhang Qian
- ☐ Marco Polo
- ☒ **Zheng He**

Grade 12 Asia

BACK

Answer: Zheng He

throne: the special chair, and the power, of a king or emperor

rival: a person who competes against you for power or a prize

capture: to catch and hold a person as a prisoner

pirate: a person who attacks and robs ships at sea



A defeated local ruler is taken aboard a ship, bound for a distant court.

FRONT

Admiral X leads his last great **voyage** in the early 1430s.

By then, the emperor who first sent him to sea has been dead for years.

New emperors sit on the throne, and their **scholar-officials** advise them.

These officials write and pass the hardest exams in the empire, and they run the government.

They see the huge fleets as very **costly** and of little real use to the empire.

Grain for the capital and soldiers for the northern border, they argue, matter more than gifts from faraway lands.

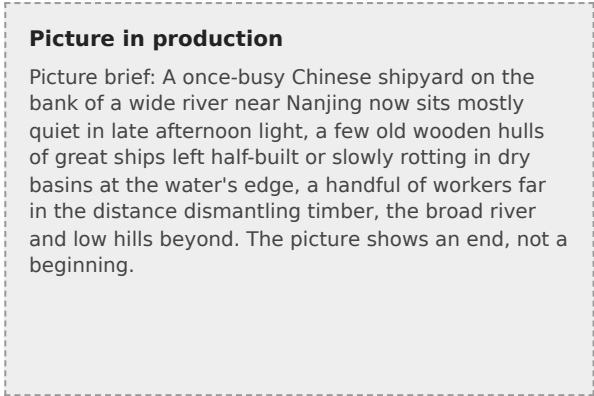
Some records of the voyages are later lost or destroyed at court.

After Admiral X, no more giant fleets sail from China again.

Later, new laws limit the size of ships allowed to leave the coast.

Admiral X himself dies around 1433, perhaps far from home on the last voyage.

A tradition says his clothes and cap lie in the grave in Nanjing.



A shipyard that once built giants now falls quiet.

Who is Admiral X?

- ☒ Zheng He
- ☐ Yi Sun-sin
- ☐ Vasco da Gama
- ☐ Christopher Columbus

BACK

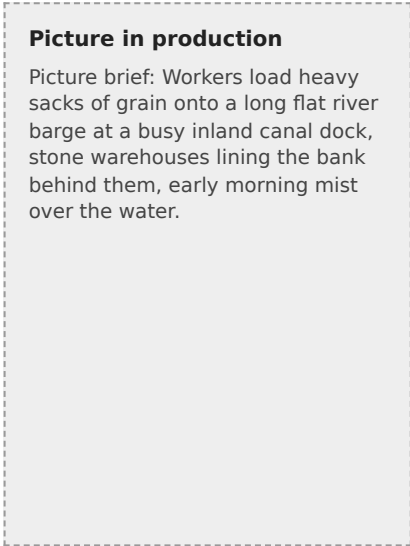
Answer: Zheng He

scholar-officials: highly educated men who pass hard exams and run the government

grain: seeds of wheat, rice, or corn used as food

costly: expensive, costing a great deal of money

voyage: a long journey by sea



Grain moving along the canals matters more to the court than ships at sea.

FRONT

Historians study Admiral X using several kinds of old sources.

Ming government records list the fleets, their captains, and their routes.

A few men who sail with the fleet later write down what they see.

A stone at his father's grave says that his family follows Islam.

Stone **tablets** from some ports also record the fleet's visits.

These sources do not fully agree on the size of the biggest ships.

Some old records say the biggest ships were as long as a football field, but many historians doubt it.

Wood and **engineering** of that time, they argue, make ships that huge hard to sail safely.

In 2002, a writer claims in a popular book that the fleet reaches the Americas.

Trained historians reject this claim, since it rests on no real **evidence**.

Meanwhile, China stops sending great fleets abroad, while European kingdoms start sending small ships further and further from home.

Historians still debate why the two paths **diverge** so sharply.

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a quiet modern museum research room, a historian in plain modern dress, seen from the side and slightly behind, measures a small wooden scale model of a Chinese treasure ship with a cloth measuring tape, two closed grey archive boxes lying beside the model on the table, soft daylight from a tall window.

How big were the ships, really? Historians measure and compare with care.

Who is Admiral X?

- ☐ Xu Fu
- ☐ Faxian
- ☒ **Zheng He**
- ☐ Ibn Battuta

University Asia

BACK

Answer: Zheng He

tablets: flat pieces of stone or wood with words cut or written on them

evidence: facts that help prove something is true

diverge: to separate and go in different directions

engineering: the skill of designing and building large structures like ships or bridges

Picture in production

Picture brief: A tall stone tablet on a carved stone base stands in an old harbor garden by the sea, seen from the side and slightly behind at a distance so that its carved face is turned away from the viewer, pale coastal cliffs and grey sea beyond.

Stone tablets like this one still record the fleet's visits to faraway harbors.

FRONT

Emperor X lives in China, more than two thousand years ago.

He becomes king when he is only thirteen.

His **state** is one of the strongest of the many **warring** states.

For years, these states fight each other.

Slowly, his armies win war after war.

At last, his state defeats all the others.

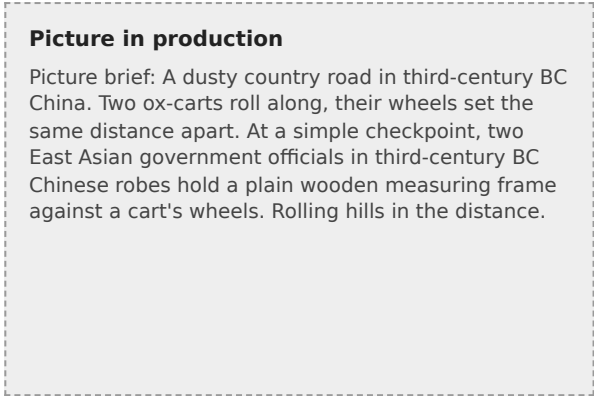
Emperor X takes a brand new **title**.

It means: the first ruler of all.

Now every part of his land uses the same writing.

Coins, **weights**, and the distance between cart wheels are the same too.

Today an army of **clay** soldiers still stands guard near his grave.



A wooden frame checks that every cart's wheels are set the same distance apart.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Kublai Khan
- ☒ **Qin Shi Huangdi**
- ☐ Han Wudi
- ☐ Liu Bang

BACK

Answer: Qin Shi Huangdi

state: a land with its own ruler and its own laws

warring: fighting wars against each other

title: a special name for a person's rank or job

weights: pieces of metal used to measure how heavy things are

clay: soft, heavy earth that can be shaped and baked hard



One official weight is used the same way, everywhere in the land.

FRONT

Emperor X rules China more than two thousand years ago.

As a young king, he has **rival** states all around him.

In 227 BC, a visitor from a rival state comes close to him.

The visitor hides a **dagger** inside a rolled map.

He tries to kill the king, but the plan fails.

Emperor X **survives**, and the wars go on.

By 221 BC, his armies defeat every rival state.

He orders new roads across his land, so armies and traders move fast.

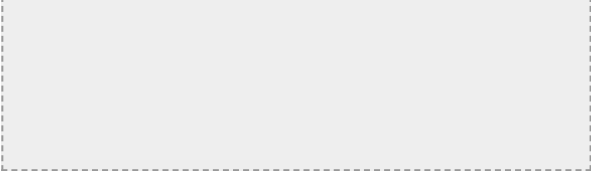
Workers dig a **canal** that joins two great river systems.

In the north, older earth walls are joined into one long wall.

This early wall is not the famous stone wall that visitors see today.

Picture in production

Picture brief: East Asian laborers in third-century BC Chinese dress build an early rammed-earth wall along a mountain ridge, carrying woven baskets of soil and packing it into wooden frames. Wide hilly landscape, small figures at a distance, no individual faces detailed.



Workers pack earth into a long wall that joins the hills together.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Tang Taizong
☐ Wu Zetian
☐ Genghis Khan
☒ **Qin Shi Huangdi**

Grade 9

Asia

BACK

Answer: Qin Shi Huangdi

dagger: a short, sharp knife used as a weapon

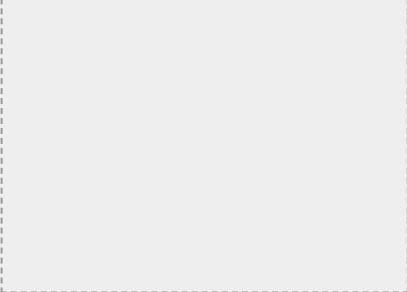
rival: a person or group that fights against you for the same thing

survives: stays alive after great danger

canal: a waterway dug by people, for boats or for water

Picture in production

Picture brief: A rolled silk map lies half unrolled on a low wooden table inside a palace hall, its far end trailing off the table, and the blade of a small dagger is just visible where the map ends. No people in the frame.



A rolled map can hide a small, sharp blade.

FRONT

Emperor X rules China with very **strict** laws.

Even small crimes bring harsh **punishment**.

His top advisor wants every **scholar** to follow one single set of ideas.

In 213 BC, the government orders many old books burned.

Books about medicine, farming, and fortune-telling stay safe.

A later historian writes that he had scholars killed who spoke against him.

Many doubt the details of this story.

As Emperor X grows older, he fears death more and more.

He sends servants to search for a medicine that stops aging forever.

No servant ever returns with such a medicine.

In 210 BC, Emperor X dies during a long journey far from his **capital**.



Officials watch as workers burn bundles of old writings.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☒ **Qin Shi Huangdi**
- ☐ Kangxi
- ☐ Yongle
- ☐ Han Wudi

Grade 12

Asia

BACK

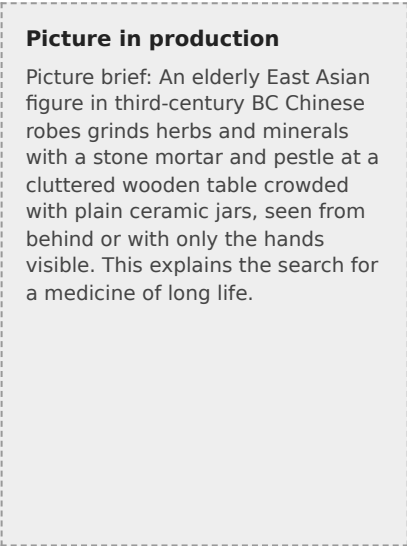
Answer: Qin Shi Huangdi

strict: very firm; rules must be obeyed

punishment: something bad that happens to you because you broke a rule

scholar: a person who studies and knows a lot about books and ideas

capital: the main city where a ruler or a government has its seat



Someone grinds herbs and minerals, searching for a medicine that stops aging.

FRONT

Near the city of Xi'an lies the **tomb** of Emperor X.

Around his tomb, workers once buried a silent army made of clay.

Thousands of clay soldiers stand in rows underground.

In 1974, farmers digging a well find the first of them.

Look closely, and no two faces are exactly alike.

Many soldiers once held real **bronze** weapons.

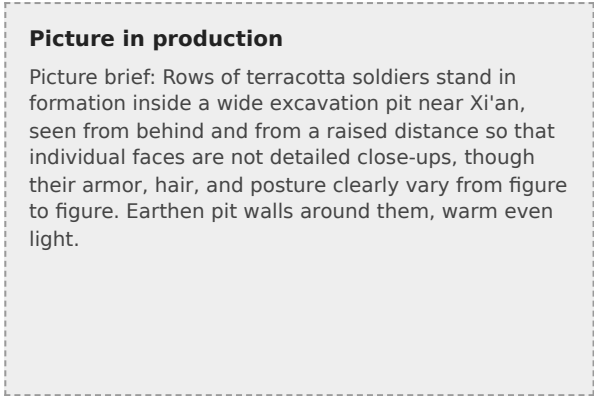
The main burial **mound** itself has never been opened.

An old historian writes that rivers of **mercury** flow inside it.

Modern soil tests near the mound show unusually high levels of mercury.

Scientists still study the ground before anyone digs any deeper.

Only a few years after the emperor's death, his whole **dynasty** falls.



Rows of clay soldiers stand underground, and the faces look different from one another.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Liu Bang
- ☐ Tang Taizong
- ☒ **Qin Shi Huangdi**
- ☐ Kublai Khan

BACK

Answer: Qin Shi Huangdi

tomb: a grave or a building that holds a dead person's body

bronze: a hard, reddish-brown metal, made by mixing copper and tin

mound: a small hill made by piling up earth

mercury: a heavy silver metal that is liquid and poisonous

dynasty: a line of rulers from the same family, one after another



A great mound of earth has never been opened.

FRONT

Emperor X joins all of China under one government more than two thousand years ago.

Was he a cruel **tyrant**, or the **founder** of a lasting nation?

Historians still argue about the answer.

Our main written source is a historian named Sima Qian.

He writes about a century after Emperor X dies, under the next dynasty.

That new dynasty gains when the old one looks bad.

Sima Qian's **account** mixes solid facts with dramatic, unproven stories.

The evidence from **archaeology** offers a second, independent voice.

Diggers, scientists, and soil samples can check the old text piece by piece.

Sometimes the buried evidence matches Sima Qian's account closely.

Sometimes it raises new doubts about details he never saw himself.

Over the centuries, the image of Emperor X has swung between monster and state-builder.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A closed, rolled bamboo-strip scroll lies on a dark wooden table beside a broken piece of ancient pottery and a small bronze arrowhead, lit by a single warm oil lamp. This contrasts the written record with physical evidence.

An old written record lies beside objects dug from the ground.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Wu Zetian
- ☒ **Qin Shi Huangdi**
- ☐ Kangxi
- ☐ Yongle

University

Asia

BACK

Answer: Qin Shi Huangdi

tyrant: a cruel ruler with total power, unfair to the people

founder: a person who starts or builds something new, like a state

archaeology: the study of the past through digging up old objects and places

account: a written report that tells what happened

Picture in production

Picture brief: A pair of bare East Asian hands gently brushes soil away from a half-buried piece of grey pottery in the ground, using a simple wooden-handled bristle brush, no face visible.

Careful hands brush away the earth from an old, buried object.

FRONT

Emperor X lives in India, about five hundred years ago.

At only thirteen years old, he becomes **ruler** of a **shaky** young kingdom in northern India.

At first, an older **guardian** named Bairam Khan rules for him.

Emperor X never learns to read or write.

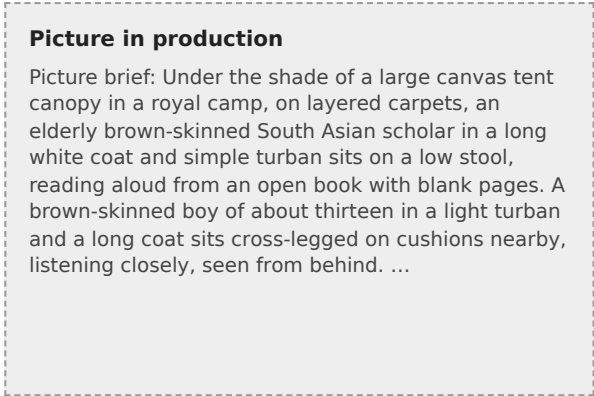
But he loves stories and ideas.

Every day, someone reads books to him out loud.

He remembers almost everything he hears.

His **library** grows to thousands of books from many lands.

He also loves elephants, and his court writers say he rides even the most dangerous ones.



A boy listens closely as a book is read aloud to him.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☒ **Akbar**
- ☐ Babur
- ☐ Krishnadevaraya
- ☐ Ashoka

BACK

Answer: Akbar

ruler: a person who is the leader of a country

shaky: not steady, in danger of falling

guardian: an adult who takes care of and protects a child

library: a big collection of books, or a room full of books



A library holds many books from many lands.

FRONT

Emperor X rules the Mughal **empire** in northern India.

Over many years, his armies win more and more land.

He also builds alliances through marriage.

He marries princesses from powerful Hindu families.

Their fathers and brothers become his loyal **allies**. In 1564, he ends an old **tax** that only non-Muslims must pay.

This wins him support from many of his people.

He also builds a brand new **capital** city.

Its walls and palaces are made of red sandstone.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A grand royal procession approaches the gate of a new red sandstone city at dusk. At the front, two elephants wear plain, pattern-free cloth covers and walk slowly side by side. Behind them, brown-skinned South Asian and Central Asian mounted guards in long coats and turbans and a closed, curtained palanquin move along a dusty road. The whole scene is viewed from a respectful distance so no face is recognisable.

A grand procession moves toward the gates of a new city.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Humayun
- ☐ Timur
- ☐ Sher Shah Suri
- ☒ **Akbar**

Grade 9

Asia

BACK

Answer: Akbar

empire: many lands and peoples ruled by one ruler

allies: people or groups who help and support each other

tax: money that people must pay to their ruler or government

capital: the main city where a ruler or government sits

Picture in production

Picture brief: In a shaded courtyard, one brown-skinned South Asian official in a long coat and turban sits cross-legged at a single low wooden table, weighing coins on a small brass balance scale, seen from behind so no face is visible; sacks of grain are stacked high behind him.

An official weighs coins and grain for the ruler's tax.

FRONT

In 1575, Emperor X builds a special hall in his red sandstone capital.

At first, only Muslim scholars argue there.

From about 1578, he also invites thinkers of other **faiths**.

Hindus, Jains, and Zoroastrians now join the talks.

From 1580, Jesuit priests from Europe join too.

They argue about God, the **soul**, and the right way to live.

Emperor X listens for hours, night after night.

Around 1582, he forms a small **circle** of trusted friends at court.

Some later writers call this circle a new religion.

Historians disagree whether this circle is a religion at all.

In the same years, his workshop paints small, detailed pictures.

Scholars there also translate old Indian **epics** into Persian.



Men of many faiths sit together and talk long into the night.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☒ Akbar
- ☐ Humayun
- ☐ Ashoka
- ☐ Krishnadevaraya

BACK

Answer: Akbar

faiths: different religions, different beliefs about God

soul: the part of a person some believe lives on after death

circle: a small, close group of people

epics: very long, old stories, often about heroes



Painters work with tiny brushes, page after page.

FRONT

Emperor X rules his empire in India with a careful system.

Officials receive **ranks**, and their rank decides their pay and duties.

A finance minister named Todar Mal reforms how land tax is measured.

His close friend, a scholar named Abu'l-Fazl, writes a long **chronicle** about his reign.

In 1568, his army takes the **fortress** of Chittor, and many defenders and townspeople are killed.

His capital of red sandstone at Fatehpur Sikri is used for only about fourteen years.

In 1585, he moves his court far to the north.

Historians are still not sure why the city is left behind.

His grandson later builds a famous white tomb, the Taj Mahal.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A weathered hill fortress of pale stone stands on a rocky rise, its high walls seen from a respectful distance across a dry valley. A scattering of plain canvas tents and cooking fires from a large camp lies below, but no battle, no bodies, and no weapons are shown in the frame, just before dawn light.

An army camps below the walls of a hill fortress.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Timur
- ☒ **Akbar**
- ☐ Jahangir
- ☐ Sher Shah Suri

Grade 12

Asia

BACK

Answer: Akbar

officials: people with a job to help run the state

rank: a level or position in an organised system

chronicle: a book that tells the story of past events

fortress: a strong building or town built for defence

Picture in production

Picture brief: An abandoned red sandstone courtyard stands quiet at sunset, tall grass growing up between the paving stones, an empty raised stone platform in the foreground, carved pillars around the edge, no people anywhere. This shows the city the court leaves behind.

Grass grows in a courtyard once busy with a whole court.

FRONT

Emperor X rules India more than four hundred years ago.

Historians still argue about how to understand him. Was his religious **tolerance** a true ideal, or mostly clever politics?

Two writers give us very different pictures of his court.

The court's official **chronicler** praises him as an almost perfect ruler.

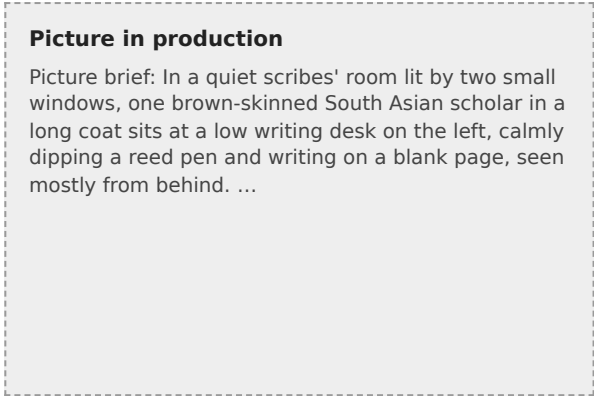
A **rival** scholar named Badauni is far more critical in his own writings.

Badauni writes in secret, and his book appears only after the emperor's death.

Badauni especially dislikes the debates about faith in the middle of the reign.

Historians must weigh both accounts carefully against each other.

In India today, people still debate his **legacy** and what it means.



Two writers, working apart, leave very different accounts of the same ruler.

Who is Emperor X?

- ☐ Aurangzeb
- ☐ Krishnadevaraya
- ☒ **Akbar**
- ☐ Timur

University

Asia

BACK

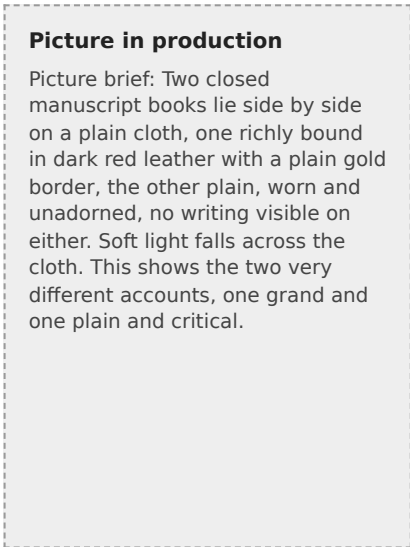
Answer: Akbar

tolerance: accepting people with different beliefs or ways of life

chronicler: a person who writes down the story of past events

rival: a person who competes against another

legacy: what a person leaves behind and is remembered for



One account is grand, the other is plain and critical.

FRONT

Event X happens in Japan, an island country in Asia.

For more than two hundred years, Japan stays closed.

Only one small **port** lets in a few **foreign** traders. Then, one day in 1853, strange black ships arrive. Thick black smoke **pours** from tall chimneys on the ships.

The ships carry powerful guns and soldiers from far away.

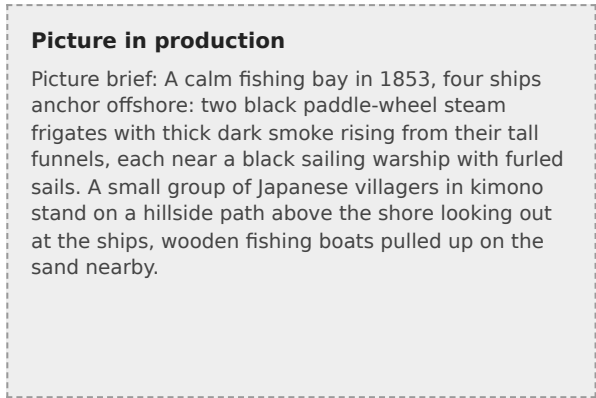
Japan's old **rulers** cannot keep the world out any longer.

Fifteen years later, power goes back to a young emperor.

He is only fifteen years old.

Very quickly, big changes sweep across the land.

Many men cut off their old **topknot** hair and try hats from the West.



One day, strange smoking ships appear in the bay, and nothing is the same again.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Opium Wars
- ☒ **The Meiji Restoration**
- ☐ The Boxer Rebellion
- ☐ The Glorious Revolution

BACK

Answer: The Meiji Restoration

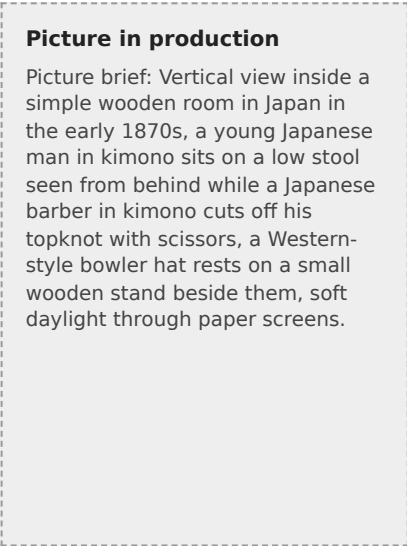
port: a town by the sea where ships load and unload

foreign: from another country

rulers: people who have the power to govern a country

pours: flows out in a thick stream

topknot: hair tied up in a knot on top of the head



Many men cut off their old topknots and try new hats from the West.

FRONT

Event X begins in Japan after centuries under military rulers called **shoguns**.

In 1854, foreign warships force the shoguns to sign a first **agreement**.

It opens two ports to American ships.

In 1858, new **treaties** open Japan to trade with several foreign powers.

These treaties favor the foreign powers, not Japan. Anger over these unfair terms splits leaders into **rival** camps.

A short civil war breaks out in 1868 and continues into 1869.

The old government falls, and a new one takes charge.

Power returns, in name, to a young emperor.

The new leaders promise in his name to seek knowledge from all over the world.

The emperor moves from Kyoto to Edo, which gets the new name Tokyo.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A formal meeting in 1854 inside a simple wooden treaty house built on the shore, a few Japanese officials in traditional court robes sit on one side of a low table, American naval officers in dark blue frock coats with epaulettes and cocked hats sit or stand on the other side, a folded blank paper document lies on the table between them, plain wooden walls and paper screens behind, soft daylight, no ships in view.

At a meeting by the shore, the country's old rulers agree to terms they did not choose.

Which event is Event X?

☒ The Meiji Restoration

☐ The Taiping Rebellion

☐ The Opium Wars

☐ The Tanzimat reforms

Grade 9

Asia

BACK

Answer: The Meiji Restoration

shoguns: military rulers who once governed the country in the emperor's name

agreement: a deal that two or more sides accept together

treaties: formal written agreements between countries

rival: competing against another group or person

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of two lines of soldiers facing each other across a misty field at dawn in 1868, both lines mostly in dark Western-style uniforms and caps with rifles at rest, a few men on each side still in traditional armor or with topknots, both lines standing still, no weapons raised, no fighting shown, distant hills behind.

Leaders who disagree about the country's path face each other on the battlefield.

FRONT

Event X reshapes Japan through a wave of new laws.

A **mission** of top officials sails abroad from 1871 to 1873.

They study schools, factories, armies and parliaments in Europe and America.

Back home, a law in 1872 promises a school for every child.

That same year, the first **railway** opens between Tokyo and Yokohama.

A law in 1873 orders young men from every class into the army.

Until then, only one warrior class carries swords and serves as soldiers.

In 1876, a new law bans that class from wearing swords in public.

Former warriors lose their old **status** and their old income.

Angry former warriors rise up in 1877, but the new army **defeats** them.

After that defeat, no one takes up arms against the new order again.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A small wooden railway station with a tiled roof in Japan in 1872, seen from the platform. Waiting passengers stand in the foreground seen from behind, most in kimono, some with paper umbrellas, a few in Western coats and bowler hats. At the far end of the platform, a small early steam locomotive with a tall chimney stands with a short line of small closed wooden carriages; ...

A new kind of engine links two cities in less than an hour.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Tanzimat reforms
- ☐ The Reform Movement of 1898
- ☒ **The Meiji Restoration**
- ☐ The Young Turk Revolution

Grade 12

Asia

BACK

Answer: The Meiji Restoration

mission: a group sent abroad with a special purpose

railway: a track with trains that carry people and goods

status: a person's rank or position in society

defeats: beats an enemy in a fight

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical close view of a single traditional sword resting alone on a plain wooden stand in a bare room, soft light from a window, a faint dust haze in the air, no hands or people in frame.

After a new law in 1876, a sword like this can no longer be worn in public.

FRONT

Event X gives Japan a new political system within a few decades.

A written **constitution** appears in 1889, granting the emperor final say.

A **parliament** opens the next year, though few citizens may vote for it.

Japan also builds a strong modern army and navy in this period.

In 1894, war breaks out against the neighboring Chinese empire.

A quick victory follows within a year, surprising observers worldwide.

A second war begins in 1904 against Russia, a much larger European empire.

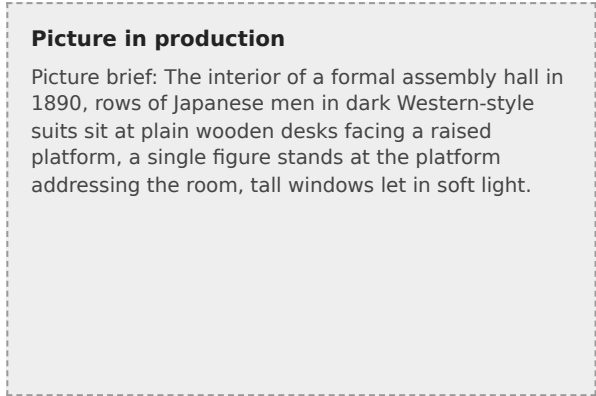
Against most **predictions**, the smaller Asian power wins that war by 1905.

By 1910, Japan has taken full control of Korea.

Ordinary peasants pay heavy new taxes to fund all this change.

Young women from poor families work long hours in new silk and cotton **mills**.

Few of them share fairly in the nation's new wealth and pride.



In this new hall, elected men gather to debate the country's laws.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The Boxer Rebellion
- ☐ The Taiping Rebellion
- ☐ The Opium Wars
- ☒ **The Meiji Restoration**

Grade 12 Asia

BACK

Answer: The Meiji Restoration

constitution: a country's basic set of laws and rules

parliament: a group of elected people who help make laws

predictions: guesses about what will happen next

mills: factories with machines that make cloth or thread



Young women like these work long hours in the new mills that help pay for change.

FRONT

Historians often call Event X in Japan a revolution carried out from above.

Unlike other revolutions, it starts among leaders, not among angry crowds.

A small group of former warriors seizes the state and rebuilds it fast.

They keep the emperor as a symbol while running the new system themselves.

Scholars still debate why this transformation succeeds so fully in Japan alone.

Some point to earlier local trade networks, **literacy** and a strong **bureaucracy**.

Others stress timing, since the great powers are busy elsewhere in those years.

Nationalists in other parts of Asia and in Africa study this example closely.

Many see it as proof that a non-Western state can stand up to the great powers of Europe.

Yet the same reforms also build the tools for later military expansion.

Within decades, the modernized army becomes a force for **conquest** abroad.

Historians therefore read the era as both an example and a warning.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A town street in the 1880s where a row of wooden telegraph poles with wires runs beside a mix of traditional wooden shopfronts and one new Western-style brick building, Japanese pedestrians in mixed dress walk past, some in kimono, others in Western coats and bowler hats, overcast daylight.

Along streets like this one, new wires and new buildings appear within a single generation.

Which event is Event X?

- ☐ The French Revolution
- ☒ **The Meiji Restoration**
- ☐ The Young Turk Revolution
- ☐ The Tanzimat reforms

University

Asia

BACK

Answer: The Meiji Restoration

bureaucracy: the officials and offices that run a state's daily business

nationalists: people who work for their nation's freedom or strength

literacy: the ability to read and write

conquest: taking control of a place by force

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a quiet archive room seen from the side, wooden shelves holding old paper-bound documents tied with cord and flat wooden boxes, a plain table with one closed old ledger, soft window light, no people.

Today, historians still study old records to understand why this change worked here.

FRONT

The X people live in the forests and hills of Central America, long ago.

Their home covers parts of Guatemala, Mexico, Belize, and Honduras.

They build tall stone pyramids among the trees.

Farmers grow **maize** in fields cut from the forest.

Maize is the base of almost every meal.

People also make a bitter drink from **cacao** beans.

Kings rule many great cities, each one on its own.

Some of these cities have tens of thousands of people.

Traders carry salt, jade, and bright feathers between the cities.

Centuries later, the **jungle** grows back over many empty cities.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide dawn view of a tall stepped stone pyramid rising above a dense green jungle canopy in Central America, seen from a distance across a river valley, mist drifting between the trees, no people visible up close.

A tall stone pyramid rises above the treetops of the jungle.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Olmecs
- ☒ **The Maya**
- ☐ The Toltecs
- ☐ The Aztecs

Grade 6

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Maya

jungle: a thick, hot forest with many trees and plants

maize: a tall plant with grain on it; another word is corn

cacao: the beans used to make chocolate

centuries: periods of one hundred years

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical close-up of a broken cacao pod held open in a brown-skinned Indigenous person's hand, revealing pale wet cacao beans inside, more whole yellow-red pods resting on a woven cloth below, soft dappled jungle light.

Cacao beans like these are ground and mixed into a drink.

FRONT

The X people of Guatemala and nearby lands never build one single empire.

Instead, they live in many separate city-states.

Cities such as Tikal and Calakmul often fight each other for power.

Each city has its own king, temples, and marketplace.

Priests and **scribes** write with small picture signs called **glyphs**.

These glyphs record kings, wars, and important dates.

Priests also build a careful calendar with many **cycles** of time.

Their calendar has a sign for zero, not borrowed from any other part of the world.

In many cities, people play a fast ball game on a stone court.

Players hit a solid **rubber** ball using only their hips and legs.

Winning a match can bring great honor to a whole city.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide daylight view of an empty stone ball court in a Central American city, two long parallel sloped stone benches with three flat round stone markers set in the playing alley, no rings on the walls, a wide grassy playing alley between them, jungle trees and a distant pyramid roofline behind, no players present.

An empty stone court where two teams once played a fast ball game.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Zapotecs
- ☐ The Mixtecs
- ☒ **The Maya**
- ☐ The Toltecs

Grade 9

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Maya

glyphs: small picture signs used for writing

scribes: people whose job is writing things down

cycles: sets of time that repeat again and again

rubber: a stretchy material made from tree sap

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical close-up of a solid dark rubber ball resting on a worn stone bench beside a simple padded cotton and leather hip belt, a sunlit stone ball court wall softly blurred behind.

Players strike this heavy rubber ball with their hips, not their hands.

FRONT

Priests among the X people study the sky with great care.

They track the path of Venus across many years.

Scribes paint long books made of folded bark paper.

These books hold the astronomy, the calendar, and the **rituals**.

In the 1520s, Spanish soldiers arrive and slowly conquer the region.

Some cities **resist** for generations, hidden deep in the forest.

In 1562, a Spanish priest named Landa orders many of these folded books burned.

He believes the books hold false and dangerous beliefs.

Almost all the books of a whole people turn to **ash**.

Only four of these folded books **survive** to the present day.

The very last free city does not fall until 1697.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide view of a tall carved stone monument standing alone in a quiet jungle clearing, photographed from behind and at a distance so no carved surface is legible, morning light filtering through the trees, thick moss on the base.

Standing stones like this once recorded the deeds and dates of kings.

Who are the X people?

☒ **The Maya**

☐ The Aztecs

☐ The Inca

☐ The Taíno

Grade 12

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Maya

rituals: special religious acts done in a fixed way

resist: to fight back and refuse to give up

ash: the gray powder left after something burns

survive: to continue to exist after a danger

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical scene of a closed folding book made of bark paper with painted but illegible covers, resting on a plain wooden table beside an unlit candle in a dim colonial room, seen at an angle so no inner pages are visible, a plain dark Spanish colonial robe sleeve at the table edge. The picture supports the idea of a book that survives.

Only a few of these folded books escaped destruction.

FRONT

The X people build many great cities across Central America.

Between about 800 and 950, many of these southern cities fall silent.

Kings stop raising new stone monuments there.

Farmers slowly leave the fields around the empty temples.

Historians still argue about the exact cause of this change.

Some point to long periods of severe **drought** in the region.

Others point to constant **warfare** between rival city-states.

Too many people may have also **strained** the land and its harvests.

Probably, several of these pressures strike at the same time.

Meanwhile, cities further north, like Chichén Itzá, keep on **thriving**.

So this is not a sudden end for every single city at once.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide view of an overgrown stone plaza in an abandoned Central American city, cracked flagstones pushed apart by tree roots, one fallen carved block half buried in vines, thick jungle closing in on all sides, soft hazy light.

Roots and vines slowly swallow a plaza that once was full of people.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Moche
- ☐ The Olmecs
- ☐ The Zapotecs
- ☒ **The Maya**

Grade 12

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Maya

drought: a long time with too little rain

warfare: fighting and war between groups

strained: pushed too hard, close to breaking

thriving: growing strong and doing very well

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a small abandoned field with dry, cracked earth and a few wilted brown maize stalks, a crumbling low stone wall in the background, harsh midday light and a dusty haze.

Long years without enough rain can empty even rich farmland.

FRONT

For centuries, no one can read the glyphs of the X people.

Early scholars guess wildly and often get the meaning wrong.

In the 1950s, a Soviet scholar named Knorozov studies the signs closely.

He argues that many glyphs **represent** sounds, not only whole ideas.

Later **decades** of careful research slowly confirm and extend his method.

By the late twentieth century, most glyphs can finally be read.

Meanwhile, a strange modern **myth** claims the world ends in 2012.

This idea comes from misreading part of the ancient calendar.

Historians and scholars of the X people reject this myth completely.

Today, **descendants** still live across the region and speak their own languages.

Many of them ask governments to respect their land and their rights.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide daylight view of a present-day village street in the highlands of Guatemala, a brown-skinned Indigenous woman seen from behind weaving a bright cloth on a backstrap loom tied to a wooden post, children in modern woven clothing walking past, low houses and green volcano slopes behind, no flags, no readable signs.

Their descendants still weave, farm, and speak their own languages today.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Inca
- ☒ **The Maya**
- ☐ The Mixtecs
- ☐ The Taíno

University

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Maya

descendants: people related to someone who lived long ago

myth: a story many people believe that is not true

represent: to stand for or show something else

decades: periods of ten years

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of an old wooden desk in a quiet mid-twentieth-century study, a magnifying glass and a pencil resting on a closed dark notebook, a stack of blank cards beside it, and a small worn stone fragment turned face down, warm desk lamp light.

Scholars spend decades matching the old signs to real sounds.

FRONT

The X people live in a high valley in Mexico.
Long ago, they build a city on an island in a lake.
Long roads of earth and stone lead across the water.

Farmers build small fields of rich mud in the **shallow** lake.

Canoes carry food and **goods** across the calm water every day.

A huge market at Tlatelolco sells food, cloth, and tools.

Spanish visitors later say they have never seen a market so big.

A great city keeps growing on the very same spot.
Today, that city is the **capital** of Mexico.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A wide view across a calm lake, seen from a hillside at a respectful distance, showing a stone city built on a small island and joined to the shore by long straight earthen causeways, with narrow canals cutting between the rooftops and a few small canoes moving on the water.

A city stands on an island, joined to the shore by long roads across the water.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Maya
- ☒ **The Aztecs**
- ☐ The Olmecs
- ☐ The Toltecs

Grade 6

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Aztecs

canoes: small boats that people move with paddles

goods: things that people buy, sell, or carry

capital: the main city of a country, where its government is

shallow: not deep, where the water is low

Picture in production

Picture brief: A vertical view of a narrow man-made island field of dark mud in shallow calm lake water, thick with rows of green maize and squash plants, young willow trees rooted along its low mud edge, a brown-skinned farmer in a plain undyed fibre wrap seen from behind poling a small dugout canoe past the plot.

Farmers grow food on man-made islands of rich mud in the shallow lake.

FRONT

The X people are a small group of newcomers.

They arrive in a valley in Mexico with a lake in the middle.

A story says their gods send them a sign, an eagle on a cactus.

They must build their city where they see this sign.

In 1325, they build Tenochtitlan on an island in that lake.

They dig canals so canoes can reach every part of the city.

A long raised stone channel called an **aqueduct** carries fresh water into the city.

In 1428, their city joins with two other cities in a strong **alliance**.

Together, the three cities defeat their old enemies and grow into an empire.

Conquered towns must now send **tribute**, such as food and cloth, at fixed times.

By the year 1500, historians **estimate** that about two hundred thousand people live in the city.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Low view along a raised fifteenth-century stone and plaster water channel, clear water flowing in the open channel in the foreground, the channel running beside an earthen causeway across a calm lake, a distant island city only a faint silhouette in morning haze, one small canoe far off.

Fresh water flows into the city along a long raised stone channel.

Who are the X people?☒ **The Aztecs**

☐ The Inca

☐ The Zapotecs

☐ The Purépecha

Grade 9

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Aztecs

alliance: an agreement between groups to work together

tribute: goods or money that a conquered people must give to a ruler

aqueduct: a long raised channel that carries water from far away

estimate: a careful guess based on facts

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical still life of tribute goods laid on a woven mat before a plain stone step, folded bundles of white cotton cloth, baskets of dried maize and beans, a small heap of green feathers and a string of jade beads, warm daylight.

Conquered towns send cloth, food, and feathers as tribute.

FRONT

The X people rule a rich empire from the valley of Mexico in the year 1519.

Spanish ships arrive on the coast that same year, led by a captain named Cortés.

Moctezuma, the ruler of the X people, receives the strangers at first with gifts.

Cortés finds **allies** among the people of Tlaxcala, old enemies of the X people.

These allies bring soldiers and knowledge of the land that prove **decisive**.

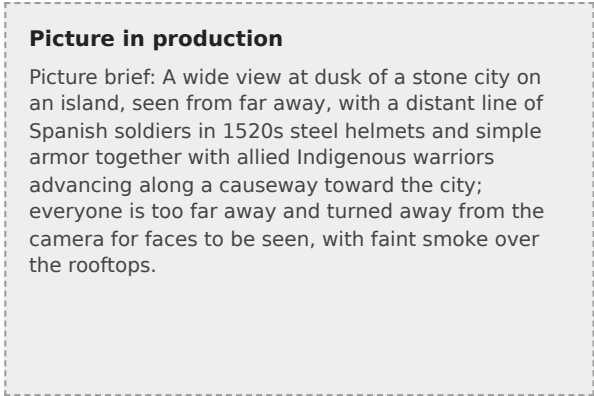
In 1520, a terrible sickness brought by the newcomers spreads through the city.

Thousands of the X people die of this new disease within months.

The weakened city cannot hold back the **siege** that follows in 1521.

After months of fighting, the city on the lake finally falls.

On its **ruins**, the newcomers build a new capital, Mexico City.



Soldiers and allies approach the city across the water at dusk.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Inca
- ☐ The Purépecha
- ☒ **The Aztecs**
- ☐ The Taíno

BACK

Answer: The Aztecs

allies: people who join and help you, especially in a fight

decisive: very important for deciding how something ends

siege: when soldiers surround a place and cut off help, to make it surrender

ruins: the broken parts left after a building or city is destroyed



New buildings slowly rise where old walls once stood.

FRONT

The X people build a great stepped temple at the heart of their capital in central Mexico.

They believe many different gods control rain, sun, and war.

As part of their religion, the X people also practice human **sacrifice**.

They use a complex calendar, with two counts of days that turn like wheels within wheels.

Priests read the calendar to choose lucky and unlucky days for important events.

Markets in the capital sell **maize**, beans, and a bitter drink made from **cacao** beans.

Farmers also grow a red fruit and a green fruit that Europeans have never tasted before.

After the conquest, sailors carry these foods, and their **Nahuatl** names, across the ocean to Europe.

Today, English speakers still use Nahuatl words such as chocolate and tomato.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide view from the base of a great stepped stone temple in a fifteenth-century Mesoamerican plaza, twin stairways rising steeply toward two small shrines side by side at the top, a thin trail of incense smoke, a few small distant brown-skinned figures in plain cloaks at the foot of the stairs seen from behind, no lake or city panorama.

A tall stepped temple rises at the heart of the city.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Maya
- ☐ The Zapotecs
- ☐ The Olmecs
- ☒ **The Aztecs**

Grade 12

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Aztecs

sacrifice: killing a person or animal as an offering to a god

cacao: the beans used to make chocolate

maize: a grain plant also known as corn

Nahuatl: a language spoken in central Mexico for many centuries

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical close-up still life of ripe red tomatoes, dark green avocados, one cut open, and a few green chili peppers on a woven cotton cloth beside a plain clay bowl, warm daylight.

Farmers here grow the red fruit and the green fruit that later travel to Europe.

FRONT

For centuries, many books tell the fall of the X people's capital as a Spanish **miracle**.

Modern historians see the story differently.

A handful of Spanish soldiers alone can never defeat such a large empire.

Tens of thousands of **indigenous** allies and a new disease decide the war.

Historians read Spanish letters and also indigenous **accounts**.

These accounts are written later in Nahuatl, using Latin letters.

Some Spanish writers boast, so historians read their letters with care.

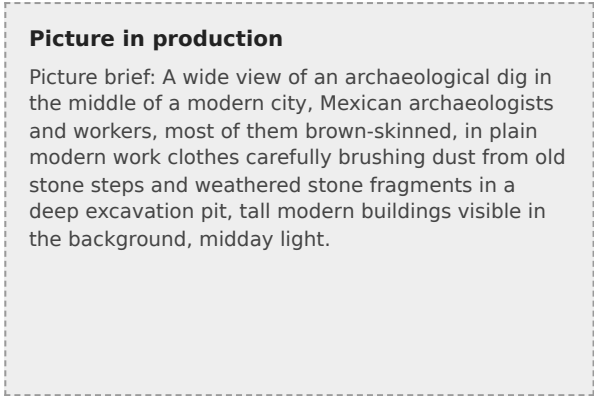
These sources often disagree about details and about who to blame.

In 1978, workers digging in Mexico City find a huge carved stone by chance.

Archaeologists then dig out the great temple beneath the streets.

They have studied the site ever since, and new objects still come to light.

Today, about one and a half million people still speak Nahuatl, the language of the X people.



Workers carefully uncover old stone steps hidden beneath a modern city.

Who are the X people?

- ☒ The Aztecs
- ☐ The Inca
- ☐ The Toltecs
- ☐ The Mixtecs

BACK

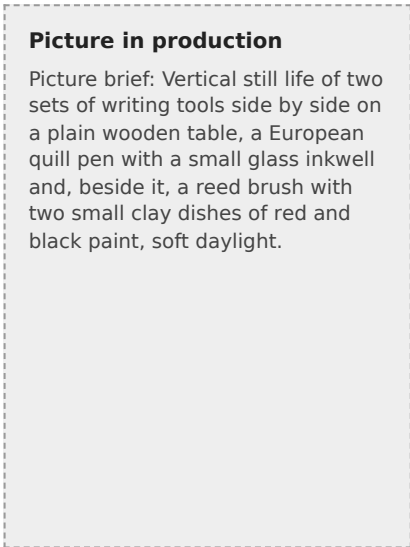
Answer: The Aztecs

indigenous: belonging to a place from the very beginning, before others arrived

accounts: stories or descriptions of events, especially written ones

archaeologists: people who study the past by digging up and examining old objects

miracle: an amazing event that seems impossible to explain



Two kinds of pens, two sides of the same story.

FRONT

The X people live high in the Andes mountains, long ago.

The land is steep, cold, and hard to farm.

Even so, families cut flat fields called **terraces** into the mountainsides.

There they grow potatoes and corn on many different levels.

They keep **herds** of llamas for wool, meat, and carrying loads.

Farmers freeze and dry potatoes to keep them for years.

Over deep **canyons**, people hang bridges of twisted rope.

The X people write no letters and no books.

Instead, they keep long knotted cords to record numbers and goods.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide daytime view of green stone-walled agricultural terraces stepping up a very steep Andean mountainside, a small herd of brown and white llamas grazing on one of the lower terraces, snow-capped peaks far behind, calm misty light, no people close enough for faces to be seen.

Families cut flat fields, called terraces, into the steep mountainside.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Aztecs
- ☐ The Moche
- ☒ **The Inca**
- ☐ The Nazca

Grade 6

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Inca

terraces: flat, step-like fields cut into the side of a steep hill

herds: groups of animals that live and move together

canyons: deep, narrow valleys with very steep sides

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a simple rope bridge woven from twisted plant fiber, stretching across a deep rocky canyon between two cliffs, a lone brown-skinned Indigenous Andean figure in 15th and 16th century Andean dress, a woven tunic, sandals, and a woollen cap, crossing at a distance seen from behind.

A bridge of twisted rope crosses the deep canyon.

FRONT

The X people build the largest empire in the Americas before European ships arrive.

Their capital, Cusco, lies high in the mountains and controls the whole empire.

Rulers divide the empire into four great parts, each with its own **governors**.

Roads link every part of the land.

Together they run about forty thousand kilometers. Along these roads, trained runners carry messages from **station** to station at great speed.

A message can travel more than two hundred kilometers in a single day.

Skilled builders raise walls of cut stone, fitted together without any **mortar**.

The stones fit so well that not even a thin knife can slide between them.

Even strong **earthquakes** rarely bring these walls down.

Picture in production

Picture brief: View of a massive ancient stone wall built from huge, perfectly fitted polygonal blocks with no mortar between them, warm late-afternoon light raking across the stone surface, a narrow empty street running alongside the base.

These huge stones fit together perfectly, without any mortar.

Who are the X people?

☒ **The Inca**

☐ The Maya

☐ The Chimú

☐ The Wari

Grade 9

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Inca

governors: people chosen to rule and manage one part of a land

mortar: a soft mix used between stones or bricks to hold them together

station: a fixed stopping place along a road or path

earthquakes: sudden shaking movements of the ground

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a lone brown-skinned Indigenous Andean runner in 15th and 16th century Andean dress, a woven tunic and sandals, moving fast along a narrow stone-paved mountain road that winds toward a small plain stone roadside shelter in the distance, dramatic peaks behind, seen from behind so no face is visible.

A runner carries a message toward the next resting station.

FRONT

The X people believe in a sun god who watches over the land.

They believe their ruler is a son of this sun god, sent to guide the people.

All **subjects** owe the ruler a share of their working time each year.

Some build roads and bridges, others farm the ruler's own fields.

Grain and dried food from these harvests fill thousands of stone **storehouses**.

In times of **drought** or disaster, rulers open the storehouses to feed the hungry.

High on a narrow mountain **ridge** in Peru, workers raise a small royal town around 1450.

Steep green peaks and thick cloud forest hide it from the world below.

For centuries, almost only local farmers know the ruins are there.

In 1911, local guides lead an American professor to the site, and photographs make it world famous.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide dawn view of an ancient stone town built along a narrow green mountain ridge, surrounded by steep cloud-covered peaks and drifting mist, curving terraced fields on the slopes below, no people visible up close.

A small mountain town on a high ridge, wrapped in morning cloud.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Tiwanaku
- ☐ The Chimú
- ☒ **The Inca**
- ☐ The Aztecs

Grade 12

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Inca

subjects: people who are ruled by a king, queen, or empire

storehouses: buildings where food or goods are kept safe for later

drought: a long period with too little rain

ridge: a long, narrow, high strip of land, like the top edge of a mountain

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a row of small rectangular stone storehouses with thatched roofs, built along a windy hillside above farm terraces, doors open to show plain sacks of grain inside, no people present.

Storehouses like these once held grain for hard years.

FRONT

A terrible new sickness kills the ruler of the X people in the late 1520s.

Spanish ships carry this sickness across the ocean even before Spanish soldiers arrive.

Two of the dead ruler's sons then fight a **civil war** over the throne.

The winner is a ruler named Atahualpa.

He hears of a small foreign army marching toward him, but he sees no danger.

In 1532, a Spanish **captain** named Pizarro meets Atahualpa in the town of Cajamarca.

Pizarro commands only about one hundred and seventy men.

Yet that same day, his men attack without warning, capture the ruler, and kill many unarmed followers.

To win his freedom, Atahualpa offers to fill a large room with gold and silver.

His people bring the **treasure**, but the Spanish keep both the gold and their prisoner.

In 1533, the Spanish put Atahualpa to death.

Fighting continues from a remote **stronghold** called Vilcabamba until 1572, when the last resistance ends.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Wide view of a stone-walled plaza in a mountain town, a small group of soldiers standing at one end, a ruler seated on a wooden litter carried by attendants at the other end, everyone shown from a respectful distance with no visible faces, tense but calm atmosphere, no violence shown.

A small group of soldiers meets a powerful ruler in a mountain town.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Maya
- ☒ **The Inca**
- ☐ The Aztecs
- ☐ The Mapuche

Grade 12

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Inca

civil war: a war between two groups from the same country

captain: an officer who leads soldiers or sailors

stronghold: a strong, well-protected place that is hard to attack

treasure: gold, silver, or other valuable things

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view inside a plain stone room, its floor covered with a growing pile of gold and silver vessels, cups, and ornaments, brought in by a line of brown-skinned Indigenous Andean carriers in 15th and 16th century Andean dress, woven tunics and sandals, seen from behind or at a distance, warm torchlight.

The room slowly fills with gold and silver, piece by piece.

FRONT

Historians still ask how a small foreign force conquers such a vast empire.

Deadly disease and a civil war already weaken the X people before the invaders come.

Groups who **resent** the ruling class also join the newcomers against their old rulers.

Horses and steel weapons give the small invading force another sharp **advantage**.

Scholars also study the X people's knotted cords, kept by trained **specialists**.

Everyone agrees the cords record numbers with great **accuracy**.

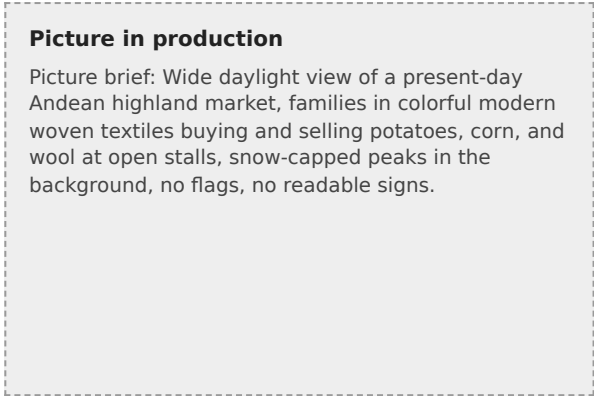
But experts still argue about whether the knots can also record words or stories.

No one has ever fully solved this old puzzle of pattern and color.

Quechua, the language the X people spread across their empire, lives on.

Eight to ten million people speak it today.

Their royal town high in the mountains now draws visitors from around the world.



Their descendants still live in the mountains and speak their own language today.

Who are the X people?

- ☐ The Nazca
- ☐ The Wari
- ☐ The Tiwanaku
- ☒ **The Inca**

University

Latin America

BACK

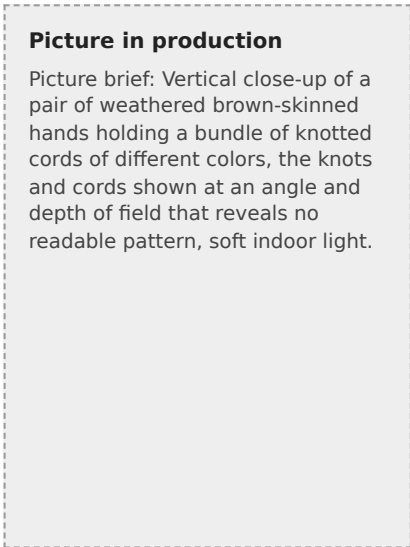
Answer: The Inca

specialists: people with special training and skill in one kind of work

accuracy: being exact and correct, without mistakes

advantage: something that helps one side do better than another

resent: to feel angry about something that seems unfair



Experts still argue about what these old knots can tell us.

FRONT

Revolution X begins on an island in the Caribbean Sea.

Ships carry many people there from Africa by **force**.

On the island, these people must work without pay in sugar fields.

Life there is hard, and many people suffer.

In 1791, the **enslaved** people **rise up** together against their **enslavers**.

They fight a long, hard war for many years.

In the end, they win, and they build their own new country.

It is the first country built by people who were once enslaved.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A wide 1790s Caribbean plantation landscape at midday: rows of tall sugar cane stretch toward low green hills, a small sugar mill with a large wheel and a cluster of simple wooden houses sit at the field's edge, a few workers in plain cotton clothing bend over the cane far in the distance.

On a Caribbean island, enslaved workers tend the sugar cane fields.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The French Revolution
- ☒ **The Haitian Revolution**
- ☐ The Mexican Revolution
- ☐ The Cuban Revolution

Grade 6

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Haitian Revolution

force: power used to make someone do something against their will

enslaved: forced by others to work without freedom or pay

enslavers: people who force other people into slavery

rise up: to fight back together against people in power

Picture in production

Picture brief: An eighteenth century three masted wooden sailing ship with square sails furled, at anchor off a palm lined Caribbean shore at dusk, seen from the beach at a distance, a small rowboat approaching the sand.

A ship arrives from across the ocean, carrying people who never chose to come.

FRONT

Revolution X takes place on France's richest **colony**.

Sugar and coffee from this colony bring in enormous wealth for France.

About half a million people there live **enslaved**.

A story says that in August 1791, secret leaders meet at night in a forest.

Tradition says that there, they plan a great **uprising** together.

Soon after, the uprising begins, and it spreads fast across the north of the colony.

A formerly enslaved man named Toussaint Louverture becomes its leader.

Two years later, French officials in the colony end slavery there.

The next year, France declares an end to slavery in all of its colonies too.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A column of Black Caribbean soldiers in worn 1790s coats and wide straw hats marches along a dirt road at dawn, seen entirely from behind, muskets over their shoulders, mist rising from fields on either side.

An army grows on the island, ready to fight for its own freedom.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Russian Revolution
- ☐ The American Revolution
- ☒ **The Haitian Revolution**
- ☐ The Mexican Revolution

Grade 9

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Haitian Revolution

colony: a land ruled and controlled by another, distant country

enslaved: forced by others to work without freedom or pay

tradition: a story or custom passed down from earlier times

uprising: a sudden, organized fight against those in power

Picture in production

Picture brief: A quiet forest clearing at night, seen from a distance among dark tree trunks, a faint orange glow of firelight flickers deep between the trees, no people visible.

Tradition says that in a forest at night, leaders once made a secret plan.

FRONT

By 1801, Revolution X has changed the whole colony.

Toussaint Louverture now governs the colony as its leader.

That year, he issues a new **constitution** for the land.

The new **ruler** of France does not accept this.

In 1802, his large army arrives from across the ocean to take back control.

French soldiers **capture** Toussaint Louverture and send him to a prison in France.

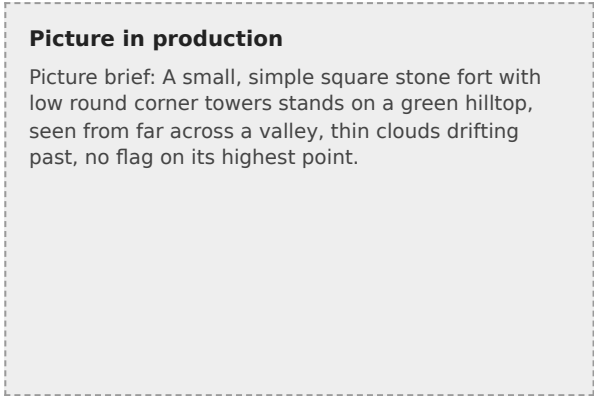
He dies there in 1803, far from home.

But the fighting continues without him under a new leader, Dessalines.

His fighters hold out in small forts high in the mountains.

In November 1803, his forces win a **decisive** battle at Vertières.

On the first day of January 1804, the colony declares its independence.



In the mountains, forts like this shelter the fighters of the island.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☒ **The Haitian Revolution**
- ☐ The Cuban Revolution
- ☐ The Texas Revolution
- ☐ The French Revolution

BACK

Answer: The Haitian Revolution

constitution: a written set of rules for how a country is governed

capture: to catch and hold a person by force

decisive: a decisive event settles a struggle clearly, once and for all

ruler: a person who holds the power to govern a country



Far from home, a leader is held alone in a cold stone cell.

FRONT

Freedom for Revolution X comes at a heavy price.

In 1804, the new nation's soldiers kill most of the French people still living in the new country.

Many other nations still hold enslaved people.

They **refuse** to accept this new free state.

For decades, hardly any country will **recognize** it as a free and equal nation.

In 1825, France demands payment for its lost colony and **threatens** war.

The new nation agrees to pay a huge **debt** in return for being recognized and left alone.

It takes more than a hundred years to pay this debt in full.

Money that could build schools and roads goes abroad instead.

The United States does not recognize the new nation until 1862.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A long, empty wooden negotiating table stands in a grand room with tall shuttered windows, a few quill pens and blank sheets of paper resting on its surface, soft daylight falling across the wood.

An empty table waits for an agreement between two very unequal sides.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The American Revolution
- ☒ **The Haitian Revolution**
- ☐ The Cuban Revolution
- ☐ The Mexican Revolution

Grade 12

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Haitian Revolution

debt: money that you owe and must pay back

recognize: to officially accept a new country as real and equal

refuse: to say no and not agree to something

threatens: warns of harm or danger unless something happens

Picture in production

Picture brief: A brass balance scale on a dark wooden desk, a plain heavy cloth money bag tied with string on one side and a folded blank paper on the other, the scale tilted toward the bag, soft lamplight.

Money on one side, a paper promise on the other.

FRONT

Historians call Revolution X the only fully successful **revolt** of enslaved people in history.

Yet for a long time, many history books in Europe barely mention it.

Some historians ask why such an important event stays at the **margins** for so long.

One suggestion is that the revolt **frightened** other slave-holding nations at the time.

The debt paid to France after independence still shapes debates about justice today.

Most written **sources** about the war come from the French side, not from the fighters.

Historians also debate how this revolt changed the fight against slavery in other lands.

When the new nation forms in 1804, it takes an old name once used by the island's first people.

That name replaces the name given by earlier European settlers.

Historians still study why this revolt succeeded when so many others failed.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A modern classroom in a Caribbean town seen from the back: Black schoolchildren in plain uniforms listen to a teacher standing beside a completely blank blackboard, sunlight through open wooden shutters.

Today, students learn the story that many books in Europe long left out.

Which revolution is Revolution X?

- ☐ The Cuban Revolution
- ☐ The Russian Revolution
- ☒ **The Haitian Revolution**
- ☐ The Texas Revolution

University

Latin America

BACK

Answer: The Haitian Revolution

revolt: an organized fight by people against those in power

margins: the edges of something, far from the main attention

frightened: made afraid of something

sources: the old letters, reports, and papers that historians use to learn about the past

Picture in production

Picture brief: Close-up of a hand tracing a finger along the plain outline of an island shape drawn on old, blank paper, an invented island shape that does not match any real island, no place names or labels anywhere, warm desk light.

An old island outline, waiting for a new name to replace an old one.

FRONT

Mr X is born in Caracas, a city in South America.
His family is very rich and important.
Mr X becomes an **orphan** when he is still a boy.
A wise teacher shapes how he sees the world.
As a young man, he travels far away to Europe.
There he hears new ideas about freedom and **self rule**.
He comes home and joins the fight for freedom.
He wants his **homeland** to rule itself.
He does not want a distant king to rule it.
He fights for many years against the king's armies.
He helps free several countries from Spanish rule.
Today, a whole country carries his name.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A wide colonial plaza in Caracas in the 1790s, seen from a raised corner at a distance, tall church towers and pale stone buildings around an open square, a horse drawn carriage crossing the cobbles, small mixed groups of white creole families, mestizo vendors, and Black and Indigenous workers going about their day in the background, no one facing the camera.

Mr X grows up in a rich and important family in a city near the coast.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ José de San Martín
- ☒ **Simón Bolívar**
- ☐ Francisco de Miranda
- ☐ Bernardo O'Higgins

Grade 6

Latin America

BACK

Answer: Simón Bolívar

orphan: a child whose parents have both died
self rule: when a place is governed by its own people, not by a king far away
homeland: the country where you are born and belong

Picture in production

Picture brief: Inside a grand colonial house, a boy in plain dark 1790s clothes stands alone at a tall window overlooking an empty courtyard, seen entirely from behind, soft grey daylight, quiet and solemn mood, no other people in the room.

As a boy, Mr X loses both his parents and grows up without them.

FRONT

By his own account, in 1805, Mr X swears on a hill in Rome to free his homeland.

He is still a young man, and his old teacher stands beside him.

Years later, in 1810, a local **council** in Caracas removes the king's governor and starts to rule on its own.

War follows, and for years Mr X loses more battles than he wins.

Twice he must flee into **exile**, his cause nearly dead.

A free Black republic in the Caribbean then gives him ships, guns, and money.

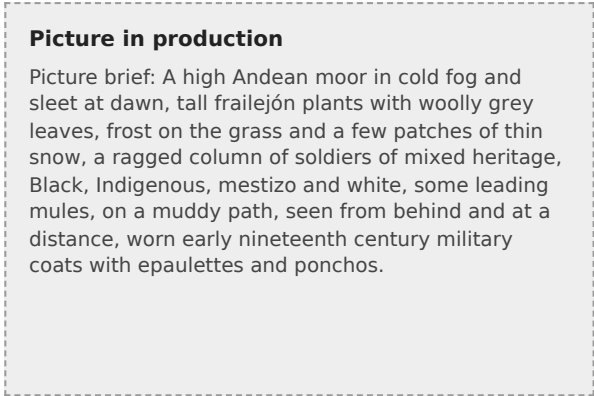
In return, Mr X promises to free enslaved people in the lands he frees.

In 1819, he leads a **ragged** army up into the freezing Andes.

Many soldiers and horses die from cold on the high mountain paths.

Coming down the other side, his army surprises the king's soldiers.

At a battle called Boyacá, Mr X wins an important victory.



High in the cold mountains, Mr X and his soldiers march on through ice and fog.

Who is Mr X?

- ☒ **Simón Bolívar**
- ☐ Toussaint Louverture
- ☐ Miguel Hidalgo
- ☐ José de San Martín

BACK

Answer: **Simón Bolívar**

council: a group of people chosen to govern or make decisions together

exile: living far from your own country, often because it is not safe to return

ragged: worn out, torn, and in poor condition



After years of defeat, the ragged army rests before its hardest march.

FRONT

Mr X helps build a large new **republic** uniting several lands in the north of South America.

In 1821, his forces win a major battle that secures his homeland for the republic.

In 1822, more victories free the mountain city of Quito, and the **port** of Guayaquil joins his republic.

That same year, Mr X meets a leader from the south, José de San Martín, at Guayaquil.

The two men talk alone, and afterward San Martín quietly leaves the independence struggle.

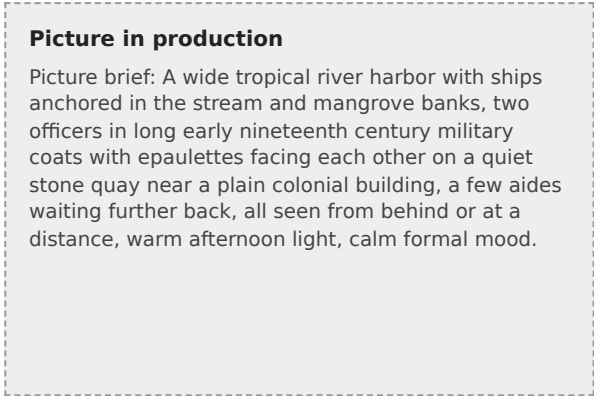
Mr X presses on to finish the fight in Peru.

In 1824, his general Antonio José de Sucre wins a **decisive** battle at Ayacucho.

That victory decides the war, and Spanish rule in South America soon ends.

The next year, a new country high in the mountains takes shape.

Grateful leaders there name the new country after Mr X himself.



Two leaders from different wars of independence meet quietly in a port city.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Bernardo O'Higgins
- ☐ Francisco de Miranda
- ☒ **Simón Bolívar**
- ☐ José Martí

BACK

Answer: Simón Bolívar

republic: a country governed by chosen leaders, not by a king or queen

port: a town by the water where ships load and unload

decisive: settling a matter completely, with a clear result



Leaders gather here to shape the laws of the new republic.

FRONT

Early in the wars, in 1813, Mr X signs a strict order. It declares war to the death against Spaniards who will not join the cause.

In 1828, Mr X takes near total power over the great republic he built.

Critics now call him a **dictator**, ruling almost like the kings he once fought.

One night, armed men break into his house to kill him.

His **companion**, Manuela Sáenz, helps him escape through a window, then faces the attackers herself.

Mr X survives, but more and more people now turn against his rule.

In 1830, the great republic starts to break apart into separate countries.

Worn out and ill, Mr X gives up all his power that same year.

He is said to write that he has only **ploughed** the sea.

He dies later that year in Santa Marta, a small coastal town, of a lung illness.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A quiet colonial street at night, a lone figure climbs out through a low window of a plain house into a dark garden, seen from a distance and from behind, while a second figure stands firm in the lit doorway facing a group of armed men approaching from the far end of the street, torchlight, tense but calm mood, no visible faces, no violence shown.

One night, armed men come for Mr X, but his companion helps him escape.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ José Martí
- ☐ Emiliano Zapata
- ☐ Antonio José de Sucre
- ☒ **Simón Bolívar**

BACK

Answer: Simón Bolívar

dictator: a ruler with total power, not chosen freely by the people

companion: a person who stays close to you and helps and supports you

ploughed: turned over the soil to prepare it for planting

Picture in production

Picture brief: A crowd of townspeople in 1820s dress fills a plaza and looks up at a balcony where one small distant figure in a dark military coat stands alone, seen from behind the crowd, no faces, no flags, no emblems, no text, no letters, no numbers.

Near the end, Mr X rules almost alone, with power that few dare question.

FRONT

Historians still debate whether Mr X is mainly a hero or a dictator.

In a letter written from Jamaica in 1815, he doubts that his region is ready for full democracy.

He argues that strong, **central government** may be needed to hold new nations together.

Later, he rules with far more personal power than most elected leaders.

Some historians stress his vision of united, independent nations, free from European crowns.

Others stress his growing **distrust** of ordinary people ruling themselves.

After his death, his name and image are used by very different political movements.

Today, coins, cities, and squares across the region still carry his name.

Modern politicians across the region still **invoke** his name and legacy.

Historians study his letters and speeches to separate the man from the myth.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A cozy writing desk in an early nineteenth century study, lit by a single candle, a folded letter tied with a plain dark ribbon, a quill standing in an inkwell, a blank sheet beside it, a small closed leather trunk nearby, the page never showing writing.

From exile, Mr X writes a long letter about the future of his region.

Who is Mr X?

- ☐ Antonio José de Sucre
- ☐ José de San Martín
- ☐ George Washington
- ☒ **Simón Bolívar**

University

Latin America

BACK

Answer: Simón Bolívar

central government: one strong government that holds power over a whole country

distrust: a feeling of not trusting someone or something

invoke: to name or use something as a reason or support for an argument

Picture in production

Picture brief: An empty weathered stone pedestal standing alone in a quiet park at dusk, no statue on top, soft fading light, a few fallen leaves at its base, no people present.

Long after his death, people still argue over how to remember Mr X.

FRONT

Empire X starts as a small state.

A Turkish prince leads this small state.

Its home is a place called Anatolia.

Slowly, the small state grows into a huge empire.

Close by, across a narrow **strait**, stands a great old city.

In 1453, Empire X takes this city.

This city becomes the empire's capital.

It lies where Europe meets Asia.

The ruler of Empire X is called the **sultan**.

The empire grows until it rules land on three **continents**.

Its gardeners also grow **tulips**, bright flowers that Europe soon loves too.

Empire X rules for about six hundred years.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Photo of a historic skyline seen from across calm water at dawn: many rounded domes and tall slender minarets rising above an old hillside town, warm golden haze in the distance.

Domes and towers rise over one of the empire's great cities.

Which empire is Empire X?

- ☐ The Roman Empire
- ☐ The Mongol Empire
- ☒ **The Ottoman Empire**
- ☐ The Byzantine Empire

Grade 6

Middle East

BACK

Answer: The Ottoman Empire

continents: large areas of land; Earth has seven of them

sultan: the ruler of the empire, like a king

tulips: garden flowers shaped like small cups

strait: a narrow passage of water between two lands

Picture in production

Picture brief: Photo close-up of many colorful tulips growing in neat rows in a formal garden, petals shaped like small cups, soft morning light.

Gardeners in the empire grow flowers shaped like small cups.

FRONT

Empire X grows fast during the 1400s and 1500s.

In 1453, a young ruler named Mehmed II takes a great walled city.

Huge new cannons smash through walls that stood for a thousand years.

The old city becomes the empire's new **capital**.

Later, a ruler named Süleyman issues new laws for the whole empire.

People call him a great **lawgiver** because of this work.

In 1526, his army wins a big battle called Mohács.

By 1529, his soldiers stand outside the gates of Vienna.

Many soldiers in this army are **janissaries**.

As boys, janissaries are taken from Christian families inside the empire.

They grow up as soldiers and **officials** loyal only to the ruler.

Picture in production

Picture brief: A giant plain bronze cannon lashed to a wooden sledge and hauled by teams of oxen along a dirt road toward distant grey city walls, drivers in 1450s dress seen from behind, overcast light.

Oxen pull a huge cannon toward the old walls.

Which empire is Empire X?

☒ **The Ottoman Empire**

☐ The Habsburg Empire

☐ The Byzantine Empire

☐ The Safavid Empire

Grade 9

Middle East

BACK

Answer: The Ottoman Empire

janissaries: soldiers in the ruler's own army, once taken from families as boys

lawgiver: a person who makes new laws for a whole country

officials: people who do official work for the ruler or the state

capital: the main city of a land, where the ruler lives

Picture in production

Picture brief: Illustration of a line of soldiers marching away from the viewer, seen only from behind, wearing tall pale felt caps and long kaftans, 15th to 16th century dress, dusty road.

These soldiers once were boys taken from Christian families.

FRONT

By the 1500s, Empire X is home to many peoples and many faiths.

Christians, Jews, and Muslims all live inside its borders.

Each religious **community** handles its own family law, its own schools, and its own places of worship.

Later, historians often call this the **millet** system.

In the capital, a gifted **architect** named Sinan designs great mosques.

His huge **domes** seem to rest lightly on rings of small windows.

Traders travel across the empire's lands between Asia and Europe.

Through these lands, a new dark drink called coffee first reaches Europe.

Coffee houses open in many cities, and people gather there to talk.

In this way, one empire connects three continents through trade and ideas.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Calm illustration of a quiet stone courtyard with a small fountain: several small groups of men and women of different skin tones in varied 16th century dress, turbans and kaftans, dark coats and brimmed caps, long robes and small caps, head scarves, sitting and talking, seen from behind or at a distance, no faces clearly visible. Shows many peoples living side by side.

Many different peoples share the streets of the empire's cities.

Which empire is Empire X?

- ☐ The Mughal Empire
- ☒ **The Ottoman Empire**
- ☐ The Abbasid Caliphate
- ☐ The Safavid Empire

Grade 12

Middle East

BACK

Answer: The Ottoman Empire

architect: a person who plans and designs buildings

domes: round roofs, shaped like half of a ball

millet: here: a religious group that handles its own family law and schools

community: a group of people who share the same faith or life

Picture in production

Picture brief: Warm illustration of the inside of an old coffee house, seen from behind the customers: men in kaftans and turbans sit on cushions around low wooden tables holding small cups, soft lamplight. Explains the empire's role in bringing coffee to Europe.

In coffee houses like this, people gather to talk and drink coffee.

FRONT

In the 1800s, other countries call Empire X the sick man of Europe.

This name means people think the empire is slowly dying.

From 1839, new **reforms** try to modernize laws, schools, and the army.

The reforms bring some change, but many old problems remain.

Railways and telegraph lines slowly connect the far parts of the empire.

In the early 1900s, wars in the Balkans strip away more land.

In 1914, the empire enters a great war on Germany's side.

During this war, from 1915, the government orders the killing of most of the empire's Armenian **population**.

Historians today call this killing a **genocide**.

The great war ends badly, and foreign armies **occupy** parts of the empire.

Empire X finally ends in 1922, after about six hundred years.

In 1923, a leader later called Atatürk helps create a new republic.

Picture in production

Picture brief: Quiet illustration of an empty grand council room: cushions and low benches line the walls, a low wooden table stands in the center, tall windows let in soft afternoon light. Shows the setting of the empire's reform meetings.

In rooms like this, officials meet to plan new reforms.

Which empire is Empire X?

- ☐ The Habsburg Empire
- ☐ The Russian Empire
- ☐ The Mughal Empire
- ☒ **The Ottoman Empire**

Grade 12

Middle East

BACK

Answer: The Ottoman Empire

reforms: changes made to laws or systems to make them better

genocide: the planned killing of very many people from one group

occupy: when an army moves into a place and controls it by force

population: all the people who live in one place

Picture in production

Picture brief: Photo of an old railway track curving through dry hills, a small 19th century steam locomotive with a tall chimney visible far in the distance, trailing faint smoke. Shows the empire's late attempts at modern reform.

Railways slowly connect the far parts of the empire.

FRONT

For a long time, **historians** told a simple story about Empire X: slow decline.

New research questions this simple story.

They argue that for centuries the empire is not weak, only changing.

It rules very different peoples, languages, and faiths inside one system.

Some historians now call it a **plural** society rather than a dying giant.

The empire finally ends in the 1920s, after political and military **crises**.

For a long time, historians relied mostly on European reports about the empire.

Today, they also read the empire's own records, kept in huge **archives** in Istanbul.

Governments still argue over how to name the killing of the Armenians in 1915, which most historians call a genocide.

Ideas from this empire, and the borders drawn when it fell, still shape the Middle East and the Balkans today.

Picture in production

Picture brief: An old covered stone market street with rows of arches and small shops, modern shoppers in today's clothes seen from behind, warm lamplight. Shows that buildings from the empire's time are still in daily use.

Markets built in the empire's time are still busy today.

Which empire is Empire X?

☒ **The Ottoman Empire**

☐ The Mongol Empire

☐ The Abbasid Caliphate

☐ The Russian Empire

University

Middle East

BACK

Answer: The Ottoman Empire

plural: made of many different parts, not just one

crises: very serious, dangerous moments; one of them is a crisis

archives: places where old records and papers are kept

historians: people who study the past

Picture in production

Picture brief: Vertical view of a narrow old stone street in a hill town of the Balkans, a slender minaret at the far end and a church bell tower nearer, washing lines between houses, no people.

In many towns, buildings from the empire's time still stand side by side.